**Supplementary Information**

# Few biological parameters suffice to reproduce measured dynamics in systems biology models: local sensitivity-based reduction with formal verification of the mathematical foundations

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## Supplementary Note: Selected subsets of the benchmark problems

Supplementary Table S1 gives the final subset $S$ for each problem (after backward elimination), the parameters removed by backward elimination, and the quantities that characterise the subset at ±5%: condition number $\kappa$ and largest VIF of the selected sensitivity columns (no collinearity: both $\leq 10$), fraction of sensitivity energy kept $R_{\text{var}}$, median $\cos\Delta$ over the 15 scenarios, and median $e_{\text{fit}}$ (admissibility: $\leq 43.6\%$). The last column gives the level of guarantee of each admissible subset: level 1, $e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ (the subset reproduces the full model after re-estimation, checked numerically); level 2, in addition $\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ (by Theorem 1 a single rescaling of the reduced response already achieves the threshold); level 3, in addition $R_{\text{var}} \geq 0.89$ (the first-order error bound G1 of Supplementary Note *Logical sequence of the formal proofs* also applies). Levels 2 and 3 are stronger guarantees, not requirements of the method; 14, 15 and 2 problems reach levels 1, 2 and 3. Calibration parameters, which are always re-estimated, are not listed. Crauste, Beer and Lang have no admissible subset; the subset at which the method stopped is shown. For Crauste it is not meaningful: about half of the perturbed simulations have no solution on the measured horizon (finite-time growth without bound), so the sensitivity matrix is incomplete.

**Supplementary Table S1.** Selected biological parameters of each benchmark problem and characteristics of the subset.

| System | Selected biological parameters $S$ | Removed by backward elimination | $\kappa$ | VIF | $R_{\text{var}}$ (%) | $\cos\Delta$ | $e_{\text{fit}}$ (%) | Level |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | kt, k_rep_nhej | – | 1.3 | 1.1 | 94 | 0.98 | 12.1 | 3 |
| Armistead | k_d, k00 | – | 1.0 | 1.0 | 58 | 0.81 | 33.0 | 1 |
| Bachmann | CISRNADelay, JAK2ActEpo | – | 2.8 | 2.5 | 36 | 0.85 | 33.7 | 1 |
| Beer | kdegi_typeIDT1, kdegi_typeIDT3, ksyn_typeIDT3, kdim_typeIDT1, beta_typeIDT3_ExpID2, beta_typeIDT3_ExpID3, beta_typeIDT3_ExpID5, beta_typeIDT3_ExpID1, beta_typeIDT3_ExpID4, init_Bac, beta_typeIDT1_ExpID6, beta_typeIDT1_ExpID5, beta_typeIDT1_ExpID1, beta_typeIDT1_ExpID4, beta_typeIDT1_ExpID3, kdim_typeIDwt, ksyn_typeIDT5, kdim_typeIDT5 | – | 7.2 | 10.0 | 71 | 0.82 | 50.1 | – |
| Bertozzi | R0_NY, I0_NY | – | 3.9 | 4.3 | 78 | 0.92 | 32.9 | 2 |
| Blasi | a_basal, a_k16_k12k16 | a_k12k16_k8k12k16, a_k5k12_k5k8k12, a_k8k12k16_4ac | 1.8 | 1.4 | 79 | 0.91 | 40.2 | 2 |
| Boehm | k_imp_hetero, k_phos | – | 1.0 | 1.0 | 68 | 0.93 | 9.4 | 2 |
| Borghans | Kz, K_par | – | 2.7 | 2.4 | 21 | 0.86 | 4.3 | 1 |
| Brannmark | k1f, km2 | – | 1.9 | 1.4 | 32 | 0.85 | 7.8 | 1 |

| System | Selected biological parameters $S$ | Removed by backward elimination | $\kappa$ | VIF | $R_{\text{var}}$ (%) | $\cos\Delta$ | $e_{\text{fit}}$ (%) | Level |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bruno | kb1, init_bcar2, init_zea_1, init_bcar1, init_bcry_1 | szea, init_b10_1 | 2.3 | 1.6 | 75 | 0.90 | 37.8 | 2 |
| Chen | k106, k44 | – | 1.0 | 1.0 | 25 | 0.90 | 8.2 | 1 |
| Crauste | rho_E | – | 1.0 | 1.0 | 0 | 0.53 | n.d. | – |
| Elowitz | n_Hill, tau_mRNA | tau_prot, tau_prot_GFP, eff | 2.9 | 2.6 | 70 | 0.89 | 35.8 | 1 |
| Fiedler | tau2, k6 | – | 1.5 | 1.2 | 42 | 0.87 | 14.7 | 1 |
| Fujita | init_AKT, reaction_6_k1 | – | 2.3 | 1.9 | 36 | 0.77 | 29.4 | 1 |
| Giordano | alpha_4, alpha_28 | – | 3.7 | 3.9 | 74 | 0.97 | 5.8 | 2 |
| Isensee | kf_RIIp_C_2__RII_C_2, xi_kf_RII_C_2__RII_2 | ks_AC_cAMP, KD_cAMP, xi_AC_cAMP_Fsk, kf_RIIp_cAMP_C_2__RIIp_2, kf_RII_2__RII_C_2 | 1.0 | 1.0 | 68 | 0.87 | 7.6 | 1 |
| Lang | kDeE2f1, kDeCe, kDeCa2, kPhCAEB, kDpCdh, kImImSKP2_1, kImImCDKN1A_CCNE_A_B_Ser130p__1, ic_wt_Nuc__CDKN1B_CCNE_A_Thr187p_, ic_wt_Cyt__CDKN1B_CCNE_A_Thr187u_, ic_wt_Nuc__SKP2, ic_wt_Cyt__CCNE_CDKN1A_B_, ic_wt_Cyt__SKP2, ic_wt_Cyt__CCNE_CDKN1A_B_1__CDKN1A_CCNE_A_B_1_Ser130u_ | – | 8.7 | 10.0 | 17 | 0.73 | 56.4 | – |
| Laske | k_imp, k_syn_R_M | k_bind_M1 | 1.4 | 1.1 | 84 | 0.99 | 10.1 | 2 |
| Liu | kappa, phi | – | 1.3 | 1.1 | 81 | 0.92 | 26.1 | 2 |
| Lucarelli | init_Rec, S2tot, S3tot, S_dephosphos, S_phos, geneF_turn, k_234, geneK_turn, S4tot, geneH_turn | – | 6.5 | 9.8 | 64 | 0.81 | 43.5 | 1 |
| Okuonghae | transmission_rate_effective, gamma_i | – | 1.3 | 1.1 | 53 | 1.00 | 4.1 | 2 |
| Oliveira | beta_0, h_hosp_rate | – | 1.2 | 1.0 | 47 | 0.95 | 12.9 | 2 |
| Perelson | c, delta | – | 1.9 | 1.5 | 100 | 1.00 | 0.0 | 3 |
| Rahman | infected_moderate_transmission_rate, infected_normal_worsen_rate | – | 5.9 | 9.3 | 60 | 0.97 | 3.7 | 2 |
| Raia | SOCS3mRNA_production, init_Rec_i | – | 5.5 | 8.1 | 69 | 1.00 | 3.3 | 2 |
| Raimundez | kdeg_membran__MKN1, ka_MAPK__MKN1 | – | 1.3 | 1.1 | 42 | 0.79 | 18.7 | 1 |
| SalazarCavazos | ratio_kpkd_Y1068__FREE, ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE | – | 5.4 | 7.9 | 84 | 0.97 | 18.7 | 2 |

| System | Selected biological parameters $S$ | Removed by backward elimination | $\kappa$ | VIF | $R_{\text{var}}$ (%) | $\cos\Delta$ | $e_{\text{fit}}$ (%) | Level |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Schwen | ini_R1, ini_R2fold | – | 3.1 | 3.0 | 46 | 0.93 | 17.1 | 2 |
| Smith | k8, kminus7b | – | 3.2 | 3.1 | 41 | 0.96 | 7.8 | 2 |
| Sneyd | l4, l2 | – | 1.1 | 1.0 | 44 | 0.88 | 38.1 | 1 |
| Weber | s12, a21 | – | 3.7 | 4.0 | 25 | 0.41 | 4.1 | 1 |
| Zhao | R_Stage_I_China, R_Stage_II_Wuhan, gamma_1_Stage_I_Hubei | – | 1.2 | 1.0 | 69 | 0.90 | 29.6 | 2 |
| Zheng | k01_02, k13_12 | – | 1.4 | 1.1 | 35 | 0.57 | 30.0 | 1 |

## Supplementary Note: Notation of the method

Supplementary Table S2 defines the symbols of the method used in the main text and in this Supplementary Information, with the values used in the analyses. Supplementary Table S3, at the end of this note, gives the number of parameters of every problem in each category and the number of free parameters in each analysis, so that the counts reported in different tables (for example $p = 9$ for Boehm in Table 1 of the main text and six biological parameters in its profile likelihood) can be reconciled.

**Supplementary Table S2.** Notation of the method.

| Symbol | Meaning | Value used |
|---|---|---|
| $x(t;\theta) \in \mathbb{R}^n$ | state trajectory of the model $\dot{x} = f(x,\theta)$ | – |
| $\theta \in \mathbb{R}^p$, $\theta_0$ | parameter vector; nominal (published) value | PEtab nominal values |
| $\Theta_B$, $\Theta_C$ | biological parameters (in the SBML model) and calibration parameters (observation scalings and offsets) | from the PEtab tables |
| $y_i(\theta) = h(g_i(x(t_i),\theta))/\sigma_i$ | $i$-th scaled output: observable $g_i$, transformation $h$ (lin, log, $\log_{10}$), noise s.d. $\sigma_i$, at the condition and time of measurement $i$ | PEtab measurement table |
| $J = \partial y/\partial \log\theta \in \mathbb{R}^{m\times p}$ | relative sensitivity matrix (central differences, step $\delta$) | $\delta = 0.01$ |
| $E_j = \|J_{:,j}\|^2$ | sensitivity energy of parameter $j$ | – |
| $R_{\text{var}}(S)$ | fraction of the energy of biological parameters captured by $S$ | $\tau_R = 0.89$ |
| $s_j$ | finite-perturbation effect of parameter $j$ (stage-2 ordering) | $\eta = 0.1$ |
| $\kappa(S)$, VIF$(S)$ | condition number and largest variance inflation factor of the normalised columns of $J_S$ | $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\text{VIF}} = 10$ |
| $\Delta y_{\text{full}}$, $\Delta y_S$ | output change when all parameters, or only those in $S \cup \Theta_C$, take their scenario values | $N = 15$, $\varepsilon = 0.05$ |
| $\cos\Delta$ | cosine similarity between $\Delta y_{\text{full}}$ and $\Delta y_S$ | – |
| $e_{\text{rel}}$ | relative error without re-estimation | – |
| $e_{\text{fit}}$ | relative error after re-estimating $\theta_S$ and $\theta_C$ | – |
| $\tau_e = \sqrt{1-c^2}$ | admissibility threshold on the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ | $c = 0.9$, $\tau_e = 0.436$ |

**Supplementary Table S2.** Notation of the method.

| Symbol | Meaning | Value used |
|---|---|---|
| $k_{\min}$ | minimum subset size | 2 |
| $\chi^2/n$ | mean squared noise-scaled residual on test data | – |
| $e_{\text{pred}}$ | relative prediction error with respect to a known truth (synthetic experiment) | – |

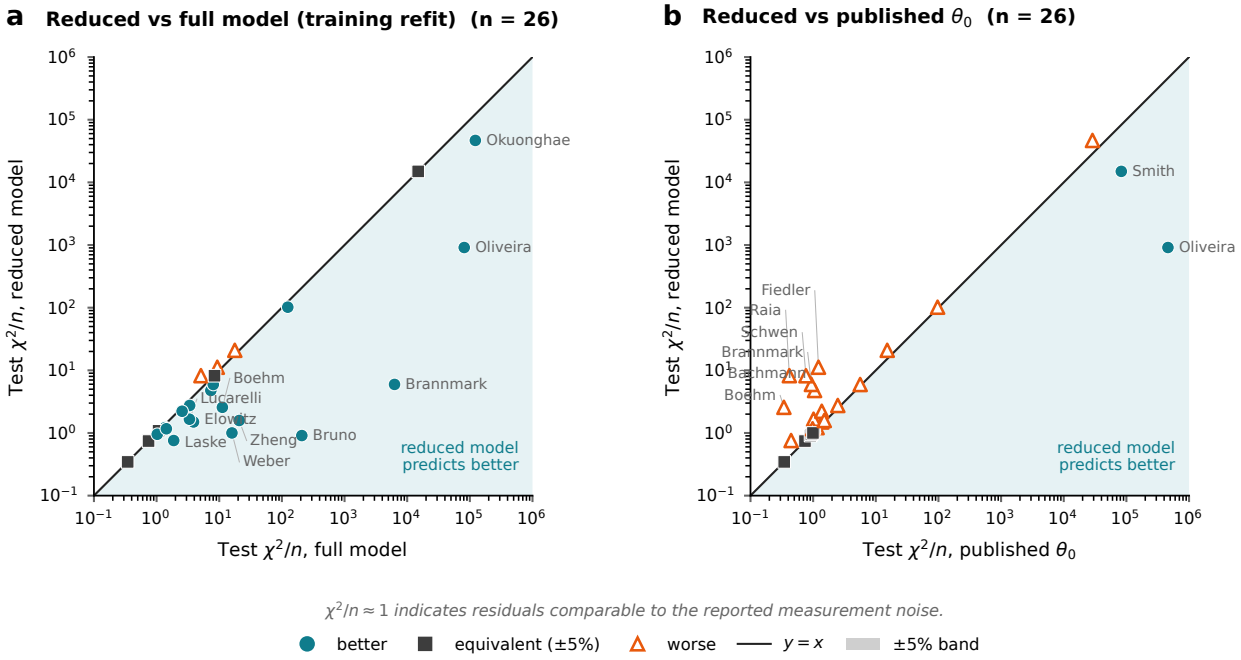
**Supplementary Table S3.** Parameter counts of every problem. $p$: parameters estimated in the PEtab problem (Table 1 of the main text), split into biological parameters (of the SBML model or of the condition table; candidates for selection), calibration parameters $\Theta_C$ (scalings and offsets of the observables, always re-estimated) and noise parameters (they enter only the standard deviation $\sigma_i$, which is evaluated at $\theta_0$ and kept fixed). Full-model profile: biological / free parameters in the profile likelihood of the full model on the training data, which excludes the parameters that act only in test conditions (so the numbers can be smaller than those of the PEtab problem); n.e., not evaluated (not run for Chen and Raimundez, the problems with the most expensive simulations, or no training/test split). Reduced problem: free parameters in the reduced problem, $|S| + |\Theta_C|$.

| Problem | $p$ | Biological | Calibration | Noise | Full-model profile | Reduced problem |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 44 | 34 | 10 | 0 | 34 / 44 | 2 + 10 |
| Armistead | 14 | 10 | 0 | 4 | 10 / 10 | 2 + 0 |
| Bachmann | 113 | 27 | 74 | 12 | 27 / 90 | 2 + 74 |
| Beer | 72 | 70 | 0 | 2 | – | – |
| Bertozzi | 8 | 6 | 0 | 2 | 3 / 3 | 2 + 0 |
| Blasi | 9 | 8 | 0 | 1 | n.e. | 2 + 0 |
| Boehm | 9 | 6 | 0 | 3 | 6 / 6 | 2 + 0 |
| Borghans | 23 | 20 | 2 | 1 | 20 / 22 | 2 + 2 |
| Brannmark | 22 | 15 | 3 | 4 | 15 / 16 | 2 + 3 |
| Bruno | 13 | 13 | 0 | 0 | 10 / 10 | 5 + 0 |
| Chen | 155 | 152 | 3 | 0 | n.e. | 2 + 3 |
| Crauste | 12 | 12 | 0 | 0 | – | – |
| Elowitz | 21 | 18 | 2 | 1 | 18 / 20 | 2 + 2 |
| Fiedler | 22 | 12 | 8 | 2 | 12 / 20 | 2 + 8 |
| Fujita | 19 | 16 | 3 | 0 | 16 / 19 | 2 + 3 |
| Giordano | 50 | 43 | 0 | 7 | 43 / 43 | 2 + 0 |
| Isensee | 46 | 32 | 11 | 3 | 32 / 43 | 2 + 11 |
| Lang | 294 | 261 | 16 | 17 | – | – |
| Laske | 13 | 6 | 2 | 5 | 6 / 7 | 2 + 2 |
| Liu | 9 | 7 | 0 | 2 | 7 / 7 | 2 + 0 |
| Lucarelli | 84 | 72 | 0 | 12 | 72 / 72 | 10 + 0 |
| Okuonghae | 16 | 14 | 0 | 2 | 14 / 14 | 2 + 0 |
| Oliveira | 12 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 12 / 12 | 2 + 0 |
| Perelson | 3 | 2 | 0 | 1 | 2 / 2 | 2 + 0 |
| Rahman | 9 | 9 | 0 | 0 | 9 / 9 | 2 + 0 |
| Raia | 39 | 18 | 5 | 16 | 18 / 23 | 2 + 5 |
| Raimundez | 136 | 57 | 79 | 0 | n.e. | 2 + 79 |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 6 | 6 | 0 | 0 | 6 / 6 | 2 + 0 |
| Schwen | 30 | 13 | 15 | 2 | 13 / 28 | 2 + 15 |
| Smith | 25 | 16 | 9 | 0 | 16 / 25 | 2 + 9 |
| Sneyd | 15 | 14 | 0 | 1 | 14 / 14 | 2 + 0 |

| Problem | $p$ | Biological | Calibration | Noise | Full-model profile | Reduced problem |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Weber | 36 | 26 | 5 | 5 | 26 / 30 | 2 + 5 |
| Zhao | 28 | 21 | 0 | 7 | 21 / 21 | 3 + 0 |
| Zheng | 46 | 45 | 0 | 1 | 45 / 45 | 2 + 0 |

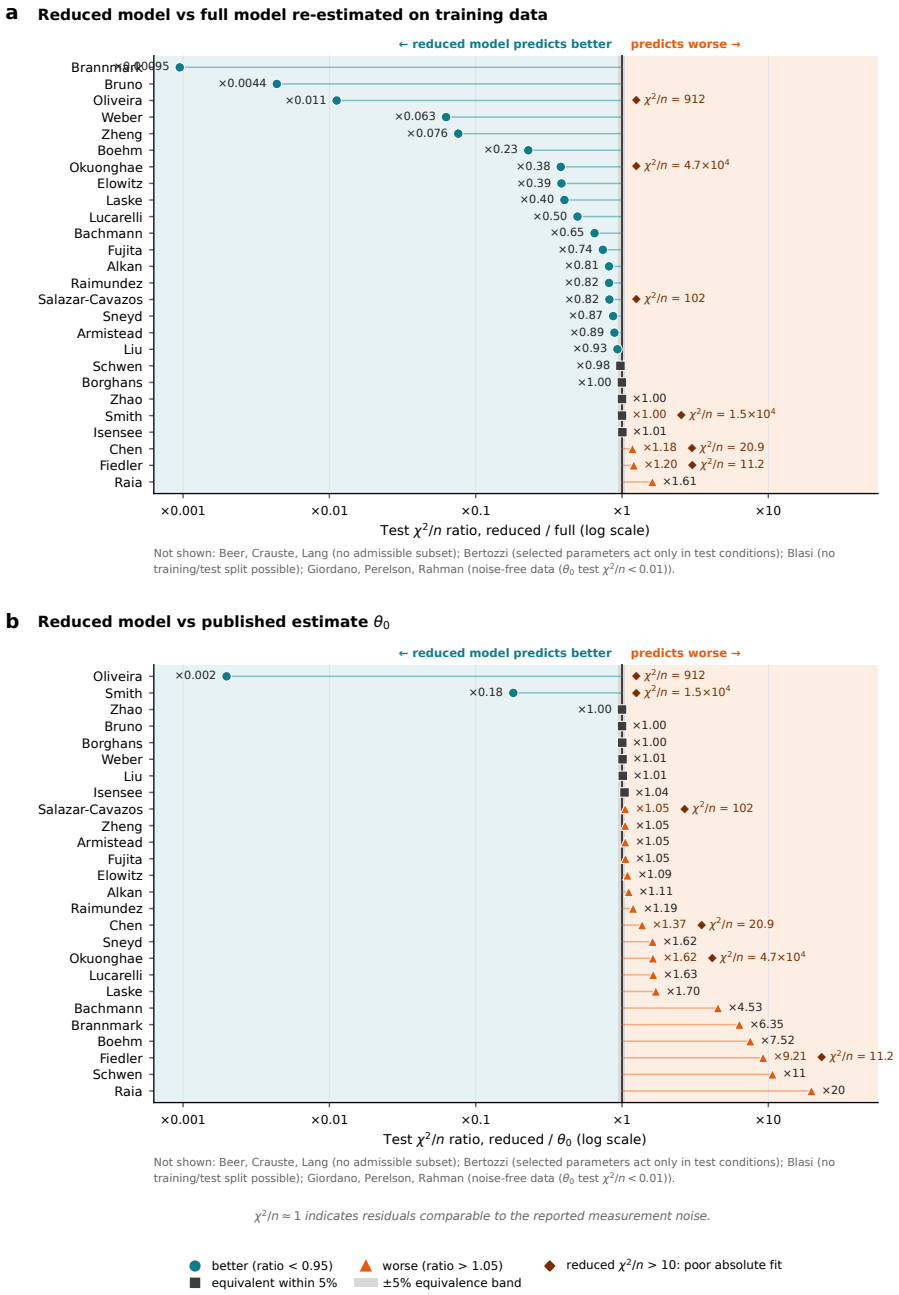
## Supplementary Note: Prediction of held-out experiments

Figure 3 of the main text compares the test $\chi^2/n$ of the reduced model with that of two references through their ratio. Supplementary Fig. S1 shows the same values as a scatter plot, which also displays their absolute level: points near $\chi^2/n = 1$ predict at the level of the measurement noise, whereas points far above it (for example Okuonghae, Oliveira and Smith) are poorly fitted by every model, so that a favourable ratio there does not imply a good prediction. The values of every problem, the problems excluded from each panel and the reasons are listed in `paper/scirep/figure3/figure3_heldout_data.csv` of the repository, together with the script that produces both figures and checks every plotted point against that table.




**Supplementary Figure S1. Prediction of held-out experiments, absolute values.** Test $\chi^2/n$ of the reduced model against **a**, the full model re-estimated on the same training data ($n = 26$) and **b**, the published estimate $\theta_0$ ($n = 27$), on logarithmic axes with the same scale. Solid line, $y = x$; grey band, equivalence within ±5%; shaded region, the reduced model predicts better. Circles, better; squares, equivalent; open triangles, worse. Names are shown for points away from the diagonal. The excluded problems are those of Figure 3.

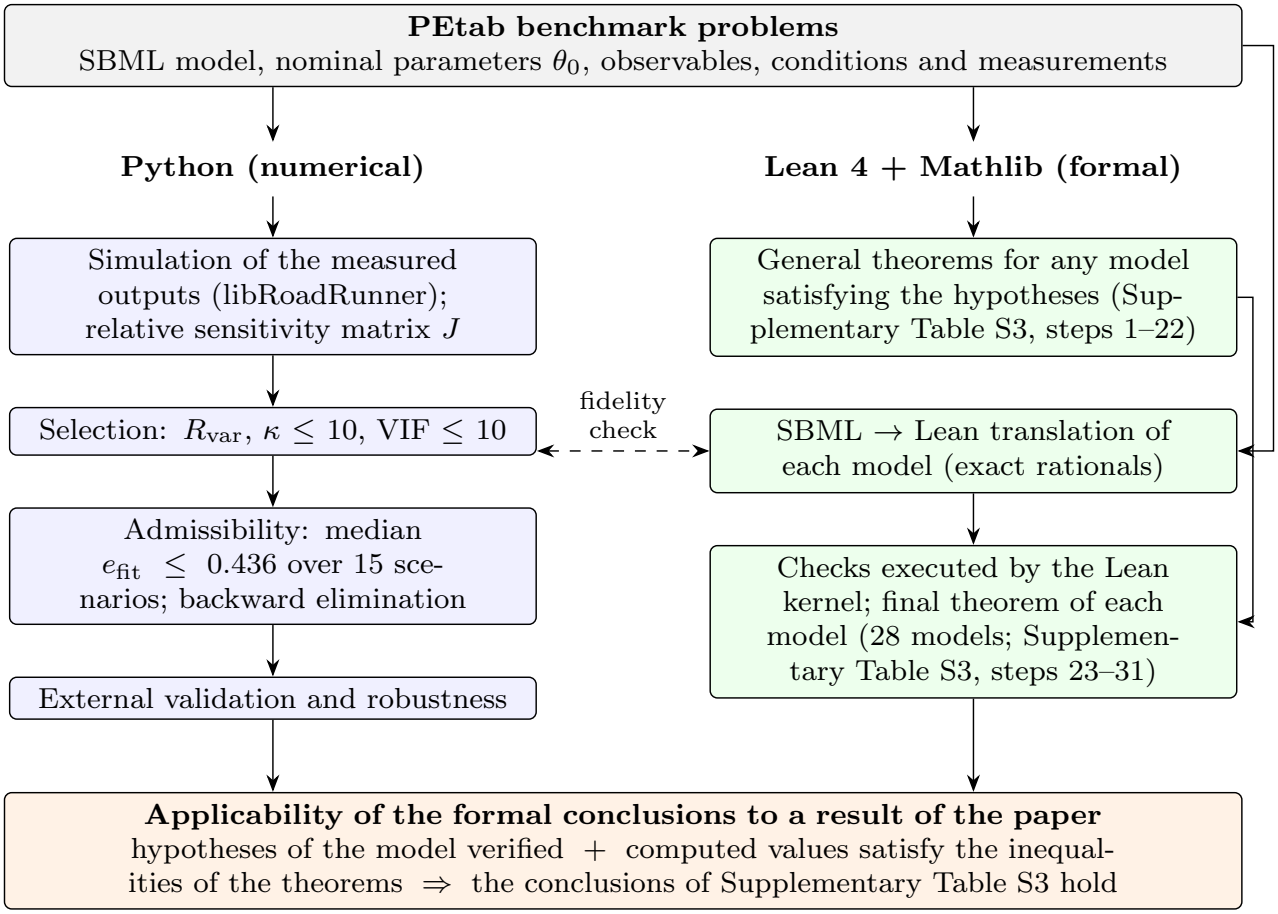
Supplementary Figure S2 shows the ratios of the reduced to the reference test $\chi^2/n$, including the comparison with the published estimate $\theta_0$. Because $\theta_0$ was obtained using all data including the test experiments, it is an optimistic reference: it predicted the test data better than the reduced model in 20 of 29 problems (Supplementary Table S26).




**Supplementary Figure S2. Prediction of held-out experiments with real data, ratios.** Ratio of the test $\chi^2/n$ of the reduced model to that of **a**, the full model re-estimated on the same training data ($n = 26$ problems), and **b**, the published estimate $\theta_0$, obtained using all data including the test experiments ($n = 27$). Left of the vertical line (circles) the reduced model predicts better; grey band, equivalence within 5% (squares); triangles, worse; ♦ flags a reduced test $\chi^2/n$ above 10. Problems without a training/test split (Bertozzi, Blasi) or with noise-free data (Giordano, Perelson, Rahman) are not shown.

## Supplementary Note: Logical sequence of the formal proofs

This note explains, in mathematical terms, the chain of results that the Lean code proves, in the order in which they build on each other. The order is that of the import graph of `lean_proofs/`: step $k$ only uses steps with a smaller number (Supplementary Table S4, column 'Uses'). Lean names of the main results are given in `typewriter` font; the statement and meaning of every theorem are in Supplementary Note *Statements of the formal theorems*, and the notation in Supplementary Table S6. Supplementary Fig. S3 shows how the formal and the numerical parts of the work fit together, and Supplementary Table S5 states the scope of each formal guarantee.




**Supplementary Figure S3. Architecture of the formal and numerical verification.** Python (left) performs all computations on the PEtab problems: simulation, sensitivities, selection, admissibility, validation and robustness. Lean 4 with Mathlib (right) proves the general theorems behind each step of the method (Supplementary Table S4) and, for 28 benchmark models translated from SBML, checks with the Lean kernel that the hypotheses on the dynamics hold. The translation of each model is compared independently with the SBML model (dashed arrow; Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*). A formal conclusion applies to a result of the paper (main-text table on what the formal verification guarantees) when the hypotheses of the model are verified and the numerical quantities computed in Python satisfy the inequalities that the theorem requires (bottom); Supplementary Table S5 gives, for each guarantee, what it establishes and what it does not.

## Modules of the formalisation

All formal proofs are collected in the folder `lean_proofs/` of the reproducibility package, a self-contained Lean 4 project (Lean 4.23.0, Mathlib v4.23.0) that compiles with a single command (`./verify.sh`). It contains 32 theory modules with 304 theorems and lemmas, and 28 benchmark models translated from SBML. No file contains `sorry` or `axiom`, and `#print axioms` reports only `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound` for every theorem. Supplementary Table S4 lists the modules in the logical order of the proofs: # is the step number, and every module only uses modules with a smaller number (column 'Uses'). $n$ is the number of theorems and lemmas in the module (its size, not an index). Supplementary Note *Statements of the formal theorems* gives the statement and meaning of every theorem and lemma; the file `THEOREMS.md` in the folder lists them as well.

**Supplementary Table S4.** Modules of the Lean formalisation in the logical order of the proofs.

| # | Module | $n$ | Uses | Content | Main theorems |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *Steps 1–13. Finite-dimensional core of the method (fixed sensitivity matrix)* | | | | | |
| 1 | `FirstOrderErrorBound` | 12 | – | Energy $E_j = (J^\top J)_{jj}$, $R_{\mathrm{var}}$ and first-order output error when parameters are fixed | `total_eq_kept_add_removed`, `first_order_error_from_Rvar` |
| 2 | `TrajectoryErrorBound` | 9 | 1 | From the Jacobian to the trajectory: error bound when discarded parameters are fixed | `sqrt_removedParamSq_le` |
| 3 | `ScaledError` | 5 | – | Theorem 1: the minimum relative error after rescaling equals $\sqrt{1-\cos^2\Delta}$ | `min_rel_error_eq` |
| 4 | `CosineCertificate` | 5 | 2 | Non-asymptotic bounds for finite perturbations; per-scenario certificate of $\cos\Delta$ | `finite_trajectory_error`, `finite_cos_certificate` |
| 5 | `RefitMonotone` | 5 | – | Re-estimating more parameters never increases the fitting error; $e_{\mathrm{fit}} \le e_{\mathrm{rel}}$ | `fitErr_anti`, `fitErr_le_erel`, `admissible_mono` |
| 6 | `Poda` | 4 | – | Theorem 2: backward elimination returns an admissible subset from which no parameter can be removed; inclusion-minimal for a monotone criterion | `prune_spec`, `prune_inclusion_minimal` |
| 7 | `Identifiability Conditioning` | 10 | – | $\kappa$ and VIF bounds imply unique and stable least-squares estimates | `ls_unique`, `ls_param_kappa_stability`, `ls_vif_inverse_stability` |
| 8 | `SpectralConditioning` | 22 | 7 | $\kappa$ and VIF exactly as computed numerically (spectral theorem, matrix inverse) | – |
| 9 | `GreedySelection` | 7 | 7 | Greedy selection returns a subset with $\kappa \le \tau_\kappa$ and $\mathrm{VIF} \le \tau_{\mathrm{VIF}}$; permanent discard is correct | `greedy_kappa_vif_guarantee` |
| 10 | `PatternMechanisms` | 4 | 2, 9 | Opposing effects imply rejection by $\kappa$ and non-identifiability; zero discarded energy implies exact first-order reduction | `not_okKappa_of_kernel`, `exact_reduction_of_zero_energy` |
| 11 | `NumericalRobustness` | 6 | 4, 9 | Finite-difference error; $R_{\mathrm{var}}$, $\kappa$ and VIF certified from approximate values with margins | `fd_column_error`, `rvar_certified_from_approx` |
| 12 | `LinearizedFit` | 3 | 3 | The first-order $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ differs from the exact one by a second-order term | `lin_le_scaled`, `fit_lower_of_lin` |

| # | Module | $n$ | Uses | Content | Main theorems |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13 | `OutputComposition` | 4 | – | Error bounds transfer from states to measured outputs, including log and $\log_{10}$ | `output_uniform_bound`, `log10_lipschitz` |
| *Steps 14–18. Ordinary differential equations: existence and sensitivities* | | | | | |
| 14 | `GlobalLipschitzODE` | 3 | – | Global existence on $[a, b]$ for globally Lipschitz vector fields | – |
| 15 | `ParamDiffODE` | 8 | 14 | Solutions depend differentiably on parameters and initial values; the derivative solves the variational equation | `hasFDerivAt_solution_param_init` |
| 16 | `LocalExistence` | 9 | 15 | Solutions exist for parameters near $\theta_0$ when the nominal solution exists | – |
| 17 | `SensitivityLipschitz` | 8 | – | Explicit Lipschitz constants of trajectories and sensitivities in $\theta$ (Grönwall) | `sens_lipschitz, traj_lipschitz` |
| 18 | `EventSystems` | 1 | 16 | Systems with events at fixed times: existence and differentiability across segments | – |
| *Steps 19–22. Certificates for ODE models* | | | | | |
| 19 | `CertifiedODEReduction` | 1 | 2, 15 | Local certificate: $R_{\mathrm{var}}(S) \geq r$ bounds the trajectory error of the reduced model | `certified_parameter_reduction` |
| 20 | `CertifiedFiniteODE` | 5 | 4, 17, 19 | Certificate of $\cos\Delta$ for the ODE with an explicitly bounded Lipschitz constant | `certified_cos_ode` |
| 21 | `ExactLinear Certificate` | 13 | 20 | Certificates with the exact linear error; local version without Lipschitz constants | `finite_cos_certificate_exact, certified_cos_ode_exact` |
| 22 | `NominalCertificate` | 1 | 16, 21 | Local $\cos\Delta$ certificate from the nominal trajectory only | – |
| *Steps 23–31. Hypotheses of the benchmark models (kinetic models and reaction networks)* | | | | | |
| 23 | `KineticRegularity` | 11 | 22 | Rate laws (mass action, Michaelis–Menten, Hill, ...) define smooth vector fields on their domain | – |
| 24 | `PositivityInvariance` | 15 | 23 | Quasi-positive models keep concentrations non-negative | – |
| 25 | `GlobalExistence` | 11 | 14, 24 | Global existence under linear growth on the non-negative orthant | – |
| 26 | `StrictExistence` | 12 | 25 | Global existence with strictly positive concentrations | `exists_global_solution_strict` |
| 27 | `KineticCheck` | 19 | 18, 24 | Verified automatic checkers for translated rate laws | – |
| 28 | `KineticNetwork` | 18 | 18, 25, 27 | Reaction networks: complete check including global existence | `network_final` |
| 29 | `RiccatiNetwork` | 9 | 28 | Existence on a finite horizon under quadratic growth (Riccati bound; used for Crauste) | `riccati_final` |
| 30 | `StrictNetwork` | 46 | 26, 28 | Networks with strictly positive domains (e.g. $\beta SI/N$, Hill with real exponent) | `strict_final_init` |
| 31 | `IntervalInit` | 5 | 30 | Parameter-dependent initial values certified with rational interval arithmetic | `strict_final_initI` |
| *Step 32. Identifiability of the reduced problem* | | | | | |

| # | Module | $n$ | Uses | Content | Main theorems |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 32 | `Profile Identifiability` | 13 | 8 | Practical identifiability of the reduced problem: if the guaranteed half-width $t^*$ from the profiled information is smaller than the distance to the bounds, the profile likelihood exceeds the threshold on both sides | `practically_identifiable_grad, tstar_linear, local_injective` |
| | Total | 304 | | | |

**Verified benchmark models (28).** Armistead, Bachmann, Bertozzi, Blasi, Boehm, Borghans, Brannmark, Bruno, Chen (501 states, in four parts), Crauste (horizon $T \leq 1$), Elowitz, Fiedler, Froehlich (1,228 states, in twelve parts), Fujita, Giordano, Isensee, Lang, Laske, Lucarelli, Okuonghae, Rahman, Raia, Raimundez, SalazarCavazos, Sneyd, Weber, Zhao and Zheng (folder `lean_proofs/Models/`). For each model, the final theorem establishes that the vector field is smooth on its domain, that the solution exists on the simulated horizon and that concentrations remain non-negative. The data of each model and the checks executed are given in Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models* and Supplementary Table S8, which also explain why the remaining seven benchmark problems were not verified.

## Setting and goal

A model is an ODE $\dot{x} = f(x, \theta)$ on $[0, T]$ with $x(0) = x^0(\theta)$, $\theta \in \mathbb{R}^p$, sampled at times $t_1, \ldots, t_N$; the sampled (noise-scaled) outputs form a vector $F(\theta) \in \mathbb{R}^m$. Fixing the parameters outside a subset $S$ at their nominal values means replacing a perturbation $\Delta\theta$ by $\Delta\theta_S$, whose components outside $S$ are zero. The proofs establish six guarantees:

(G1) for small perturbations, the output error of the reduced model, $\|F(\theta_0 + \Delta\theta) - F(\theta_0 + \Delta\theta_S)\|$, is bounded by the sensitivity energy discarded, i.e. by $R_{\mathrm{var}}(S)$;

(G2) the cosine $\cos\Delta$ between full and reduced output changes determines the best relative error obtainable by rescaling the reduced response, $\sqrt{1 - \cos^2\Delta}$, and the linearised re-estimation of several parameters is at least as good;

(G3) the conditioning tests ($\kappa$, VIF) imply that the *linearised* least-squares problem for $\theta_S$ has a unique solution that is stable with respect to the data;

(G4) the fitting error is monotone in the re-estimated set, and backward elimination returns a subset from which no single parameter can be removed;

(G5) the hypotheses needed for (G1)–(G3) (smoothness, existence of solutions, positivity, differentiability) hold for the translated benchmark models;

(G6) a parameter of the reduced problem is practically identifiable (its profile likelihood exceeds the 95% threshold on both sides within the bounds) when a guaranteed half-width $t^*$, computed from the profiled information, the residual gradient and a bound on the nonlinear remainder, is smaller than the distance to the bounds.

Steps 1–22 prove (G1)–(G4) for any model satisfying explicit hypotheses; steps 23–31 prove that the 28 verified benchmark models satisfy them (G5); step 32 proves (G6) for any reduced problem. Supplementary Table S5 states, for each guarantee, what is proved, what is not, and which numerical quantity connects it with the results of the paper.

**Supplementary Table S5.** Scope of the formal guarantees. Numerical values refer to the final subsets of the 31 admissible benchmark problems and were computed in Python in double precision.

| Guarantee | What Lean proves | What it does not prove | Numerical connection with the paper |
|---|---|---|---|
| G1. Error of the reduced model | For small $\Delta\theta$: $\|F(\theta_0+\Delta\theta) - F(\theta_0+\Delta\theta_S)\| \leq (\sqrt{(1-R_{\mathrm{var}})E}+\eta)\|\Delta\theta\|$; an explicit version for finite $\|h\| \leq \rho_0$ with a Lipschitz constant $L_c$ (steps 1–4, 19–20) | A small error for arbitrarily large perturbations; that the selected subsets have $R_{\mathrm{var}}$ close to 1 | $R_{\mathrm{var}}(S)$ of the final subsets has median 0.60 and is $\geq 0.89$ in 2 of 31 (level 3 of Supplementary Table S1); the bound is therefore informative only for some subsets, and admissibility is decided by $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ (G2, G4); the explicit finite version could not certify any benchmark scenario because $L_c$ is very large (see below) |
| G2. Cosine and fitting error | $\min_\alpha \|a-\alpha b\|/\|a\| = \sqrt{1-\cos^2(a,b)}$; the linearised fit of several parameters is no worse; certificates of $\cos\Delta$ for finite and small perturbations (steps 3–4, 12, 20–22) | That the nonlinear multi-parameter optimisation performed in Python reaches its optimum; the value of $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ itself | Median $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ over 15 scenarios at $\pm 5\%$ is $\leq \tau_e = 0.436$ in all 31 admissible problems (largest value 0.4355); the median $\cos\Delta$ is $\geq 0.9$ in 17 of them (levels 2–3 of Supplementary Table S1), so a subset can be admissible because re-estimating several parameters fits better than rescaling |
| G3. Conditioning | Uniqueness and stability of the linear least-squares estimate with normalised sensitivity columns, with $\kappa = \sqrt{\lambda_{\max}/\lambda_{\min}}$ and $\mathrm{VIF}_j = [(Z^\top Z)^{-1}]_{jj}$ as computed (steps 7–9) | Global or structural identifiability of the nonlinear model; uniqueness of the nonlinear calibration | $\kappa \leq 6.6$ and $\mathrm{VIF} \leq 9.85$ for all 31 final subsets (thresholds $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\mathrm{VIF}} = 10$) |
| G4. Re-estimation and pruning | $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ never increases when parameters are added; $e_{\mathrm{fit}} \leq e_{\mathrm{rel}}$; pruning returns an admissible subset from which no parameter can be removed, and which is minimal with respect to inclusion when the criterion is monotone (steps 5–6) | That the result is the admissible subset of smallest size; that the numerical evaluation of admissibility is exact | Admissibility of each candidate subset is evaluated numerically (15 scenarios, median $e_{\mathrm{fit}} \leq 0.436$) |
| G5. Benchmark models | For 28 translated models: smooth vector field, existence of the solution on the horizon (every $T$, or $T \leq 1$ for Crauste), non-negativity, solutions for $\theta$ near $\theta_0$ and their differentiability (steps 23–31) | That the SBML and PEtab files are correct; the accuracy of the numerical simulations; experimental conditions that override parameters or initial values (the translation uses the nominal values) | The translated vector fields, parameter values and initial values agree with the SBML models evaluated by libRoadRunner (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*) |

**Supplementary Table S5.** Scope of the formal guarantees. Numerical values refer to the final subsets of the 31 admissible benchmark problems and were computed in Python in double precision.

| Guarantee | What Lean proves | What it does not prove | Numerical connection with the paper |
|---|---|---|---|
| G6. Identifiability of the selected parameters | If $\lvert\langle r_0, A\delta\rangle\rvert \le \gamma\lVert A\delta\rVert$, $I_j\delta_j^2 \le \lVert A\delta\rVert^2$ and the nonlinear remainder is at most $\varepsilon$ on the admissible set, every point outside $\lvert\delta_j\rvert < t^*$ has $\Delta\chi^2 \ge 3.84$, so $\theta_j$ is practically identifiable when $t^*$ is below the distance to both bounds (step 32) | Identifiability of the full model or global identifiability; a bound on the remainder over the whole admissible set, which is evaluated only at the computed profile points | The linear condition ($\gamma = \varepsilon = 0$) agrees with the profiles for all 72 evaluable selected parameters; the full hypotheses hold for 24 parameters, never for a non-identifiable one, and for all selected parameters in 7 problems (Supplementary Note *Identifiability of the selected parameters*) |

### Steps 1–13. Finite-dimensional core of the method

Here the sensitivity matrix $J = DF(\theta_0)$ is a fixed $m \times p$ matrix with column energies $E_j = \sum_i J_{ij}^2$, $E = \sum_j E_j$, $E_S = \sum_{j\in S} E_j$.

**Steps 1–2 (error of the reduced model, G1).** The total energy splits as $E = E_S + E_{S^c}$, and by Cauchy–Schwarz

$$\lVert J\Delta\theta - J\Delta\theta_S\rVert = \Big\lVert\sum_{j\notin S} J_{\cdot j}\Delta\theta_j\Big\rVert \le \sqrt{E_{S^c}}\,\lVert\Delta\theta_{S^c}\rVert \le \sqrt{(1 - R_{\mathrm{var}}(S))\,E}\,\lVert\Delta\theta\rVert$$

(`first_order_error_from_Rvar`). If $F$ is differentiable at $\theta_0$, the nonlinear error differs from the linear one by $o(\lVert\Delta\theta\rVert)$, so for every $\eta > 0$ and small $\Delta\theta$, $\lVert F(\theta_0+\Delta\theta) - F(\theta_0+\Delta\theta_S)\rVert \le (\sqrt{(1-r)E}+\eta)\lVert\Delta\theta\rVert$ whenever $R_{\mathrm{var}}(S) \ge r$ (`trajectory_error_from_Rvar`). This is the guarantee behind stage 1 of the selection. It is local, and it does not by itself make a subset admissible: admissibility is a separate, numerical test on finite perturbations (steps 5–6).

**Step 3 (cosine and fitting error, G2).** For vectors $a$ (full response) and $b$ (reduced response),

$$\min_{\alpha\in\mathbb{R}} \frac{\lVert a - \alpha b\rVert}{\lVert a\rVert} = \sqrt{1 - \cos^2(a,b)},$$

attained at $\alpha^* = \langle a, b\rangle/\lVert b\rVert^2$ (`min_rel_error_eq`, Theorem 1 of the paper). Hence, for $c > 0$, a relative error of at most $\tau_e = \sqrt{1-c^2}$ after rescaling is equivalent to $\lvert\cos\Delta\rvert \ge c$; in particular $\cos\Delta \ge c$ implies it (the sign matters only because $\alpha$ may be negative). The identity concerns a single scale factor. The method re-estimates several parameters, and step 12 shows that the linearised fit over the span of their sensitivity columns is at least as good as rescaling (`lin_le_scaled`); the exact nonlinear fit differs from the linearised one by a second-order term. Thus $\cos\Delta \ge c$ is a sufficient condition for admissibility to first order, not a necessary one, and the actual $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ is computed numerically.

**Step 4 (finite perturbations).** If $DF$ is $L_c$-Lipschitz on the ball $\bar{B}(\theta_0, \rho_0)$, Taylor's theorem gives $\lVert F(\theta_0 + h) - F(\theta_0) - Jh\rVert \le L_c\lVert h\rVert^2$, hence

$$\lVert F(\theta_0 + h) - F(\theta_0 + h_S)\rVert \le \sqrt{E_{S^c}}\,\lVert h_{S^c}\rVert + 2L_c\lVert h\rVert^2,$$

and, writing $A = \lVert Jh\rVert - L_c\lVert h\rVert^2 > 0$, the inequality $(\sqrt{E_{S^c}}\lVert h_{S^c}\rVert + 2L_c\lVert h\rVert^2)^2 \le (1-c^2)A^2$ certifies $\cos\Delta(h) \ge c$ for that perturbation (`finite_cos_certificate`).

**Steps 5–6 (re-estimation and pruning, G4).** With $e_{\mathrm{fit}}(S) = \inf\{r(\theta) : \theta_j = \theta_{0,j}\ \forall j \notin S\}$, enlarging $S$ (or adding calibration parameters) never increases $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$, and $e_{\mathrm{fit}} \le e_{\mathrm{rel}}$ (`fitErr_anti`, `fitErr_le_erel`); therefore admissibility is preserved under enlargement. Backward elimination stops at an admissible $R \subseteq S$ such that $R \setminus \{x\}$ is not admissible for any $x \in R$ (`prune_spec`, Theorem 2 of the paper).

**Steps 7–9 (conditioning and selection, G3).** Let $Z$ have the normalised sensitivity columns of $S$. If $\sigma_{\min}\|u\| \le \|Zu\| \le \sigma_{\max}\|u\|$ with $\sigma_{\min} > 0$, the linear least-squares estimate (the first-order approximation of the re-estimation of $\theta_S$) is unique and, for two data vectors $y, y'$,

$$\|v - v'\| \le \kappa\,\|y - y'\|, \qquad |v_j - v'_j| \le \sqrt{\mathrm{VIF}_j}\,\|y - y'\|$$

(`ls_unique`, `ls_kappa_stability`, `ls_vif_inverse_stability`). Step 8 identifies these quantities with what is computed numerically: $\kappa = \sqrt{\lambda_{\max}/\lambda_{\min}}$ from the eigenvalues of $Z^\top Z$ and $\mathrm{VIF}_j = [(Z^\top Z)^{-1}]_{jj}$ (`ls_kappa_stability_spectral`, `ls_vif_matrix_stability`); note that $\kappa$ is the condition number of $Z$, i.e. the square root of that of $Z^\top Z$. These results concern the linearised problem; they do not establish identifiability of the nonlinear model. Step 9 proves that the greedy selection returns a subset with $\kappa \le \tau_\kappa$ and $\mathrm{VIF} \le \tau_{\mathrm{VIF}}$, and, because both tests are inherited by subsets, that a discarded candidate would still fail at the end (`greedy_kappa_vif_guarantee`).

**Steps 10–13 (complements).** Two parameters with proportional sensitivity columns ($Ze_a = \lambda Ze_b$) give $Z(e_a - \lambda e_b) = 0$, so no $\kappa$ threshold accepts both and the estimate is not unique; zero discarded energy makes the reduction exact to first order (step 10). Values computed with finite differences and rounding certify $R_{\mathrm{var}}$, $\kappa$ and VIF for the exact matrix when explicit margins hold (step 11). The linearised $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ used for large systems differs from the exact one by at most $M\rho^2$ (step 12). Error bounds transfer from states to measured outputs through Lipschitz observation functions, including log and $\log_{10}$ (step 13).

## Steps 14–18. Ordinary differential equations

Steps 1–13 need $F$ to be differentiable, with known derivative, for every $\theta$ near $\theta_0$. Steps 14–18 prove this for ODE models.

**Step 14.** If $v(t,\cdot)$ is $K$-Lipschitz, Picard iteration on intervals of length at most $1/(2K)$ gives a solution on all of $[a,b]$ (`exists_solution_Icc`).

**Step 15 (sensitivities).** If $f$ is $C^1$ on an open set $U$ containing the nominal trajectory and $x^0$ is differentiable, then $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ at $\theta_0$ for every $t \in [0,T]$, and its derivative $S(t)$ solves the variational equation

$$\dot S(t) = \partial_x f(x_0(t),\theta_0)\,S(t) + \partial_\theta f(x_0(t),\theta_0), \qquad S(0) = \partial_\theta x^0(\theta_0)$$

(`hasFDerivAt_solution_param_init`). The proof combines a uniform linearisation of $f$ near the compact trajectory with a Grönwall estimate in a tube around it.

**Step 16.** Solutions for $\theta$ near $\theta_0$ exist automatically once the nominal solution exists (`exists_solutions_near`), so this need not be assumed.

**Step 17 (explicit constants).** If $\|Df\| \le M_1$ and $Df$ is $M_2$-Lipschitz on a convex set containing the trajectories,

$$\|x(t;\theta) - x(t;\theta')\| \le (e^{M_1 T} - 1)\|\theta - \theta'\|, \qquad \|S_\theta(t) - S_{\theta'}(t)\| \le M_2 e^{2M_1 T}\frac{e^{M_1 T} - 1}{M_1}\|\theta - \theta'\|$$

(`traj_lipschitz`, `sens_lipschitz`).

**Step 18.** The same holds segment by segment for systems with events at fixed times (`event_hasFDerivAt`).

### Steps 19–22. Certificates for ODE models

Steps 19–22 apply steps 1–13 to $F = \mathcal{F}$, the vector of states at the sampling times, whose derivative is the sampled sensitivity matrix $\mathcal{S} = (S(t_1), \dots, S(t_N))$ given by steps 14–18.

**Step 19.** The energy criterion computed from $\mathcal{S}$ bounds the trajectory error of the reduced model: for every $\eta > 0$ and small $\Delta\theta$,

$$R_{\mathrm{var}}(S) \geq r \;\Rightarrow\; \|\mathcal{F}(\theta_0 + \Delta\theta) - \mathcal{F}(\theta_0 + \Delta\theta_S)\| \leq \big(\sqrt{(1-r)E} + \eta\big)\|\Delta\theta\|$$

(`certified_parameter_reduction`).

**Step 20.** Step 17, applied at the $N$ sampling times, provides the Lipschitz constant needed in step 4, $L_c = \sqrt{N}\, M_2 e^{2M_1 T}(e^{M_1 T} - 1)/M_1$, so the finite-perturbation certificate of $\cos\Delta$ becomes fully explicit for ODE models (`certified_cos_ode`).

**Step 21.** The certificate is sharpened by using the exact linear error $\|\mathcal{S}(h - h_S)\|$ instead of its energy bound, and a local version without any Lipschitz constant is proved: $\lim_{s\to 0^+} \cos\Delta(sh) = \cos(\mathcal{S}h, \mathcal{S}h_S)$, so if the linear cosine computed from $\mathcal{S}$ exceeds $c$, then $\cos\Delta(sh) > c$ for all small $s > 0$ (`certified_cos_ode_exact`, `local_cos_ode`).

**Step 22.** Combining steps 16 and 21, the local certificate requires only that the nominal solution exist (`local_cos_from_nominal`).

### Steps 23–31. Hypotheses of the benchmark models

The results of steps 14–22 assume that $f$ is $C^1$ on an open set containing the trajectory and that the nominal solution exists on $[0, T]$. Steps 23–31 prove these assumptions for the benchmark models from their equations.

**Step 23 (smoothness).** Rate laws are represented as expressions built from constants, concentrations, parameters, $+, -, \times, \div$, powers, exp and log. Wherever an expression is well defined (non-zero denominators, positive bases of real powers and arguments of log) it is $C^\infty$, and this set is open (`contDiffOn_field`); Michaelis–Menten and Hill laws are covered (`ok_mm`, `ok_hill`, `ok_hillR`). This yields the local certificate for every kinetic model (`kinetic_local_cos`).

**Step 24 (positivity).** If $f$ is quasi-positive ($y \geq 0$, $y_i = 0 \Rightarrow f_i(y) \geq 0$), solutions starting in the non-negative orthant stay there (`nonneg_of_quasiPositive`); the proof applies Grönwall's inequality to the squared negative part.

**Step 25 (global existence).** If, in addition, $\sum_i w_i f_i(y) \leq a + b\sum_i w_i y_i$ on the orthant for weights $w_i > 0$, then $\sum_i w_i x_i(t)$ grows at most exponentially, the solution remains in a box $[0, B]^n$ on which $f$ is Lipschitz, and by step 14 it exists on $[0, T]$ for every $T$ (`exists_global_solution`).

**Step 26.** The same holds when some species must remain strictly positive (for example, when they appear in denominators), provided their consumption is at most proportional to their concentration (`exists_global_solution_strict`).

**Steps 27–28 (automatic checks).** Boolean functions that inspect the syntax of the rate laws decide well-definedness, sign and quasi-positivity, and each is proved sound (for example `qp_sound`). For a reaction network $f_i = \sum_k \nu_{ik} r_k$, the checks `checkNet` and `checkGrowth` imply the hypotheses of steps 23–25 (`checkNet_sound`, `checkGrowth_sound`), and the end-to-end theorem `network_final` gives existence, positivity and differentiability for every horizon.

**Steps 29–31.** Three extensions cover the remaining models: quadratic growth, $\sum_i w_i f_i \leq Q(\sum_i w_i y_i + 1)^2$, gives existence up to the Riccati time $1/(Q(\sum_i w_i x_i^0 + 1))$ (`riccati_final`, used for Crauste with

$T \leq 1$); networks with strictly positive domains (`strict_final_init`); and parameter-dependent initial values checked with rational interval arithmetic (`strict_final_initI`).

**Benchmark models.** Each file in `lean_proofs/Models/` contains the rate laws, stoichiometry, parameter values and initial values of one model, translated from SBML with exact rational numbers. The checks of steps 27–31 are executed by the Lean kernel (`decide +kernel`), and one end-to-end theorem is then applied: `network_final` (15 models), `network_final_init` (5), `network_segments_final` (1), `strict_final_init` (5), `strict_final_initI` (1) or `riccati_final` (1). The resulting theorem states that the model satisfies the hypotheses of Parts II–III. Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models* gives the data and the checks of each model.

### Connection with the numerical results and what the proofs do not cover

Lean proves implications; it does not recompute the numerical results. The sensitivity matrices, $R_{\text{var}}$, $\kappa$, VIF, $\cos\Delta$ and $e_{\text{fit}}$ reported in the paper are computed in Python, in double precision. Three levels of evidence should therefore be distinguished.

- *General mathematics (G1–G4).* Proved in Lean for every model that satisfies the stated hypotheses.
- *Hypotheses of specific models (G5).* Proved in Lean for 28 benchmark models from their translated equations; the translation was compared independently with the SBML models (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).
- *Numerical conditions.* The inequalities required by the theorems ($\kappa \leq 10$, VIF $\leq 10$, median $e_{\text{fit}} \leq 0.436$, and $R_{\text{var}} \geq r$ for the bound of G1) were evaluated in floating-point arithmetic; Supplementary Table S5 gives their values. The certified margins of step 11 were not applied to these computations. When the explicit finite-perturbation certificates of steps 4 and 20 are evaluated with bounds $M_1$, $M_2$ computed from the vector fields, the resulting constants $L_c$ ranged from about $10^2$ to $10^{24}$ and no scenario at $\pm 5\%$ could be certified in any model (table `results/preliminary/finite_certificates.md` of the reproducibility package). These certificates are therefore of theoretical value; in practice the method relies on the local results (steps 19, 21 and 22) and on the numerical admissibility test. The conclusions of G1–G3 for a particular problem are therefore conditional on the computed values; for the closest cases (VIF = 9.85 in Lucarelli and $e_{\text{fit}} = 0.4355$ in Lucarelli) a small numerical error could change the decision.

The sensitivities used by the method are relative, $J = \partial y / \partial \log\theta$; the theorems apply to them through the change of variables $\theta = e^u$, which is smooth for $\theta > 0$. Finally, the formal results are local, around the published estimate $\theta_0$; the behaviour for large parameter changes is assessed empirically in the paper.

## Supplementary Note: Statements of the formal theorems

This note states, in mathematical notation, every theorem and lemma of the Lean formalisation (32 modules, 304 declarations) and explains what it means, so that the formal statements can be read alongside the code. The Lean name is given as it appears in the source (prefixed by the module namespace). Hypotheses are written before $\Rightarrow$; standing assumptions of each module are given in its description. Supplementary Table S6 explains the symbols used throughout; symbols specific to a module are explained at the start of that module. Supplementary Table S7 gives the statements, in

one block per module, in the order of Supplementary Table S4; the blocks are grouped as in Supplementary Note *Logical sequence of the formal proofs*. The same content, with the Lean identifiers, is in `lean_proofs/FORMULAS.md`.

**Supplementary Table S6.** Notation of the formalisation.

| Symbol | Lean | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| $n,\ p,\ N$ | `n, p, N` | number of state variables, of parameters and of sampling times |
| $\theta \in \mathbb{R}^p,\ \theta_0$ | `θ, θ₀` | parameter vector; nominal (published) parameter values |
| $\dot{x} = f(x, \theta)$ | `f` | right-hand side of the ODE (vector field) |
| $x(t;\theta) \in \mathbb{R}^n$ | `x θ t` | solution of the ODE at time t for parameters $\theta$ |
| $x_0(t)$ | `x₀` | nominal solution, i.e. the solution for $\theta = \theta_0$ |
| $x^0(\theta),\ D_0$ | `x0, D0` | initial value as a function of $\theta$, and its derivative at $\theta_0$ |
| $U$ | `U` | open set of (state, parameter) pairs on which f is continuously differentiable (ContDiffOn ℝ 1) |
| $K$ | `K` | convex set containing all trajectories considered (used for explicit constants) |
| $[0, T]$ | `Icc 0 T` | simulation horizon |
| $x$ solves the ODE | `HasDerivWithinAt (x θ) (f (x θ t) θ) (Icc 0 T) t` | x(·;$\theta$) is differentiable on [0,T] and its derivative equals f(x,$\theta$) |
| $t_1, \ldots, t_N$ | `tk` | sampling (measurement) times |
| $\mathcal{F}(\theta) \in \mathbb{R}^{Nn}$ | `sampled x tk θ` | states at all sampling times stacked into one vector |
| $F : \mathbb{R}^p \to \mathbb{R}^m$ | `F` | generic differentiable output map (for example the stacked, noise-scaled measured outputs) |
| $DF(\theta),\ J$ | `DF θ, J, L` | derivative of F (sensitivity matrix); J = DF($\theta_0$) |
| $J_{ij}$ | `jacobianOf L` | entry (i, j) of the matrix of the linear map L: J_ij = (L e_j)_i |
| $S(t) = \partial x(t;\theta_0)/\partial\theta$ | `S, S₀` | state sensitivity matrix; solves the variational equation |
| $\mathcal{S}$ | `sampledCLM S tk, sensMatrix S tk` | sensitivity at all sampling times stacked into one Nn × p matrix |
| $\dot{S} = \partial_x f\, S + \partial_\theta f$ | `HasDerivWithinAt S (... ∘L S t + ...)` | variational (sensitivity) equation along the nominal solution |
| $S \subseteq \{1, \ldots, p\}$ | `S, Sset : Finset (Fin p)` | subset of parameters that are re-estimated; the others stay at $\theta_0$ |
| $S^c$ | `removedSet S` | discarded (fixed) parameters |
| $h,\ \Delta\theta$ | `h, Δθ` | parameter perturbation |
| $h_S$ | `keepS S h` | perturbation restricted to S (components outside S set to 0) |
| $E_j = \sum_i J_{ij}^2$ | `columnEnergy J j` | sensitivity energy of parameter j (diagonal entry of $J^\top J$) |
| $E = \mathrm{tr}(J^\top J)$ | `totalColumnEnergy J` | total sensitivity energy |
| $E_S,\ E_{S^c}$ | `keptColumnEnergy J S, removedColumnEnergy J S` | energy of the selected and of the discarded parameters |
| $R_{\mathrm{var}}(S) = E_S/E$ | `r * totalColumnEnergy ≤ keptColumnEnergy` | fraction of sensitivity energy kept; the condition R_var(S) ≥ r is written r·E ≤ E_S |
| $\|h_{S^c}\|^2 = \sum_{j\notin S} h_j^2$ | `removedParamSq S h` | squared size of the perturbation of the discarded parameters |
| $\cos(a,b) = \dfrac{\langle a,b\rangle}{\|a\|\,\|b\|}$ | `cosv a b` | cosine between two vectors |

**Supplementary Table S6.** Notation of the formalisation.

| Symbol | Lean | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| $\cos\Delta(h)$ | `cosv (F (θ₀+h) - F θ₀) (F (θ₀+h_S) - F θ₀)` | cosine between the output change of the full perturbation and that of the perturbation restricted to S |
| $c$ | `c` | cosine threshold (the method uses c = 0.9, i.e. $\tau_e = \sqrt{(1 - c^2)} = 0.436$) |
| $\bar{B}(\theta_0, \rho_0)$ | `closedBall θ₀ ρ₀` | closed ball of radius $\rho_0$ around $\theta_0$ (range of perturbations) |
| $L_c$ | `Lc` | Lipschitz constant of DF on the ball: $\|DF(\theta) - DF(\theta_0)\| \le L_c \|\theta - \theta_0\|$ |
| $M_1,\ M_2$ | $M_1$, $M_2$ | bounds on $\|Df\|$ and on the Lipschitz constant of Df on K |
| $Z$ | `Z` | linear map whose columns are the (normalised) sensitivity columns of the candidate subset |
| $\sigma_{\min},\ \sigma_{\max}$ | `σmin, σmax` | lower and upper bounds $\sigma_{\min}\|u\| \le \|Zu\| \le \sigma_{\max}\|u\|$ (extreme singular values) |
| $\kappa_0,\ V$ | `κ₀, V, Vb` | thresholds on the condition number $\kappa$ and on the variance inflation factor VIF |
| $\operatorname{supp} u \subseteq S$ | `SupportedOn S u` | u_i = 0 for all i outside S |
| $v \in \mathrm{LS}(Z, y)$ | `IsLSMin Z y v` | v minimises $\|Zv - y\|$ (least-squares estimate) |
| $\forall \theta \approx \theta_0$ | `∀ᶠ θ in 𝓝 θ₀` | for all $\theta$ in some neighbourhood of $\theta_0$ |
| $o(\|\Delta\theta\|)$ | `=o[𝓝 0]` | little-o as $\Delta\theta \to 0$ |
| $e,\ e(x, \theta)$ | `e : KExpr n p, e.eval (x, θ)` | syntax tree of a rate law built from constants, x_i, θ_j, +, −, ×, ÷, integer and real powers, exp and log; its value |
| $\mathrm{ok}_e(x, \theta)$ | `e.ok (x, θ)` | e is well defined at (x, $\theta$): non-zero denominators, positive bases of real powers and positive arguments of log |
| $F_1, \ldots, F_n;\ f_F$ | `F : Fin n → KExpr n p, field F x θ` | rate expressions of a kinetic model and the vector field they define |
| $\mathcal{D}_F$ | `domain F` | set of (x, $\theta$) where all F_i are well defined |
| $P,\ \theta_P > 0$ | `pos, PosParams pos θ` | parameters declared positive, and the condition $\theta$_j > 0 for those parameters |
| $y \ge 0$ | `Nonneg y` | all components of y are non-negative |
| $\Sigma,\ y \in P_\Sigma$ | `sx, SPos sx y` | species required to stay strictly positive; y ≥ 0 and y_j > 0 for j ∈ Σ |
| $(r_k, \nu_k)$ | `Rx : List (KExpr × List (Fin n × ℚ))` | reaction k with rate law r_k and stoichiometric column $\nu$_k |
| $f_i = \sum_k \nu_{ik} r_k$ | `netF Rx, coef` | vector field of a reaction network; $\nu$_ik = coef |
| $w_i$ | `c : Fin n → ℚ` | positive weights of the growth (Lyapunov-type) bound Σ_i w_i f_i ≤ a + b Σ_i w_i x_i |
| $\theta_q,\ x_q$ | `θq, xq` | rational parameter values and initial values taken from the model files |
| $\iota(q)$ | `qvec q` | rational vector viewed as a real vector |
| `check`$(\cdot) = \mathrm{true}$ | `checkModel, checkNet, ... = true` | a Boolean checker, executed by Lean on the model, returns true |

## Steps 1–13. Finite-dimensional core of the method (fixed sensitivity matrix)

### Step 1. `FirstOrderErrorBound` (12)

First-order (linearised) output error when the parameters outside S are fixed. Here J is a numeric m × p matrix.

Notation: $(J\Delta\theta)_i$ (`linResponse J Δθ i`): linear response of output i: Σ_j J_ij Δθ_j; $(J\Delta\theta_S)_i$ (`reducedResponse J S Δθ i`): linear response with only the parameters in S perturbed; $\|v\|^2$ (`sqNorm v`): sum of squares of the components of v.

**Supplementary Table S7.** Statements of the formal theorems and lemmas, one block per module. Step 1: `FirstOrderErrorBound`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `sqNorm_nonneg` | $\|v\|^2 \geq 0$ | A sum of squares is non-negative. |
| `columnEnergy_nonneg` | $E_j \geq 0$ | Each sensitivity energy is non-negative. |
| `removedColumnEnergy_nonneg` | $E_{S^c} \geq 0$ | The discarded energy is non-negative. |
| `removedParamSq_nonneg` | $\|\Delta\theta_{S^c}\|^2 \geq 0$ | The size of the discarded perturbation is non-negative. |
| `sum_split` | $\sum_j f_j = \sum_{j\in S} f_j + \sum_{j\notin S} f_j$ | A sum over all parameters splits into selected plus discarded ones. |
| `total_eq_kept_add_removed` | $\mathrm{tr}(J^\top J) = E_S + E_{S^c}$ | Total energy = kept energy + discarded energy. |
| `response_sub_reduced` | $(J\Delta\theta)_i - (J\Delta\theta_S)_i = \sum_{j\notin S} J_{ij}\Delta\theta_j$ | The truncation error is exactly the contribution of the discarded columns. |
| `first_order_error_sq_bound` | $\|J\Delta\theta - J\Delta\theta_S\|^2 \leq E_{S^c}\,\|\Delta\theta_{S^c}\|^2$ | First-order error bound (squared form, Cauchy–Schwarz). |
| `first_order_error_bound` | $\|J\Delta\theta - J\Delta\theta_S\| \leq \sqrt{E_{S^c}}\,\|\Delta\theta_{S^c}\|$ | First-order error bound (norm form). |
| `removedParamSq_le` | $\|\Delta\theta_{S^c}\|^2 \leq \|\Delta\theta\|^2$ | The discarded part of a perturbation is no larger than the whole perturbation. |
| `first_order_error_from_removed_fraction` | $E_{S^c} \leq \varepsilon E \;\Rightarrow\; \|J\Delta\theta - J\Delta\theta_S\|^2 \leq \varepsilon\, E\,\|\Delta\theta\|^2$ | If at most a fraction $\varepsilon$ of the energy is discarded, the first-order error is at most $\sqrt{(\varepsilon \mathrm{E})}\|\Delta\theta\|$. |
| `first_order_error_from_Rvar` | $rE \leq E_S \;\Rightarrow\; \|J\Delta\theta - J\Delta\theta_S\|^2 \leq (1-r)\,E\,\|\Delta\theta\|^2$ | Stage-1 criterion: R_var(S) ≥ r bounds the first-order error by $\sqrt{((1 – r)\mathrm{E})}\|\Delta\theta\|$. |

### Step 2. `TrajectoryErrorBound` (9)

From the linear map to the true (nonlinear) output: error of the reduced model for small perturbations.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 2: `TrajectoryErrorBound`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `keepS_apply` | $(h_S)_j = \begin{cases} h_j & j \in S \\ 0 & j \notin S \end{cases}$ | Definition of the restricted perturbation. |
| `norm_keepS_le` | $\|h_S\| \le \|h\|$ | Restricting a perturbation cannot increase its size. |
| `clm_apply_eq_linResponse` | $(L\Delta\theta)_i = \sum_j J_{ij}\Delta\theta_j$ | A linear map acts through its matrix J. |
| `clm_keepS_eq_reducedResponse` | $(L\Delta\theta_S)_i = \sum_{j\in S} J_{ij}\Delta\theta_j$ | Same for the restricted perturbation. |
| `linear_part_bound` | $\|L\Delta\theta - L\Delta\theta_S\| \le \sqrt{E_{S^c}}\,\|\Delta\theta_{S^c}\|$ | Linear error bound for a linear map. |
| `sqrt_removedParamSq_le` | $\|\Delta\theta_{S^c}\| \le \|\Delta\theta\|$ | Norm form of the previous inequality on perturbations. |
| `remainder_isLittleO` | $\big[F(\theta_0{+}\Delta\theta) - F(\theta_0{+}\Delta\theta_S)\big] - \big[L\Delta\theta - L\Delta\theta_S\big] = o(\|\Delta\theta\|)$ | If F is differentiable at $\theta_0$ with derivative L, the nonlinear error differs from the linear one by a term of higher order. |
| `trajectory_error_bound` | $\forall\eta>0,\ \forall\Delta\theta\approx 0:\ \|F(\theta_0{+}\Delta\theta) - F(\theta_0{+}\Delta\theta_S)\| \le \sqrt{E_{S^c}}\,\|\Delta\theta_{S^c}\| + \eta\|\Delta\theta\|$ | Local error bound of the reduced model for the true output map. |
| `trajectory_error_from_Rvar` | $rE \le E_S \Rightarrow \forall\eta>0,\forall\Delta\theta\approx 0:$ $\|F(\theta_0{+}\Delta\theta) - F(\theta_0{+}\Delta\theta_S)\| \le \big(\sqrt{(1-r)E}+\eta\big)\|\Delta\theta\|$ | Same bound expressed with R_var(S) ≥ r. |

### Step 3. `ScaledError` (5)

Theorem 1 of the paper: the minimum relative error after rescaling the reduced response equals $\sqrt{(1 - \cos^2\Delta)}$.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 3: `ScaledError`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `norm_sub_smul_sq` | $\|a-\alpha b\|^2 = \|a\|^2 - 2\alpha\langle a,b\rangle + \alpha^2\|b\|^2$ | Expansion of the squared error. |
| `scaled_error_ge` | $\|a\|^2 - \dfrac{\langle a,b\rangle^2}{\|b\|^2} \le \|a-\alpha b\|^2 \quad \forall\alpha$ | Lower bound for every scaling $\alpha$ (b ≠ 0). |
| `scaled_error_eq` | $\left\|a - \dfrac{\langle a,b\rangle}{\|b\|^2}b\right\|^2 = \|a\|^2 - \dfrac{\langle a,b\rangle^2}{\|b\|^2}$ | The bound is attained at $\alpha^* = \langle$a,b$\rangle/\|$b$\|^2$. |
| `scaled_error_cos` | $\|a\|^2 - \dfrac{\langle a,b\rangle^2}{\|b\|^2} = \|a\|^2\big(1-\cos^2(a,b)\big)$ | Rewriting in terms of the cosine. |
| `min_rel_error_eq` | $\min_\alpha \dfrac{\|a-\alpha b\|}{\|a\|} = \sqrt{1-\cos^2(a,b)}$ | Theorem 1: with a the full response and b the reduced one, the best relative error is $\sqrt{(1 - \cos^2\Delta)}$; hence cos Δ ≥ c ⇔ error ≤ $\tau_e$. |

### Step 4. `CosineCertificate` (5)

Non-asymptotic bounds for finite perturbations and a per-scenario certificate of cos Δ.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 4: `CosineCertificate`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `cos_lower_of_rel_error` | $c^2+\varepsilon^2\le 1,\ \|a-b\|\le\varepsilon\|a\|\Rightarrow c\,\|a\|\,\|b\|\le\langle a,b\rangle$ | A small relative error implies a large cosine. |
| `cos_ge_of_rel_error` | $0\le\varepsilon<1,\ c\ge 0,\ c^2+\varepsilon^2\le 1,\ \|a-b\|\le\varepsilon\|a\|,\ a\ne 0\Rightarrow b\ne 0,\ \cos(a,b)\ge c$ | Same, with the cosine itself. |
| `taylor_bound` | $\|F(\theta_0+h)-F(\theta_0)-DF(\theta_0)h\|\le L_c\|h\|^2\quad(\|h\|\le\rho_0)$ | Taylor bound when DF is L_c-Lipschitz on the ball. |
| `finite_trajectory_error` | $\|F(\theta_0+h)-F(\theta_0+h_S)\|\le\sqrt{E_{S^c}}\,\|h_{S^c}\|+2L_c\|h\|^2$ | Error of the reduced model for a finite perturbation (E computed from J = DF($\theta_0$)). |
| `finite_cos_certificate` | $A=\|Jh\|-L_c\|h\|^2>0,\ \big(\sqrt{E_{S^c}}\|h_{S^c}\|+2L_c\|h\|^2\big)^2\le(1-c^2)A^2\Rightarrow\cos\Delta(h)\ge c$ | Certificate of cos Δ for one perturbation h, computable from J, L_c and ‖h‖. |

### Step 5. `RefitMonotone` (5)

Re-estimating more parameters never increases the fitting error.

Notation: $\mathcal{B}$ (`B`): admissible parameter region (bounds); $r(\theta)\ge 0$ (`r`): fitting error of $\theta$ (for example the relative output error); feas($S$) (`feas θ0 B S`): $\{\theta\in\mathcal{B}:\theta_\mathrm{j}=\theta_{0,j}\text{ for j}\notin\mathrm{S}\}$; $e_{\mathrm{fit}}(S)=\inf_{\theta\in\mathrm{feas}(S)}r(\theta)$ (`fitErr r θ0 B S`): best error when only S is re-estimated.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 5: `RefitMonotone`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `feas_mono` | $S\subseteq T\Rightarrow\mathrm{feas}(S)\subseteq\mathrm{feas}(T)$ | More free parameters, more candidates. |
| `fitErr_anti` | $S\subseteq T\Rightarrow e_{\mathrm{fit}}(T)\le e_{\mathrm{fit}}(S)$ | The fitting error is anti-monotone in S. |
| `fitErr_union_le` | $e_{\mathrm{fit}}(S\cup C)\le e_{\mathrm{fit}}(S)$ | Adding the calibration parameters C never hurts. |
| `fitErr_le_erel` | $\theta_s\in\mathrm{feas}(S)\Rightarrow e_{\mathrm{fit}}(S)\le r(\theta_s)$ | e_fit ≤ e_rel: re-estimating is never worse than keeping the perturbed values of S. |
| `admissible_mono` | $S\subseteq T,\ e_{\mathrm{fit}}(S)\le\tau\Rightarrow e_{\mathrm{fit}}(T)\le\tau$ | Admissibility is preserved when parameters are added. |

### Step 6. `Poda` (4)

Theorem 2 of the paper: backward elimination (pruning) returns an admissible subset from which no parameter can be removed; with a monotone criterion, no proper subset of it is admissible.

Notation: $Q(S)$ (`Q`): admissibility predicate; prune($S$) (`prune Q pick hpick S`): repeatedly remove an element whose removal keeps Q, until none exists.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 6: `Poda`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `prune_spec` | $Q(S) \Rightarrow Q(R) \ \wedge \ R \subseteq S \ \wedge \ \forall x \in R : \neg Q(R \setminus \{x\}), \quad R = \mathrm{prune}(S)$ | Pruning keeps admissibility and stops at a set from which no single parameter can be removed. |
| `exists_minimal_admissible` | $Q(S) \Rightarrow \exists R \subseteq S : \ Q(R) \ \wedge \ \forall x \in R : \neg Q(R \setminus \{x\})$ | Every admissible subset contains an admissible subset from which no single parameter can be removed. |
| `no_proper_admissible_of_monotone` | $(U \subseteq T \wedge Q(U) \Rightarrow Q(T)) \ \wedge \ \forall x \in R : \neg Q(R \setminus \{x\}) \Rightarrow \forall U \subsetneq R : \ \neg Q(U)$ | With a monotone criterion, no single removable parameter implies that no proper subset is admissible. |
| `prune_inclusion_minimal` | $Q$ monotone, $Q(S) \Rightarrow Q(R) \ \wedge \ R \subseteq S \ \wedge \ \forall U \subsetneq R : \ \neg Q(U)$ | Pruning returns an inclusion-minimal admissible subset when the criterion is monotone (for e_fit: RefitMonotone.admissible_mono, with optimal re-estimation). |

### Step 7. `IdentifiabilityConditioning` (10)

Bounds on $\kappa$ and VIF imply unique and stable least-squares estimates.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 7: `IdentifiabilityConditioning`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `IsLSMin.inner_residual_eq_zero` | $v \in \mathrm{LS}(Z, y) \Rightarrow \langle Zv - y, Zw \rangle = 0 \ \ \forall w$ | Normal equations: the residual is orthogonal to the range of Z. |
| `ls_response_stability` | $\|Z(v - v')\| \leq \|y - y'\|$ | Fitted responses are 1-Lipschitz in the data (v, v′ least-squares estimates for data y, y′). |
| `ls_param_stability` | $\sigma_{\min}\|u\| \leq \|Zu\| \Rightarrow \|v - v'\| \leq \|y - y'\|/\sigma_{\min}$ | Parameter estimates are stable when $\sigma_{\min} > 0$. |
| `ls_unique` | $\sigma_{\min} > 0 \Rightarrow v = v'$ (same $y$) | The least-squares estimate is unique. |
| `one_le_kappa_mul_sigmaMin` | $\|Ze_j\| = 1, \ \sigma_{\max} \leq \kappa\sigma_{\min} \Rightarrow 1 \leq \kappa\,\sigma_{\min}$ | With unit columns, $\sigma_{\max} \geq 1$. |
| `ls_kappa_stability` | $\|Ze_j\| = 1 \Rightarrow \|v - v'\| \leq \kappa\,\|y - y'\|$ | With normalised columns, $\kappa$ bounds the sensitivity of the estimates to the data. |
| `ls_param_kappa_stability` | $\|D(\theta - \theta')\| \leq \kappa\,\|y - y'\|$ | Same for the estimates in the original scale, $\theta = \mathrm{D}^{-1}\mathrm{v}$ with a column-scaling D. |
| `ls_vif_coordinate_stability` | $\big(u_j = 1 \Rightarrow \|Zu\|^2 \geq 1/V\big) \Rightarrow \|v_j - v'_j\| \leq \sqrt{V}\,\|y - y'\|$ | A bounded VIF makes each coordinate stable. |
| `vif_geometric_of_inverse` | $\langle Zw, Zu \rangle = u_j \ \forall u, \ w_j \leq V \Rightarrow \big(u_j = 1 \Rightarrow \|Zu\|^2 \geq 1/V\big)$ | The VIF computed from the inverse Gram matrix (w = $(\mathrm{Z}^\top\mathrm{Z})^{-1}$e_j, VIF_j = w_j) implies the geometric condition. |
| `ls_vif_inverse_stability` | $w_j \leq V \Rightarrow \|v_j - v'_j\| \leq \sqrt{V}\,\|y - y'\|$ | Coordinate stability from the VIF as computed numerically. |

**Step 8.** `SpectralConditioning` **(22)**

$\kappa$ and VIF exactly as computed numerically: eigenvalues of the Gram matrix and the inverse matrix.

Notation: $G = Z^\top Z$ (`gram Z`): Gram operator; $\lambda_1 \geq \cdots \geq \lambda_k,\ v_i$ (`lam Z, evec Z`): eigenvalues (decreasing) and orthonormal eigenvectors of G; $\lambda_{\max} = \lambda_1,\ \lambda_{\min} = \lambda_k$ (`lam Z (iMax hk), lam Z (iMin hk)`): largest and smallest eigenvalue (k > 0); $\kappa = \sqrt{\lambda_{\max}/\lambda_{\min}}$: condition number of Z; $M$ (`M : Matrix (Fin m) (Fin k) ℝ, matCLM M`): numeric matrix and the linear map it defines.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 8: `SpectralConditioning`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `inner_gram` | $\langle Gu, v\rangle = \langle Zu, Zv\rangle$ | Defining property of the Gram operator. |
| `gram_isSymmetric` | $G = G^\top$ | The Gram operator is symmetric. |
| `finrank_eq` | $\dim \mathbb{R}^k = k$ | Dimension (needed for the spectral theorem). |
| `lam_antitone` | $\lambda_1 \geq \lambda_2 \geq \cdots \geq \lambda_k$ | Eigenvalues are sorted in decreasing order. |
| `gram_evec` | $Gv_i = \lambda_i v_i$ | Eigenvector equation. |
| `sq_norm_apply_evec` | $\|Zv_i\|^2 = \lambda_i$ | Eigenvalues are squared singular values. |
| `lam_nonneg` | $\lambda_i \geq 0$ | The Gram matrix is positive semidefinite. |
| `sq_norm_apply_eq_sum` | $\|Zu\|^2 = \sum_i \lambda_i \langle v_i, u\rangle^2$ | Spectral decomposition of $\|$Zu$\|^2$. |
| `sq_norm_eq_sum` | $\|u\|^2 = \sum_i \langle v_i, u\rangle^2$ | Parseval identity in the eigenbasis. |
| `sq_norm_bounds` | $lo \leq \lambda_i \leq hi\ \forall i \Rightarrow lo\,\|u\|^2 \leq \|Zu\|^2 \leq hi\,\|u\|^2$ | Eigenvalue bounds give norm bounds. |
| `lam_le_max` | $\lambda_i \leq \lambda_{\max}$ | Largest eigenvalue. |
| `min_le_lam` | $\lambda_{\min} \leq \lambda_i$ | Smallest eigenvalue. |
| `norm_bounds` | $\sqrt{\lambda_{\min}}\,\|u\| \leq \|Zu\| \leq \sqrt{\lambda_{\max}}\,\|u\|$ | Extreme singular values bound $\|$Zu$\|$. |
| `opNorm_eq_sqrt_lamMax` | $\|Z\| = \sqrt{\lambda_{\max}}$ | The operator norm is the largest singular value. |
| `sqrt_lamMin_mul_le` | $\sqrt{\lambda_{\min}}\,\|u\| \leq \|Zu\|$ | Lower bound by the smallest singular value. |
| `le_sqrt_lamMin` | $\big(\forall u:\ \sigma\|u\| \leq \|Zu\|\big) \Rightarrow \sigma \leq \sqrt{\lambda_{\min}}$ | $\sqrt{\lambda_{\min}}$ is the best possible lower constant. |
| `ls_kappa_stability_spectral` | $\|Ze_j\| = 1,\ \lambda_{\min} > 0 \Rightarrow \|v - v'\| \leq \sqrt{\lambda_{\max}/\lambda_{\min}}\,\|y - y'\|$ | Stability of least squares with $\kappa$ exactly as computed (ratio of singular values). |
| `matCLM_apply` | $(\mathrm{matCLM}\,M)\,u = Mu$ | A matrix acts on vectors by multiplication. |
| `inner_matCLM` | $\langle Mu, Mv\rangle = u^\top (M^\top M) v$ | Inner products through the Gram matrix. |
| `gram_toEuclideanLin` | $G(\mathrm{matCLM}\,M) = M^\top M$ | The abstract Gram operator is the matrix $M^\top M$. |
| `vif_matrix_inverse` | $\det(M^\top M) \neq 0,\ w = (M^\top M)^{-1} e_j \Rightarrow \langle Mw, Mu\rangle = u_j\ \forall u,\ w_j = [(M^\top M)^{-1}]_{jj}$ | The diagonal of the inverse Gram matrix (the VIF for normalised columns) satisfies the hypothesis of vif_geometric_of_inverse. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 8: `SpectralConditioning`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `ls_vif_matrix_stability` | $[(M^\top M)^{-1}]_{jj} \le V \Rightarrow \lvert v_j - v'_j\rvert \le \sqrt{V}\,\lVert y - y'\rVert$ | Coordinate stability with the VIF exactly as computed numerically. |

### Step 9. `GreedySelection` (7)

The greedy selection algorithm with permanent discard and its guarantees.

Notation: $G = \text{greedy}(\text{ok}, \text{stop}, l, S)$ (`greedy ok stop l S`): scan the ordered list l; add j if ok(S ∪ {j}), otherwise discard j permanently; stop when stop(S); okKappa$(Z, \kappa_0, S)$ (`okKappa Z` $\kappa_0$ `S`): $\exists\, \sigma_{\min} > 0$, $\sigma_{\max} \le \kappa_0 \sigma_{\min}$ with $\sigma_{\min}\|u\| \le \|Zu\| \le \sigma_{\max}\|u\|$ for all u supported on S ($\kappa \le \kappa_0$); okVIF$(Z, V, S)$ (`okVIF Z V S`): for j ∈ S and every u supported on S with u_j = 1: $\|Zu\|^2 \ge 1/V$ (VIF_j ≤ V).

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 9: `GreedySelection`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `greedy_ok` | $\text{ok}(S) \Rightarrow \text{ok}(G)$ | The result always passes the test. |
| `greedy_subset` | $S \subseteq G \subseteq S \cup l$ | The result only contains the start set and candidates from the list. |
| `greedy_discard_permanent` | ok anti-monotone, $j \in l,\ j \notin G \Rightarrow \neg\,\text{ok}(G \cup \{j\})\ \vee\ \text{stop}(G)$ | Discarding is never a mistake: a rejected candidate would still fail with the final set. |
| `supportedOn_mono` | $S \subseteq T,\ \text{supp}\,u \subseteq S \Rightarrow \text{supp}\,u \subseteq T$ | Support is monotone. |
| `okKappa_anti` | $S \subseteq T,\ \text{okKappa}(T) \Rightarrow \text{okKappa}(S)$ | Removing parameters never worsens the condition number. |
| `okVIF_anti` | $S \subseteq T,\ \text{okVIF}(T) \Rightarrow \text{okVIF}(S)$ | Removing parameters never worsens the VIF. |
| `greedy_kappa_vif_guarantee` | $R = \text{greedy}(\text{okKappa} \wedge \text{okVIF}, \text{stop}, l, \emptyset)$ : $\kappa(R) \le \kappa_0,\ \text{VIF}(R) \le V,\ R \subseteq l,\ \forall j \in l \setminus R:\ R \cup \{j\}$ fails $\vee$ stop$(R)$ | Guarantee of the selection step: the returned subset satisfies $\kappa \le \tau_\kappa$ and VIF $\le \tau_{\text{VIF}}$, and every discarded candidate would violate one of them. |

### Step 10. `PatternMechanisms` (4)

Mechanisms behind the robustness patterns: opposing effects and zero discarded energy.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 10: `PatternMechanisms`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `not_okKappa_of_kernel` | $u \ne 0,\ \text{supp}\,u \subseteq S,\ Zu = 0 \Rightarrow \neg\,\text{okKappa}(Z, \kappa_0, S)\ \forall \kappa_0$ | If two or more parameters in S have exactly compensating effects, no threshold accepts S. |
| `ls_not_unique_of_kernel` | $Zu = 0,\ u \ne 0,\ v \in \text{LS}(Z, y) \Rightarrow v + u \in \text{LS}(Z, y),\ v + u \ne v$ | In that case the estimate is not unique (non-identifiability). |
| `opposing_pair_kernel` | $Ze_a = \lambda Z e_b,\ a \ne b \Rightarrow e_a - \lambda e_b \ne 0,\ Z(e_a - \lambda e_b) = 0$ | Two proportional sensitivity columns give a kernel vector. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 10: `PatternMechanisms`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `exact_reduction_of_zero_energy` | $E_{S^c} = 0 \Rightarrow J\Delta\theta = J\Delta\theta_S$ | If the discarded parameters have zero sensitivity, the reduction is exact to first order. |

### Step 11. `NumericalRobustness` (6)

From approximate numerical values (finite differences, rounding) to the exact hypotheses, with explicit margins.

Notation: $\tilde{J}$, $\tilde{Z}$ (`Jt, Zt`): approximate (computed) matrices; $\tau$, $\tau_j$ ($\tau$): bounds on the approximation error; $J_{\cdot j}$ (`col J j`): column j of J.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 11: `NumericalRobustness`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `fd_column_error` | $\|v\| = 1,\ 0 < \delta \le \rho_0 \Rightarrow$ $\left\|\frac{F(\theta_0+\delta v) - F(\theta_0)}{\delta} - DF(\theta_0)v\right\| \le L_c\,\delta$ | Error of a finite-difference column with step $\delta$. |
| `columnEnergy_eq_norm_sq` | $E_j = \|J_{\cdot j}\|^2$ | Energy of a column is its squared norm. |
| `rvar_certified_from_approx` | $\|J_{\cdot j} - \tilde{J}_{\cdot j}\| \le \tau_j,\ r\Big(\sum_{j\in S}(\|\tilde{J}_{\cdot j}\| - \tau_j)_+^2 + \sum_{j\notin S}(\|\tilde{J}_{\cdot j}\| + \tau_j)^2\Big) \le \sum_{j\in S}(\|\tilde{J}_{\cdot j}\| - \tau_j)_+^2 \Rightarrow rE(J) \le E_S(J)$ | R_var(S) $\ge$ r for the exact matrix follows from a check on the approximate one with margins. |
| `opNorm_le_frobenius` | $\|Du\| \le \sqrt{\sum_j \|De_j\|^2}\,\|u\|$ | Operator norm bounded by the Frobenius norm. |
| `kappa_certified_from_approx` | $\|(Z - \tilde{Z})u\| \le \tau\|u\|,\ \tau < \tilde{\sigma}_{\min},\ \tilde{\sigma}_{\max} + \tau \le \kappa_0(\tilde{\sigma}_{\min} - \tau) \Rightarrow \mathrm{okKappa}(Z, \kappa_0, S)$ | $\kappa \le \kappa_0$ for the exact matrix from bounds on the approximate one. |
| `vif_certified_from_approx` | $\mathrm{okVIF}(\tilde{Z}, \tilde{V}, S),\ \tau < \tilde{\sigma}_{\min} \Rightarrow \mathrm{okVIF}\Big(Z, \frac{\tilde{V}}{(1 - \tau/\tilde{\sigma}_{\min})^2}, S\Big)$ | VIF bound for the exact matrix from the approximate one. |

### Step 12. `LinearizedFit` (3)

The linearised e_fit (used for large systems) and its relation to the exact e_fit.

Notation: $A(c)$, $F(c)$ (`A, F`): linear and exact responses as functions of the re-estimated parameters c; $d$ (`d`): target response (perturbed full model).

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 12: `LinearizedFit`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `lin_le_scaled` | $b \in V,\ v = \arg\min_{w\in V} \|d - w\| \Rightarrow \|d - v\| \le \|d\|\sqrt{1 - \cos^2(d, b)}$ | The linear best fit in a subspace containing b is at least as good as rescaling b. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 12: `LinearizedFit`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `fit_upper_of_lin` | $\|F(c) - A(c)\| \le M\|c\|^2 \Rightarrow \|F(c) - d\| \le \|A(c) - d\| + M\|c\|^2$ | Upper bound: the exact error at the linear optimum exceeds the linear error by at most a second-order term. |
| `fit_lower_of_lin` | $\|F(c) - A(c)\| \le M\|c\|^2\ \forall c,\ e_{\text{lin}} \le \|A(c) - d\|\ \forall c,\ \|c\| \le \rho \Rightarrow e_{\text{lin}} - M\rho^2 \le \|F(c) - d\|$ | Lower bound: no exact fit within radius $\rho$ is better than e_lin – M$\rho^2$. |

### Step 13. `OutputComposition` (4)

Error bounds transfer from states to measured outputs y_i = h(g_i(x(t_i), $\theta$))/$\sigma$_i, including log and log10 transforms.

Notation: $G_i$ (`G i`): observation function of output i.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 13: `OutputComposition`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `output_sq_bound` | $\|G_i(x_i) - G_i(x_i')\| \le K\|x_i - x_i'\| \Rightarrow \sum_i \big(G_i(x_i) - G_i(x_i')\big)^2 \le K^2 \sum_i \|x_i - x_i'\|^2$ | Lipschitz observables transfer squared state errors to outputs. |
| `output_uniform_bound` | $\|x_i - x_i'\| \le \varepsilon \Rightarrow \sum_{i \in s} \big(G_i(x_i) - G_i(x_i')\big)^2 \le \|s\|\, K^2 \varepsilon^2$ | Uniform version. |
| `log_lipschitz` | $a, b \ge c > 0 \Rightarrow \|\log a - \log b\| \le \|a - b\|/c$ | Natural logarithm is Lipschitz away from 0. |
| `log10_lipschitz` | $a, b \ge c > 0 \Rightarrow \|\log_{10} a - \log_{10} b\| \le \dfrac{\|a - b\|}{c \ln 10}$ | Same for log10 (PEtab observable transformation). |

## Steps 14–18. Ordinary differential equations: existence and sensitivities

### Step 14. `GlobalLipschitzODE` (3)

Existence of solutions on a whole interval for vector fields that are Lipschitz in the state.

Notation: $\text{Sol}_{[a,c]}(\alpha)$ (`IsSolOn v a c` $\alpha$): $\alpha$ solves $\alpha'$(t) = v(t, $\alpha$(t)) on [a, c].

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 14: `GlobalLipschitzODE`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `isSolOn_self` | $\text{Sol}_{[a,a]}(\alpha)$ | Every function solves the equation on a single point (base case). |
| `extend_solution` | $K(d-c) \le \frac{1}{2},\ \text{Sol}_{[a,c]}(\alpha) \Rightarrow \exists \gamma :\ \gamma(a) = \alpha(a),\ \text{Sol}_{[a,d]}(\gamma)$ | If v(t,·) is K-Lipschitz and continuous in t, a solution can be extended by a step of length at most 1/(2K) (Picard iteration). |
| `exists_solution_Icc` | $\forall y_0\ \exists \alpha :\ \alpha(a) = y_0,\ \text{Sol}_{[a,b]}(\alpha)$ | Global existence on [a, b] for a vector field that is K-Lipschitz in the state. |

**Step 15.** `ParamDiffODE` **(8)**

Differentiable dependence of ODE solutions on parameters and initial values (the derivative solves the variational equation).

Notation: $\iota_1$, $\iota_2$ (`ContinuousLinearMap.inl / inr`): embeddings u ↦ (u, 0) and k ↦ (0, k) of the state and parameter spaces into their product.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 15: `ParamDiffODE`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `uniform_linearization` | $\exists \delta \in (0, R]\ \forall z \in K_0,\ \|w - z\| \le \delta :$ $\|g(w) - g(z) - Dg(z)(w - z)\| \le \eta \|w - z\|$ | A $C^1$ function is uniformly linearisable near a compact set $K_0$ whose R-neighbourhood lies in U, for every $\eta > 0$. |
| `tube_gronwall` | $\|x_\theta(t) - y_h(t)\| \le$ $\delta_0 e^{KT} + \varepsilon_g \dfrac{e^{KT} - 1}{K} \quad \forall t \in [0, T]$ | Grönwall inequality in a tube: an approximate solution y_h with defect $\le \varepsilon_g$ that stays within $\sigma$ of the nominal trajectory, compared with an exact solution x_$\theta$ starting $\delta_0$ away; the exact solution does not leave the tube where v is K-Lipschitz. |
| `norm_comp_inl_le` | $\|L \circ \iota_1\| \le \|L\|$ | Restricting a linear map on a product to the first factor does not increase its norm. |
| `clm_prod_apply_split` | $L(u, k) = L(\iota_1 u) + L(\iota_2 k)$ | A linear map on a product splits into its state and parameter parts. |
| `lipschitzOn_slice` | $\|Df\| \le M$ on $\bar{B}(c, \rho) \times \{\theta\} \Rightarrow y \mapsto$ $f(y, \theta)$ is $M$-Lipschitz on $\bar{B}(c, \rho)$ | Lipschitz constant of a slice from a bound on the derivative. |
| `hasFDerivAt_solution_param_init` | $\exists S :\ S(0) = D_0,\ \dot{S}(t) =$ $\partial_x f(x_0(t), \theta_0) S(t) +$ $\partial_\theta f(x_0(t), \theta_0),\ \left.\dfrac{\partial x(t;\theta)}{\partial \theta}\right\|_{\theta_0} = S(t)$ | Main theorem: if f is $C^1$ on an open U containing the nominal trajectory, solutions exist for $\theta$ near $\theta_0$ and x(0;$\theta$) = $x^0(\theta)$ is differentiable, then x(t;$\theta$) is differentiable in $\theta$ for every t ∈ [0,T] and its derivative solves the variational equation. |
| `hasFDerivAt_solution_param_on` | $x(0;\theta) = x(0;\theta_0) \Rightarrow \exists S :\ S(0) = 0,\ \dot{S} =$ $\partial_x f\, S + \partial_\theta f,\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_0) = S(t)$ | Same with an initial value that does not depend on $\theta$. |
| `hasFDerivAt_solution_param` | $f \in C^1(\mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^p) \Rightarrow \exists S :\ S(0) = 0,\ \dot{S} =$ $\partial_x f\, S + \partial_\theta f,\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_0) = S(t)$ | Same for a vector field that is $C^1$ everywhere. |

**Step 16.** `LocalExistence` **(9)**

Solutions exist for all parameters near $\theta_0$ as soon as the nominal solution exists (removes the hypothesis that perturbed solutions exist).

Notation: $\mathrm{clamp}_c(y)_i = \max(-c, \min(c, y_i))$ (`clampE c y`): truncation of each component to [–c, c].

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 16: `LocalExistence`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `clampE_apply` | $\mathrm{clamp}_c(y)_i = \max(-c, \min(c, y_i))$ | Definition. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 16: `LocalExistence`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `abs_clamp_sub_le` | $\lvert \mathrm{clamp}_c(a) - \mathrm{clamp}_c(b)\rvert \le \lvert a-b\rvert$ | Scalar truncation is 1-Lipschitz. |
| `dist_clampE_le` | $\lVert \mathrm{clamp}_c(y) - \mathrm{clamp}_c(y')\rVert \le \lVert y-y'\rVert$ | Vector truncation is 1-Lipschitz. |
| `lipschitz_clampE` | $\mathrm{clamp}_c$ is 1-Lipschitz | Same, as a Lipschitz statement. |
| `clampE_eq` | $\lVert y\rVert \le c \Rightarrow \mathrm{clamp}_c(y) = y$ | Truncation does not change small vectors. |
| `clampE_zero` | $c \ge 0 \Rightarrow \mathrm{clamp}_c(0) = 0$ | Truncation fixes the origin. |
| `norm_clampE_le` | $\lVert \mathrm{clamp}_c(y)\rVert \le (n+1)\,c$ | Truncated vectors are bounded. |
| `exists_solutions_near` | $\exists x(\cdot;\theta):\ x(\cdot;\theta_0) = x_0,\ \forall \theta \approx \theta_0:\ x(0;\theta) = x^0(\theta),\ \dot{x} = f(x,\theta),\ (x(t;\theta),\theta) \in U$ | If f is $C^1$ on U, the nominal solution exists on [0,T] inside U and $x^0$ is continuous at $\theta_0$, then solutions exist on the same interval for all $\theta$ close to $\theta_0$. |
| `hasFDerivAt_of_nominal_solution` | $\exists x(\cdot;\theta),\ \exists S:\ S(0) = D_0,\ \dot{S} = \partial_x f\, S + \partial_\theta f,\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_0) = S(t)$ | Existence near $\theta_0$ and differentiability, assuming only the nominal solution. |

### Step 17. `SensitivityLipschitz` (8)

Explicit constants: Lipschitz dependence of trajectories and sensitivities on $\theta$ (Grönwall).

Notation: $g(z) = f(x,\theta),\ Dg$ (`g, Dg`): vector field as a function of z = (x, $\theta$) and its derivative.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 17: `SensitivityLipschitz`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `gronwall_zero_init` | $u(0) = 0,\ \lVert u'\rVert \le K\lVert u\rVert + \varepsilon \Rightarrow \lVert u(t)\rVert \le \varepsilon \dfrac{e^{KT}-1}{K}$ | Grönwall inequality with zero initial value. |
| `norm_comp_inl_le` | $\lVert \partial_x g\rVert \le \lVert Dg\rVert$ | The state part of a derivative is bounded by the whole derivative. |
| `norm_comp_inr_le` | $\lVert \partial_\theta g\rVert \le \lVert Dg\rVert$ | Same for the parameter part. |
| `g_lipschitz` | $\lVert Dg\rVert \le M_1$ on convex $K \Rightarrow \lVert g(z) - g(z')\rVert \le M_1\lVert z - z'\rVert$ | Mean-value inequality. |
| `norm_pair_sub_le` | $\lVert (a,b) - (a',b')\rVert \le \lVert a-a'\rVert + \lVert b-b'\rVert$ | Norm on the product space. |
| `traj_lipschitz` | $\lVert x(t;\theta) - x(t;\theta')\rVert \le \lVert \theta - \theta'\rVert\,(e^{M_1 T} - 1)$ | Trajectories depend Lipschitz-continuously on $\theta$. |
| `sens_bound` | $\lVert S(t)\rVert \le e^{M_1 T} - 1$ | Explicit bound on the sensitivity. |
| `sens_lipschitz` | $\lVert S_\theta(t) - S_{\theta'}(t)\rVert \le \lVert \theta - \theta'\rVert\, M_2\, e^{2M_1 T} \dfrac{e^{M_1 T}-1}{M_1}$ | Sensitivities depend Lipschitz-continuously on $\theta$; this gives the constant L_c used in the certificates. |

### Step 18. `EventSystems` (1)

Hypothesis 2: systems with events at fixed times (piecewise ODEs with reset maps).

Notation: $f_k,\ L_k,\ R_k$ (`f k, L k, R k`): vector field, length and reset map of segment k: y_{k+1}(0) = R_k(y_k(L_k), $\theta$).

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 18: `EventSystems`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `event_hasFDerivAt` | $\exists Y_k(\cdot;\theta):\ Y_k(\cdot;\theta_0) = y_k,\ \dot{Y}_k = f_k(Y_k,\theta),\ Y_{k+1}(0;\theta) = R_k(Y_k(L_k;\theta),\theta),\ \theta \mapsto Y_k(s;\theta)$ differentiable at $\theta_0$ | If each f_k is $C^1$, each R_k is differentiable and the nominal segments exist, solutions exist near $\theta_0$ on every segment and are differentiable in $\theta$. |

## Steps 19–22. Certificates for ODE models

### Step 19. `CertifiedODEReduction` (1)

Main local theorem for ODE models: the sensitivity exists and R_var(S) bounds the error of the reduced model.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 19: `CertifiedODEReduction`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `certified_parameter_reduction` | $\exists S(\cdot):\ S(0) = D_0,\ \dot{S} = \partial_x f\, S + \partial_\theta f,$ and $rE(\mathcal{S}) \le E_S(\mathcal{S}) \Rightarrow \forall \eta > 0, \forall \Delta\theta \approx 0:\ \|\mathcal{F}(\theta_0+\Delta\theta) - \mathcal{F}(\theta_0+\Delta\theta_S)\| \le \big(\sqrt{(1-r)E+\eta}\big)\|\Delta\theta\|$ | Hypotheses: f is $C^1$ on an open set U containing the nominal trajectory, solutions exist for $\theta$ near $\theta_0$ with initial value $x^0(\theta)$ differentiable at $\theta_0$. Conclusion: the sampled sensitivity matrix $\mathcal{S}$ exists, solves the variational equation, and the energy criterion computed from it bounds the trajectory error of fixing the parameters outside S. |

### Step 20. `CertifiedFiniteODE` (5)

Certificate of cos $\Delta$ for ODE models with a Lipschitz constant L_c that is itself bounded formally.

Notation: $\mathcal{S}u$ (`sampledCLM S tk u`): (S(t_1)u, ..., S(t_N)u), the sampled sensitivity applied to u.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 20: `CertifiedFiniteODE`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `sampledCLM_apply` | $(\mathcal{S}u)_{(k,i)} = (S(t_k)u)_i$ | Component (k, i) of the sampled sensitivity is component i of S(t_k)u. |
| `hasFDerivAt_sampled` | $\forall k:\ \partial_\theta x(t_k;\theta) = S(t_k) \Rightarrow D\mathcal{F}(\theta) = \mathcal{S}$ | If every sampled state is differentiable, so is the stacked vector, with the stacked sensitivity as derivative. |
| `jacobianOf_sampledCLM` | $J(\mathcal{S}) = \texttt{sensMatrix}(S,t)$ | The matrix of the sampled map is the Nn × p sensitivity matrix. |
| `sampledCLM_sub_le` | $\|S(t_k) - S'(t_k)\| \le B\ \forall k \Rightarrow \|\mathcal{S} - \mathcal{S}'\| \le \sqrt{N}\,B$ | Sampling N times multiplies a uniform bound by $\sqrt{N}$. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 20: `CertifiedFiniteODE`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `certified_cos_ode` | $\left(\sqrt{E_{S^c}}\|h_{S^c}\| + 2L_c\|h\|^2\right)^2 \leq (1-c^2)\left(\|\mathcal{S}_0 h\| - L_c\|h\|^2\right)^2 \Rightarrow \cos\Delta(h) \geq c, \quad L_c = \sqrt{N} M_2 e^{2M_1 T} \dfrac{e^{M_1 T} - 1}{M_1}$ | Hypotheses: f is $C^1$ on U; on a convex K $\subseteq$ U, $\|Df\| \leq M_1$ and Df is $M_2$-Lipschitz; solutions exist for $\theta$ in a set containing the ball $\bar{B}(\theta_0, \rho_0)$, start from the same initial value and stay in K. Conclusion: the sensitivity $\mathcal{S}_0$ exists and, for every subset S and every $\|h\| \leq \rho_0$ with $\|\mathcal{S}_0 h\| - L_c\|h\|^2 > 0$, the displayed inequality certifies $\cos\Delta(h) \geq c$. |

**Step 21.** `ExactLinearCertificate` **(13)**

(A1) Certificates with the exact linear error $\|J(h - h_S)\|$ instead of its energy bound, and (A2) a local version without Lipschitz constants.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 21: `ExactLinearCertificate`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `cos_certificate_of_bounds` | $0 < A \leq \|a\|,\ \|a-b\| \leq e,\ e^2 \leq (1-c^2)A^2,\ c > 0 \Rightarrow b \neq 0,\ \cos(a,b) \geq c$ | Generic certificate lemma. |
| `cosv_smul` | $\cos(ra, rb) = \cos(a,b) \quad (r > 0)$ | The cosine is invariant under a common positive rescaling. |
| `continuousAt_cosv` | $(a,b) \mapsto \cos(a,b)$ is continuous at $a \neq 0,\ b \neq 0$ | Continuity of the cosine. |
| `keepS_smul` | $(sh)_S = s\, h_S$ | Restriction to S is linear. |
| `norm_linear_part_eq` | $\|Jh - Jh_S\| = \sqrt{\sum_i \left(\sum_{j \notin S} J_{ij} h_j\right)^2}$ | The exact linear error is computable from J. |
| `finite_trajectory_error_exact` | $\|F(\theta_0 + h) - F(\theta_0 + h_S)\| \leq \|J(h - h_S)\| + 2L_c\|h\|^2$ | (A1) Finite-perturbation error with the exact linear term. |
| `exact_le_Rvar_bound` | $\|Jh - Jh_S\| \leq \sqrt{E_{S^c}}\,\|h_{S^c}\|$ | The exact bound is never worse than the energy bound. |
| `finite_cos_certificate_exact` | $\|Jh\| - L_c\|h\|^2 > 0,\ \left(\|J(h-h_S)\| + 2L_c\|h\|^2\right)^2 \leq (1-c^2)\left(\|Jh\| - L_c\|h\|^2\right)^2 \Rightarrow \cos\Delta(h) \geq c$ | (A1) Certificate of cos $\Delta$ with the exact linear error. |
| `certified_cos_ode_exact` | $\left(\|\mathcal{S}_0(h - h_S)\| + 2L_c\|h\|^2\right)^2 \leq (1-c^2)\left(\|\mathcal{S}_0 h\| - L_c\|h\|^2\right)^2 \Rightarrow \cos\Delta(h) \geq c$ | (A1) ODE version with the formally bounded L_c of certified_cos_ode. |
| `tendsto_cos_delta` | $Jh \neq 0,\ Jh_S \neq 0 \Rightarrow \lim_{s \to 0^+} \cos\Delta(sh) = \cos(Jh, Jh_S)$ | (A2) For small perturbations, cos $\Delta$ tends to the linear cosine computed from J. |
| `eventually_cos_delta_gt` | $c < \cos(Jh, Jh_S) \Rightarrow \cos\Delta(sh) > c$ for all sufficiently small $s > 0$ | (A2) Local certificate without L_c. |
| `exists_cos_delta_gt` | $c < \cos(Jh, Jh_S) \Rightarrow \exists s_0 > 0\ \forall s \in (0, s_0) : \cos\Delta(sh) > c$ | Explicit form of the previous statement. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 21: `ExactLinearCertificate`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `local_cos_ode` | $\exists \mathcal{S}_0\ \forall S, h:\ c < \cos(\mathcal{S}_0 h, \mathcal{S}_0 h_S) \Rightarrow \exists s_0 > 0\ \forall s \in (0, s_0):\ \cos \Delta_{\mathcal{F}}(sh) > c$ | (A2) ODE version: if f is $C^1$ around the nominal trajectory and solutions exist near $\theta_0$, the linear cosine computed from the sampled sensitivity certifies cos $\Delta$ for small perturbations. |

### Step 22. `NominalCertificate` (1)

Local certificate of cos $\Delta$ assuming only the nominal solution.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 22: `NominalCertificate`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `local_cos_from_nominal` | $\exists x(\cdot;\theta),\ \exists \mathcal{S}_0:\ \forall S, h:\ c < \cos(\mathcal{S}_0 h, \mathcal{S}_0 h_S) \Rightarrow \exists s_0 > 0\ \forall s \in (0, s_0):\ \cos \Delta_{\mathcal{F}}(sh) > c$ | Combines LocalExistence and ExactLinearCertificate: from the nominal solution alone, solutions near $\theta_0$ and the sensitivity exist, and the linear cosine certifies cos $\Delta$ for small perturbations. |

## Steps 23–31. Hypotheses of the benchmark models (kinetic models and reaction networks)

### Step 23. `KineticRegularity` (11)

Hypothesis 1: rate laws (mass action, Michaelis–Menten, Hill, ...) define infinitely differentiable vector fields on their domain.

Notation: $\mathrm{MM}(V, K, x) = \dfrac{Vx}{K + x}$ (`mm V K x`): Michaelis–Menten law; $\mathrm{Hill}_m = \dfrac{Vx^m}{K^m + x^m}$ (`hill V K x m`, `hillR V K x h`): Hill law with integer (m) or real (h) exponent; noDen($e$) (`e.noDen`): e has no division, real power or logarithm (mass action).

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 23: `KineticRegularity`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `KExpr.contDiffAt_eval` | $\mathrm{ok}_e(z) \Rightarrow e \in C^k$ near $z$ $(\forall k)$ | Every well-defined rate expression is smooth. |
| `KExpr.isOpen_ok` | $\{z : \mathrm{ok}_e(z)\}$ is open | The set where e is well defined is open. |
| `KExpr.ok_of_noDen` | $\mathrm{noDen}(e) \Rightarrow \mathrm{ok}_e(z)\ \forall z$ | Mass-action expressions are defined everywhere. |
| `KExpr.ok_mm` | $K > 0,\ x \geq 0 \Rightarrow \mathrm{ok}(\mathrm{MM}(V, K, x))$ | Michaelis–Menten is well defined for positive K and non-negative x. |
| `KExpr.ok_hill` | $K > 0,\ x \geq 0 \Rightarrow \mathrm{ok}(\mathrm{Hill}_m(V, K, x))$ | Hill law with integer exponent. |
| `KExpr.ok_hillR` | $K > 0,\ x > 0 \Rightarrow \mathrm{ok}(\mathrm{Hill}_h(V, K, x))$ | Hill law with real exponent requires x > 0. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 23: `KineticRegularity`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `isOpen_domain` | $\mathcal{D}_F$ is open | The domain of a kinetic model is open. |
| `contDiffOn_field` | $f_F \in C^k(\mathcal{D}_F)$ $(\forall k)$ | The vector field of a kinetic model is smooth on its domain. |
| `domain_eq_univ` | $\forall i:\ \mathrm{noDen}(F_i) \Rightarrow \mathcal{D}_F = \mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^p$ | Pure mass-action models are defined everywhere. |
| `kinetic_hasFDerivAt` | $(x_0(t), \theta_0) \in \mathcal{D}_F\ \forall t \Rightarrow \exists x(\cdot;\theta), S:\ S(0) = D_0,\ \dot{S} = \partial_x f_F\, S + \partial_\theta f_F,\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_0) = S(t)$ | Existence near $\theta_0$ and differentiability for every kinetic model whose nominal solution stays in the domain. |
| `kinetic_local_cos` | $\exists x(\cdot;\theta), \mathcal{S}_0:\ c < \cos(\mathcal{S}_0 h, \mathcal{S}_0 h_S) \Rightarrow \exists s_0 > 0\ \forall s \in (0, s_0):\ \cos \Delta_{\mathcal{F}}(sh) > c$ | Local cos $\Delta$ certificate for kinetic models. |

### Step 24. `PositivityInvariance` (15)

Quasi-positive models keep concentrations non-negative.

Notation: $y^+ = \max(y, 0)$ (`pos y`): componentwise positive part.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 24: `PositivityInvariance`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `pos_apply` | $(y^+)_i = \max(y_i, 0)$ | Definition. |
| `pos_nonneg` | $y^+ \geq 0$ | The positive part is non-negative. |
| `pos_eq_self` | $y \geq 0 \Rightarrow y^+ = y$ | Non-negative vectors are unchanged. |
| `dist_pos_le` | $\|y^+ - y'^+\| \leq \|y - y'\|$ | The positive part is 1-Lipschitz. |
| `sub_pos_apply` | $(y - y^+)_i = \min(y_i, 0)$ | Negative part. |
| `pos_apply_eq_zero` | $y_i < 0 \Rightarrow (y^+)_i = 0$ | Negative components are set to 0. |
| `isClosed_nonneg` | $\{y:\ y \geq 0\}$ is closed | The non-negative orthant is closed. |
| `hasDerivAt_negSq` | $\frac{d}{da} \min(a, 0)^2 = 2 \min(a, 0)$ | Derivative of the squared negative part. |
| `nonneg_core` | $x(a) \geq 0,\ \|v(x) - v(x^+)\| \leq K\|x - x^+\|,\ \big(x_i^+ = 0 \Rightarrow v_i(x^+) \geq 0\big) \Rightarrow x(t) \geq 0\ \forall t \in [a, b]$ | Core argument: the squared negative part satisfies a Grönwall inequality with zero initial value. |
| `nonneg_of_quasiPositive` | $\big(y \geq 0,\ y_i = 0 \Rightarrow v_i(y) \geq 0\big),\ x(0) \geq 0 \Rightarrow x(t) \geq 0\ \forall t \in [0, T]$ | Quasi-positive $C^1$ vector fields keep the orthant invariant. |
| `kinetic_nonneg` | $\mathbb{R}^n_{\geq 0} \times \{\theta\} \subseteq \mathcal{D}_F,\ f_F$ quasi-positive, $x(0) \geq 0 \Rightarrow x(t) \geq 0,\ (x(t), \theta) \in \mathcal{D}_F$ | Kinetic version. |
| `kinetic_hasFDerivAt_of_nonneg` | $\Rightarrow \exists x(\cdot;\theta), S:\ S(0) = D_0,\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_0) = S(t)$ | Kinetic models defined on the orthant: positivity plus existence near $\theta_0$ and differentiability. |
| `exampleModel_orth` | $\dot{x} = \theta_0 - \frac{\theta_1 x}{\theta_2 + x}:\ \theta_2 > 0,\ x \geq 0 \Rightarrow (x, \theta) \in \mathcal{D}$ | Worked example (Michaelis–Menten degradation): well defined on the orthant. |
| `exampleModel_qp` | $\theta_0 \geq 0,\ x = 0 \Rightarrow \dot{x} \geq 0$ | The example is quasi-positive. |
| `exampleModel_nonneg` | $\theta_0 \geq 0,\ \theta_2 > 0,\ x(0) \geq 0 \Rightarrow x(t) \geq 0$ | The example stays non-negative. |

**Step 25.** `GlobalExistence` **(11)**

Condition C4: global existence of the nominal solution under a linear growth bound on the non-negative orthant.

Notation: $\mathrm{clamp}_B(z)_i = \max(0, \min(B, z_i))$ (`clampB B z`): truncation to the box [0, B]$^n$; $[0, B]^n$ (`box B`): box.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 25: `GlobalExistence`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `clampB_apply` | $\mathrm{clamp}_B(z)_i = \max(0, \min(B, z_i))$ | Definition. |
| `clampB_nonneg` | $\mathrm{clamp}_B(z) \geq 0$ | Truncation is non-negative. |
| `clampB_le` | $B \geq 0 \Rightarrow \mathrm{clamp}_B(z)_i \leq B$ | Truncation is bounded by B. |
| `clampB_pos` | $\mathrm{clamp}_B(z^+) = \mathrm{clamp}_B(z)$ | Truncation ignores the negative part. |
| `clampB_eq` | $0 \leq z \leq B \Rightarrow \mathrm{clamp}_B(z) = z$ | Truncation fixes points of the box. |
| `dist_clampB_le` | $\lVert \mathrm{clamp}_B(y) - \mathrm{clamp}_B(y') \rVert \leq \lVert y - y' \rVert$ | Truncation is 1-Lipschitz. |
| `clampB_mem` | $\mathrm{clamp}_B(z) \in [0, B]^n$ | Truncation lands in the box. |
| `convex_box` | $[0, B]^n$ is convex | Convexity of the box. |
| `isCompact_box` | $[0, B]^n$ is compact | Compactness of the box. |
| `lipschitzOn_box` | $v \in C^1(U),\ [0, B]^n \subseteq U \Rightarrow \exists L$ : $v$ is $L$-Lipschitz on $[0, B]^n$ | $C^1$ vector fields are Lipschitz on compact boxes. |
| `exists_global_solution` | $v$ quasi-positive, $\sum_i w_i v_i(z) \leq a + b\sum_i w_i z_i\ (z \geq 0),\ x^0 \geq 0 \Rightarrow \exists x$ : $x(0) = x^0,\ \dot{x} = v(x),\ x(t) \geq 0\ \forall t \in [0, T]$ | Global existence for every horizon T: the weighted sum Σ w_i x_i grows at most exponentially, so the solution cannot blow up. |

**Step 26.** `StrictExistence` **(12)**

Global existence when some species must stay strictly positive (for example denominators x_j).

Notation: $\ell_i = \varepsilon\ (i \in \Sigma),\ 0\ (i \notin \Sigma)$ (`lo sx ε i`): lower corner of the box; $\mathrm{clamp}_Q(z)_i = \max(\ell_i, \min(B, z_i))$ (`clampQ sx ε B z`): truncation to the box Q = Π_i [ℓ_i, B]; $Q$ (`boxQ sx ε B`): box.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 26: `StrictExistence`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `lo_nonneg` | $\varepsilon \geq 0 \Rightarrow \ell_i \geq 0$ | Lower corner is non-negative. |
| `lo_le` | $0 \leq \varepsilon \leq B \Rightarrow \ell_i \leq B$ | Lower corner is below B. |
| `clampQ_apply` | $\mathrm{clamp}_Q(z)_i = \max(\ell_i, \min(B, z_i))$ | Definition. |
| `clampQ_mem` | $\mathrm{clamp}_Q(z) \in Q$ | Truncation lands in the box. |
| `boxQ_sPos` | $\varepsilon > 0,\ z \in Q \Rightarrow z \in P_\Sigma$ | The box lies in the strict region. |
| `clampQ_pos` | $\mathrm{clamp}_Q(z^+) = \mathrm{clamp}_Q(z)$ | Truncation ignores the negative part. |
| `clampQ_eq` | $\ell \leq z \leq B \Rightarrow \mathrm{clamp}_Q(z) = z$ | Truncation fixes points of the box. |
| `dist_clampQ_le` | $\lVert \mathrm{clamp}_Q(y) - \mathrm{clamp}_Q(y') \rVert \leq \lVert y - y' \rVert$ | Truncation is 1-Lipschitz. |
| `convex_boxQ` | $Q$ is convex | Convexity. |
| `isCompact_boxQ` | $Q$ is compact | Compactness. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 26: `StrictExistence`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `lipschitzOn_boxQ` | $v \in C^1(U),\ Q \subseteq U \Rightarrow v$ Lipschitz on $Q$ | Lipschitz on the box. |
| `exists_global_solution_strict` | $v$ quasi-positive on $P_\Sigma$, $v_i(z) \geq -C_B z_i$ ($i \in \Sigma,\ z \leq B$), $\sum_i w_i v_i \leq a + b\sum_i w_i z_i,\ x^0 \in P_\Sigma \Rightarrow \exists x:\ x(t) \in P_\Sigma\ \forall t \in [0,T]$ | Global existence staying in the strict region: species in $\Sigma$ decay at most exponentially and never reach 0. |

### Step 27. `KineticCheck` (19)

Verified Boolean checkers that Lean runs on each translated model (SBML → KExpr → Lean).

Notation: isNonneg, isPos, okOrth (`isNonneg pos e, isPos pos e, okOrth pos e`): syntactic tests: e $\geq 0$, e $> 0$, e well defined on the orthant; vanishes$_i$, qp$_i$ (`vanishes i e, qp pos i e`): e $= 0$ when x_i $= 0$; quasi-positivity of component i; checkModel, checkInit (`checkModel pos F, checkInit pos G`): all components pass okOrth and qp; initial expressions G pass okOrth and isNonneg.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 27: `KineticCheck`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `KExpr'.isNonneg_sound` | $y \geq 0,\ \theta_P > 0,\ \text{isNonneg}(e) \Rightarrow e(y,\theta) \geq 0$ | Soundness of the non-negativity checker. |
| `KExpr'.isPos_sound` | $y \geq 0,\ \theta_P > 0,\ \text{isPos}(e) \Rightarrow e(y,\theta) > 0$ | Soundness of the positivity checker. |
| `KExpr'.okOrth_sound` | $y \geq 0,\ \theta_P > 0,\ \text{okOrth}(e) \Rightarrow \text{ok}_e(y,\theta)$ | Soundness of the domain checker. |
| `KExpr'.vanishes_sound` | $y_i = 0,\ \text{vanishes}_i(e) \Rightarrow e(y,\theta) = 0$ | Soundness of the vanishing checker. |
| `KExpr'.qp_sound` | $y \geq 0,\ y_i = 0,\ \theta_P > 0,\ \text{qp}_i(e) \Rightarrow e(y,\theta) \geq 0$ | Soundness of the quasi-positivity checker. |
| `checkModel_spec` | $\text{checkModel}(F) \Rightarrow \text{okOrth}(F_i) \wedge \text{qp}_i(F_i)\ \forall i$ | Unfolding of the model checker. |
| `checkModel_sound` | $\text{checkModel}(F),\ \theta_P > 0 \Rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n_{\geq 0} \times \{\theta\} \subseteq \mathcal{D}_F\ \wedge\ \big(y \geq 0, y_i = 0 \Rightarrow f_{F,i}(y,\theta) \geq 0\big)$ | A checked model is well defined and quasi-positive on the orthant. |
| `checked_model_hasFDerivAt` | $x_0(0) \geq 0 \Rightarrow x_0(t) \geq 0,\ (x_0(t),\theta_0) \in \mathcal{D}_F,\ \exists x(\cdot;\theta), S:\ S(0) = D_0,\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_0) = S(t)$ | Checked model: positivity, existence near $\theta_0$ and differentiability. |
| `checked_segments_hasFDerivAt` | $y_{k+1}(0) = y_k(L_k) \Rightarrow \exists Y_k(\cdot;\theta):$ segments solve and are differentiable in $\theta$ | Same for models simulated in segments (condition changes at fixed times). |
| `qvec_apply` | $\iota(q)_i = q_i$ | Rational vectors as real vectors. |
| `posParams_qvec` | $\text{checkPosParams}(\theta_q) \Rightarrow \iota(\theta_q)_P > 0$ | The rational parameter values are positive where declared. |
| `nonneg_qvec` | $\text{checkNonneg}(x_q) \Rightarrow \iota(x_q) \geq 0$ | The rational initial values are non-negative. |
| `checked_model_final` | $\text{checkModel} \wedge \text{checkPosParams} \wedge \text{checkNonneg} \Rightarrow x_0 \geq 0,$ in $\mathcal{D}_F,\ \exists x(\cdot;\theta), S:\ S(0) = 0,\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_q) = S(t)$ | End-to-end theorem for a checked model with rational parameters and initial values. |
| `checked_segments_final` | same, for segmented models | End-to-end theorem for segmented models. |
| `checkInit_spec` | $\text{checkInit}(G) \Rightarrow \text{okOrth}(G_i) \wedge \text{isNonneg}(G_i)$ | Unfolding of the initial-value checker. |
| `nonneg_zero` | $0 \geq 0$ | The zero vector is non-negative. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 27: `KineticCheck`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `init_differentiable` | checkInit$(G) \Rightarrow \theta \mapsto$ $G(\theta)$ differentiable at $\theta_0$ | Parameter-dependent initial values are differentiable. |
| `init_nonneg` | checkInit$(G) \Rightarrow G(\theta_0) \geq 0$ | Parameter-dependent initial values are non-negative. |
| `checked_model_final_init` | $x(0;\theta) = G(\theta) : \ \ldots, \ S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_q)$ | End-to-end theorem with parameter-dependent initial values. |

### Step 28. `KineticNetwork` (18)

Reaction networks f_i = Σ_k $\nu$_ik r_k: complete automatic check including global existence (C4).

Notation: checkNet, checkGrowth (`checkNet pos Rx, checkGrowth pos c Rx`): every reaction passes the domain and quasi-positivity test; every reaction passes the linear-growth test with weights w; $\ell_e(\theta)$ (`lowval pos` $\theta$ `e`): positive constant lower bound of e (from lowerpos); $A_e, B_e$ (`linBound pos` $\theta$ `e`): coefficients of a linear bound e ≤ A + B Σ_j y_j.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 28: `KineticNetwork`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `eval_netExpr` | $f_i(z) = \sum_k \nu_{ik}\, r_k(z)$ | The network vector field is the stoichiometric sum. |
| `ok_netExpr` | $\forall k : \ \mathrm{ok}_{r_k}(z) \Rightarrow \mathrm{ok}_{f_i}(z)$ | Well-defined rates give a well-defined field. |
| `coef_mul_nonneg` | termOK$(r_k, \nu_k),\ y \geq 0,\ y_i = 0 \Rightarrow$ $\nu_{ik}\, r_k(y,\theta) \geq 0$ | Each reaction respects quasi-positivity (consumption terms vanish when the species is absent). |
| `checkNet_sound` | checkNet $\Rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n_{\geq 0} \times \{\theta\} \subseteq$ $\mathcal{D} \ \wedge \ f$ quasi-positive | Soundness of the network checker. |
| `eval_varfree` | $e$ without state variables $\Rightarrow e(y,\theta) =$ $e(y',\theta)$ | Constant expressions do not depend on the state. |
| `ssum_nonneg` | $y \geq 0 \Rightarrow \sum_j y_j \geq 0$ | Sum of a non-negative vector. |
| `lowerpos_sound` | lowerpos$(e),\ y \geq 0 \Rightarrow 0 < \ell_e(\theta) \leq e(y,\theta)$ | Denominators bounded away from 0. |
| `linBound_sound` | linOK$(e),\ y \geq 0 \Rightarrow A_e, B_e \geq 0,\ e(y,\theta) \leq$ $A_e + B_e \sum_j y_j$ | Linear upper bound of a rate law. |
| `sum_c_coef` | $\sum_i w_i \nu_{ik} = \langle w, \nu_k \rangle$ | Weighted stoichiometry. |
| `sum_c_netExpr` | $\sum_i w_i f_i = \sum_k \langle w, \nu_k \rangle\, r_k$ | Weighted sum of the vector field. |
| `checkGrowth_sound` | checkGrowth $\Rightarrow \exists a, b \geq 0 :$ $\sum_i w_i f_i(y,\theta) \leq a + b \sum_i w_i y_i \ (y \geq 0)$ | Soundness of the growth checker. |
| `checkNet_append` | checkNet$(A +\!\!+ B) =$ checkNet$(A) \wedge$ checkNet$(B)$ | The check can be split over parts of a large model. |
| `checkGrowth_append` | checkGrowth$(A +\!\!+ B) =$ checkGrowth$(A) \wedge$ checkGrowth$(B)$ | Same for the growth check. |
| `c_ge_one` | checkGrowth $\Rightarrow w_i \geq 1$ | Weights are at least 1. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 28: `KineticNetwork`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `network_exists` | checkNet, checkGrowth, $x^0 \geq 0 \Rightarrow \exists x : \dot{x} = f(x, \theta_0),\ x(t) \geq 0\ \forall t \in [0, T]$ | Global existence for checked networks. |
| `network_final` | $\Rightarrow \exists x_0 \geq 0$ on $[0, T],\ \exists x(\cdot;\theta), S :\ S(0) = 0,\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_q) = S(t)$ | End-to-end theorem for a network with rational parameters and initial values. Used by the models Bertozzi, Blasi, Boehm, Brannmark, Bruno, Chen, Froehlich, Isensee, Lang, Laske, Raimundez, Sneyd, Weber, Zhao, Zheng. |
| `network_final_init` | $x(0;\theta) = G(\theta) :\ \ldots,\ S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_q)$ | Same with parameter-dependent initial values. Used by the models Bachmann, Fujita, Lucarelli, Raia, SalazarCavazos. |
| `network_segments_final` | same, for segmented models | Same for models simulated in segments. Used by the models Giordano. |

### Step 29. `RiccatiNetwork` (9)

Existence on a finite horizon under quadratic growth (Riccati bound); used for Crauste.

Notation: $\varphi(y) = \sum_i w_i y_i$ (`phi c y`): weighted total; $Q$ (`Qof (tot c θq Rx)`): Riccati constant max(A, B/2, C) of the bound $\Sigma$ w_i f_i $\leq$ A + B$\varphi$ + C$\varphi^2$.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 29: `RiccatiNetwork`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `exists_solution_riccati` | $\sum_i w_i v_i(z) \leq Q(\varphi(z)+1)^2,\ (1+\delta)Q(\varphi(x^0)+1)T < 1 \Rightarrow \exists x \geq 0$ on $[0, T]$ | Quasi-positive field with quadratic growth: the solution exists up to the Riccati blow-up time. |
| `qval_sound` | $\mathrm{qc}(e) \Rightarrow e(y, \iota(\theta_q)) = \mathrm{qval}(e) \in \mathbb{Q}$ | Constant expressions evaluate exactly in rational arithmetic. |
| `qnn_sound` | $\mathrm{qnn}(e) \Rightarrow e = \mathrm{qval}(e) \geq 0$ | Non-negative rational constants. |
| `var_le_phi` | $w > 0,\ y \geq 0 \Rightarrow y_j \leq \varphi(y)/w_j$ | Each species is bounded by the weighted total. |
| `linV_sound` | $\mathrm{linC}(e) \Rightarrow 0 \leq e \leq A + B\varphi(y),\ A, B \geq 0$ | Linear bound of a rate law. |
| `prodV_sound` | $0 \leq a \leq A_1 + B_1\varphi,\ 0 \leq b \leq A_2 + B_2\varphi \Rightarrow 0 \leq ab \leq A + B\varphi + C\varphi^2$ | Product of two linear bounds is a quadratic bound. |
| `quadV_sound` | $\mathrm{quadC}(e) \Rightarrow 0 \leq e \leq A + B\varphi + C\varphi^2$ | Quadratic bound of a rate law. |
| `tot_sound` | $\sum_k \langle w, \nu_k \rangle r_k \leq A + B\varphi + C\varphi^2$ | Quadratic bound of the weighted vector field (sum over reactions with positive weight). |
| `riccati_final` | checkRiccati :\ $1.1\,Q(\varphi(x_q)+1)T_q < 1,\ T \leq T_q \Rightarrow \exists x_0 \geq 0$ on $[0, T],\ \exists x(\cdot;\theta), S :\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_q) = S(t)$ | End-to-end theorem on a finite horizon (Crauste: T $\leq$ 1). Used by the models Crauste. |

**Step 30.** `StrictNetwork` **(46)**

Reaction networks with strictly positive domains (e.g. $\beta$SI/N, Hill laws with real exponents): checkers and their soundness.

Notation: UB($\theta$) (`UB ub` $\theta$): declared lower/upper bounds of parameters hold; PP($\theta$) (`PP pos ub` $\theta$): $\theta$_P $> 0$ and UB($\theta$); sNonneg, snp, expLe1, sPos, sOk: syntactic tests on P_$\Sigma$: e $\geq 0$, e $\leq 0$, $0 \leq$ e $\leq 1$ (exponential of a non-positive term), e $> 0$, e well defined; Bnd($e$) (`BndB sx` $\theta$ `bx e`): $\forall$B $\exists$M: $0 \leq$ e(y,$\theta$) $\leq$ M on P_$\Sigma$ (and on [0,B]$^n$ if bx); Cons$_i$($e$) (`ConsB sx` $\theta$ `i e`): $\forall$B $\exists$K: $0 \leq$ e(y,$\theta$) $\leq$ K$\cdot$y_i on P_$\Sigma \cap$ [0,B]$^n$ (consumption term proportional to y_i); checkNetS, checkGrowthS (`checkNetS pos ub sx Rx, checkGrowthS pos ub c Rx`): network checks on the strict region.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 30: `StrictNetwork`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `keq_sound` | $\mathrm{keq}(a,b) \Rightarrow a = b$ | Syntactic equality is sound. |
| `qge1_sound` | $\mathrm{qge1}(e) \Rightarrow e \geq 1$ | Rational constant $\geq 1$. |
| `qgt1_sound` | $\mathrm{qgt1}(e) \Rightarrow e > 1$ | Rational constant $> 1$. |
| `addlb_sound` | $\theta_j \geq r \geq -q \Rightarrow q + \theta_j \geq 0$ | Sum of a constant and a parameter with a declared lower bound. |
| `subub_sound` | $0 < \theta_j \leq r \leq q \Rightarrow 0 \leq q - \theta_j \leq q$ | Difference of a constant and a parameter with a declared upper bound. |
| `ub_qvec` | $\mathrm{checkUB}(\theta_q) \Rightarrow \mathrm{UB}(\iota(\theta_q))$ | The rational parameters satisfy the declared bounds. |
| `sign_sound` | $\mathrm{sNonneg}(e) \Rightarrow e \geq 0,\ \mathrm{snp}(e) \Rightarrow e \leq 0,\ \mathrm{expLe1}(e) \Rightarrow 0 \leq e \leq 1$ | Joint soundness of the sign checkers (y $\geq$ 0, PP($\theta$)). |
| `sNonneg_sound` | $\mathrm{sNonneg}(e) \Rightarrow e(y,\theta) \geq 0$ | Non-negativity checker. |
| `expLe1_sound` | $\mathrm{expLe1}(e) \Rightarrow 0 \leq e(y,\theta) \leq 1$ | Exponential of a non-positive term. |
| `sPos_sound` | $y \in P_\Sigma,\ \mathrm{sPos}(e) \Rightarrow e(y,\theta) > 0$ | Positivity checker on the strict region. |
| `sOk_sound` | $y \in P_\Sigma,\ \mathrm{sOk}(e) \Rightarrow \mathrm{ok}_e(y,\theta)$ | Domain checker on the strict region. |
| `snp_sound` | $\mathrm{snp}(e) \Rightarrow e(y,\theta) \leq 0$ | Non-positivity checker. |
| `summand_sound` | $\mathrm{summand}(X,d) \Rightarrow 0 \leq X \leq d$ | X is a non-negative summand of d, so X/d $\in$ [0, 1]. |
| `bndB_const` | $e$ constant, $e \geq 0 \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(e)$ | Constants are bounded. |
| `bndB_div_lowerpos` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(a),\ d \geq \ell > 0 \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(a/d)$ | Division by a term bounded away from 0. |
| `bndB_summand` | $\mathrm{summand}(a,d) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(a/d)$ | Saturating terms a/(a + ...) are bounded. |
| `bndB_mul` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(a), \mathrm{Bnd}(b) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(ab)$ | Products of bounded terms. |
| `bndB_add` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(a), \mathrm{Bnd}(b) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(a+b)$ | Sums of bounded terms. |
| `bndB_frac_mul_l` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(u/d), \mathrm{Bnd}(v) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(uv/d)$ | Bounded fraction times bounded factor. |
| `bndB_frac_mul_r` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(u), \mathrm{Bnd}(v/d) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(uv/d)$ | Same, factor on the left. |
| `bndB_pair` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(a_1/d_1), \mathrm{Bnd}(a_2/d_2) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}\big(a_1a_2/(d_1d_2)\big)$ | Product of two bounded fractions. |
| `bndB_pair'` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(a_1/d_2), \mathrm{Bnd}(a_2/d_1) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}\big(a_1a_2/(d_1d_2)\big)$ | Same, crossed pairing. |
| `consB_mul_l` | $\mathrm{Cons}_i(a), \mathrm{Bnd}(b) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Cons}_i(ab)$ | Proportional to y_i times bounded. |
| `consB_mul_r` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(a), \mathrm{Cons}_i(b) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Cons}_i(ab)$ | Same, factor on the left. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 30: `StrictNetwork`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `consB_div_lowerpos` | $\mathrm{Cons}_i(a),\ d \geq \ell > 0 \Rightarrow \mathrm{Cons}_i(a/d)$ | Proportional term divided by a positive term. |
| `bndB_congr` | $e \equiv e',\ \mathrm{Bnd}(e') \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(e)$ | Bounds depend only on the value of the expression. |
| `consB_congr` | $e \equiv e',\ \mathrm{Cons}_i(e') \Rightarrow \mathrm{Cons}_i(e)$ | Same for proportional bounds. |
| `eval_pair` | $\frac{a_1 a_2}{d_1 d_2} = \frac{a_1}{d_1} \cdot \frac{a_2}{d_2}$ | Algebraic identity used to pair factors. |
| `eval_pair'` | $\frac{a_1 a_2}{d_1 d_2} = \frac{a_1}{d_2} \cdot \frac{a_2}{d_1}$ | Crossed pairing. |
| `consB_var` | $\mathrm{Cons}_i(y_i)$ | A species is proportional to itself. |
| `consB_npow` | $k \geq 1,\ \mathrm{Cons}_i(a),\ \mathrm{Bnd}(a) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Cons}_i(a^k)$ | Powers of proportional terms. |
| `bndB_npow` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(a) \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(a^k)$ | Powers of bounded terms. |
| `bndB_exp_np` | $a \leq 0 \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(e^a)$ | Exponential of a non-positive term is in (0, 1]. |
| `bndB_var` | $\mathrm{Bnd}(y_j)$ on $[0, B]^n$ | Species are bounded on the box. |
| `bq_of` | $\big(\mathrm{Bnd}(a) \wedge d \geq \ell > 0\big) \vee \mathrm{satb} \vee \mathrm{bpair} \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd}(a/d)$ | Assembles the three ways of bounding a fraction. |
| `cq_of` | $\big(\mathrm{Cons}_i(a) \wedge d \geq \ell > 0\big) \vee \mathrm{cpair} \Rightarrow \mathrm{Cons}_i(a/d)$ | Assembles the ways of proving a proportional fraction. |
| `bnd_sound` | $\mathrm{bnd}, \mathrm{satb}, \mathrm{bpair} \Rightarrow \mathrm{Bnd};\quad \mathrm{cons}, \mathrm{cpair} \Rightarrow \mathrm{Cons}_i$ | Joint soundness of the bound checkers. |
| `term_qp` | $\mathrm{termOKS}(r_k, \nu_k),\ y \in P_\Sigma,\ y_i = 0 \Rightarrow \nu_{ik} r_k(y, \theta) \geq 0$ | Quasi-positivity of each reaction on the strict region. |
| `term_decay` | $i \in \Sigma \Rightarrow \forall B\ \exists K \geq 0 :\ \nu_{ik} r_k(y, \theta) \geq -K y_i\ (y \in P_\Sigma,\ y \leq B)$ | Consumption of a strictly positive species is at most proportional to it. |
| `checkNetS_sound` | $\mathrm{checkNetS} \Rightarrow P_\Sigma \times \{\theta\} \subseteq \mathcal{D},\ f$ quasi-positive, $f_i \geq -C_B y_i\ (i \in \Sigma)$ | Soundness of the strict network checker. |
| `term_growth` | $\mathrm{growthOKS} \Rightarrow \exists A, B \geq 0 :\ \langle w, \nu_k \rangle r_k(y, \theta) \leq A + B \sum_j y_j$ | Growth bound for one reaction. |
| `checkGrowthS_sound` | $\mathrm{checkGrowthS} \Rightarrow \exists a, b \geq 0 :\ \sum_i w_i f_i \leq a + b \sum_i w_i y_i\ (y \in P_\Sigma)$ | Growth bound for the network. |
| `c_ge_oneS` | $\mathrm{checkGrowthS} \Rightarrow w_i \geq 1$ | Weights are at least 1. |
| `strict_exists` | $x^0 \in P_\Sigma \Rightarrow \exists x :\ \dot{x} = f(x, \theta_0),\ x(t) \in P_\Sigma\ \forall t \in [0, T]$ | Global existence in the strict region. |
| `init_sPos` | $\mathrm{checkInitS}(G),\ \mathrm{PP}(\theta_0) \Rightarrow G(\theta_0) \in P_\Sigma$ | Initial values lie in the strict region. |
| `strict_final_init` | $\Rightarrow x_0(t) \in P_\Sigma \cap \mathcal{D},\ \exists x(\cdot;\theta), S :\ S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_q),\ \partial_\theta x(t; \theta_q) = S(t)$ | End-to-end theorem for networks with strictly positive domains. Used by the models Armistead, Borghans, Elowitz, Okuonghae, Rahman. |

### Step 31. `IntervalInit` (5)

Parameter-dependent initial values certified with rational interval arithmetic.

Notation: $[l, u]$ (`ival θq e = some (l, u)`): rational interval enclosing the value of e at $\theta$_q; checkInitI (`checkInitI sx θq G`): interval check that G($\theta$_q) $\geq 0$ and $> 0$ on $\Sigma$.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 31: `IntervalInit`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `mul_mem_corners` | $x \in [a_1, a_2],\ y \in [b_1, b_2] \Rightarrow \min_{i,j} a_i b_j \le xy \le \max_{i,j} a_i b_j$ | Interval multiplication rule. |
| `imul_sound` | $x \in a,\ y \in b \Rightarrow xy \in a \otimes b$ | Rational interval product encloses the real product. |
| `ival_sound` | $\mathrm{ival}(e) = [l, u] \Rightarrow \mathrm{ok}_e(y, \iota(\theta_q)) \ \wedge\ l \le e(y, \iota(\theta_q)) \le u$ | Interval evaluation is sound (real powers restricted to square roots). |
| `initI_sound` | $\mathrm{checkInitI}(G) \Rightarrow (0, \iota(\theta_q)) \in \mathcal{D}_G,\ G(\iota(\theta_q)) \in P_\Sigma$ | The initial values are well defined and lie in the strict region. |
| `strict_final_initI` | $x(0;\theta) = G(\theta) :\ x_0(t) \in P_\Sigma \cap \mathcal{D},\ \exists x(\cdot;\theta), S :\ S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_q),\ \partial_\theta x(t;\theta_q) = S(t)$ | End-to-end theorem with initial values checked by interval arithmetic. Used by the models Fiedler. |

## Step 32. Identifiability of the reduced problem

### Step 32. `ProfileIdentifiability` (13)

Practical identifiability of the reduced problem by profile likelihood: lower bound of the cost increase, profiled information, guaranteed half-width t* of the confidence interval, local structural identifiability.

Notation: $\Delta\chi^2(\delta) = \|r(\hat\theta + \delta)\|^2 - \|r_0\|^2$ (`dchi2 R δ`): increase of the cost from the optimum; $A$ (`A`): sensitivity of the noise-scaled residuals at the optimum; $I_j = 1/[(A^\top A)^{-1}]_{jj}$ (`I`): profiled information of parameter j; $t^*$ (`tstar, tstarGrad`): guaranteed half-width of the confidence interval of log $\theta$_j.

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 32: `ProfileIdentifiability`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `dchi2_lower` | $\langle r_0, A\delta\rangle = 0,\ \|r(\delta) - r_0 - A\delta\| \le \varepsilon \le \|A\delta\| \Rightarrow \Delta\chi^2(\delta) \ge (\|A\delta\| - \varepsilon)^2 - 2\|r_0\|\varepsilon$ | Lower bound of the cost increase at a stationary point with bounded nonlinear remainder. |
| `info_of_inverse` | $\langle Zw, Zu\rangle = u_j\ \forall u,\ w_j > 0 \Rightarrow u_j^2/w_j \le \|Zu\|^2\ \forall u$ | Profiled information from the column w of the inverse Gram matrix. |
| `info_of_matrix` | $\det(M^\top M) \ne 0,\ [(M^\top M)^{-1}]_{jj} > 0 \Rightarrow u_j^2/[(M^\top M)^{-1}]_{jj} \le \|Mu\|^2$ | The same with the computed matrix inv(J.T @ J). |
| `dchi2_ge_of_coord` | $I\varphi(\delta)^2 \le \|A\delta\|^2,\ \|\varphi(\delta)\| \ge t^* = \dfrac{\varepsilon + \sqrt{c + 2\|r_0\|\varepsilon}}{\sqrt{I}} \Rightarrow \Delta\chi^2(\delta) \ge c$ | The profile exceeds the threshold c beyond t*. |
| `confidence_coord_lt` | $\delta \in F,\ \Delta\chi^2(\delta) < c \Rightarrow \|\varphi(\delta)\| < t^*$ | The confidence region lies in the slab —δ_j— < t*. |
| `practically_identifiable` | $t^* < d_-,\ t^* < d_+ \Rightarrow$ PracticallyIdentifiable | If t* is smaller than the distances to the bounds, $\theta$_j is practically identifiable within the bounds. |
| `tstar_linear` | $t^*(1/w, 0, c, r_0) = \sqrt{c\,w}$ | With $\varepsilon = 0$, t* is the Wald half-width $\sqrt{(c\ [(A^\top A)^{-1}]_{jj})}$. |
| `local_injective` | $\sigma\|\delta\| \le \|A\delta\|,\ \|G(\delta) - G(0) - A\delta\| \le M\|\delta\|^2,\ 0 < \|\delta\| < \sigma/M \Rightarrow G(\delta) \ne G(0)$ | Local structural identifiability: distinct parameters near the optimum give distinct outputs. |

**Supplementary Table S7.** (continued). Step 32: `ProfileIdentifiability`.

| Lean name | Statement | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| `dchi2_lower_grad` | $\lvert\langle r_0, A\delta\rangle\rvert \le \gamma\lVert A\delta\rVert \Rightarrow \Delta\chi^2(\delta) \ge (\lVert A\delta\rVert - \varepsilon)^2 - 2\gamma\lVert A\delta\rVert - 2\lVert r_0\rVert\varepsilon$ | Lower bound with a residual gradient $\gamma$ (numerical optimum). |
| `tstarGrad_zero` | $t^*_{\gamma=0} = t^*$ | With $\gamma = 0$ the two half-widths coincide. |
| `dchi2_ge_of_coord_grad` | $\lvert\varphi(\delta)\rvert \ge \dfrac{\varepsilon + \gamma + \sqrt{\gamma^2 + c + 2\lVert r_0\rVert\varepsilon + 2\gamma\varepsilon}}{\sqrt{I}} \Rightarrow \Delta\chi^2(\delta) \ge c$ | The profile exceeds c beyond t* (numerical optimum). |
| `practically_identifiable_grad` | $t^*_\gamma < d_-,\ t^*_\gamma < d_+ \Rightarrow$ PracticallyIdentifiable | Main theorem with a numerical optimum. |
| `stat_of_projection` | $\langle r_0 - p, A\delta\rangle = 0\ \forall\delta,\ \lVert p\rVert \le \gamma \Rightarrow \lvert\langle r_0, A\delta\rangle\rvert \le \gamma\lVert A\delta\rVert$ | $\gamma$ is the norm of the projection of r_0 onto the range of A. |

## Supplementary Note: Verified benchmark models

This note lists, for each of the 28 benchmark models verified in Lean, the data contained in its file in `lean_proofs/Models/`, the checks executed by the Lean kernel on those data and the final theorem that results. Each file was generated from the SBML model and the PEtab parameter table of the benchmark by `lean_translation/sbml_to_lean.py`, with every number written as an exact rational. The checks are Boolean functions proved sound in steps 27–31 (Supplementary Note *Logical sequence of the formal proofs*); each is evaluated by the Lean kernel (`decide +kernel`), so its value `true` is part of the proof. The final theorem `Models.<model>.final` then has no pending hypotheses: it states that the model satisfies the assumptions of steps 14–22 (smooth vector field on a domain containing the trajectory, existence of the nominal solution on the horizon, non-negativity, and differentiability of the solution with respect to the parameters). `#print axioms` for every final theorem reports only `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound` (`CheckModelAxioms.lean`). Supplementary Table S8 summarises the models, the next subsections describe the independent check of the translation, a complete example (Boehm) and the benchmark problems that were not verified, and the last subsections give the data of each model.

**Supplementary Table S8.** Benchmark models verified in Lean. $n$: states (species, plus time when a rate law depends on it); $p$: parameters; $R$: rate terms (reactions after splitting reversible ones); $|\Sigma|$: species proved strictly positive; horizon: time interval on which existence of the solution is proved; final theorem: family of the end-to-end theorem that the model instantiates (Supplementary Note *Statements of the formal theorems*); time: compilation time of the model files (s); fidelity: largest relative difference between the Lean translation and the SBML model evaluated by libRoadRunner (vector field, parameter values and initial values).

| Model | $n$ | $p$ | $R$ | $\lvert\Sigma\rvert$ | Horizon | Final theorem | Time | Fidelity |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Armistead_Cell DeathDis2024 | 4 | 10 | 8 | 4 | all $T \ge 0$ | `strict_final_init` | 5 | 0 |
| Bachmann_MSB2011 | 25 | 27 | 43 | – | all $T \ge 0$ | `network_final_init` | 12 | $3 \times 10^{-15}$ |
| Bertozzi_PNAS2020 | 3 | 0 | 2 | – | all $T \ge 0$ | `network_final` | 188 | 0 |
| Blasi_Cell Systems2016 | 16 | 8 | 36 | – | all $T \ge 0$ | `network_final` | 8 | $4 \times 10^{-15}$ |

**Supplementary Table S8.** Benchmark models verified in Lean. $n$: states (species, plus time when a rate law depends on it); $p$: parameters; $R$: rate terms (reactions after splitting reversible ones); $|\Sigma|$: species proved strictly positive; horizon: time interval on which existence of the solution is proved; final theorem: family of the end-to-end theorem that the model instantiates (Supplementary Note *Statements of the formal theorems*); time: compilation time of the model files (s); fidelity: largest relative difference between the Lean translation and the SBML model evaluated by libRoadRunner (vector field, parameter values and initial values).

| Model | $n$ | $p$ | $R$ | $\lvert\Sigma\rvert$ | Horizon | Final theorem | Time | Fidelity |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Boehm_JProteome Res2014 | 9 | 6 | 10 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 7 | $4 \times 10^{-16}$ |
| Borghans_Biophys Chem1997 | 3 | 20 | 9 | 3 | all $T \geq 0$ | `strict_final_init` | 5 | $2 \times 10^{-16}$ |
| Brannmark_JBC2010 | 9 | 15 | 14 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 6 | $1 \times 10^{-13}$ |
| Bruno_JExpBot2016 | 7 | 6 | 6 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 4 | $2 \times 10^{-16}$ |
| Chen_MSB2009 | 501 | 152 | 1,243 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 1080 | $8 \times 10^{-14}$ |
| Crauste_Cell Systems2017 | 5 | 12 | 12 | – | $T \leq 1$ | `riccati_final` | 6 | 0 |
| Elowitz_Nature2000 | 8 | 18 | 18 | 8 | all $T \geq 0$ | `strict_final_init` | 6 | $2 \times 10^{-16}$ |
| Fiedler_BMCSyst Biol2016 | 7 | 12 | 8 | 6 | all $T \geq 0$ | `strict_final_initI` | 15 | 0 |
| Froehlich_Cell Systems2018 | 1,228 | 4,088 | 4,487 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 2021 | $6 \times 10^{-14}$ |
| Fujita_SciSignal2010 | 9 | 16 | 13 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final_init` | 5 | $1 \times 10^{-16}$ |
| Giordano_Nature2020 | 10 | 43 | 96 | – | 6 segments | `network_segments_final` | 8 | $4 \times 10^{-16}$ |
| Isensee_JCB2018 | 25 | 32 | 34 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 8 | $1 \times 10^{-14}$ |
| Lang_PLOSComput Biol2024 | 124 | 164 | 663 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 264 | $2 \times 10^{-15}$ |
| Laske_PLOSComput Biol2019 | 34 | 6 | 51 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 10 | 0 |
| Lucarelli_Cell Systems2018 | 33 | 69 | 67 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final_init` | 26 | $4 \times 10^{-15}$ |
| Okuonghae_Chaos SolitonsFractals2020 | 8 | 14 | 11 | 6 | all $T \geq 0$ | `strict_final_init` | 5 | $7 \times 10^{-16}$ |
| Rahman_MBS2016 | 7 | 9 | 19 | 4 | all $T \geq 0$ | `strict_final_init` | 5 | $1 \times 10^{-15}$ |
| Raia_Cancer Research2011 | 14 | 18 | 14 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final_init` | 5 | $6 \times 10^{-16}$ |
| Raimundez_PCB2020 | 22 | 57 | 91 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 15 | $1 \times 10^{-12}$ |
| SalazarCavazos_MBoC2020 | 75 | 6 | 457 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final_init` | 318 | $2 \times 10^{-13}$ |
| Sneyd_PNAS2002 | 6 | 14 | 16 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 5 | $4 \times 10^{-15}$ |
| Weber_BMC2015 | 7 | 26 | 18 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 6 | 0 |
| Zhao_QuantBiol2020 | 4 | 21 | 3 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 5 | 0 |
| Zheng_PNAS2012 | 15 | 45 | 44 | – | all $T \geq 0$ | `network_final` | 7 | $1 \times 10^{-15}$ |

## Agreement of the translation with the SBML models

Lean checks the expressions it is given; whether these expressions are the model of the benchmark is a separate question. The script `lean_translation/verify_translation.py` answers it without using the translator: it reads the rate laws, the stoichiometry, the parameter values $\theta_q$ and the initial values directly from the Lean files, evaluates the vector field in floating point, and compares it with the derivatives computed by libRoadRunner from the original SBML model with the nominal parameters of the PEtab table, at the initial state and at five random positive states. It also compares $\theta_q$ with the PEtab nominal values and the initial values (or $G(\theta_q)$) with those of the SBML model. Over the 28 models, the largest relative difference is $1 \times 10^{-12}$, i.e. agreement to rounding error (Supplementary Table S8, last column). As a control, changing one parameter value, one initial value or one stoichiometric coefficient of the Lean file by 1% is detected (relative differences of $10^{-2}$). The comparison covers the model without condition-specific overrides, which is what the Lean files describe; for models defined by segments it covers the first segment.

## A complete example: Boehm_JProteomeRes2014

The model of STAT5 dimerisation by Boehm et al. is small enough to follow every step. Its file is `lean_proofs/Models/Boehm_JProteomeRes2014.lean` (about 60 lines).

**1. Model.** The SBML model has 8 species, and the stimulus decays as $e^{-\theta_1 \tau}$, where $\tau$ is time; the translator therefore adds $\tau$ as a ninth state with $\dot{\tau} = 1$. The six estimated parameters are $\theta_1 =$ Epo_degradation_BaF3 (0.02698), $\theta_2 =$ k_exp_hetero ($1.001 \times 10^{-5}$), $\theta_3 =$ k_exp_homo (0.00617), $\theta_4 =$ k_imp_hetero (0.01637), $\theta_5 =$ k_imp_homo ($9.775 \times 10^4$), $\theta_6 =$ k_phos ($1.577 \times 10^4$). The vector field is $f_i = \sum_k \nu_{ik} v_k$ with the following rate terms $v_k$ and stoichiometric coefficients $\nu_{ik}$, listed in Supplementary Table S9 (the constants come from compartment volumes and fixed parameters of the SBML model).

**Supplementary Table S9.** Rate terms and stoichiometry of the Lean model of Boehm_JProteomeRes2014.

| $k$ | Rate term $v_k$ | Stoichiometry $\nu_{\cdot k}$ |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | $\frac{7}{5}\,\frac{1}{8000000}\,e^{(-\theta_1)\,\tau}\,\mathrm{STAT5A}^2\,\theta_6$ | STAT5A: -10/7, pApA: 5/7 |
| 2 | $\frac{7}{5}\,\frac{1}{8000000}\,e^{(-\theta_1)\,\tau}\,\mathrm{STAT5A}\,\mathrm{STAT5B}\,\theta_6$ | STAT5A: -5/7, STAT5B: -5/7, pApB: 5/7 |
| 3 | $\frac{9}{20}\,\theta_3\,\mathrm{nucpApA}$ | STAT5A: 10/7, nucpApA: -20/9 |
| 4 | $\frac{9}{20}\,\theta_2\,\mathrm{nucpApB}$ | STAT5A: 5/7, STAT5B: 5/7, nucpApB: -20/9 |
| 5 | $\frac{7}{5}\,\frac{1}{8000000}\,e^{(-\theta_1)\,\tau}\,\mathrm{STAT5B}^2\,\theta_6$ | STAT5B: -10/7, pBpB: 5/7 |
| 6 | $\frac{9}{20}\,\theta_3\,\mathrm{nucpBpB}$ | STAT5B: 10/7, nucpBpB: -20/9 |
| 7 | $\frac{7}{5}\,\theta_4\,\mathrm{pApB}$ | pApB: -5/7, nucpApB: 20/9 |
| 8 | $\frac{7}{5}\,\theta_5\,\mathrm{pApA}$ | pApA: -5/7, nucpApA: 20/9 |
| 9 | $\frac{7}{5}\,\theta_5\,\mathrm{pBpB}$ | pBpB: -5/7, nucpBpB: 20/9 |
| 10 | 1 | tau: 1 |

**2. Translation into Lean.** Each rate term is a `KExpr`, for example `KExpr.npow (KExpr.var 0) 2` stands for $\mathrm{STAT5A}^2$; numbers are exact rationals, and the list `Rx` pairs each term with its stoichiometric column. The initial value is the rational vector `xq` (STAT5A and STAT5B positive, all other states 0), and $\theta_q$ holds the six parameters.

**3. Checks.** Four Boolean checks are evaluated by the Lean kernel: `net_ok` (every rate term is well defined for $x \geq 0$, and every term that consumes a species vanishes when that species is 0, so the field

is quasi-positive), `growth_ok` (with weights $w_i = 1$, $\sum_i f_i \le a + b\sum_i x_i$: the stoichiometric columns of six terms have a negative sum, and the remaining ones, the nuclear-import terms 7–9 and $\dot{\tau} = 1$, are at most linear in the states), `theta_ok` (all $\theta_j > 0$) and `x0_ok` ($x_q \ge 0$).

**4. Final theorem.** `def final := network_final pos Rx net_ok c growth_ok` $\theta_q$ `theta_ok xq x0_ok` applies the end-to-end theorem of step 28 to these data. Its statement is: for every $T \ge 0$ there is a solution $x_0$ on $[0, T]$ with $x_0(0) = x_q$, $x_0(t) \ge 0$ and $(x_0(t), \theta_q)$ in the domain; there is a family $x(\cdot;\theta)$ of solutions for $\theta$ near $\theta_q$ with $x(\cdot;\theta_q) = x_0$; and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ at $\theta_q$ with derivative $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$, solving the variational equation. These are the hypotheses of steps 14–22 for this model.

**5. Reproduction.** From the folder `lean_proofs/`, the command

```
lake env lean Models/Boehm_JProteomeRes2014.lean
```

compiles the file in a few seconds and prints

```
'Models.Boehm_JProteomeRes2014.final' depends on axioms:  [propext,
Classical.choice, Quot.sound]
```

and, from the folder `certificados/`, the command

```
python3 verifica_traduccion.py Boehm_JProteomeRes2014
```

compares the file with the SBML model (largest relative difference $4 \times 10^{-16}$).

## Benchmark problems without a verified model

Of the 34 benchmark problems analysed in the paper, 27 have a verified model; Froehlich, which is verified in Lean, is the further problem analysed only on its state trajectories. The remaining seven problems were not verified, for the following reasons. They are not counted in any statement that relies on G5. Here *verified* refers only to the formal verification in Lean of the hypotheses on the dynamics (G5): the numerical analysis of these seven problems (selection, admissibility, external validation and robustness) is complete and is reported together with the other problems in the main text and in this Supplementary Information; what is missing for them is only the machine-checked proof that their equations satisfy the hypotheses of the theorems.

- **Smith**: two reactions (R16f and R17f) have rates $k_{11}\,\mathrm{Akt}\,\max(\mathrm{PIP3} - \mathrm{basal}, 0)$ and $k_{12}\,\mathrm{PKC}\,\max(\mathrm{PIP3} - \mathrm{basal}, 0)$, written in the SBML model as a piecewise expression. The maximum has a kink at PIP3 = basal, so the vector field is not $C^1$ and the theorem on the differentiability of the solution with respect to the parameters (steps 15–17) does not apply. Finite-difference sensitivities remain valid as long as the trajectory does not cross the kink; a proof that it never does on the simulated horizon would allow the model to be verified, but it is not implemented.
- **Liu** and **Oliveira**: they contain events triggered by the state or by a parameter-dependent condition, not at fixed times; such events are outside Hypothesis 2 (step 18).
- **Alkan**: the model translates, but the syntactic checkers cannot establish well-definedness for 22 rate terms or quasi-positivity for 6 of them; this does not mean that the properties fail, only that the automatic proof does not cover them.
- **Perelson** and **Schwen**: the quasi-positivity check fails for two rate terms each, so non-negativity of the solutions is not established by the checker.
- **Beer**: smoothness and quasi-positivity are verified on both segments of the model, but the linear growth check is not satisfied, so existence of the nominal solution on the horizon is not proved; only a conditional theorem (assuming the solution exists) is available.

## Data of each model

### Armistead_CellDeathDis2024

- **File:** `Models/Armistead_CellDeathDis2024.lean`.
- **States ($n = 4$):** Cer, Sphingo, S1P, Sphinga.
- **Strictly positive species $\Sigma$ (4):** Cer, Sphingo, S1P, Sphinga.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 10$):** k00 = 0.2381; k0 = 1000; k_d = 0.9068; k1 = 0.3011; k2 = 1000; k3 = 0.001; k4 = 2.362; k5 = 0.001001; alpha_hai1a = 0.5; alpha_cer = -0.3275.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 9 of 10.
- **Rate terms:** 8, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the strict region $P_\Sigma$, quasi-positive, and consumption of species in $\Sigma$ at most proportional to their concentration (`checkNetS`); linear growth bound on $P_\Sigma$ (`checkGrowthS`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta_0) \in P_\Sigma$ (`checkInitS`); declared parameter bounds hold at $\theta_0$ (`checkUB`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference 0.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Armistead_CellDeathDis2024.final` := `strict_final_init`): for every $T \geq 0$ the nominal solution exists on $[0, T]$ and stays in $P_\Sigma$ (species in $\Sigma$ strictly positive) and in the domain; solutions near $\theta_0$ exist and are differentiable, $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Bachmann_MSB2011

- **File:** `Models/Bachmann_MSB2011.lean`.
- **States ($n = 25$):** EpoRJAK2, EpoRpJAK2, p1EpoRpJAK2, p2EpoRpJAK2, p12EpoRpJAK2, EpoRJAK2_CIS, SHP1, SHP1Act, STAT5, pSTAT5, npSTAT5, CISnRNA1, CISnRNA2, CISnRNA3, CISnRNA4, CISnRNA5, CISRNA, CIS, SOCS3nRNA1, SOCS3nRNA2, SOCS3nRNA3, SOCS3nRNA4, SOCS3nRNA5, SOCS3RNA, SOCS3.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 27$):** CISEqc = 432.9; CISEqcOE = 0.5303; CISInh = $7.852 \times 10^8$; CISRNADelay = 0.1448; CISRNATurn = 1000; CISTurn = 0.008399; EpoRActJAK2 = 0.2673; EpoRCISInh = $1 \times 10^6$; EpoRCISRemove = 5.43; JAK2ActEpo = $6.332 \times 10^5$; JAK2EpoRDeaSHP1 = 142.7; SHP1ActEpoR = 0.001; SHP1Dea = 0.008162; SHP1ProOE = 2.826; SOCS3Eqc = 173.6; SOCS3EqcOE = 0.6792; SOCS3Inh = 10.41; SOCS3RNADelay = 1.065; SOCS3RNATurn = 0.008309; SOCS3Turn = $1 \times 10^4$; STAT5ActEpoR = 39; STAT5ActJAK2 = 0.07811; STAT5Exp = 0.07451; STAT5Imp = 0.02689; init_EpoRJAK2 = 3.976; init_SHP1 = 26.73; init_STAT5 = 79.75.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 27 of 27.
- **Rate terms:** 43, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \leq a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta)$ well defined and non-negative at $\theta_0$ (`checkInit`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $3 \times 10^{-15}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Bachmann_MSB2011.final` := `network_final_init`): same as `network_final`, with initial value $x(0) = G(\theta)$ and $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Bertozzi_PNAS2020

- **File:** `Models/Bertozzi_PNAS2020.lean`.
- **States ($n = 3$):** I_, R_, S_.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 0$):** .
- **Parameters declared positive:** 0 of 0.
- **Rate terms:** 2, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (2 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference 0.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Bertozzi_PNAS2020.final := network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Blasi_CellSystems2016

- **File:** `Models/Blasi_CellSystems2016.lean`.
- **States ($n = 16$):** x_0ac, x_k8, x_k5, x_k12, x_k16, x_k5k8, x_k5k12, x_k5k16, x_k8k12, x_k8k16, x_k12k16, x_k5k8k12, x_k5k8k16, x_k5k12k16, x_k8k12k16, x_4ac.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 8$):** a_basal = 0.0668; a_k8 = 0.0273; a_k5_k5k12 = 2.062; a_k12_k5k12 = 0.5519; a_k16_k12k16 = 0.6959; a_k5k12_k5k8k12 = 0.3253; a_k12k16_k8k12k16 = 2.205; a_k8k12k16_4ac = 3.592.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 8 of 8.
- **Rate terms:** 36, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (1 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $4 \times 10^{-15}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Blasi_CellSystems2016.final := network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Boehm_JProteomeRes2014

- **File:** `Models/Boehm_JProteomeRes2014.lean`.
- **States ($n = 9$):** STAT5A, STAT5B, pApB, pApA, pBpB, nucpApA, nucpApB, nucpBpB, $\tau$ (tiempo).
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 6$):** Epo_degradation_BaF3 = 0.02698; k_exp_hetero = $1.001 \times 10^{-5}$; k_exp_homo = 0.00617; k_imp_hetero = 0.01637; k_imp_homo = $9.775 \times 10^{4}$; k_phos = $1.577 \times 10^{4}$.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 6 of 6.
- **Rate terms:** 10, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (2 non-zero entries).

- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $4 \times 10^{-16}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Boehm_JProteomeRes2014.final` := `network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Borghans_BiophysChem1997

- **File:** `Models/Borghans_BiophysChem1997.lean`.
- **States ($n = 3$):** Z_state, Y_state, A_state.
- **Strictly positive species $\Sigma$ (3):** Z_state, Y_state, A_state.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 20$):** K2 = 0.09995; K_par = 11.41; Ka = 0.1976; Kd = 0.3925; Kf = 1.138; Kp = 0.9966; Ky = 0.2004; Kz = 0.3034; Vd = 92.87; Vm2 = 7.457; Vm3 = 22.7; Vp = 2.757; beta_par = 1.124; epsilon_par = 0.1632; init_A_state = 1; init_Y_state = 0.9993; init_Z_state = 0.08792; n_par = 4.103; v0 = 2.318; v1 = 1.005.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 20 of 20.
- **Rate terms:** 9, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the strict region $P_\Sigma$, quasi-positive, and consumption of species in $\Sigma$ at most proportional to their concentration (`checkNetS`); linear growth bound on $P_\Sigma$ (`checkGrowthS`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta_0) \in P_\Sigma$ (`checkInitS`); declared parameter bounds hold at $\theta_0$ (`checkUB`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $2 \times 10^{-16}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Borghans_BiophysChem1997.final` := `strict_final_init`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution exists on $[0, T]$ and stays in $P_\Sigma$ (species in $\Sigma$ strictly positive) and in the domain; solutions near $\theta_0$ exist and are differentiable, $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Brannmark_JBC2010

- **File:** `Models/Brannmark_JBC2010.lean`.
- **States ($n = 9$):** IR, IRins, IRp, IRiP, IRi, IRS, IRSiP, X, Xp.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 15$):** k1a = 0.1772; k1aBasic = 0.0003928; k1b = 0.1747; k1c = 0.05086; k1d = $5 \times 10^5$; k1e = $1 \times 10^{-6}$; k1f = $5 \times 10^5$; k1g = 1729; k1r = 0.0267; k21 = 2.102; k22 = 666.8; k3 = $4.944 \times 10^{-5}$; k_IRSiP_DosR = 37.94; km2 = 1.16; km3 = 0.4164.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 15 of 15.
- **Rate terms:** 14, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (9 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $1 \times 10^{-13}$.

- **Final theorem** (`Models.Brannmark_JBC2010.final := network_final`): for every $T \geq 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Bruno_JExpBot2016

- **File:** `Models/Bruno_JExpBot2016.lean`.
- **States ($n = 7$):** bcar, bcry, b10, bio, ohb10, ohbio, zea.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 6$):** k5 = 0.003087; kb1 = 0.01663; kb2 = 0.005844; kc1 = 0.001679; kc2 = 0.006976; kc4 = 0.006083.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 6 of 6.
- **Rate terms:** 6, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (5 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \leq a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $2 \times 10^{-16}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Bruno_JExpBot2016.final := network_final`): for every $T \geq 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Chen_MSB2009

- **File:** `Models/Chen_MSB2009.lean` and 5 part files in `Models/Chen_MSB2009/`.
- **States:** $n = 501$ species (listed in the file).
- **Parameters:** $p = 152$, with nominal values in $\theta_q$ (exact rationals) in the file.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 152 of 152.
- **Rate terms:** 1,243, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (27 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \leq a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $8 \times 10^{-14}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Chen_MSB2009.final := network_final`): for every $T \geq 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Crauste_CellSystems2017

- **File:** `Models/Crauste_CellSystems2017.lean`.
- **States ($n = 5$):** Naive, EarlyEffector, LateEffector, Memory, Pathogen.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 12$):** delta_EL = 0.5179; delta_LM = 0.02258; delta_NE = 0.01193; mu_EE = $3.914 \times 10^{-5}$; mu_LE = $1 \times 10^{-10}$; mu_LL = $8.115 \times 10^{-6}$; mu_N = 0.7399; mu_P = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; mu_PE = $1.412 \times 10^{-10}$; mu_PL = $3.634 \times 10^{-5}$; rho_E = 0.5074; rho_P = 0.1264.

- **Parameters declared positive:** 12 of 12.
- **Rate terms:** 12, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (2 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** values 1, $1 \times 10^5$.
- **Horizon:** $T \le T_q = 1$ (quadratic growth; Riccati bound).
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`); quadratic growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le Q(\varphi+1)^2$ and $1.1\,Q(\varphi(x_q)+1)T_q < 1$ (`checkRiccati`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference 0.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Crauste_CellSystems2017.final` := `riccati_final`): for every $T \le T_q$ the nominal solution exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain; solutions near $\theta_0$ exist and are differentiable, $S(0) = 0$.

### Elowitz_Nature2000

- **File:** `Models/Elowitz_Nature2000.lean`.
- **States ($n = 8$):** X_protein, Y_protein, Z_protein, GFP, X_mRNA, Y_mRNA, Z_mRNA, GFP_mRNA.
- **Strictly positive species $\Sigma$ (8):** X_protein, Y_protein, Z_protein, GFP, X_mRNA, Y_mRNA, Z_mRNA, GFP_mRNA.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 18$):** KM = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; eff = 0.03016; eff_GFP = 0.001952; init_GFP = $3.387 \times 10^{-5}$; init_GFP_mRNA = 131.4; init_X_mRNA = 2.557; init_X_protein = 30.81; init_Y_mRNA = 1000; init_Y_protein = 0.0008183; init_Z_mRNA = 19.37; init_Z_protein = 994.4; n_Hill = 1.523; tau_mRNA = 12.62; tau_mRNA_GFP = 0.0004041; tau_prot = 5.359; tau_prot_GFP = 71.93; tps_active = 0.6123; tps_repr = $1 \times 10^{-5}$.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 18 of 18.
- **Rate terms:** 18, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the strict region $P_\Sigma$, quasi-positive, and consumption of species in $\Sigma$ at most proportional to their concentration (`checkNetS`); linear growth bound on $P_\Sigma$ (`checkGrowthS`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta_0) \in P_\Sigma$ (`checkInitS`); declared parameter bounds hold at $\theta_0$ (`checkUB`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $2 \times 10^{-16}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Elowitz_Nature2000.final` := `strict_final_init`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution exists on $[0, T]$ and stays in $P_\Sigma$ (species in $\Sigma$ strictly positive) and in the domain; solutions near $\theta_0$ exist and are differentiable, $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Fiedler_BMCSystBiol2016

- **File:** `Models/Fiedler_BMCSystBiol2016.lean`.
- **States ($n = 7$):** RAF, pRAF, MEK, pMEK, ERK, pERK, $\tau$ (tiempo).
- **Strictly positive species $\Sigma$ (6):** RAF, pRAF, MEK, pMEK, ERK, pERK.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 12$):** K_1 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; K_2 = 1.511; K_3 = 0.9605; k10 = 0.02641; k11 = 163.2; k2 = 1.226; k3 = 769.2; k4 = 2.907; k5 = 577.6; k6 = 3.608; tau1 = 0.2428; tau2 = 0.02114.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 12 of 12.

- **Rate terms:** 8, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the strict region $P_\Sigma$, quasi-positive, and consumption of species in $\Sigma$ at most proportional to their concentration (`checkNetS`); linear growth bound on $P_\Sigma$ (`checkGrowthS`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values $G(\theta_0) \in P_\Sigma$ certified by rational interval arithmetic (`checkInitI`); declared parameter bounds hold at $\theta_0$ (`checkUB`); the real powers in $G$ are square roots.
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference 0.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Fiedler_BMCSystBiol2016.final := strict_final_initI`): same as `strict_final_init`, with the initial values certified by interval arithmetic.

### Froehlich_CellSystems2018

- **File:** `Models/Froehlich_CellSystems2018.lean` and 13 part files in `Models/Froehlich_CellSystems2018/`.
- **States:** $n = 1{,}228$ species (listed in the file).
- **Parameters:** $p = 4088$, with nominal values in $\theta_q$ (exact rationals) in the file.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 4088 of 4088.
- **Rate terms:** 4,487, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (0 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $6 \times 10^{-14}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Froehlich_CellSystems2018.final := network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Fujita_SciSignal2010

- **File:** `Models/Fujita_SciSignal2010.lean`.
- **States ($n = 9$):** EGFR, pEGFR, pEGFR_Akt, Akt, pAkt, S6, pAkt_S6, pS6, EGF_EGFR.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 16$):** EGFR_turnover = 0.00148; init_AKT = 0.02693; init_EGFR = $3.754 \times 10^7$; init_S6 = 188.1; reaction_1_k1 = 0.003691; reaction_1_k2 = 0.002301; reaction_2_k1 = 0.0009365; reaction_2_k2 = $6.097 \times 10^4$; reaction_3_k1 = 0.4332; reaction_4_k1 = 0.03016; reaction_5_k1 = $3.273 \times 10^{-6}$; reaction_5_k2 = 0.0003985; reaction_6_k1 = $5.463 \times 10^{-6}$; reaction_7_k1 = 0.0118; reaction_8_k1 = 0.0009448; reaction_9_k1 = 0.02851.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 16 of 16.
- **Rate terms:** 13, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta)$ well defined and non-negative at $\theta_0$ (`checkInit`).

- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $1 \times 10^{-16}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Fujita_SciSignal2010.final := network_final_init`): same as `network_final`, with initial value $x(0) = G(\theta)$ and $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Giordano_Nature2020

- **File:** `Models/Giordano_Nature2020.lean`.
- **States ($n = 10$):** Susceptible, Infected, Diagnosed, Ailing, Recognized, Threatened, Healed, Extinct, CumulativeDiagnosed, DiagnosedHealed.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 43$):** alpha_0 = 0.57; beta_0 = 0.011; delta_0 = 0.011; epsilon_0 = 0.171; eta_0 = 0.125; gamma_0 = 0.456; kappa_0 = 0.017; lam_0 = 0.034; mu_0 = 0.017; nu_0 = 0.027; rho_0 = 0.034; sigma_0 = 0.017; tau = 0.01; theta = 0.371; xi_0 = 0.017; zeta_0 = 0.125; alpha_4 = 0.422; alpha_22 = 0.36; alpha_28 = 0.21; beta_4 = 0.0057; beta_22 = 0.005; delta_4 = 0.0057; delta_22 = 0.005; epsilon_12 = 0.143; epsilon_38 = 0.2; eta_22 = 0.034; eta_38 = 0.025; gamma_4 = 0.285; gamma_22 = 0.2; gamma_28 = 0.11; kappa_22 = 0.017; kappa_38 = 0.02; lam_22 = 0.08; mu_22 = 0.008; nu_22 = 0.015; rho_22 = 0.017; rho_38 = 0.02; sigma_22 = 0.017; sigma_38 = 0.01; xi_22 = 0.017; xi_38 = 0.02; zeta_22 = 0.034; zeta_38 = 0.025.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 43 of 43.
- **Rate terms:** 96, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (6 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Segments:** [0, 4], [4, 12], [12, 22], [22, 28], [28, 38], [38, 50].
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`); segment lengths are non-negative.
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $4 \times 10^{-16}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Giordano_Nature2020.final := network_segments_final`): the same conclusions on each segment of the piecewise-defined model, with continuity across segment boundaries.

### Isensee_JCB2018

- **File:** `Models/Isensee_JCB2018.lean`.
- **States ($n = 25$):** AC, pAC, AC_Fsk, pAC_Fsk, cAMP, Csub, Csub_H89, RII_C_2, RIIp_C_2, RIIp_cAMP_C_2, RIIp_cAMP_2, Sp8_Br_cAMPS, Rp8_Br_cAMPS, Rp8_pCPT_cAMPS, Rp_cAMPS, RIIp_Rp8_Br_cAMPS_C_2, RIIp_Rp8_pCPT_cAMPS_C_2, RIIp_Rp_cAMPS_C_2, RIIp_Sp8_Br_cAMPS_C_2, RIIp_Sp8_Br_cAMPS_2, RIIp_2, RII_2, IBMX, PDE, pPDE.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 32$):** KD_Fsk = 14.28; KD_H89 = 0.04807; KD_IBMX = 11.96; KD_cAMP = 2.85; kdeg_cAMP = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; kdeg_cAMP_free = 7.384; kf_Fsk = 1000; kf_H89 = 0.0007427; kf_RII_2__RII_C_2 = 1.264; kf_RII_C_2__RII_2 = 0.01875; kf_RII_C_2__RIIp_C_2 = 0.02277; kf_RIIp_2__RII_2 = 0.0323; kf_RIIp_C_2__RII_C_2 = 0.0257; kf_RIIp_cAMP_C_2__RIIp_2 = 0.1053; kf_cAMP = 0.5015; ki_IBMX = 1000; ki_Rp8_Br_cAMPS_pAB = 6.446; ki_Rp8_pCPT_cAMPS_pAB = 9.39; ki_Rp_cAMPS_pAB = 0.01632; ki_Sp8_Br_cAMPS_AM = 0.1317; ks_AC_cAMP = 0.4232; xi_AC_cAMP_Fsk = 642.4; xi_b_Rp8_Br_cAMPS = 0.04056; xi_b_Rp8_pCPT_cAMPS = 0.02668; xi_b_Rp_cAMPS = 0.6039; xi_b_Sp8_Br_cAMPS = 21.62; xi_kf_RII_2__RII_C_2 = 0.01893; xi_kf_RII_C_2__RII_2 = 0.811; xi_KD_Rp8_Br_cAMPS = 0.03996; xi_KD_Rp8_pCPT_cAMPS = 0.1942; xi_KD_Rp_cAMPS = 0.163; xi_KD_Sp8_Br_cAMPS = 0.2232.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 32 of 32.
- **Rate terms:** 34, each with its stoichiometric column.

- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (10 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $1 \times 10^{-14}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Isensee_JCB2018.final := network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Lang_PLOSComputBiol2024

- **File:** `Models/Lang_PLOSComputBiol2024.lean`.
- **States:** $n = 124$ species (listed in the file).
- **Parameters:** $p = 164$, with nominal values in $\theta_q$ (exact rationals) in the file.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 164 of 164.
- **Rate terms:** 663, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (107 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** values 1, 2, 3.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $2 \times 10^{-15}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Lang_PLOSComputBiol2024.final := network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Laske_PLOSComputBiol2019

- **File:** `Models/Laske_PLOSComputBiol2019.lean`.
- **States ($n = 34$):** V_ex, V_end, Vp_cyt, Vp_nuc, R_C, R_C_RdRp, R_V, R_V_RdRp, R_M1, R_M2, R_M3, R_M4, R_M5, R_M6, R_M7, R_M8, P_B1, P_B2, P_PA, P_HA, P_NP, P_NA, P_M1, P_NEP, Vp_nuc_M1, Vp_cyt_M1, V_rel, P_RdRp, Cp, V_att_Hi, V_att_Lo, P_M2, B_att_Lo, B_att_Hi.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 6$):** k_imp = 0.296; k_syn_R_M = $3.06 \times 10^4$; k_syn_R_C = 1.53; k_syn_R_V = 100.9; k_bind_M1 = $1.82 \times 10^{-6}$; k_rel = 0.0011.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 6 of 6.
- **Rate terms:** 51, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (3 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference 0.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Laske_PLOSComputBiol2019.final := network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Lucarelli_CellSystems2018

- **File:** `Models/Lucarelli_CellSystems2018.lean`.
- **States ($n = 33$):** TGFb, Rec, TGFb_pRec, S2, S3, S4, S2_S4_S4, ppS2_ppS2_ppS2, ppS3_ppS3_ppS3, S4_S4_S4, pS2, pS3, ppS2, ppS3, ppS2_ppS2_S4, ppS2_ppS2_ppS3, ppS2_ppS3_ppS3, ppS3_ppS3_S4, ppS2_ppS3_S4, ppS3_S4_S4, ppS2_S4_S4, geneA, geneB, geneC, geneD, geneE, geneF, geneG, geneH, geneI, geneJ, geneK, geneL.
- **Parameters:** $p = 69$, with nominal values in $\theta_q$ (exact rationals) in the file.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 69 of 69.
- **Rate terms:** 67, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta)$ well defined and non-negative at $\theta_0$ (`checkInit`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $4 \times 10^{-15}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Lucarelli_CellSystems2018.final := network_final_init`): same as `network_final`, with initial value $x(0) = G(\theta)$ and $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Okuonghae_ChaosSolitonsFractals2020

- **File:** `Models/Okuonghae_ChaosSolitonsFractals2020.lean`.
- **States ($n = 8$):** susceptible, exposed, asymptomatic, symptomatic, detected, recovered, deceased, detected_cumulative.
- **Strictly positive species $\Sigma$ (6):** susceptible, exposed, asymptomatic, symptomatic, detected, detected_cumulative.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 14$):** alpha = 0.5; d_0 = 0.015; d_D = 0.015; gamma_0 = 0.1398; gamma_a = 0.1398; gamma_i = 0.06667; nu = 0.5; psi = 0.0135; sigma = 0.1923; theta = $2 \times 10^{-12}$; asymptomatic_start = 188; symptomatic_start = 212; exposed_start = 441; transmission_rate_effective = 0.4236.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 14 of 14.
- **Rate terms:** 11, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the strict region $P_\Sigma$, quasi-positive, and consumption of species in $\Sigma$ at most proportional to their concentration (`checkNetS`); linear growth bound on $P_\Sigma$ (`checkGrowthS`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta_0) \in P_\Sigma$ (`checkInitS`); declared parameter bounds hold at $\theta_0$ (`checkUB`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $7 \times 10^{-16}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Okuonghae_ChaosSolitonsFractals2020.final := strict_final_init`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution exists on $[0, T]$ and stays in $P_\Sigma$ (species in $\Sigma$ strictly positive) and in the domain; solutions near $\theta_0$ exist and are differentiable, $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Rahman_MBS2016

- **File:** `Models/Rahman_MBS2016.lean`.

- **States ($n = 7$):** susceptible, infected_normal, infected_moderate, infected_weak, treated_normal, treated_moderate, treated_weak.
- **Strictly positive species $\Sigma$ (4):** susceptible, infected_normal, infected_moderate, infected_weak.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 9$):** infected_normal_transmission_rate_relative = 427.5; infected_moderate_transmission_rate = 0.002927; infected_weak_transmission_rate_relative = 993; infected_weak_treatment_rate = 0.0001; infected_normal_worsen_rate = 0.6654; infected_moderate_worsen_rate = 0.007976; treated_moderate_improve_rate = 0.1364; treated_weak_improve_rate = 0.7756; behavioural_change_rate = $1.338 \times 10^{-7}$.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 9 of 9.
- **Rate terms:** 19, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the strict region $P_\Sigma$, quasi-positive, and consumption of species in $\Sigma$ at most proportional to their concentration (`checkNetS`); linear growth bound on $P_\Sigma$ (`checkGrowthS`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta_0) \in P_\Sigma$ (`checkInitS`); declared parameter bounds hold at $\theta_0$ (`checkUB`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $1 \times 10^{-15}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Rahman_MBS2016.final` := `strict_final_init`): for every $T \geq 0$ the nominal solution exists on $[0, T]$ and stays in $P_\Sigma$ (species in $\Sigma$ strictly positive) and in the domain; solutions near $\theta_0$ exist and are differentiable, $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Raia_CancerResearch2011

- **File:** `Models/Raia_CancerResearch2011.lean`.
- **States ($n = 14$):** Rec, Rec_i, IL13_Rec, p_IL13_Rec, p_IL13_Rec_i, JAK2, pJAK2, STAT5, pSTAT5, SOCS3mRNA, DecoyR, IL13_DecoyR, SOCS3, CD274mRNA.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 18$):** CD274mRNA_production = 0.02121; DecoyR_binding = 0.003851; JAK2_p_inhibition = 0.07814; JAK2_phosphorylation = 1.017; Kon_IL13Rec = 0.002278; Rec_intern = 0.3441; Rec_phosphorylation = 1000; Rec_recycle = 0.002098; SOCS3_accumulation = 451.8; SOCS3_degradation = 0.04338; SOCS3_translation = 15.72; SOCS3mRNA_production = 0.1434; STAT5_phosphorylation = 0.01948; init_Rec_i = 235.1; pJAK2_dephosphorylation = 0.0001759; pRec_degradation = 0.2096; pRec_intern = 0.5853; pSTAT5_dephosphorylation = 0.0002748.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 18 of 18.
- **Rate terms:** 14, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \leq a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta)$ well defined and non-negative at $\theta_0$ (`checkInit`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $6 \times 10^{-16}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Raia_CancerResearch2011.final` := `network_final_init`): same as `network_final`, with initial value $x(0) = G(\theta)$ and $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Raimundez_PCB2020

- **File:** `Models/Raimundez_PCB2020.lean`.

- **States ($n = 22$):** EGFR, EGFR_CET, EGFR_EGF, EGFR_EGF_2, pEGFR_EGF_2, pEGFR_EGF_2_i, MMET, MMET_2, pMMET_2, pMMET_2_i, MMET_EGFR, pMMET_pEGFR, pMMET_pEGFR_i, MMET_METinh, MMET_MMET_METinh, MMET_METinh_2, EGFR_MMET_METinh, RAS_GTP, pMAPK, pPI3K, pMPI3K, pAKT.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 57$):** KD_EGFR_CET = 0.218; KD_EGFR_EGF = 0.3208; KD_METinh = 0.04194; d_AKTtotal__MKN1_2_HS746T = 0; d_AKTtotal__fm_2_hm = 0.8229; d_MAPKtotal__MKN1_2_HS746T = 0; d_MAPKtotal__fm_2_hm = 0.4275; d_MPI3Ktotal__fm_2_hm = -1.545; d_PI3Ktotal__fm_2_hm = -0.5318; d_RAStotal__MKN1_2_HS746T = $-1.06 \times 10^{-22}$; d_RAStotal__fm_2_hm = -0.5382; d_kdeg_membran__MKN1_2_HS746T = -0.6; d_kdeg_pEGFR_EGF_2_i__MKN1_2_HS746T = 3; d_kexp_pEGFR_EGF_2_i__MKN1_2_HS746T = -0.2382; d_kimp_pEGFR_EGF_2__MKN1_2_HS746T = -1.746; d_ksyn_EGFR__MKN1_2_HS746T = -3; d_ksyn_EGFR__fm_2_hm = -0.0876; d_ksyn_MMET__fm_2_hm = -0.5189; ka_AKT__MKN1 = 443.1; ka_MAPK__MKN1 = 1000; ka_PI3K__basal = 0.0003649; ka_PI3K__pEGFR_EGF_2 = 0.001701; ka_RAS__basal__MKN1 = 0.0002145; ka_RAS__pEGFR_EGF_2__MKN1 = $1.47 \times 10^{-5}$; kbin_EGFR_CET = 0.5853; kbin_EGFR_EGF = 8.882; kdeg_membran__MKN1 = 0.002259; kdeg_pEGFR_EGF_2_i__MKN1 = 0.0668; kdim_EGFR_EGF = 0.03239; kdim_MMET = $2.61 \times 10^{-5}$; kdim_MMET_EGFR = 0.001882; kdim_MMETinh = 0.03127; kexp_pEGFR_EGF_2_i__MKN1 = 0.7517; ki_AKT__MKN1 = 18.47; ki_MAPK = 2.177; ki_PI3K__MKN1 = 1.316; ki_RAS__MKN1 = 0.327; kimp_pEGFR_EGF_2__MKN1 = 0.7469; kpho_EGFR_EGF = 1.344; kpho_MMET = 2.543; kpho_MMET_EGFR = 4.563; ksyn_MMET__HS746T_fm = 0.02635; xi_ka_PI3K_pMMET_2 = 301.3; xi_ka_PI3K_pMMET_pEGFR = 0.7655; xi_ka_RAS_pMMET_2 = 0.4494; xi_ka_RAS_pMMET_pEGFR = 0.2536; xi_kdeg_pMMET_2_i = 0.7837; xi_kdeg_pMMET_pEGFR_i = 3.533; xi_kdim_MMET = 0.9748; xi_kdim_MMET_EGFR = 1; xi_kexp_pMMET_2_i = 1.243; xi_kexp_pMMET_pEGFR_i = 0.2864; xi_ki_MPI3K = 0.00322; xi_kimp_pMMET_2 = 0.07715; xi_kimp_pMMET_pEGFR = 0.00796; xi_kpho_MMET = 0.008328; xi_kpho_MMET_EGFR = 0.06967.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 45 of 57.
- **Rate terms:** 91, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (0 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $1 \times 10^{-12}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Raimundez_PCB2020.final` := `network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### SalazarCavazos_MBoC2020

- **File:** `Models/SalazarCavazos_MBoC2020.lean`.
- **States:** $n = 75$ species (listed in the file).
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 6$):** GRB2_total__FREE = $1.699 \times 10^5$; SHC1_total__FREE = $6.494 \times 10^5$; kdephosY1068__FREE = 1.659; kdephosYN__FREE = 0.01718; ratio_kpkd_Y1068__FREE = 0.1575; ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE = 0.4448.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 6 of 6.
- **Rate terms:** 457, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** expressions $G(\theta)$ in the parameters (SBML initial assignments).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.

- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); parameter-dependent initial values $G(\theta)$ well defined and non-negative at $\theta_0$ (`checkInit`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $2 \times 10^{-13}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.SalazarCavazos_MBoC2020.final := network_final_init`): same as `network_final`, with initial value $x(0) = G(\theta)$ and $S(0) = \partial_\theta G(\theta_0)$.

### Sneyd_PNAS2002

- **File:** `Models/Sneyd_PNAS2002.lean`.
- **States ($n = 6$):** IPR_O, IPR_R, IPR_I1, IPR_S, IPR_A, IPR_I2.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 14$):** k1 = 3.727; k2 = $1 \times 10^5$; k3 = 15.75; k4 = $9.994 \times 10^4$; k_1 = 0.9239; k_2 = 0.001002; k_3 = 1.915; k_4 = 3079; l2 = 0.9401; l4 = 2.858; l6 = $1 \times 10^5$; l_2 = 0.3477; l_4 = 0.01388; l_6 = 0.001.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 14 of 14.
- **Rate terms:** 16, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (1 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $4 \times 10^{-15}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Sneyd_PNAS2002.final := network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Weber_BMC2015

- **File:** `Models/Weber_BMC2015.lean`.
- **States ($n = 7$):** PKD, PKDDAGa, PI4K3B, PI4K3Ba, CERTERa, CERT, CERTTGNa.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 26$):** a11 = 0.1825; a12 = 26.67; a21 = 1.877; a22 = 0.0001; a31 = 0.1353; a32 = 0.0001; a33 = 0.0001; m11 = $1 \times 10^{10}$; m22 = 2154; m31 = $9.97 \times 10^9$; m33 = $4.187 \times 10^7$; p11 = 4.244; p12 = 0.005936; p13 = 0.00246; p21 = 5.629; p22 = 21.79; p31 = 2538; p32 = 16.77; p33 = $2.166 \times 10^4$; pu3 = $1 \times 10^8$; pu4 = $3.313 \times 10^7$; pu5 = 33.7; pu6 = 113.4; s12 = $8.846 \times 10^4$; s21 = $2.961 \times 10^6$; s31 = $4.328 \times 10^6$.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 26 of 26.
- **Rate terms:** 18, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (7 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference 0.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Weber_BMC2015.final := network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Zhao_QuantBiol2020

- **File:** `Models/Zhao_QuantBiol2020.lean`.
- **States ($n = 4$):** Susceptible, Unquarantined_Infected, Quarantined_Infected, Confirmed_Infected.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 21$):** R_Stage_I_Wuhan = 4.709; gamma_1_Stage_I_Wuhan = 0.063; gamma_2_Stage_I_Wuhan = 0.05; R_Stage_II_Wuhan = 0.7575; gamma_1_Stage_II_Wuhan = 0.3917; gamma_2_Stage_II_Wuhan = 0.0643; R_Stage_III_Wuhan = 0.4797; gamma_1_Stage_III_Wuhan = 0.6185; gamma_2_Stage_III_Wuhan = 0.322; R_Stage_I_Hubei = 5.934; gamma_1_Stage_I_Hubei = 0.05; gamma_2_Stage_I_Hubei = 0.05; R_Stage_II_Hubei = 0.6079; gamma_1_Stage_II_Hubei = 0.488; gamma_2_Stage_II_Hubei = 0.1914; R_Stage_I_China = 1.528; gamma_1_Stage_I_China = 0.1941; gamma_2_Stage_I_China = 0.05; R_Stage_II_China = 0.5753; gamma_1_Stage_II_China = 0.5157; gamma_2_Stage_II_China = 0.2189.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 21 of 21.
- **Rate terms:** 3, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (3 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference 0.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Zhao_QuantBiol2020.final` := `network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

### Zheng_PNAS2012

- **File:** `Models/Zheng_PNAS2012.lean`.
- **States ($n = 15$):** K27me0K36me0, K27me0K36me1, K27me1K36me0, K27me0K36me2, K27me1K36me1, K27me2K36me0, K27me0K36me3, K27me1K36me2, K27me2K36me1, K27me3K36me0, K27me1K36me3, K27me2K36me2, K27me3K36me1, K27me2K36me3, K27me3K36me2.
- **Parameters and nominal values $\theta_0$ ($p = 45$):** inflowp = 0.03048; k00_01 = 997.3; k00_10 = 0.234; k01_00 = 479.8; k01_02 = 1.913; k01_11 = 2.651; k02_01 = 0.06996; k02_03 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k02_12 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k03_02 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k03_13 = 988.1; k10_00 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k10_11 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k10_20 = 0.2692; k11_01 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k11_10 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k11_12 = 11.85; k11_21 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k12_02 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k12_11 = 0.107; k12_13 = 0.03563; k12_22 = 0.01062; k13_03 = 450.4; k13_12 = 0.1953; k13_23 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k20_10 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k20_21 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k20_30 = 0.1507; k21_11 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k21_20 = 0.0354; k21_22 = 999.3; k21_31 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k22_12 = 0.05338; k22_21 = 426.1; k22_23 = 0.1517; k22_32 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k23_13 = 0.7912; k23_22 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k30_20 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k30_31 = 0.2813; k31_21 = $1.001 \times 10^{-5}$; k31_30 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$; k31_32 = 0.3536; k32_22 = 0.633; k32_31 = $1 \times 10^{-5}$.
- **Parameters declared positive:** 45 of 45.
- **Rate terms:** 44, each with its stoichiometric column.
- **Initial values:** constant rational vector $x_q$ (15 non-zero entries).
- **Weights $w_i$ of the growth bound:** all equal to 1.
- **Checks executed by the kernel:** rate laws well defined on the non-negative orthant and quasi-positive (`checkNet`); linear growth bound $\sum_i w_i f_i \le a + b \sum_i w_i x_i$ with the weights $w$ (`checkGrowth`); nominal parameters positive where declared (`checkPosParams`); initial values non-negative (`checkNonneg`).
- **Fidelity of the translation:** largest relative difference $1 \times 10^{-15}$.
- **Final theorem** (`Models.Zheng_PNAS2012.final` := `network_final`): for every $T \ge 0$ the nominal solution from $x_q$ exists on $[0, T]$, is non-negative and stays in the domain of the rate laws; solutions exist for all $\theta$ near $\theta_0$, and $x(t;\theta)$ is differentiable in $\theta$ with sensitivity $S(t)$, $S(0) = 0$.

## Supplementary Note: Reproducibility package

All programs, results and formal proofs of this work are collected in a reproducibility package (folder `reproducibility/` of the repository `https://github.com/monicammr/archivos`, archived on Zenodo, DOI `10.5281/zenodo.23338175`). Its file `README.md` is a step-by-step manual; this note summarises what can be checked and how.

### Contents of the package

- `analysis/`: the method and every numerical analysis of the paper in Python (simulation of the measured outputs of a PEtab problem, selection, external and nested validation, synthetic experiment, robustness, single-parameter subsets, settings, cost, simulator check, comparison with other criteria, identifiability, SCT example), including the additional analyses described in the Supplementary Notes on robustness (independent directions), on the synthetic experiment (true signal and other amplitudes), on the method settings (error in units of the noise) and on random scenarios and large problems; all settings and seeds are in `analysis/config.py`.
- `results/`: the results of these analyses, one file per benchmark problem, with a data dictionary (`DATA_DICTIONARY.md`).
- `figures_tables/`: the programs that produce every figure, table and Supplementary Note that contains numbers from those results.
- `lean_proofs/`: the Lean 4 development (32 modules, 304 theorems and lemmas, 28 benchmark models).
- `lean_translation/`: the translator of the SBML models into Lean and the independent check of the translation.

The PEtab problems are downloaded from the benchmark collection at commit `fcbddf1` by `scripts/get_benchmark.sh`; the step-count data of the SCT example are available from the authors on reasonable request.

### Three levels of checking

1. *From the stored results to the paper* (less than a minute): `python figures_tables/build_all.py` regenerates the figures, Table 1 and the Supplementary Tables and Notes with numbers, and prints the counts quoted in the text. The README relates every figure and table to the program and the result files it comes from.
2. *The formal proofs* (1–2 hours): see below.
3. *From the PEtab problems to the results* (minutes per problem, about one to two days in total on four cores): the programs of `analysis/` are run in the order given in the README, writing to a separate folder, and `scripts/compare_results.py` compares the new results with the stored ones. With the fixed seeds the results are deterministic; small differences can arise only where a simulation fails to integrate in one run and not in another (some scenarios of Chen and Isensee) and from different versions of the numerical libraries; for example, the selection of Lang and Raimundez gave the same subsets with libRoadRunner 2.9.2 and 2.10.0, with $e_{\text{fit}}$ agreeing to within $10^{-8}$ (Supplementary Note *Random scenarios and large problems*). The analyses of the largest problems need a many-core machine: on a 128-core server the complete set of analyses of one large problem (validation, synthetic experiment, comparison with the other criteria and identifiability) takes one to a few hours.

### What each check of the formal verification establishes

- *Compilation* establishes that every proof is accepted by the Lean kernel, i.e. that each theorem follows from its hypotheses.
- *Axiom inspection* (`#print axioms`) establishes that no proof relies on an unproved assumption: the only axioms are `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound`, which are part of Lean's standard logic.
- *The fidelity check* of Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models* establishes that the data on which the model checks run (rate laws, stoichiometry, parameter values and initial values) are those of the benchmark models.

The statements themselves should be compared with the mathematics they are meant to encode; Supplementary Note *Statements of the formal theorems* gives each statement in mathematical notation for this purpose.

### Versions

Lean 4.23.0 (file `lean_proofs/lean-toolchain`) and Mathlib at tag `v4.23.0` (file `lean_proofs/lakefile.lean`). The Python programs use Python 3.11 with libRoadRunner 2.10, libSBML 5.21, NumPy, SciPy, pandas, SymPy and Matplotlib at the versions listed in `requirements.txt`.

### Steps for the formal verification

1. Install the Lean version manager `elan` (`https://github.com/leanprover/elan`); it reads the Lean version from `lean-toolchain`.
2. In the folder `lean_proofs/`, run `./verify.sh`. The script (i) checks that no file contains `sorry` or an `axiom` declaration, (ii) downloads the precompiled Mathlib (`lake exe cache get`), (iii) compiles the 31 theory modules and the 28 models (`lake build`) and (iv) prints the axioms of every theorem (`CheckAxioms.lean`) and of the final theorem of every model (`CheckModelAxioms.lean`). The theory compiles in a few minutes; the models take longer, the largest (Chen and Froehlich) about 30 minutes each. A large stack is needed (`ulimit -s unlimited`; the build passes `--tstack=4000000` to the model files).
3. To inspect one model only: `lake env lean Models/<model>.lean`. The last line of each model file prints the axioms of its final theorem.
4. To locate a theorem: Supplementary Table S4 gives the module of every main result, and `lean_proofs/FORMULAS.md` lists every declaration with its module and statement; the module `X` is the file `lean_proofs/X.lean`.
5. To check the translation of the models (needs the benchmark): in the folder `lean_translation/`, `python sbml_to_lean.py` regenerates the model files from the SBML models (the files are identical to those of `lean_proofs/Models/`), `python verify_translation.py` compares every model file with its SBML model and writes `results/sbml_to_lean/translation_fidelity.json`, and `python mutation_control.py` shows that a 1% change of one number of a model file is detected.

Our complete build log, with the compilation time of every module, is `lean_proofs/BUILD_LOG.md`.

### First-order re-estimation

For the eight problems treated to first order, the first-order re-estimation uses the columns of the sensitivity matrix of the selected and of the calibration parameters, $J_{S\cup\Theta_C}$; the program computes the columns of both kinds of parameters. Run from scratch, without any cached result, it reproduces exactly the subsets and $e_{\text{fit}}$ reported for all eight problems (for example Bachmann: CISRNADelay and JAK2ActEpo, $e_{\text{fit}} = 0.337$; Chen: k106 and k44, 0.082).

## Supplementary Note: Verification of the simulator

Our simulation of the measured outputs (`analysis/petab_problem.py`, libRoadRunner with CVODE, relative and absolute tolerances $10^{-7}$ and $10^{-10}$) was compared, at the nominal parameters $\theta_0$, with the reference simulations distributed with the benchmark (file `simulations.tsv` of each problem), matching every measurement by observable, experimental condition and time. For measurement $i$ the relative difference is $|\hat{y}_i - y_i^{\text{ref}}|/\max(|y_i^{\text{ref}}|, 10^{-12})$; Supplementary Table S10 gives its median and maximum for every problem.

In all problems with a comparable reference the median difference is below $10^{-5}$ except Chen ($1.1 \times 10^{-4}$), Crauste (0.8%, a very stiff model), Lang, Perelson and Zheng. In Lang, an oscillating cell-cycle model simulated to $t = 136{,}472$, the median difference is 2.8% and the peaks differ by an accumulated phase shift. In Perelson the difference is 17%; the initial state of the SBML model is stationary and our simulation respects it, which suggests, but does not prove, that the reference was generated with other values. In Zheng the reference file contains the measured data rather than a simulation. Problems without a comparable reference have no file in the benchmark or use different condition identifiers; for them (Fujita, Isensee, Okuonghae, Oliveira, Raia, Blasi and Zhao) this check cannot exclude an implementation error.

Because all our criteria are evaluated on noise-scaled outputs, the relevant size of a discrepancy is its value in units of the recorded noise, $|h(\hat{y}_i) - h(y_i^{\text{ref}})|/\sigma_i$. In these units the discrepancy is negligible in Perelson (at most $2 \times 10^{-6}$, because its recorded noise is large compared with the outputs), in Crauste (at most 0.17) and in Sneyd (median $3 \times 10^{-7}$; only the duplicated rows exceed one), but not in Lang: the median is 0.29, 22% of the measurements differ by more than one noise unit and the largest difference is 18. The results of Lang should therefore be read with this caveat. In Zheng the same quantity compares our simulation with the measured data (median 0.47), so it is a residual rather than a simulation error.

**Supplementary Table S10.** Agreement of our simulation of the measured outputs with the reference simulations of the benchmark at $\theta_0$: number of measurements and conditions, estimated parameters $p$ and those that affect the outputs, and median and maximum relative difference.

| Problem | Meas. | Cond. | $p$ | $p_y$ | Median | Max | Note |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 1733 | 73 | 44 | 44 | $3.1 \times 10^{-8}$ | $3.1 \times 10^{-5}$ | agrees |
| Armistead | 58 | 2 | 14 | 10 | 0 | $6.1 \times 10^{-7}$ | agrees |
| Bachmann | 541 | 36 | 113 | 101 | $7.1 \times 10^{-8}$ | $2.2 \times 10^{-5}$ | agrees |
| Beer | 27132 | 19 | 72 | 70 | $5.9 \times 10^{-8}$ | $3.8 \times 10^{-4}$ | agrees |
| Bertozzi | 22 | 2 | 8 | 6 | $1.6 \times 10^{-7}$ | $1.3 \times 10^{-6}$ | agrees |
| Blasi | 252 | 1 | 9 | 8 | – | – | reference file has 288 rows for 252 measurements |
| Boehm | 48 | 1 | 9 | 6 | $1.1 \times 10^{-7}$ | $8.6 \times 10^{-7}$ | agrees |
| Borghans | 111 | 1 | 23 | 22 | $2.2 \times 10^{-6}$ | $1.6 \times 10^{-4}$ | agrees |
| Brannmark | 43 | 8 | 22 | 18 | $2.3 \times 10^{-7}$ | $1.3 \times 10^{-5}$ | agrees |

| Problem | Meas. | Cond. | $p$ | $p_y$ | Median | Max | Note |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bruno | 77 | 6 | 13 | 13 | $1.3 \times 10^{-7}$ | $2.3 \times 10^{-6}$ | agrees |
| Chen | 120 | 4 | 155 | 155 | $1.1 \times 10^{-4}$ | $2.8 \times 10^{-3}$ | agrees |
| Crauste | 21 | 1 | 12 | 12 | $7.8 \times 10^{-3}$ | $7.9 \times 10^{-2}$ | median difference below 1% (very stiff model) |
| Elowitz | 58 | 1 | 21 | 20 | $1.6 \times 10^{-6}$ | $1.7 \times 10^{-5}$ | agrees |
| Fiedler | 72 | 3 | 22 | 20 | $1.1 \times 10^{-7}$ | $9.9 \times 10^{-7}$ | agrees |
| Fujita | 144 | 6 | 19 | 19 | – | – | reference uses other condition identifiers |
| Giordano | 313 | 1 | 50 | 43 | $8.9 \times 10^{-7}$ | $2.0 \times 10^{-6}$ | agrees |
| Isensee | 687 | 123 | 46 | 43 | – | – | reference uses other condition identifiers |
| Lang | 9600 | 1 | 294 | 277 | $2.8 \times 10^{-2}$ | $2.3 \times 10^{0}$ | oscillator simulated to $t = 136{,}472$: medians agree, peaks differ by an accumulated phase shift |
| Laske | 42 | 3 | 13 | 8 | $1.3 \times 10^{-7}$ | $4.5 \times 10^{-7}$ | agrees |
| Liu | 100 | 2 | 9 | 7 | $2.9 \times 10^{-8}$ | $6.1 \times 10^{-7}$ | agrees |
| Lucarelli | 1755 | 16 | 84 | 72 | 0 | $1.5 \times 10^{-6}$ | agrees |
| Okuonghae | 92 | 1 | 16 | 14 | – | – | no reference file in the benchmark |
| Oliveira | 120 | 1 | 12 | 12 | – | – | no reference file in the benchmark |
| Perelson | 16 | 1 | 3 | 2 | $1.7 \times 10^{-1}$ | $4.5 \times 10^{-1}$ | discrepancy; the initial state is stationary ($\dot{V}(0) = 0$) and our simulation respects it, so the reference was probably generated with other values |
| Rahman | 23 | 1 | 9 | 9 | $6.5 \times 10^{-8}$ | $6.0 \times 10^{-7}$ | agrees |
| Raia | 205 | 4 | 39 | 23 | – | – | reference uses other condition identifiers |
| Raimundez | 627 | 170 | 136 | 136 | $9.3 \times 10^{-6}$ | $3.3 \times 10^{-5}$ | agrees |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 18 | 4 | 6 | 6 | $7.5 \times 10^{-9}$ | $1.2 \times 10^{-7}$ | agrees |
| Schwen | 286 | 19 | 30 | 28 | $2.0 \times 10^{-8}$ | $2.1 \times 10^{-7}$ | agrees |
| Smith | 62 | 35 | 25 | 25 | $2.6 \times 10^{-8}$ | $7.2 \times 10^{-7}$ | agrees |
| Sneyd | 135 | 9 | 15 | 14 | $2.0 \times 10^{-7}$ | $5.3 \times 10^{-1}$ | median exact; the maximum comes from duplicated rows at the same time |
| Weber | 135 | 2 | 36 | 31 | $1.0 \times 10^{-10}$ | $1.5 \times 10^{-8}$ | agrees |
| Zhao | 82 | 7 | 28 | 21 | – | – | reference file has 169 rows |
| Zheng | 60 | 1 | 46 | 45 | $1.1 \times 10^{-1}$ | $9.0 \times 10^{-1}$ | reference file contains the measured data, not a simulation |

Froehlich is not included: its 9,169 experimental conditions, each requiring a simulation of a model with 1,228 species, made the analysis of its measured outputs infeasible with the resources available (Supplementary Note *Computational cost*).

## Supplementary Note: Robustness to the size of parameter changes

This note describes in detail how the robustness of the selected subsets to the size of the parameter changes was assessed (Fig. 5 of the main text) and gives, for every admissible problem, the full distribution of the fitting error over the random scenarios, not only its median.

### Random scenarios

For a problem with $p$ estimated parameters, fifteen random directions $u^{(1)}, \dots, u^{(15)} \in [-1, 1]^p$ are drawn once, with independent components $u_j^{(k)} \sim \mathcal{U}(-1, 1)$, from a pseudo-random generator with fixed seed (NumPy `default_rng(42)`). For a perturbation size $\varepsilon$, scenario $k$ changes all parameters simultaneously:

$$\theta^{(k)}(\varepsilon) = \theta_0 \odot \big(\mathbf{1} + \varepsilon\, u^{(k)}\big), \qquad \theta_j^{(k)}(\varepsilon) = \theta_{0,j}\,\big(1 + \varepsilon\, u_j^{(k)}\big), \quad j = 1, \dots, p,$$

so that every parameter is multiplied by a factor between $1-\varepsilon$ and $1+\varepsilon$. The same fifteen directions are used at every size $\varepsilon \in \{0.01, 0.05, 0.10, 0.20, 0.30, 0.40, 0.50\}$; only $\varepsilon$ changes (paired design). Differences between sizes are therefore due to the size of the change and not to different random draws, and the scenarios at $\varepsilon = 0.05$ are exactly those used to select the subset. The directions of every problem are stored in the result files (`results/robustness/<problem>.json`, key `u`), and the script checks that they are identical at every size.

### Errors in each scenario

Let $y(\theta) \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be the vector of noise-scaled measured outputs (main text, Methods) and $S$ the selected biological parameters together with the calibration parameters $\Theta_C$. For scenario $k$,

$$\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)} = y\big(\theta^{(k)}\big) - y(\theta_0), \qquad \Delta y_S^{(k)} = y\big(\theta_S^{(k)}\big) - y(\theta_0), \qquad \big(\theta_S^{(k)}\big)_j = \begin{cases} \theta_j^{(k)}, & j \in S \\ \theta_{0,j}, & j \notin S, \end{cases}$$

that is, $\Delta y_S$ is the output change when only the retained parameters take their scenario values. The error without re-estimation and the cosine are

$$e_{\text{rel}}^{(k)} = \frac{\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)} - \Delta y_S^{(k)}\|}{\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)}\|}, \qquad \cos\Delta^{(k)} = \frac{\langle \Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)}, \Delta y_S^{(k)} \rangle}{\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)}\|\,\|\Delta y_S^{(k)}\|}.$$

The error after re-estimation is the smallest relative distance between the reduced model and the output of the full model in the scenario, when the retained parameters are free and all others are fixed at $\theta_0$:

$$e_{\text{fit}}^{(k)} = \min\Big\{ e_{\text{rel}}^{(k)},\ \min_{v \in B} \frac{\|y(\theta_0[S \leftarrow v]) - y(\theta^{(k)})\|}{\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)}\|} \Big\}, \qquad B = \prod_{j \in S} \Big[ \tfrac{|\theta_{0,j}|}{10},\ 10\,|\theta_{0,j}| \Big],$$

where $\theta_0[S \leftarrow v]$ is $\theta_0$ with the components in $S$ replaced by $v$. The inner minimisation is a bounded nonlinear least-squares problem in $\log|v|$ (trust-region reflective method, at most $100(|S|+1)$ function evaluations, finite-difference step $10^{-3}$), started from the scenario values (clipped to $B$) and from $\theta_0$; the smaller result is kept. Since $v = \theta_S^{(k)}$ is admissible when it lies in $B$, $e_{\text{fit}} \le e_{\text{rel}}$ always holds (this is also proved in Lean, step 5). For the problems whose simulations are too slow for repeated nonlinear fits (Alkan, Bachmann, Chen, Isensee, Lucarelli, Raimundez), the first-order version is used,

$$e_{\text{fit,lin}}^{(k)} = \min\Big\{ e_{\text{rel}}^{(k)},\ \min_{c \in \mathbb{R}^{|S|}} \frac{\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)} - J_S\, c\|}{\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)}\|} \Big\},$$

with $J_S$ the columns of the relative sensitivity matrix for $S$ (central differences, step 1%); it differs from the exact value by a second-order term (Lean, step 12). A scenario is discarded when the simulation fails or when the full-model change is negligible, $\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)}\| < \max(10^{-10}\|y(\theta_0)\|, 10^{-6})$, because the relative errors are then undefined; the number $n \le 15$ of valid scenarios is reported for every problem and size.

For Chen some simulations fail in a run-dependent way, so the set of valid scenarios (7 to 13 of 15) differs slightly between runs; the medians of this rerun differ from those of the main text by at most 1.2 percentage points and the pattern is unchanged. At ±5% the scenarios are those of the selection, and the median $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ agrees with Table 1 of the main text to within $10^{-5}$ in every problem except Isensee (9.8% here, 7.6% in Table 1). Isensee is, with Chen, the problem in which most simulations fail (only 1 to 6 of the 15 scenarios per level can be simulated), so the median is taken over very few scenarios and depends on which of them succeed; both values are far below $\tau_e$.

### Summaries over the scenarios

For each problem and size $\varepsilon$, with $e^{(1)}, \dots, e^{(n)}$ the values of $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ in the valid scenarios:

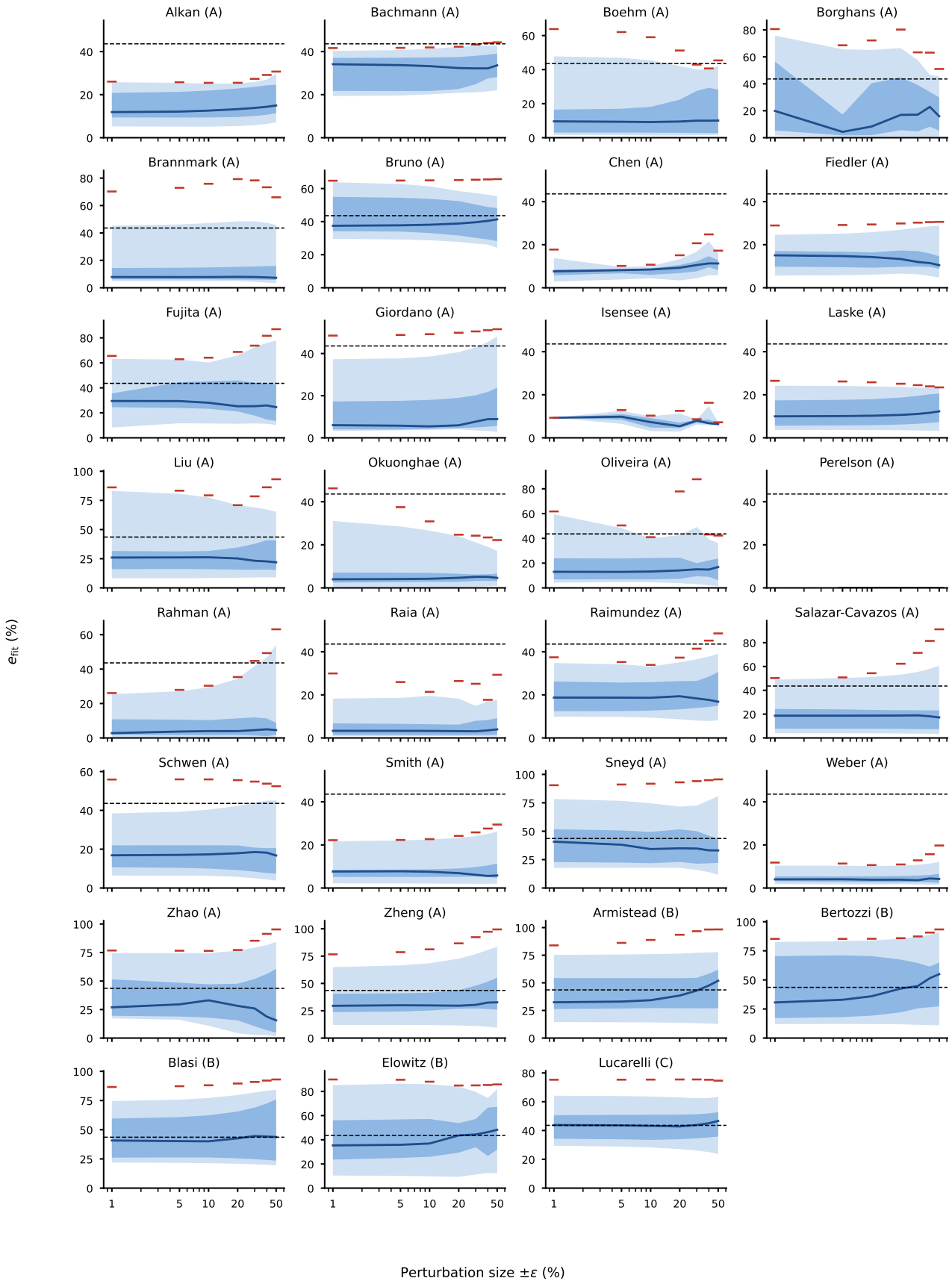
- median $\tilde{e}_{\mathrm{fit}}$, first and third quartiles $Q_1, Q_3$ (interquartile range $Q_3 - Q_1$), and the 5th and 95th percentiles $P_5, P_{95}$, computed by linear interpolation between order statistics (with $n = 15$, $P_5$ and $P_{95}$ lie between the two smallest and the two largest values);
- maximum $\max_k e_{\mathrm{fit}}^{(k)}$, the worst scenario;
- pass rate, the fraction of scenarios in which the reduced model reproduces the full one,

$$\pi(\varepsilon) = \frac{\#\{k :\ e_{\mathrm{fit}}^{(k)} \le \tau_e\}}{n}, \qquad \tau_e = \sqrt{1 - 0.9^2} = 0.436.$$

Admissibility at ±5% and the robustness patterns of the main text use the median: pattern A, $\tilde{e}_{\mathrm{fit}} \le \tau_e$ at every size; B, admissible up to at least ±10%, first failing at ±20% or more and not recovering; C, irregular (fails and is admissible again at a larger size); D, not admissible at ±10% or less. The median requires that at least half of the scenarios are reproduced; the pass rate and the maximum show how many, and how badly the others fail.

### Results

At ±5%, the size used for selection, all 31 admissible problems reproduce the full model in at least half of the scenarios by construction, and 13 of them in all scenarios. Supplementary Fig. S4 shows, for every problem, the median, the interquartile range, the 5–95% range and the worst scenario at each size; Supplementary Table S11 gives the pass rate and Supplementary Table S12 the full summary at ±5% and ±50%.




**Supplementary Figure S4. Fitting error over the fifteen scenarios at each perturbation size.** For every admissible problem (pattern in parentheses): median $\tilde{e}_{\mathrm{fit}}$ (line), interquartile range (dark band), 5–95% range (light band) and worst scenario (red marks); dashed line, $\tau_e = 43.6\%$. The same fifteen directions are used at every size.

**Supplementary Table S11.** Pass rate $\pi(\varepsilon)$: percentage of valid scenarios with $e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$, and number of valid scenarios when it is below 15 (in parentheses).

| Problem | ±1% | ±5% | ±10% | ±20% | ±30% | ±40% | ±50% | Pattern |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | A |
| Bachmann | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 93 | 93 | A |
| Boehm | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 100 | 100 | 93 | A |
| Borghans | 60 | 80 | 73 | 73 | 73 | 93 | 93 | A |
| Brannmark | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | A |
| Bruno | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 67 | A |
| Chen | 100 (11) | 100 (8) | 100 (9) | 100 (13) | 100 (12) | 100 (8) | 100 (8) | A |
| Fiedler | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | A |
| Fujita | 80 | 67 | 67 | 73 | 73 | 73 | 73 | A |
| Giordano | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 87 | A |
| Isensee | 100 (1) | 100 (4) | 100 (6) | 100 (6) | 100 (3) | 100 (5) | 100 (2) | A |
| Laske | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | A |
| Liu | 80 | 80 | 80 | 80 | 80 | 73 | 80 | A |
| Okuonghae | 93 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | A |
| Oliveira | 87 | 87 | 100 | 93 | 93 | 100 | 100 | A |
| Perelson | – | 100 (2) | 100 (11) | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | A |
| Rahman | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 93 | 87 | 87 | A |
| Raia | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | A |
| Raimundez | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 93 | 93 | A |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 87 | 87 | 87 | 87 | 87 | 87 | 87 | A |
| Schwen | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | 93 | A |
| Smith | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | A |
| Sneyd | 67 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 73 | 73 | A |
| Weber | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | A |
| Zhao | 60 | 73 | 73 | 73 | 67 | 67 | 60 | A |
| Zheng | 73 | 73 | 73 | 73 | 73 | 67 | 67 | A |
| Armistead | 60 | 60 | 60 | 53 | 53 | 47 | 47 | B |
| Bertozzi | 60 | 60 | 60 | 53 | 47 | 47 | 40 | B |
| Blasi | 53 | 53 | 53 | 53 | 47 | 47 | 47 | B |
| Elowitz | 60 | 60 | 60 | 47 | 47 | 40 | 33 | B |
| Lucarelli | 47 | 53 | 53 | 53 | 47 | 47 | 47 | C |

**Supplementary Table S12.** Summary of $e_{\text{fit}}$ (%) over the scenarios at ±5% and ±50%: median, interquartile range $[Q_1, Q_3]$, 5–95% range $[P_5, P_{95}]$, maximum and pass rate $\pi$.

| | ±5% | | | | | ±50% | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Problem | Median | $[Q_1, Q_3]$ | $[P_5, P_{95}]$ | Max | $\pi$ | Median | $[Q_1, Q_3]$ | $[P_5, P_{95}]$ | Max | $\pi$ |
| Alkan | 12 | [9, 21] | [5, 25] | 26 | 100 | 15 | [11, 25] | [7, 30] | 31 | 100 |
| Bachmann | 34 | [22, 37] | [20, 41] | 42 | 100 | 34 | [28, 39] | [22, 43] | 44 | 93 |
| Boehm | 9 | [3, 17] | [1, 47] | 62 | 93 | 10 | [3, 28] | [2, 42] | 45 | 93 |
| Borghans | 4 | [2, 17] | [1, 66] | 69 | 80 | 16 | [5, 30] | [0, 46] | 51 | 93 |
| Brannmark | 8 | [6, 15] | [5, 46] | 73 | 93 | 7 | [6, 16] | [3, 46] | 66 | 93 |
| Bruno | 38 | [34, 54] | [29, 63] | 65 | 60 | 41 | [28, 48] | [24, 55] | 66 | 67 |
| Chen | 8 | [7, 9] | [4, 10] | 10 | 100 | 11 | [8, 13] | [6, 16] | 17 | 100 |
| Fiedler | 15 | [10, 17] | [6, 25] | 29 | 100 | 10 | [9, 15] | [5, 29] | 31 | 100 |
| Fujita | 29 | [24, 44] | [12, 63] | 63 | 67 | 25 | [14, 43] | [10, 78] | 87 | 73 |
| Giordano | 6 | [4, 18] | [4, 38] | 49 | 93 | 9 | [6, 24] | [3, 48] | 52 | 87 |
| Isensee | 10 | [8, 11] | [6, 13] | 13 | 100 | 6 | [6, 7] | [6, 7] | 7 | 100 |

| | ±5% | | | | | ±50% | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Problem | Median | $[Q_1, Q_3]$ | $[P_5, P_{95}]$ | Max | $\pi$ | Median | $[Q_1, Q_3]$ | $[P_5, P_{95}]$ | Max | $\pi$ |
| Laske | 10 | [6, 18] | [4, 24] | 26 | 100 | 12 | [7, 21] | [3, 23] | 23 | 100 |
| Liu | 26 | [16, 31] | [8, 81] | 83 | 80 | 22 | [15, 41] | [9, 65] | 93 | 80 |
| Okuonghae | 4 | [3, 7] | [0, 29] | 37 | 100 | 5 | [3, 7] | [1, 17] | 22 | 100 |
| Oliveira | 13 | [7, 24] | [5, 48] | 50 | 87 | 17 | [6, 24] | [1, 36] | 42 | 100 |
| Perelson | 0 | [0, 0] | [0, 0] | 0 | 100 | 0 | [0, 0] | [0, 0] | 0 | 100 |
| Rahman | 4 | [2, 11] | [1, 27] | 28 | 100 | 5 | [2, 9] | [0, 54] | 63 | 87 |
| Raia | 3 | [1, 7] | [1, 19] | 26 | 100 | 4 | [2, 9] | [1, 18] | 29 | 100 |
| Raimundez | 19 | [12, 26] | [10, 34] | 35 | 100 | 17 | [15, 31] | [8, 39] | 49 | 93 |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 19 | [8, 24] | [4, 50] | 51 | 87 | 17 | [7, 23] | [3, 61] | 91 | 87 |
| Schwen | 17 | [10, 22] | [6, 39] | 56 | 93 | 17 | [7, 21] | [4, 45] | 52 | 93 |
| Smith | 8 | [5, 9] | [2, 22] | 22 | 100 | 6 | [5, 11] | [2, 26] | 29 | 100 |
| Sneyd | 38 | [22, 51] | [18, 77] | 91 | 60 | 33 | [22, 43] | [12, 81] | 96 | 73 |
| Weber | 4 | [3, 5] | [2, 10] | 11 | 100 | 4 | [2, 7] | [2, 12] | 20 | 100 |
| Zhao | 30 | [19, 49] | [16, 74] | 77 | 73 | 16 | [5, 61] | [2, 84] | 95 | 60 |
| Zheng | 30 | [24, 41] | [12, 66] | 79 | 73 | 33 | [26, 55] | [10, 84] | 99 | 67 |
| Armistead | 33 | [27, 54] | [14, 76] | 86 | 60 | 52 | [27, 62] | [13, 78] | 98 | 47 |
| Bertozzi | 33 | [18, 71] | [12, 83] | 85 | 60 | 55 | [27, 65] | [11, 91] | 93 | 40 |
| Blasi | 40 | [26, 61] | [22, 76] | 87 | 53 | 44 | [24, 76] | [20, 84] | 93 | 47 |
| Elowitz | 36 | [25, 57] | [10, 86] | 90 | 60 | 48 | [32, 67] | [12, 82] | 86 | 33 |
| Lucarelli | 44 | [34, 51] | [29, 64] | 75 | 53 | 47 | [36, 53] | [24, 63] | 75 | 47 |

### Independent directions at each size

*Purpose.* The paired design above reuses the same fifteen directions at every perturbation size, so that the differences between sizes are due only to the size of the change. Its limitation is that the sizes above ±5% are not tested with new random draws: a subset could appear robust because the particular fifteen directions happen to be favourable, or fragile because a few unfavourable directions are repeated at every size. To separate the effect of the size from that of the particular directions, the whole evaluation was repeated with independent directions at each size.

*Design.* For each admissible problem, with its final subset fixed and its calibration parameters re-estimated as above, the fifteen directions at size $\varepsilon$ were drawn with seed $42 + 1000\,i$, where $i$ is the position of $\varepsilon$ in the list of sizes, except at ±5%, which keeps seed 42 and therefore the scenarios of the selection. Everything else (the discarding of scenarios, the re-estimation, the first-order $e_{\text{fit}}$ of the six large admissible problems, the median and the classification into patterns) is identical to the paired design (`robustness.py` with `ROBUST_INDEP=1` in the reproducibility package; results in `results/robustness_independent/`).

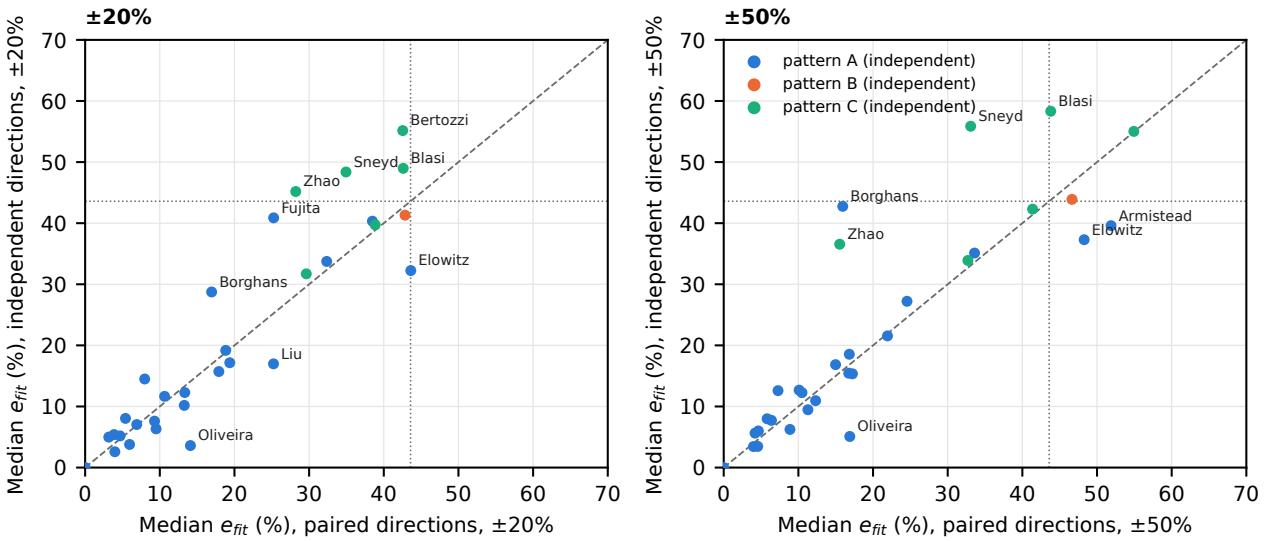
*Results.* Supplementary Table S13 gives the pattern of every problem with both designs and the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ with independent directions at every size, and Supplementary Figure S5 compares the medians of the two designs at ±20% and ±50%. Of the 31 admissible problems, the paired design classifies 26 as pattern A, 4 as B and 1 as C, and the independent design 24, 1 and 6. Twenty-two problems are of pattern A in both designs, and their medians with the two designs lie close to each other and far below the threshold. Nine problems change: Bruno, Sneyd, Zhao and Zheng (A → C), Armistead and Elowitz (B → A), Bertozzi and Blasi (B → C) and Lucarelli (C → B). All nine have medians within about ten percentage points of $\tau_e$ at the larger sizes in at least one design, and the median at a given size can differ by up to 27 percentage points between the two sets of directions (Borghans at ±50%, which nevertheless keeps pattern A). Pattern C, which requires the median to cross the threshold more than once, is the typical outcome when the median fluctuates around $\tau_e$, and it becomes more frequent

with independent directions because each size then adds its own sampling fluctuation.

*Interpretation.* The statement that most subsets remain adequate for parameter changes of up to ±50% does not depend on the particular directions: it holds for the 22 problems of pattern A in both designs. For the nine problems whose pattern changes, fifteen scenarios per size are not enough to establish where admissibility is lost, and their pattern should be read as "close to the threshold at large perturbations" rather than as a definite collapse or recovery. Admissibility at ±5%, on which the selection and all other analyses rely, is not affected, because both designs use the same scenarios at that size.

**Supplementary Table S13.** Robustness with independent directions at each perturbation size. Pattern with the paired design (the same fifteen directions rescaled at every size, as in the main text) and with independent directions (new directions at every size; in bold when the pattern changes); median $e_{\text{fit}}$ (%) over the valid scenarios at each size with independent directions; and pass rate $\pi$ (%) at ±50%. At ±5% both designs use the scenarios of the selection.

| Problem | Paired | Indep. | ±1% | ±5% | ±10% | ±20% | ±30% | ±40% | ±50% | $\pi_{50}$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | A | A | 24 | 12 | 16 | 10 | 17 | 21 | 17 | 93 |
| Armistead | B | **A** | 35 | 33 | 33 | 40 | 31 | 35 | 40 | 53 |
| Bachmann | A | A | 32 | 34 | 31 | 34 | 29 | 33 | 35 | 87 |
| Bertozzi | B | **C** | 49 | 33 | 30 | 55 | 36 | 27 | 55 | 27 |
| Blasi | B | **C** | 44 | 40 | 33 | 49 | 37 | 46 | 58 | 27 |
| Boehm | A | A | 7 | 9 | 11 | 6 | 20 | 9 | 13 | 93 |
| Borghans | A | A | 10 | 4 | 8 | 29 | 32 | 23 | 43 | 53 |
| Brannmark | A | A | 18 | 8 | 12 | 14 | 9 | 16 | 13 | 100 |
| Bruno | A | **C** | 38 | 38 | 41 | 40 | 42 | 46 | 42 | 53 |
| Chen | A | A | 6 | 8 | 10 | 8 | 8 | 11 | 9 | 100 |
| Elowitz | B | **A** | 33 | 36 | 25 | 32 | 33 | 31 | 37 | 60 |
| Fiedler | A | A | 11 | 15 | 10 | 12 | 8 | 8 | 12 | 100 |
| Fujita | A | A | 23 | 29 | 39 | 41 | 35 | 29 | 27 | 73 |
| Giordano | A | A | 4 | 6 | 3 | 4 | 9 | 5 | 6 | 100 |
| Isensee | A | A | 6 | 10 | 6 | 8 | 7 | 6 | 8 | 100 |
| Laske | A | A | 13 | 10 | 15 | 12 | 9 | 8 | 11 | 100 |
| Liu | A | A | 11 | 26 | 24 | 17 | 28 | 26 | 22 | 80 |
| Lucarelli | C | **B** | 41 | 44 | 35 | 41 | 44 | 51 | 44 | 40 |
| Okuonghae | A | A | 4 | 4 | 5 | 5 | 11 | 4 | 6 | 93 |
| Oliveira | A | A | 9 | 13 | 14 | 4 | 17 | 17 | 5 | 93 |
| Perelson | A | A | – | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 100 |
| Rahman | A | A | 3 | 4 | 6 | 3 | 9 | 2 | 3 | 100 |
| Raia | A | A | 6 | 3 | 3 | 5 | 3 | 3 | 3 | 100 |
| Raimundez | A | A | 23 | 19 | 17 | 17 | 18 | 18 | 19 | 100 |
| Salazar-Cavazos | A | A | 14 | 19 | 31 | 19 | 20 | 18 | 15 | 93 |
| Schwen | A | A | 23 | 17 | 15 | 16 | 18 | 22 | 15 | 100 |
| Smith | A | A | 8 | 8 | 9 | 7 | 7 | 8 | 8 | 100 |
| Sneyd | A | **C** | 38 | 38 | 54 | 48 | 44 | 36 | 56 | 20 |
| Weber | A | A | 4 | 4 | 5 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 6 | 100 |
| Zhao | A | **C** | 28 | 30 | 40 | 45 | 22 | 44 | 37 | 53 |
| Zheng | A | **C** | 35 | 30 | 27 | 32 | 23 | 45 | 34 | 73 |




**Supplementary Figure S5. Median $e_{\text{fit}}$ with paired and with independent directions.** Each point is one admissible problem, at ±20% (left) and ±50% (right): median $e_{\text{fit}}$ over the scenarios with the fifteen directions of the selection rescaled to that size ($x$) and with fifteen new directions drawn for that size ($y$), coloured by the pattern obtained with independent directions. Dashed, identity; dotted, $\tau_e = 43.6\%$. Problems far from the identity or on different sides of the threshold are labelled.

## Supplementary Note: Random scenarios and large problems

This note describes in detail three aspects of the computations that the main text and the other notes only summarise: how the random scenarios treat parameters whose nominal values are negative, zero or extremely small; how the problems with the most expensive simulations were computed, and how the results were checked across machines; and why the greedy search of the method does not reach an admissible subset in Lang although one exists.

### Construction of the random scenarios

Every random scenario used by the method (selection, admissibility test, robustness, the admissibility test applied to the other criteria and the error in units of the noise) has the form

$$\theta_j^{(k)} = \theta_{0,j}\left(1 + \varepsilon\, u_j^{(k)}\right), \qquad u_j^{(k)} \sim \mathcal{U}(-1,1), \quad k = 1,\dots,15,$$

with the directions $u^{(k)}$ drawn from a generator with fixed seed (42), so that all these analyses use exactly the same scenarios and their comparisons are paired. Because $|\varepsilon u_j^{(k)}| \le \varepsilon \le 0.5$, the factor $1 + \varepsilon u_j^{(k)}$ lies in $[1-\varepsilon, 1+\varepsilon] \subset (0,2)$: every parameter keeps its sign and changes by at most a fraction $\varepsilon$ of its value. No clipping or lower bound is applied to the perturbed values, so that the relative size of the change is the same for every parameter whatever the magnitude or sign of its nominal value. Three groups of parameters deserve comment:

- *Negative nominal values.* Eleven estimated parameters have negative nominal values: `alpha_cer` in Armistead, a factor of the ceramide feedback, and ten parameters of Raimundez that describe differences between the two cell lines on a linear scale. They are perturbed by $\pm\varepsilon$ of their value

like the others, and in every re-estimation their sign is fixed and $\log|\theta_j|$ is optimised within $[\log(|\theta_{0,j}|/10), \log(10|\theta_{0,j}|)]$.

- *Very small positive values.* Lang has 44 estimated parameters with nominal values below $10^{-12}$ (initial amounts and rate constants estimated on a logarithmic scale, with lower bound $10^{-24}$ in the benchmark). They are perturbed relatively, like all others, so their perturbations have the same relative size.
- *Zero nominal values.* Six estimated parameters have nominal value zero (four in Lang, two in Raimundez). The simulator represents them by $10^{-12}$; their relative perturbations, and therefore their columns of the relative sensitivity matrix $J$ and their finite-perturbation effects, are negligible, so our method never selects them. Pivoted QR, which normalises every column of its sensitivity matrix to unit length and uses an absolute finite-difference step for very small values, can select them: one of its two parameters in Raimundez (`d_MAPKtotal__MKN1_2_HS746T`) has nominal value zero.

A scenario is discarded when the simulation fails or when the change of the full model is negligible ($\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}\| < \max(10^{-10}\|y(\theta_0)\|, 10^{-6})$), and the number of valid scenarios is reported in every table.

### Computation of the problems with expensive simulations

Eight problems have simulations slow enough to make the repeated nonlinear re-estimation of the admissibility test impractical (Alkan, Bachmann, Beer, Chen, Isensee, Lang, Lucarelli and Raimundez); for them $e_{\text{fit}}$ is computed to first order (Methods), and six of them are admissible. These problems, and the analyses that need many fits of a large model, were computed on shared servers with 128 and 256 cores; the others on an 8-core workstation. The following implementation details matter for reproducing the results:

- *Parallelisation.* The columns of $J$ and the stage-2 ordering by finite effects are distributed over processes; in the nested validation the finite-difference Jacobian of each fit of the full model is distributed as well (70 processes in Raimundez, which reduced the computation from hours to about a minute), and in the identifiability analysis the points of the profiles are computed in parallel.
- *Caches.* For problems with more than 200 parameters, $J$, the stage-2 ordering and the $e_{\text{fit}}$ of the subsets already evaluated are stored on disk so that an interrupted run can resume. Each setting of the method (Supplementary Note *Sensitivity to the method settings*) uses its own cache, because these quantities depend on the finite-difference step, the integrator tolerances and the perturbation size.
- *Full model.* The full model is re-estimated on real data in every admissible problem (up to 155 free parameters, in Chen), and in the synthetic experiment only when it has at most 100 free parameters once those acting only in test conditions are removed, which excludes Chen and Raimundez. All real-data numbers of the paper come from a single run, the nested validation (Supplementary Note *Leakage-free nested validation*).
- *Checkpoints.* Long fits write checkpoints identified by the problem and the number of free parameters. When an analysis is repeated with a different subset of the same size, the results and checkpoints of that problem must be deleted first; otherwise an earlier fit would be resumed. Likewise, the admissibility test of the subsets of the other criteria must run after their selections (pivoted QR, Brun, Morris, profile likelihood) have been computed.

### Agreement between machines

The selection of Lang and Raimundez was computed independently on the workstation and on the 128-core server, with the same code and NumPy (2.4.6) and SciPy (1.17.1) but different versions of the simulator (libRoadRunner 2.9.2 on the workstation and 2.10.0 on the server): both runs gave the same subsets, and the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ agreed to within $10^{-8}$. All the analyses of Armistead were also computed on both machines; the test $\chi^2/n$ of the reduced model in the nested validation agreed to within $10^{-8}$ (1.2181).

### Dependence of the greedy search on its path: Lang

In Lang, an oscillating cell-cycle model with 294 estimated parameters (277 of which affect the outputs) simulated to $t = 136{,}472$, the method stops without an admissible subset. Stage 1 does not reach the energy threshold $\tau_R$ (the 13 parameters accepted by the conditioning test keep 17% of the sensitivity energy), so stage 2 orders the parameters by their finite effect. The first parameter is `kDeE2f1` (degradation of E2F1) and the second `kDeCe`; the pair is not admissible, and the search keeps adding the next parameters in this order as long as the conditioning test is satisfied, until no further parameter can be added ($\kappa = 8.7$, VIF $= 9.99$, just below the limit of 10). The resulting 13 parameters have a median first-order $e_{\text{fit}}$ of 56%, above $\tau_e$. Because adding parameters can never increase the first-order $e_{\text{fit}}$ (Lean, `fitErr_union_le`), no subset of these 13 parameters is admissible either.

Admissible pairs nevertheless exist outside this path. With the same scenarios and only the conditioning threshold changed (Supplementary Table S14), the search accepts a different second parameter and finds {`kDeE2f1`, `kSySkp2`} ($e_{\text{fit}} = 13\%$, with $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\text{VIF}} = 5$) and {`kDeE2f1`, `kSyCb1`} (16%, with 30); with finite-difference steps of 0.1% or 5% it finds {`kDeE2f1`, `kAspEB55`} and {`kDeE2f1`, `kSyCb1`}. With perturbations of ±1%, or with coarser integrator tolerances ($10^{-6}/10^{-8}$), the pair {`kDeE2f1`, `kDeCe`} itself becomes admissible (8% and 13%); this last result shows that the first-order $e_{\text{fit}}$ of this long oscillatory simulation is sensitive to the accuracy of the integration, which agrees with the discrepancy between our simulation of Lang and the reference simulation of the benchmark (Supplementary Note *Verification of the simulator*). Lang is therefore non-admissible under the method as defined, but the failure reflects the greedy nature of the search, which commits to the second parameter with the largest finite effect, and not the absence of a small admissible subset; a search that explored several candidates for each position (for example a beam search) would find one. We kept the method unchanged and report Lang as not admissible.

### Settings variants of Raimundez

Raimundez, with 136 estimated parameters of which 79 are calibration parameters, selects {`kdeg_membran__MKN1`, `ka_MAPK__MKN1`} in every computed variant of the settings, with a median $e_{\text{fit}}$ between 18% and 19%; the selection of this problem is insensitive to the settings. Two variants of Lang (±10% and tolerances $10^{-9}/10^{-12}$) and one of Raimundez ($\tau_e = 0.10$) did not finish in the available computing time.

**Supplementary Table S14.** Settings variants of Lang and Raimundez, computed as in Supplementary Table S32 (one setting changed at a time, all others at their baseline values, the same scenarios). Cell: selected subset and median $e_{\text{fit}}$; =, the same subset as the baseline; ×, not admissible (number of parameters at which the search stopped and its $e_{\text{fit}}$). Not computed: variants that did not finish in the available computing time.

| Setting | Lang | Raimundez |
|---|---|---|
| Baseline | × (13 par., 56%) | `kdeg_membran__MKN1`, `ka_MAPK__MKN1` (19%) |
| $\delta = 0.1\%$ | `kDeE2f1`, `kAspEB55` (11%) | = (19%) |
| $\delta = 5\%$ | `kDeE2f1`, `kSyCb1` (16%) | = (19%) |
| tolerances $10^{-9}/10^{-12}$ | not computed | = (19%) |
| tolerances $10^{-6}/10^{-8}$ | `kDeE2f1`, `kDeCe` (13%) | = (19%) |
| perturbation ±1% | `kDeE2f1`, `kDeCe` (8%) | = (19%) |
| perturbation ±10% | not computed | = (18%) |
| $\tau_R = 0.80$ | × (13 par., 56%) | = (19%) |
| $\tau_R = 0.85$ | × (13 par., 56%) | = (19%) |
| $\tau_R = 0.95$ | × (13 par., 56%) | = (19%) |
| $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\text{VIF}} = 5$ | `kDeE2f1`, `kSySkp2` (13%) | = (19%) |
| $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\text{VIF}} = 30$ | `kDeE2f1`, `kSyCb1` (16%) | = (19%) |
| $\tau_e = 0.10$ | × (13 par., 56%) | not computed |
| $\tau_e = 0.20$ | × (13 par., 56%) | = (19%) |
| $\tau_e = 0.30$ | × (13 par., 56%) | = (19%) |
| $\tau_e = 0.50$ | × (13 par., 56%) | = (19%) |

## Supplementary Note: Synthetic prediction experiment

With real data the true parameters are unknown and, in addition, the published estimate $\theta_0$ at which the non-selected parameters are fixed was obtained using the test experiments (Supplementary Note *Leakage-free nested validation*). To measure the prediction error itself, without either limitation, we repeated the external validation with synthetic data generated from a known truth that $\theta_0$ has not seen.

### Design

1. *Truth.* For each seed $s \in \{42, \ldots, 61\}$, a vector $u \in [-1, 1]^p$ with components $u_j \sim \mathcal{U}(-1, 1)$ is drawn (NumPy `default_rng`$(s)$) and $\theta^*_j = \theta_{0,j}(1 + 0.2\, u_j)$ for every parameter that can be estimated from the training data (parameters acting only in test conditions stay at $\theta_{0,j}$, since no method could learn them).
2. *Data.* $\tilde{y}_i = y_i(\theta^*) + \epsilon_i$ with $\epsilon_i \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$ in noise-scaled units, i.e. Gaussian noise with the standard deviation $\sigma_i$ recorded in the benchmark, drawn from the same generator.
3. *Split and fits.* The same training/test split as for the real data. The reduced model (re-estimating $S \cup \Theta_C$) and the full model (re-estimating all parameters) are fitted to the synthetic training data from $\theta_0$, with the same least-squares method and bounds. The full model was not re-estimated for Chen and Raimundez, which have more than 100 free parameters after removing those that act only in the test conditions (Bachmann has 101 parameters that affect the outputs but 84 free ones, and its full model was re-estimated).

4. *Prediction error.* On the test measurements,

$$e_{\mathrm{pred}} = \frac{\|y_{\mathrm{test}}(\hat{\theta}) - y_{\mathrm{test}}(\theta^*)\|}{\|y_{\mathrm{test}}(\theta^*) - y_{\mathrm{test}}(\theta_0)\|},$$

the error of the prediction relative to the change of the true response; $e_{\mathrm{pred}} = 1$ for $\theta_0$, and $e_{\mathrm{pred}} \leq \tau_e = 0.436$ is used as the success criterion.

5. *Signal and noise.* When the change from $\theta_0$ to $\theta^*$ moves the test outputs less than the noise, the fits are dominated by the noise of the training data and $e_{\mathrm{pred}}$, whose denominator is then small, is unstable. The signal is considered larger than the noise when the test $\chi^2/n$ of $\theta_0$ on the synthetic data is at least 2.

The full-model fits, with many free parameters, can end in different local optima when they are repeated with other library versions, which does not change any qualitative conclusion.

## Results

Over all seeds, 620 problem–seed combinations were planned (31 admissible problems × 20 seeds). Forty could not be evaluated because Bertozzi and Blasi have no training/test split, eight failed in Isensee because the synthetic truth $\theta^*$ could not be simulated, and in two the prediction error is undefined (Chen, seed 51, in which the fitted reduced model could not be simulated on the test conditions, and Perelson, seed 50). The remaining 570 cases, 320 with signal and 250 without, are the denominators below. Among the cases with signal, the reduced model reached $e_{\mathrm{pred}} \leq \tau_e$ in 178 of 320 (56%; between 31% and 76% depending on the seed) and predicted at least as well as the full model in 160 of 282 (57%; 40–73%). Without signal, the reduced model predicted at the noise level (test $\chi^2/n \leq 2$) in 197 of 250 cases.

The outcome is stable within each problem (Supplementary Table S15 and main-text Fig. 3b) and divides the benchmark into two groups. The reduced model predicts better than the full model in almost every seed where the full model is over-parameterised for the available data: Weber (20 of 20 seeds), Isensee (12 of 12), Fiedler and Bruno (6 of 6), Brannmark (17 of 18), Zheng (18 of 20) and Elowitz (14 of 17). It predicts worse in almost every seed of the other group, in which the full model, re-estimated on the training data, predicts well (the reason is not established; the full-model profiles of these problems show few identifiable parameters, Supplementary Note *Profile likelihood*): Oliveira (0 of 20), Armistead (1 of 12), Fujita (1 of 18), Okuonghae (2 of 20) and Salazar-Cavazos (3 of 18). Beating the full model does not imply an accurate prediction: in Brannmark the reduced model reaches the threshold in only 1 of 18 seeds, and in Raimundez, Zhao and Schwen it rarely does. Supplementary Table S16 gives the counts for every seed.

**Supplementary Table S15.** Synthetic prediction experiment, reduced and full model, 20 seeds (42–61). Seeds: valid seeds; signal: seeds in which the test $\chi^2/n$ of $\theta_0$ on the synthetic data is at least 2. Median $e_{\mathrm{pred}}$ over valid seeds. Last two columns, over the seeds with signal: reduced model with $e_{\mathrm{pred}} \leq \tau_e$, and reduced $e_{\mathrm{pred}}$ no larger than that of the full model (–, full model not re-estimated: more than 100 free parameters).

| Problem | Seeds | Signal | Reduced $e_{\mathrm{pred}}$ | Full $e_{\mathrm{pred}}$ | Reduced $\leq \tau_e$ | Reduced $\leq$ full |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 20 | 3 | 0.306 | 0.326 | 3/3 | 1/3 |
| Armistead | 20 | 12 | 0.467 | 0.227 | 7/12 | 1/12 |
| Bachmann | 20 | 2 | 2.85 | 4.65 | 0/2 | 2/2 |
| Bertozzi | *not evaluable* | | | | | |

*(continued)*

| Problem | Seeds | Signal | Reduced $e_{\text{pred}}$ | Full $e_{\text{pred}}$ | Reduced $\leq \tau_e$ | Reduced $\leq$ full |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Blasi | *not evaluable* | | | | | |
| Boehm | 20 | 4 | 1.51 | 5.65 | 1/4 | 2/4 |
| Borghans | 20 | 11 | 0.648 | 0.494 | 2/11 | 5/11 |
| Brannmark | 20 | 18 | 2.1 | 13.4 | 1/18 | 17/18 |
| Bruno | 20 | 6 | 0.429 | 11 | 4/6 | 6/6 |
| Chen | 19 | 18 | 0.144 | – | 17/18 | – |
| Elowitz | 20 | 17 | 0.293 | 0.454 | 11/17 | 14/17 |
| Fiedler | 20 | 6 | 1.15 | 3.51 | 1/6 | 6/6 |
| Fujita | 20 | 18 | 0.345 | 0.183 | 14/18 | 1/18 |
| Giordano | 20 | 0 | 346 | 515 | 0/0 | – |
| Isensee | 12 | 12 | 0.134 | 0.839 | 9/12 | 12/12 |
| Laske | 20 | 0 | 1.91 | 8.45 | 0/0 | – |
| Liu | 20 | 1 | 0.863 | 0.913 | 0/1 | 0/1 |
| Lucarelli | 20 | 0 | 1.01 | 3.27 | 0/0 | – |
| Okuonghae | 20 | 20 | 0.156 | 0.014 | 17/20 | 2/20 |
| Oliveira | 20 | 20 | 0.392 | 0.0111 | 12/20 | 0/20 |
| Perelson | 19 | 1 | 20.9 | 20.9 | 0/1 | 1/1 |
| Rahman | 20 | 19 | 0.118 | 0.372 | 15/19 | 13/19 |
| Raia | 20 | 8 | 0.453 | 0.467 | 7/8 | 5/8 |
| Raimundez | 20 | 20 | 0.571 | – | 3/20 | – |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 20 | 18 | 0.334 | 0.213 | 12/18 | 3/18 |
| Schwen | 20 | 9 | 2.63 | 2.53 | 0/9 | 5/9 |
| Smith | 20 | 20 | 0.0954 | 0.179 | 18/20 | 14/20 |
| Sneyd | 20 | 1 | 0.598 | 0.453 | 1/1 | 1/1 |
| Weber | 20 | 20 | 0.359 | 3.77 | 11/20 | 20/20 |
| Zhao | 20 | 16 | 1 | 1 | 0/16 | 11/16 |
| Zheng | 20 | 20 | 0.41 | 0.681 | 12/20 | 18/20 |

**Supplementary Table S16.** Synthetic prediction experiment, reduced and full model: counts per seed.

| Seed | Problems | With signal | Reduced $\leq \tau_e$ | Compared with full | Reduced $\leq$ full |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 42 | 28 | 13 | 8 | 11 | 6 |
| 43 | 28 | 19 | 12 | 17 | 9 |
| 44 | 29 | 16 | 7 | 14 | 7 |
| 45 | 28 | 14 | 9 | 12 | 7 |
| 46 | 29 | 17 | 9 | 15 | 10 |
| 47 | 28 | 14 | 8 | 12 | 6 |
| 48 | 29 | 12 | 6 | 11 | 6 |
| 49 | 28 | 15 | 10 | 13 | 9 |
| 50 | 27 | 17 | 6 | 15 | 11 |
| 51 | 28 | 18 | 9 | 17 | 10 |
| 52 | 29 | 20 | 11 | 18 | 11 |
| 53 | 29 | 17 | 8 | 15 | 6 |
| 54 | 29 | 15 | 9 | 13 | 6 |
| 55 | 29 | 17 | 10 | 15 | 11 |
| 56 | 29 | 16 | 5 | 14 | 6 |
| 57 | 29 | 14 | 9 | 12 | 6 |
| 58 | 28 | 17 | 13 | 15 | 10 |
| 59 | 28 | 17 | 10 | 15 | 8 |
| 60 | 29 | 16 | 10 | 14 | 7 |

*(continued)*

| Seed | Problems | With signal | Reduced $\leq \tau_e$ | Compared with full | Reduced $\leq$ full |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 61 | 29 | 16 | 9 | 14 | 8 |

### Size of the signal and other amplitudes

*Purpose.* The experiment above has three limitations. First, it defines the cases with signal through the test $\chi^2/n$ of $\theta_0$ on the synthetic data, a quantity that contains the noise realisation; a case could be classified by the particular noise drawn rather than by the true change. Second, $e_{\text{pred}}$ divides by the true change of the test outputs, so when that change is small compared with the noise the measure is unstable and partly reflects the noise of the training data. Third, the truth was generated at a single distance from $\theta_0$ ($\pm 20\%$), so the experiment says nothing about how the result depends on that distance. Two additional computations address these points.

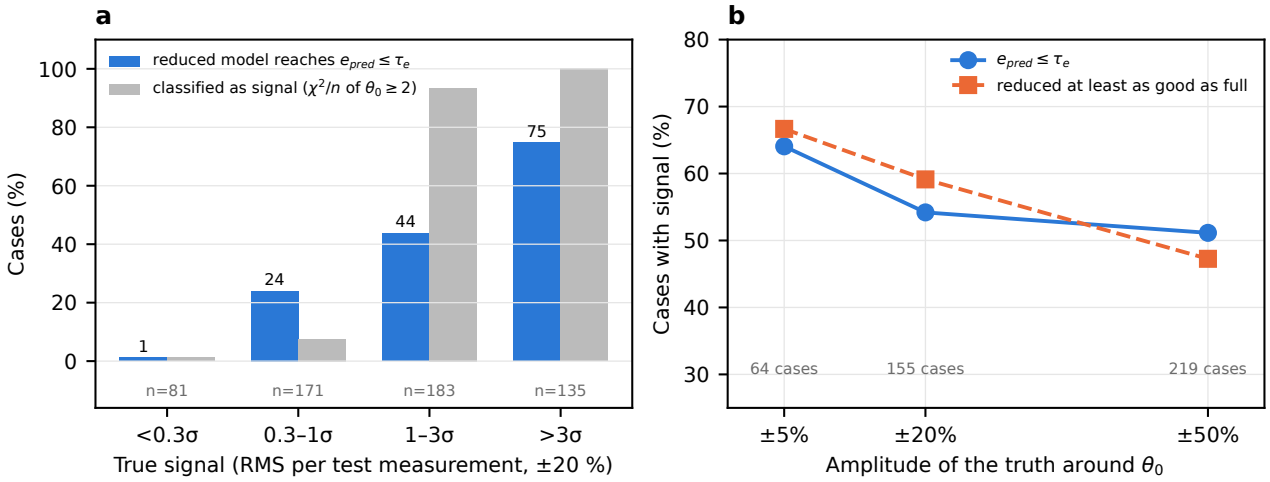
*Design.* (i) *True signal.* For every problem and seed, the change of the true response, $y(\theta^*) - y(\theta_0)$, was computed without any fit or noise. Because the outputs are divided by the recorded noise standard deviations, its root mean square over the test measurements, $\|y_{\text{test}}(\theta^*) - y_{\text{test}}(\theta_0)\|/\sqrt{n_{\text{test}}}$, is the size of the signal in units of $\sigma$ per measurement (`synthetic_seeds.py` with `SINT_SOLO_SENAL=1`; results in `results/synthetic_signal_a005`, `_a020` and `_a050`). (ii) *Other amplitudes.* The complete experiment (truth, noisy data, the same split and the same fits of the reduced and the full model) was repeated with truths $\theta^* = \theta_0(1 + a\,u)$ for $a = 0.05$ and $a = 0.50$, with seeds 42–51, and compared with $a = 0.20$ on the same seeds (`SINT_AMPLITUD`; results in `results/synthetic_seeds_a005` and `_a050`). As in the main experiment, the full model was not re-estimated in Chen and Raimundez.

*Results.* Supplementary Table S17 gives the signal and the success per problem at the three amplitudes, and Supplementary Figure S6 summarises them. At $a = 0.20$ the median signal over all problems and seeds is $1.25\sigma$ per measurement (interquartile range 0.50–2.84); it is $0.31\sigma$ at $a = 0.05$ and $2.63\sigma$ at $a = 0.50$, and it varies by orders of magnitude between problems, from below $10^{-3}\sigma$ in Giordano and Perelson, whose recorded noise is far larger than the outputs, to tens or hundreds of $\sigma$ in Okuonghae and Oliveira. The success of the reduced model grows steadily with the true signal: $e_{\text{pred}} \leq \tau_e$ in 1% of the 81 cases with a signal below $0.3\sigma$, 24% of the 171 between $0.3\sigma$ and $\sigma$, 44% of the 183 between $\sigma$ and $3\sigma$ and 75% of the 135 above $3\sigma$. Below about one noise unit per measurement, $e_{\text{pred}}$ therefore reflects mainly the noise of the training data, as the review pointed out. The criterion used above to define the cases with signal agrees closely with the true signal: it classifies as cases with signal 1% and 8% of the cases whose true signal is below $0.3\sigma$ and between $0.3\sigma$ and $\sigma$, and 93% and 100% of those between $\sigma$ and $3\sigma$ and above $3\sigma$; the counts reported above are thus essentially the counts of cases with a true signal of at least one noise unit.

At the three amplitudes, the number of cases with signal grows from 64 ($\pm 5\%$) to 155 ($\pm 20\%$) and 219 ($\pm 50\%$), as the truth moves further from $\theta_0$. Among these cases, the reduced model reached $e_{\text{pred}} \leq \tau_e$ in 64%, 54% and 51%, and predicted at least as well as the full model in 67% (42 of 63), 59% (81 of 137) and 47% (95 of 201). The reduction is local: it predicts best when the truth is close to the reference $\theta_0$ around which the subset was selected, its advantage over the full model disappears for changes of $\pm 50\%$, where the full model, which can move all its parameters, more often recovers the truth, and yet it still reaches the prediction threshold in about half of the cases. This is consistent with the robustness analysis, in which most subsets remain admissible up to $\pm 50\%$: reproducing the full model at large perturbations and predicting new data from noisy measurements at large distances from $\theta_0$ are different tasks, and the second depends also on the noise and on the training data.

**Supplementary Table S17.** True signal and success of the reduced model in the synthetic experiment at three amplitudes of the truth, $\theta^* = \theta_0(1 + a\,u)$. Signal: median over the seeds of the root mean square of $y(\theta^*) - y(\theta_0)$ per test measurement, in units of the recorded noise $\sigma$ (seeds 42–61 at $a = 0.20$, 42–51 otherwise). Success: seeds with $e_{\mathrm{pred}} \le \tau_e$ among those with signal (test $\chi^2/n$ of $\theta_0 \ge 2$), seeds 42–51 at every amplitude.

| Problem | Signal ±5% | ±20% | ±50% | Success ±5% | ±20% | ±50% |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 0.22 | 0.65 | 2.2 | – | 3/3 | 9/10 |
| Armistead | 0.27 | 1.3 | 3.1 | – | 2/5 | 4/8 |
| Bachmann | 0.14 | 0.53 | 1.5 | – | 0/2 | 0/10 |
| Boehm | 0.15 | 0.46 | 1.7 | 0/1 | 1/3 | 4/6 |
| Borghans | 0.9 | 1.2 | 1.2 | 0/3 | 1/6 | 1/5 |
| Brannmark | 0.72 | 1.8 | 5.9 | 0/3 | 1/10 | 0/10 |
| Bruno | 0.16 | 0.72 | 1.5 | – | 1/1 | 4/8 |
| Chen | 0.51 | 2.5 | 6.2 | 1/1 | 8/8 | 7/8 |
| Elowitz | 0.62 | 2.3 | 4 | 1/1 | 5/9 | 7/10 |
| Fiedler | 0.23 | 0.89 | 2.1 | – | 0/4 | 5/10 |
| Fujita | 0.65 | 2.4 | 5.6 | 2/2 | 7/8 | 5/10 |
| Giordano | $8.2 \times 10^{-5}$ | $4.4 \times 10^{-4}$ | $9.0 \times 10^{-4}$ | – | – | – |
| Isensee | 0.66 | 2.7 | 6.5 | – | 4/4 | 3/5 |
| Laske | 0.095 | 0.31 | 0.92 | – | – | 2/4 |
| Liu | 0.068 | 0.31 | 0.59 | – | – | 0/1 |
| Lucarelli | 0.096 | 0.39 | 0.95 | – | – | 1/4 |
| Okuonghae | 59 | $2.1 \times 10^{2}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{2}$ | 9/10 | 8/10 | 8/10 |
| Oliveira | $1.4 \times 10^{2}$ | $6.1 \times 10^{2}$ | $9.7 \times 10^{2}$ | 5/10 | 4/10 | 2/10 |
| Perelson | $1.8 \times 10^{-7}$ | $7.3 \times 10^{-7}$ | $1.7 \times 10^{-6}$ | – | – | – |
| Rahman | 1 | 4.9 | 11 | 5/5 | 8/9 | 9/10 |
| Raia | 0.17 | 0.65 | 1.5 | – | 3/3 | 5/6 |
| Raimundez | 0.51 | 2 | 5.5 | – | 2/10 | 4/10 |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 0.44 | 1.9 | 4.4 | 1/3 | 5/9 | 5/9 |
| Schwen | 0.2 | 0.91 | 2.4 | 0/1 | 0/4 | 1/9 |
| Smith | 15 | 64 | $1.6 \times 10^{2}$ | 10/10 | 10/10 | 10/10 |
| Sneyd | 0.14 | 0.55 | 1.5 | – | – | 4/7 |
| Weber | 1.6 | 3.7 | 7.1 | 3/6 | 5/10 | 7/10 |
| Zhao | 0.35 | 1.7 | 6.8 | 0/1 | 0/7 | 0/9 |
| Zheng | 1.3 | 4.6 | 10 | 4/7 | 6/10 | 5/10 |




**Supplementary Figure S6. Signal and amplitude in the synthetic experiment. a**, Cases at ±20% (all seeds) grouped by the true signal, the root mean square of $y(\theta^*) - y(\theta_0)$ per test measurement in noise units: percentage in which the reduced model reaches $e_{\text{pred}} \le \tau_e$ (blue) and percentage classified as cases with signal by the criterion of the experiment, test $\chi^2/n$ of $\theta_0 \ge 2$ (grey); $n$, number of cases. **b**, Seeds 42–51 at the three amplitudes of the truth: among the cases with signal, percentage in which the reduced model reaches the threshold (circles) and in which it predicts at least as well as the full model (squares).

## Supplementary Note: Single-parameter subsets

The method requires at least $k_{\min} = 2$ biological parameters. This note examines whether a single parameter could suffice.

### Design

For every admissible problem the candidates are the ten biological parameters with the largest sensitivity energy $E_j$ and the ten with the largest finite effect $s_j$ (the two orderings of the method). Each candidate $j$ is tested alone, with the calibration parameters $\Theta_C$ re-estimated together with it as in the method: $\{j\}$ is admissible if the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ over the same 15 scenarios at ±5% is at most $\tau_e$ (without the requirement $|S| \ge 2$). For the best admissible candidate $j^*$ (smallest median $e_{\text{fit}}$) we also computed the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ at ±10% and its external validation, real and synthetic, exactly as for the selected subset $S$ (Supplementary Note *Synthetic prediction experiment*). Bachmann, Chen, Isensee and Raimundez were not included because the repeated nonlinear re-estimations are too slow.

### Results

A single parameter was admissible at ±5% in 15 of the 27 problems examined. In the synthetic prediction experiment the selected subset $S$ predicted better than the best single parameter (smaller $e_{\text{pred}}$) in 9 of the 15 problems where both could be evaluated (Supplementary Table S18), but on real data the single parameter had the lower test $\chi^2/n$ in 10 of the 15 (Supplementary Table S18). The evidence is therefore mixed, and the minimum size $k_{\min} = 2$ should be regarded as a design choice rather than as a result.

**Supplementary Table S18.** Problems in which a single biological parameter $j^*$ is admissible: median $e_{\text{fit}}$ (%) at ±5% and ±10%, test $\chi^2/n$ on real data and $e_{\text{pred}}$ in the synthetic experiment, for $\{j^*\}$ and for the selected subset $S$ (both with $\Theta_C$ re-estimated).

| | | $e_{\text{fit}}$ ±5% | | $e_{\text{fit}}$ ±10% | | Real $\chi^2/n$ | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Problem | $j^*$ | $j^*$ | $S$ | $j^*$ | $S$ | $j^*$ | $S$ | $e_{\text{pred}}$ $j^*$ / $S$ |
| Alkan | `kt` | 21 | 12 | 13 | 12 | 2.74 | 2.75 | 0.13 / 0.13 |
| Borghans | `v0` | 10 | 4 | 14 | 8 | 0.75 | 0.74 | 1.00 / 1.04 |
| Brannmark | `km2` | 9 | 8 | 9 | 8 | 1.63 | 5.96 | 1.19 / 0.92 |
| Fiedler | `k10` | 15 | 15 | 15 | 14 | 11.68 | 11.21 | 0.16 / 0.23 |
| Fujita | `reaction_2_k1` | 20 | 29 | 22 | 28 | 5.96 | 5.94 | 0.53 / 0.95 |
| Giordano | `gamma_4` | 11 | 6 | 11 | 5 | $1.1 \times 10^{-8}$ | $1.0 \times 10^{-7}$ | 1.78 / 1,027 |
| Laske | `k_imp` | 16 | 10 | 16 | 10 | 0.44 | 0.76 | 3.19 / 0.50 |
| Okuonghae | `gamma_0` | 5 | 4 | 5 | 4 | $4.1 \times 10^{4}$ | $4.7 \times 10^{4}$ | 0.30 / 0.08 |
| Oliveira | `delta_` | 11 | 13 | 12 | 13 | $2.0 \times 10^{4}$ | 912 | 0.38 / 0.29 |
| Rahman | `infected_ moderate_ transmission_ rate` | 11 | 4 | 12 | 4 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | $2.0 \times 10^{-3}$ | 0.35 / 0.07 |
| Raia | `init_Rec_i` | 4 | 3 | 4 | 3 | 7.42 | 8.22 | 0.43 / 0.48 |
| Salazar-Cavazos | `ratio_kpkd_Y1068_ _FREE` | 30 | 19 | 29 | 19 | 100.00 | 102 | 0.79 / 0.17 |
| Schwen | `ini_R2fold` | 19 | 17 | 19 | 17 | 8.08 | 8.20 | 1.89 / 2.03 |
| Smith | `k30r` | 8 | 8 | 8 | 8 | $7.1 \times 10^{4}$ | $1.5 \times 10^{4}$ | 1.00 / 0.07 |
| Weber | `a21` | 6 | 4 | 6 | 4 | 0.99 | 1.00 | 0.94 / 0.63 |

## Supplementary Note: Identifiability of the selected parameters

### Question

The method selects a subset $S$ that is *sufficient*: re-estimating $S$ together with the calibration parameters $\Theta_C$, with the other parameters at $\theta_0$, reproduces the outputs of the full model. Sufficiency does not imply that the data determine the values of the selected parameters. A selected parameter could, for example, compensate for a scaling factor of the measurement, so that only their product is determined. This note examines whether the selected parameters are also practically identifiable in the reduced problem, that is, with $S \cup \Theta_C$ free and the remaining parameters at their published values.

### Design

1. *Local check.* At $\theta_0$, the columns of the sensitivity matrix for $S \cup \Theta_C$, normalised to unit length and not centred (the Fisher information of the reduced problem up to scaling), were examined: for each selected parameter, the variance inflation factor (VIF) within $S \cup \Theta_C$ and the column of $\Theta_C$ or $S$ most similar to it.
2. *Profile likelihood of the reduced problem.* With all measurements of the problem and the noise levels of the benchmark, the reduced problem was fitted from $\theta_0$ (minimum $\hat{\theta}$). For each selected parameter $\theta_j$, $\log|\theta_j|$ was fixed at displacements of 0.05 to 4.6 from $\log|\hat{\theta}_j|$ and the other parameters of $S \cup \Theta_C$ were re-estimated, with the same least-squares method and bounds $[|\theta_0|/10, 10|\theta_0|]$ as in the rest of the study. If a profile point improved the minimum, the reduced problem was re-fitted from that point and the profile repeated (at most three rounds). Only points within the

bounds of $\theta_j$ were used. As in Raue et al. (2009), $\theta_j$ is *identifiable* if $\Delta\chi^2$ exceeds 3.84 (95%, one degree of freedom) on both sides within the bounds, *practically non-identifiable* if on one side only, and *flat* otherwise. Because several problems have recorded noise levels that do not match the scatter of the data, a robust variant scales the threshold by $\max(1, \chi^2_{\min}/\text{d.f.})$, which is equivalent to rescaling the noise so that the fit has $\chi^2/\text{d.f.} = 1$.

3. *Condition of the formal theorem.* For each selected parameter we computed the quantities that appear in the theorem described below: the profiled information $I_j = 1/[(A^\top A)^{-1}]_{jj}$, where $A$ is the sensitivity matrix of the residuals with respect to $\log|\theta|$ for $S \cup \Theta_C$ at $\hat{\theta}$; the residual gradient $\gamma = \|Pr_0\|$, the norm of the projection of the residual at $\hat{\theta}$ onto the range of $A$; and the nonlinear remainder $\|r(\hat{\theta}+\delta) - r_0 - A\delta\|$ at the computed profile points.

Five problems with expensive simulations (Bachmann, Chen, Isensee, Raimundez, Smith) were computed on a server (Raimundez on a 128-core server, the others on a 256-core server) and the other 26 on an 8-core workstation, so the profiles cover all 31 problems with an admissible subset.

## Mathematical derivation of the identifiability condition

This subsection states the result that is verified in Lean (module `ProfileIdentifiability`, step 32 of Supplementary Table S4) and gives the complete argument, with the reasoning behind each step. All statements are deterministic inequalities in a real inner-product space: no probabilistic assumption is used in the proofs, and the statistical meaning enters only through the threshold $c$.

### Setting

Let $k$ be the number of free parameters of the reduced problem, the selected biological parameters $S$ and the calibration parameters $\Theta_C$, all other parameters being fixed at $\theta_0$. We work with the displacement $\delta \in \mathbb{R}^k$ of their logarithms, $\log|\theta| = \log|\hat{\theta}| + \delta$, from the optimum $\hat{\theta}$ of the reduced fit. Let

$$r(\delta) = \Big(\frac{y_i(\hat{\theta}+\delta) - \tilde{y}_i}{\sigma_i}\Big)_{i=1,\dots,m} \in \mathbb{R}^m$$

be the vector of noise-scaled residuals over all measurements ($y_i$ the model output, $\tilde{y}_i$ the measurement and $\sigma_i$ its recorded noise level, all after the transformation of the observable), so that the weighted least-squares cost is $\chi^2(\delta) = \|r(\delta)\|^2$. Write $r_0 = r(0)$ and

$$\Delta\chi^2(\delta) = \|r(\delta)\|^2 - \|r_0\|^2,$$

the increase of the cost when the parameters move by $\delta$ from the optimum. Let $A = \partial r/\partial\delta\,(0) \in \mathbb{R}^{m\times k}$ be the sensitivity matrix of the residuals at the optimum and

$$\rho(\delta) = r(\delta) - r_0 - A\delta$$

the nonlinear remainder of the first-order expansion. Fix a selected parameter $j$ and denote by $\delta_j$ the $j$-th coordinate of $\delta$. $F \subseteq \mathbb{R}^k$ is the admissible set (the bounds $[|\theta_0|/10, 10|\theta_0|]$ of every free parameter), and $d_-$, $d_+ > 0$ are the distances from $\log|\hat{\theta}_j|$ to the lower and upper bound of $\theta_j$.

The profile likelihood of $\theta_j$ is $\mathrm{PL}_j(t) = \min\{\Delta\chi^2(\delta) : \delta \in F,\ \delta_j = t\}$. By Wilks' theorem, $\{t : \mathrm{PL}_j(t) < c\}$ with $c = \chi^2_{1;0.95} = 3.84$ is the 95% profile-likelihood confidence interval of $\log|\theta_j| - \log|\hat{\theta}_j|$ (Raue et al., 2009); this is the only place where a statistical argument enters.

**Definition 1** (Practical identifiability within the bounds)**.** $\theta_j$ is *practically identifiable* if there are $0 < t_- < d_-$ and $0 < t_+ < d_+$ such that $\Delta\chi^2(\delta) \geq c$ for every $\delta \in F$ with $\delta_j \leq -t_-$ or $\delta_j \geq t_+$.

Equivalently, $\mathrm{PL}_j(t) \geq c$ for $t \leq -t_-$ and for $t \geq t_+$: the profile exceeds the threshold on both sides before reaching the bounds, so the confidence interval is contained in $(-t_-, t_+)$ and is finite. This is the definition applied numerically to the computed profiles, and it is the predicate `PracticallyIdentifiable` in Lean.

### Hypotheses

**Hypothesis 1** (approximate stationarity)**.** There is $\gamma \geq 0$ with $|\langle r_0, A\delta\rangle| \leq \gamma \|A\delta\|$ for all $\delta$.

At an exact unconstrained minimum the normal equations give $A^\top r_0 = 0$, so $\gamma = 0$. A numerical optimiser stops at a tolerance, and an optimum can lie on a bound, so the hypothesis allows a residual gradient. Proposition 2 shows how $\gamma$ is computed.

**Hypothesis 2** (profiled information)**.** There is $I_j > 0$ with $I_j\, \delta_j^2 \leq \|A\delta\|^2$ for all $\delta$.

$\|A\delta\|^2$ is the linear prediction of the increase of the cost. The hypothesis says that a displacement $\delta_j$ of the parameter of interest cannot be hidden by moving the other free parameters: whatever they do, the outputs change by at least $\sqrt{I_j}\,|\delta_j|$ in units of noise. Lemma 2 gives the best such constant.

**Hypothesis 3** (bounded nonlinearity)**.** There is $\varepsilon \geq 0$ with $\|\rho(\delta)\| \leq \varepsilon$ for all $\delta \in F$.

This is the only hypothesis that involves the model away from the optimum.

### Step 1: a lower bound for the increase of the cost

**Lemma 1** (`dchi2_lower_grad`)**.** *Under Hypotheses 1 and 3, for every $\delta \in F$ with $\|A\delta\| \geq \varepsilon$,*

$$\Delta\chi^2(\delta) \;\geq\; (\|A\delta\| - \varepsilon)^2 - 2\gamma\|A\delta\| - 2\|r_0\|\varepsilon.$$

*Proof.* Since $r(\delta) = r_0 + (A\delta + \rho)$, expanding the square gives the exact identity

$$\Delta\chi^2(\delta) = 2\langle r_0, A\delta\rangle + 2\langle r_0, \rho\rangle + \|A\delta + \rho\|^2.$$

We bound each term from below. (i) By Hypothesis 1, $2\langle r_0, A\delta\rangle \geq -2\gamma\|A\delta\|$. (ii) By the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality and Hypothesis 3, $2\langle r_0, \rho\rangle \geq -2\|r_0\|\,\|\rho\| \geq -2\|r_0\|\varepsilon$. (iii) By the triangle inequality, $\|A\delta\| = \|(A\delta + \rho) - \rho\| \leq \|A\delta + \rho\| + \|\rho\|$, so $\|A\delta + \rho\| \geq \|A\delta\| - \varepsilon \geq 0$, and squaring preserves the inequality between non-negative numbers. Adding (i)–(iii) gives the claim. □

*Reasoning.* The identity separates three effects. The quadratic term $\|A\delta + \rho\|^2$ is the information: how much the outputs move. The term $2\langle r_0, A\delta\rangle$ vanishes at an exact optimum and measures how far the optimiser is from it. The cross term $2\langle r_0, \rho\rangle$ couples the misfit of the model with its nonlinearity: when the model fits the data well ($\|r_0\|$ small) the nonlinearity matters little, but when the misfit is large, as in the problems whose recorded noise does not match the data, even a moderate nonlinearity can lower the profile. This is why $\|r_0\|$ appears in the result.

### Step 2: the information that remains for one parameter

**Lemma 2** (`info_of_inverse`, `info_of_matrix`)**.** *If $A^\top A$ is invertible, Hypothesis 2 holds with $I_j = 1/[(A^\top A)^{-1}]_{jj}$, and this constant is the largest possible.*

*Proof.* Let $w = (A^\top A)^{-1} e_j$, so that $A^\top A w = e_j$ and, for every $\delta$, $\langle Aw, A\delta\rangle = \langle A^\top A w, \delta\rangle = \delta_j$. In particular $\|Aw\|^2 = w_j = [(A^\top A)^{-1}]_{jj} > 0$. By Cauchy–Schwarz, $\delta_j^2 = \langle Aw, A\delta\rangle^2 \le \|Aw\|^2 \|A\delta\|^2 = w_j \|A\delta\|^2$, which is Hypothesis 2 with $I_j = 1/w_j$. For $\delta = w$ equality holds, so no larger constant is possible. □

*Reasoning.* The extremal direction $w$ is the displacement that moves $\theta_j$ by one unit while the other free parameters compensate as well as possible in the least-squares sense; $I_j$ is the squared output change that still remains. Equivalently, if $a_j$ is the column of $A$ for $\theta_j$ and $P_{-j}$ the orthogonal projection onto the span of the other columns, then $I_j = \|(\mathrm{I} - P_{-j})a_j\|^2$, the part of the effect of $\theta_j$ that no combination of the other parameters can reproduce. This second form follows directly from $\|A\delta\| = \|\delta_j a_j + A_{-j}\delta_{-j}\| \ge |\delta_j| \operatorname{dist}(a_j, \operatorname{span} A_{-j})$, and it also holds when two *other* columns are collinear (for example two calibration parameters with the same effect), in which case $A^\top A$ is singular but the information of $\theta_j$ is still well defined. We computed $I_j$ in this form. This is the quantity that distinguishes identifiability from collinearity: the condition number and the VIF of normalised columns measure only the angle between columns, whereas $I_j$ measures the size of the remaining effect in units of the noise, so a parameter strongly correlated with a scaling factor can still be identifiable when the data are precise (Brannmark, Fiedler, Raia), and an uncorrelated parameter cannot be identifiable when the recorded noise is much larger than its effect (Giordano, Perelson).

**Step 3: the profile crosses the threshold**

**Theorem 1** (`dchi2_ge_of_coord_grad`)**.** *Under Hypotheses 1–3, let*

$$t^* = \frac{\varepsilon + \gamma + \sqrt{\gamma^2 + c + 2\|r_0\|\varepsilon + 2\gamma\varepsilon}}{\sqrt{I_j}}.$$

*Then $\Delta\chi^2(\delta) \ge c$ for every $\delta \in F$ with $|\delta_j| \ge t^*$.*

*Proof.* Write $a = \|A\delta\|$, $K = \gamma^2 + c + 2\|r_0\|\varepsilon + 2\gamma\varepsilon \ge 0$ and $s = \sqrt{K}$. By Hypothesis 2, $a \ge \sqrt{I_j}\,|\delta_j| \ge \sqrt{I_j}\,t^* = \varepsilon + \gamma + s$. In particular $a \ge \varepsilon$, so Lemma 1 applies. Put $x = a - \varepsilon \ge \gamma + s \ge 0$. Then $x - \gamma \ge s \ge 0$, hence $(x-\gamma)^2 \ge s^2 = K$, that is $x^2 - 2\gamma x \ge c + 2\|r_0\|\varepsilon + 2\gamma\varepsilon$. By Lemma 1,

$$\Delta\chi^2(\delta) \;\ge\; x^2 - 2\gamma(x+\varepsilon) - 2\|r_0\|\varepsilon \;=\; (x^2 - 2\gamma x) - 2\gamma\varepsilon - 2\|r_0\|\varepsilon \;\ge\; c. \qquad \square$$

*Reasoning.* The lower bound of Lemma 1 is a quadratic function of $a$ that becomes positive and grows once $a$ exceeds the losses caused by the gradient and the nonlinearity. $t^*$ is obtained by solving that quadratic for the value of $a$ at which the bound reaches $c$, and translating it to $\delta_j$ through the information: each unit of $\delta_j$ guarantees $\sqrt{I_j}$ units of output change.

**Corollary 1** (`practically_identifiable_grad`, `confidence_coord_lt`)**.** *Under Hypotheses 1–3, with $c > 0$: (a) every $\delta \in F$ with $\Delta\chi^2(\delta) < c$ satisfies $|\delta_j| < t^*$, so the 95% profile-likelihood interval of $\log|\theta_j|$ is contained in $(-t^*, t^*)$; (b) if $t^* < d_-$ and $t^* < d_+$, $\theta_j$ is practically identifiable within the bounds.*

*Proof.* (a) is the contrapositive of Theorem 1. For (b), $t^* > 0$ because $c > 0$ and $I_j > 0$; take $t_- = t_+ = t^*$ in the definition: any $\delta \in F$ with $\delta_j \le -t^*$ or $\delta_j \ge t^*$ has $|\delta_j| \ge t^*$, so $\Delta\chi^2(\delta) \ge c$ by Theorem 1. □

**Step 4: special cases and the computable constants**

**Proposition 1** (`tstar_linear`, `tstarGrad_zero`)**.** *With $\gamma = 0$ the half-width reduces to $t^* = (\varepsilon + \sqrt{c + 2\|r_0\|\varepsilon})/\sqrt{I_j}$, and with also $\varepsilon = 0$ to*

$$t^* = \sqrt{c/I_j} = \sqrt{c\,[(A^\top A)^{-1}]_{jj}},$$

*the half-width of the Wald (linearised) confidence interval.*

*Proof.* Direct substitution; with $I_j = 1/w_j$, $\sqrt{c}/\sqrt{1/w_j} = \sqrt{c\,w_j}$. □

*Reasoning.* For a model that is exactly linear in $\delta$ and an exact optimum, $\Delta\chi^2(\delta) = \|A\delta\|^2$ and its minimum over $\delta_j = t$ is exactly $I_j t^2$ (Lemma 2, equality case), so the profile is the parabola $I_j t^2$ and the Wald interval is exact: the condition $\sqrt{c/I_j} < d_\pm$ is then necessary and sufficient. The general theorem quantifies how much the nonlinearity ($\varepsilon$), the misfit ($\|r_0\|$) and the optimiser ($\gamma$) can widen that interval.

**Proposition 2** (`stat_of_projection`)**.** *If $p$ is the orthogonal projection of $r_0$ onto the range of $A$ ($\langle r_0 - p, A\delta\rangle = 0$ for all $\delta$), Hypothesis 1 holds with $\gamma = \|p\|$.*

*Proof.* $\langle r_0, A\delta\rangle = \langle p, A\delta\rangle$, and Cauchy–Schwarz gives $|\langle p, A\delta\rangle| \le \|p\|\,\|A\delta\|$. □

We computed $p$ by linear least squares, $p = Ac^*$ with $c^* = \arg\min_c \|r_0 - Ac\|$.

**Proposition 3** (`local_injective`: local structural identifiability)**.** *Let $G$ be the map from the free parameters to the outputs and $A$ its derivative at 0. If $\|A\delta\| \ge \sigma\|\delta\|$ for all $\delta$ ($\sigma$ the smallest singular value) and $\|G(\delta) - G(0) - A\delta\| \le M\|\delta\|^2$ for $\|\delta\| \le r$, then $G(\delta) \ne G(0)$ for every $\delta \ne 0$ with $\|\delta\| \le r$ and $M\|\delta\| < \sigma$.*

*Proof.* If $G(\delta) = G(0)$, the remainder equals $-A\delta$, so $\sigma\|\delta\| \le \|A\delta\| \le M\|\delta\|^2$, that is $\sigma \le M\|\delta\|$, a contradiction. □

*Reasoning.* This statement does not involve the data: it says that, near the optimum, different parameter values produce different outputs, so the parameters are identifiable from noise-free outputs. Practical identifiability (Corollary 1) is stronger, because it accounts for the noise and asks that the outputs change by more than the noise allows.

**Relation with sufficiency**

Admissibility and practical identifiability are different properties, and neither implies the other. Admissibility asks whether re-estimating $S \cup \Theta_C$ reproduces the outputs of the full model after all parameters are perturbed; it holds, for example, when $\theta_j$ and a scaling factor $s$ enter only through their product $s\theta_j$, because the product can absorb any change, and in that case $I_j = 0$ and $\theta_j$ is not identifiable (Fujita is an instance). Conversely, a parameter can be identifiable without being sufficient to reproduce the full model. The paper establishes the two properties separately: admissibility by the re-estimation test (Theorems 1 and 2 of the main text and the other steps of Supplementary Table S4), and identifiability by the profiles, with Corollary 1 as a sufficient condition.

**What is proved and what is computed**

Lemmas 1 and 2, Theorem 1, Corollary 1 and Propositions 1–3 are proved in Lean for arbitrary $r$, $A$, $F$ and constants, using only the three standard axioms (`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`); Supplementary Table S7 gives their formal statements (step 32). The projection form of $I_j$ is the elementary inequality given after Lemma 2; the formal development uses the inverse-matrix form, and the theorem itself takes Hypothesis 2 as an assumption, so either form can be used to verify it. For each problem, $A$ is computed by central finite differences (step 0.01 in $\log|\theta|$), $\gamma$ by Proposition 2, $I_j$ by projection and $\|r_0\|$ directly. The remainder $\varepsilon$ is the only quantity that cannot be bounded over the admissible set with the methods of this study: we evaluated it at the computed profile points. Far from the optimum, the response of an ODE model saturates and its linearisation overestimates the change of the outputs, so a single bound over the whole range of a factor of 10 is very pessimistic. The application of Corollary 1 to a particular problem is therefore a numerical check of its hypotheses, as for the other guarantees of the paper (Supplementary Table S5).

## Results

Supplementary Table S19 summarises the results for the 31 problems with an admissible subset, Supplementary Figure S7 shows the profile of every selected parameter in every problem, and Supplementary Table S20 gives, for every parameter, its confidence interval and the quantities of the formal condition ($I_j$, the Wald half-width, $\gamma$, $\varepsilon$ and the distances to the bounds).

*Profile likelihood.* In 25 of the 31 problems all selected parameters were practically identifiable, and 65 of the 74 selected parameters were identifiable (72 of them could be evaluated). The exceptions are of three kinds. In Fujita a selected parameter is confounded with a measurement scaling factor: the columns of `reaction_6_k1` and `scaling_pS6_tot` have cosine 1.00, and neither selected parameter is identifiable. In Giordano and Perelson the recorded noise levels are far larger than the residuals ($\chi^2/n < 10^{-2}$), so no parameter change raises $\chi^2$ by 3.84; in Okuonghae and Oliveira one parameter is identifiable and the profile of the other could not be simulated. In Smith, the optimum of `k8` lies at the lower bound of the study. With the robust threshold, 23 of the 31 problems keep all their parameters identifiable (60 of the 74 parameters): Raia ($\chi^2$/d.f. = 1,791) and Chen (168) lose one or both, and so does the second parameter of Smith (1,894), because their recorded noise levels are too small for the scatter of the data.

*Local check.* A VIF above 10 within $S \cup \Theta_C$ flags a correlation between a selected parameter and a calibration parameter, but it does not by itself make the parameter non-identifiable: in Brannmark, Fiedler, Isensee, Rahman, Raia, Raimundez, Schwen and Weber the VIF exceeds 10, yet all their selected parameters are identifiable in the profiles, because the data are informative enough to separate them. Only in Fujita does the confounding reach the profile.

*Condition of the theorem.* The linear condition ($\varepsilon = 0$, $\gamma = 0$) agrees with the profile classification for all 72 parameters whose profile could be evaluated (Supplementary Table S19, column Wald): it holds for the 65 identifiable parameters and fails for the other seven. With the nonlinear remainder evaluated at the profile points, the hypotheses of the theorem hold for 24 parameters (column Lean), and never for a parameter whose profile is not identifiable. The quantitative certificate is therefore conservative: the profiled information $I_j$ explains which parameters are identifiable, and the nonlinearity of the models is what prevents a certificate over the whole range of the study.

*Cost of the identifiability check.* The last column of Supplementary Table S19 gives the computing time needed to determine the identifiability of the selected parameters of each problem: one fit of the reduced problem and the re-estimations at the 40 profile points of its two selected parameters (more for Bruno, Lucarelli and Zhao). Because only the selected and calibration parameters are free, each re-estimation

is small. The median over the 31 problems was 34 s of computing time; 20 problems needed less than a minute and 24 less than ten minutes. The check took hours only where a single simulation is slow (Chen, 44 s per simulation on the server: 15 h) or where many calibration parameters are re-estimated at every point (Raimundez, 79: 4.0 h; Isensee: 4.3 h). The profile points are independent, so on many cores the elapsed time is a fraction of these values (Chen took about 3 h on the server). These include problems in which the profile likelihood of the full model takes hours (Bachmann, 40 h of computing time) or was not run (Chen, Raimundez; Supplementary Note *Profile likelihood*), so the identifiability of the selected subset can be verified at a fraction of that cost. The times were measured on three machines (an 8-core workstation and shared servers with 128 and 256 cores) and are observed times, not benchmarks.

### Subsets that are both sufficient and identifiable

Admissibility and practical identifiability are different properties (see *Relation with sufficiency* above), so a subset that can be used to reduce the model and whose parameters are also determined by the data has to satisfy both. For a problem with selected subset $S$ and calibration parameters $\Theta_C$ we distinguish four nested conditions, each checked for every parameter of $S$:

1. *Reducible (admissible).* Re-estimating $S \cup \Theta_C$ with the other parameters at $\theta_0$ reproduces the full model: the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ over the 15 scenarios is at most $\tau_e = \sqrt{1 - c^2} = 0.436$ (Theorems 1 and 2 of the main text and steps 1–22 of Supplementary Table S4).
2. *Identifiable by the profiles.* For every $\theta_j$, $j \in S$, the profile of the reduced problem exceeds $\Delta\chi^2 = 3.84$ on both sides within the bounds (the predicate `PracticallyIdentifiable`).
3. *Linear condition.* $\sqrt{c/I_j} < \min(d_-, d_+)$ for every $j \in S$ (Proposition 1 with $\gamma = \varepsilon = 0$): the Wald interval is inside the bounds.
4. *Hypotheses of the theorem.* $t_j^* < \min(d_-, d_+)$ for every $j \in S$, with $I_j$, $\gamma$ (Proposition 2) and $\|r_0\|$ computed at the optimum and $\varepsilon$ the largest nonlinear remainder at the computed profile points; by Corollary 1 every parameter of $S$ is then practically identifiable. Because $\varepsilon$ is evaluated at points rather than bounded over the whole admissible set, this is a numerical check of the hypotheses, not a proof for the particular model.

Of the 34 problems, 31 satisfy condition 1. Of these, 25 also satisfy condition 2 for all their selected parameters (23 with the robust threshold); the six exceptions are listed under *Profile likelihood* above. Condition 3 holds for all selected parameters in 27 problems: the 25 of condition 2 and Okuonghae and Oliveira, in which the profile of one parameter could not be simulated, so that the linear condition cannot be compared with it. Condition 4 holds for all selected parameters in seven problems, Armistead ($|S| = 2$), Blasi (2), Boehm (2), Bruno (5), Rahman (2), Sneyd (2) and Zheng (2), none of which has calibration parameters. The models of these seven problems are also among the 28 verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*), so for them the whole chain is covered: the hypotheses on the dynamics are proved in Lean, the subset is admissible, and the computed quantities satisfy the hypotheses of the identifiability theorem. In the other 24 admissible problems the subset is reducible and, in 18 of them, identifiable by the profiles, but condition 4 fails for at least one parameter: in Fujita, Giordano, Perelson and Smith because the information $I_j$ is already insufficient (condition 3 fails), and in the others because of the nonlinear remainder $\varepsilon$ (in Raimundez, for example, both parameters satisfy condition 3 but the remainder reaches 215 and 241 noise units, Supplementary Table S20).

## Scope

The result is practical identifiability of the reduced problem: local, within the bounds of the study, with the non-selected parameters at $\theta_0$ and with the noise model of the benchmark. It is not identifiability of the full model, in which all parameters are free: in the profile likelihood of the full model only 20 of the 52 selected parameters evaluated were identifiable (Supplementary Note *Profile likelihood*). That contrast is consistent with the purpose of the method. The data do not determine all the parameters of these models, but, with the other parameters at their published values, a few selected parameters are both sufficient to reproduce the outputs and, in most problems, determined by the data. Identifiability does not imply that the estimated values are the true biological values: they depend on the values at which the other parameters are fixed.

**Supplementary Table S19.** Identifiability of the selected parameters in the reduced problem ($S \cup \Theta_C$ free, other parameters at $\theta_0$, all measurements). $|S|$, $|\Theta_C|$: selected biological and calibration parameters; $\chi^2/n$: at the optimum of the reduced problem; VIF: largest variance inflation factor of a selected parameter among the columns of $J_{S\cup\Theta_C}$ (unit-norm, uncentred) at $\theta_0$. Profile: class of each selected parameter by profile likelihood with $\Delta\chi^2 = 3.84$ within $[|\theta_0|/10, 10|\theta_0|]$ (I, identifiable, the profile exceeds the threshold on both sides; N, practically non-identifiable, on one side; F, flat; –, the profile could not be simulated); robust: the same with the threshold scaled by $\max(1, \chi^2_{\min}/\text{d.f.})$. Wald: parameters whose linear (Wald) interval $\sqrt{3.84\,[(J^\top J)^{-1}]_{jj}}$ fits within the bounds on both sides; Lean: parameters for which the hypotheses of `practically_identifiable_grad` hold at the computed profile points up to the first crossing. Time: computing time needed to determine the identifiability of the selected parameters, that is, the fit of the reduced problem plus the re-estimations at all profile points, summed over the fits (CPU time; the points were computed in parallel, so the wall-clock time is shorter); $^{\text{S}}$, computed on a shared server (128 or 256 cores), otherwise on an 8-core workstation. For Isensee and Smith the profile was repeated after a better optimum was found, and only the last round is counted; for Chen, two profile points (one of them outside the bounds) did not finish and are not counted.

| Problem | $\lvert S\rvert$ | $\lvert\Theta_C\rvert$ | $\chi^2/n$ | VIF | Profile | Robust | Wald | Lean | Time |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 2 | 10 | 1.96 | 1.1 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 1/2 | 21.6 min |
| Armistead | 2 | 0 | 1.04 | 1.1 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 2/2 | <1 s |
| Bachmann | 2 | 74 | 1.16 | 6.1 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 35.2 min$^{\text{S}}$ |
| Bertozzi | 2 | 0 | 1.10 | 5.9 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 1 s |
| Blasi | 2 | 0 | 6.46 | 2.3 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 2/2 | 5 s |
| Boehm | 2 | 0 | 1.04 | 1.4 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 2/2 | 4 s |
| Borghans | 2 | 2 | 0.97 | 2.6 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 34 s |
| Brannmark | 2 | 3 | 1.13 | 127.2 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 58 s |
| Bruno | 5 | 0 | 0.90 | 1.3 | I I I I I | I I I I I | 5/5 | 5/5 | 19 s |
| Chen | 2 | 3 | 168 | 1.1 | I I | N I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 14.8 h$^{\text{S}}$ |
| Elowitz | 2 | 2 | 1.07 | 6.0 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 22 s |
| Fiedler | 2 | 8 | 1.04 | 47.2 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 35 s |
| Fujita | 2 | 3 | 5.48 | 2.5e+08 | F F | F F | 0/2 | 0/2 | 1.1 min |
| Giordano | 2 | 0 | 0.00 | 4.1 | N F | N F | 0/2 | 0/2 | 6 s |
| Isensee | 2 | 11 | 1.02 | 41.6 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 4.3 h$^{\text{S}}$ |
| Laske | 2 | 2 | 0.18 | 2.7 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 1/2 | 1.2 min |
| Liu | 2 | 0 | 1.02 | 1.3 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 7 s |
| Lucarelli | 10 | 0 | 1.22 | 9.9 | I I I I I I I I I I | I I I I I I I I I I | 10/10 | 4/10 | 54.9 min |
| Okuonghae | 2 | 0 | 1,413 | 1.3 | – I | – N | 2/2 | 0/2 | 4 s |
| Oliveira | 2 | 0 | 182 | 1.0 | – I | – I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 6 s |
| Perelson | 2 | 0 | 0.00 | 1.2 | F F | F F | 0/2 | 0/2 | <1 s |
| Rahman | 2 | 0 | 0.00 | 39.0 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 2/2 | 1 s |

| Problem | $\lvert S\rvert$ | $\lvert\Theta_C\rvert$ | $\chi^2/n$ | VIF | Profile | Robust | Wald | Lean | Time |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Raia | 2 | 5 | 1,791 | 2.3e+04 | I I | F F | 2/2 | 0/2 | 1.4 min |
| Raimundez | 2 | 79 | 4.85 | 75.5 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 4.0 h[S] |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 2 | 0 | 44.96 | 5.7 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 40 s |
| Schwen | 2 | 15 | 0.96 | 39.1 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 6.2 min |
| Smith | 2 | 9 | 1,894 | 29.3 | N I | N F | 1/2 | 0/2 | 48.1 min[S] |
| Sneyd | 2 | 0 | 1.01 | 1.0 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 2/2 | 20 s |
| Weber | 2 | 5 | 0.94 | 631.0 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 0/2 | 37 s |
| Zhao | 3 | 0 | 0.27 | 1.0 | I I I | I I I | 3/3 | 1/3 | 9 s |
| Zheng | 2 | 0 | 1.03 | 1.1 | I I | I I | 2/2 | 2/2 | 9 s |

**Supplementary Table S20.** Identifiability of every selected parameter in the reduced problem. Class: profile-likelihood class with the threshold 3.84 / with the robust threshold (I, identifiable; N, practically non-identifiable; F, flat; –, the profile could not be simulated). CI: 95% profile-likelihood interval of $\log_{10}\theta_j - \log_{10}\hat{\theta}_j$, interpolated between profile points ($\infty$, the profile does not cross the threshold on that side within the bounds). $I_j$: profiled information $1/[(A^\top A)^{-1}]_{jj}$ (computed by projection); Wald: half-width $\sqrt{3.84/I_j}$ in $\log_{10}$ units; $\gamma = \|Pr_0\|$; $\varepsilon$: largest nonlinear remainder at the profile points; $d_-$, $d_+$: distances from $\log_{10}\hat{\theta}_j$ to $\log_{10}(|\theta_0|/10)$ and $\log_{10}(10|\theta_0|)$; Lean: hypotheses of `practically_identifiable_grad` satisfied at the profile points up to the first crossing.

| Problem | Parameter | Class | CI ($\log_{10}$) | $I_j$ | Wald | $\gamma$ | $\varepsilon$ | $d_-$ | $d_+$ | Lean |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | kt | I/I | $[-2.8\times10^{-3}, 2.5\times10^{-3}]$ | $1.0\times10^{5}$ | $2.7\times10^{-3}$ | $4.7\times10^{-4}$ | 41.9 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | k_rep_nhej | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 903.6 | 0.03 | $4.7\times10^{-4}$ | 50.7 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Armistead | k_d | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 1870.3 | 0.02 | $3.3\times10^{-6}$ | 46.5 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | k00 | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 1031.7 | 0.03 | $3.3\times10^{-6}$ | 46.3 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| Bachmann | CISRNADelay | I/I | $[-0.04, 0.05]$ | 364.7 | 0.04 | 0.59 | 158.9 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | JAK2ActEpo | I/I | $[-0.06, 0.06]$ | 194.0 | 0.06 | 0.59 | 30.1 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Bertozzi | R0_NY | I/I | $[-0.04, 0.04]$ | 442.3 | 0.04 | $1.5\times10^{-4}$ | 82.5 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | I0_NY | I/I | $[-0.07, 0.06]$ | 150.8 | 0.07 | $1.5\times10^{-4}$ | 103.1 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Blasi | a_basal | I/I | $[-8.7\times10^{-3}, 8.6\times10^{-3}]$ | 9745.2 | $8.6\times10^{-3}$ | $3.3\times10^{-4}$ | 52.8 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | a_k16_k12k16 | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 1136.9 | 0.03 | $3.3\times10^{-4}$ | 41.3 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| Boehm | k_imp_hetero | I/I | $[-0.04, 0.04]$ | 489.3 | 0.04 | $1.1\times10^{-3}$ | 42.5 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | k_phos | I/I | $[-0.07, 0.08]$ | 121.0 | 0.08 | $1.1\times10^{-3}$ | 18.2 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| Borghans | Kz | I/I | $[-5.2\times10^{-3}, 5.0\times10^{-3}]$ | $1.3\times10^{5}$ | $2.4\times10^{-3}$ | 1.53 | 2393.2 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | K_par | I/I | $[-6.0\times10^{-3}, 4.7\times10^{-3}]$ | $1.1\times10^{5}$ | $2.5\times10^{-3}$ | 1.53 | 2417.3 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Brannmark | k1f | I/I | $[-0.20, 0.22]$ | 19.8 | 0.19 | 0.02 | 17.3 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | km2 | I/I | $[-0.11, 0.14]$ | 56.3 | 0.11 | 0.02 | 38.2 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Bruno | kb1 | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 2009.9 | 0.02 | $1.1\times10^{-5}$ | 104.7 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | init_bcar2 | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 2215.7 | 0.02 | $1.1\times10^{-5}$ | 68.0 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | init_zea_1 | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 1977.5 | 0.02 | $1.1\times10^{-5}$ | 62.3 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | init_bcar1 | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 1358.7 | 0.02 | $1.1\times10^{-5}$ | 54.7 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | init_bcry_1 | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.02]$ | 1144.5 | 0.03 | $1.1\times10^{-5}$ | 47.4 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| Chen | k106 | I/N | $[-0.04, 0.03]$ | 402.9 | 0.04 | 13.01 | 58.4 | 0.78 | 1.22 | |
| | k44 | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | $2.6\times10^{4}$ | $5.3\times10^{-3}$ | 13.01 | 418.4 | 1.05 | 0.95 | |
| Elowitz | n_Hill | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 1951.7 | 0.02 | 0.05 | 170.4 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | tau_mRNA | I/I | $[-0.01, 0.01]$ | 3646.0 | 0.01 | 0.05 | 242.0 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Fiedler | tau2 | I/I | $[-0.06, 0.06]$ | 186.8 | 0.06 | $9.6\times10^{-4}$ | 53.6 | 0.97 | 1.03 | |
| | k6 | I/I | $[-0.38, 0.36]$ | 5.6 | 0.36 | $9.6\times10^{-4}$ | 6.7 | 1.22 | 0.78 | |
| Fujita | init_AKT | F/F | $[-\infty, \infty]$ | $3.2\times10^{-4}$ | 47.81 | 0.34 | 0.1 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | reaction_6_k1 | F/F | $[-\infty, \infty]$ | 0.1 | 2.56 | 0.34 | 1.0 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Giordano | alpha_4 | N/N | $[-\infty, 0.29]$ | $7.3\times10^{-4}$ | 31.58 | $3.3\times10^{-8}$ | 6.7 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | alpha_28 | F/F | $[-\infty, \infty]$ | $1.2\times10^{-5}$ | 250.77 | $3.3\times10^{-8}$ | 0.6 | 1.02 | 0.98 | |

| Problem | Parameter | Class | CI ($\log_{10}$) | $I_j$ | Wald | $\gamma$ | $\varepsilon$ | $d_-$ | $d_+$ | Lean |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Isensee | kf_RIIp_C_2__RII_C_2 | I/I | $[-0.04, 0.03]$ | 271.7 | 0.05 | $3.0 \times 10^{-3}$ | 110.0 | 1.01 | 0.99 | |
| | xi_kf_RII_C_2__RII_2 | I/I | $[-0.05, 0.02]$ | 36.2 | 0.14 | $3.0 \times 10^{-3}$ | 21.3 | 0.97 | 1.03 | |
| Laske | k_imp | I/I | $[-0.13, 0.11]$ | 48.8 | 0.12 | $5.0 \times 10^{-4}$ | 65.6 | 0.99 | 1.01 | |
| | k_syn_R_M | I/I | $[-0.11, 0.11]$ | 57.3 | 0.11 | $5.0 \times 10^{-4}$ | 8.5 | 1.04 | 0.96 | ✓ |
| Liu | kappa | I/I | $[-0.05, 0.05]$ | 307.1 | 0.05 | $3.3 \times 10^{-4}$ | 34.6 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | phi | I/I | $[-0.07, 0.08]$ | 132.7 | 0.07 | $3.3 \times 10^{-4}$ | 23.4 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Lucarelli | init_Rec | I/I | $[-0.01, 0.01]$ | 4870.0 | 0.01 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 158.7 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | S2tot | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 1654.9 | 0.02 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 56.8 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | S3tot | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 951.5 | 0.03 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 42.1 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | S_dephosphos | I/I | $[-0.06, 0.06]$ | 230.7 | 0.06 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 39.3 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | S_phos | I/I | $[-0.06, 0.06]$ | 229.8 | 0.06 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 31.0 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | geneF_turn | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 1510.9 | 0.02 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 47.4 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | k_234 | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 628.1 | 0.03 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 26.3 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | geneK_turn | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 720.8 | 0.03 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 49.2 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | S4tot | I/I | $[-0.04, 0.04]$ | 453.3 | 0.04 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 44.7 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | geneH_turn | I/I | $[-0.04, 0.04]$ | 390.9 | 0.04 | $1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ | 3.7 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| Okuonghae | transmission_rate_effective | –/– | – | $1.1 \times 10^{8}$ | $8.1 \times 10^{-5}$ | 0.04 | 0 | 1.01 | 0.99 | |
| | gamma_i | I/N | $[-4.4 \times 10^{-3}, 4.2 \times 10^{-3}]$ | $3.9 \times 10^{4}$ | $4.3 \times 10^{-3}$ | 0.04 | 18.3 | 0.28 | 1.72 | |
| Oliveira | beta_0 | –/– | – | $4.9 \times 10^{8}$ | $3.9 \times 10^{-5}$ | 1.17 | 0 | 0.94 | 1.06 | |
| | h_hosp_rate | I/I | $[-5.3 \times 10^{-3}, 6.5 \times 10^{-3}]$ | $2.2 \times 10^{4}$ | $5.8 \times 10^{-3}$ | 1.17 | 64.3 | 1.22 | 0.78 | |
| Perelson | c | F/F | $[-\infty, \infty]$ | $3.7 \times 10^{-10}$ | $4.4 \times 10^{4}$ | $2.0 \times 10^{-6}$ | $1.6 \times 10^{-5}$ | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | delta | F/F | $[-\infty, \infty]$ | $1.9 \times 10^{-10}$ | $6.1 \times 10^{4}$ | $2.0 \times 10^{-6}$ | $3.2 \times 10^{-5}$ | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Rahman | infected_moderate_transmission_rate | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.04]$ | 671.3 | 0.03 | $6.0 \times 10^{-5}$ | 104.5 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | infected_normal_worsen_rate | I/I | $[-0.05, 0.06]$ | 235.8 | 0.06 | $6.0 \times 10^{-5}$ | 97.2 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| Raia | SOCS3mRNA_production | I/F | $[-0.04, 0.03]$ | 340.4 | 0.05 | 0.42 | 124.5 | 0.23 | 1.77 | |
| | init_Rec_i | I/F | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 227.7 | 0.06 | 0.42 | 161.8 | 0.34 | 1.66 | |
| Raimundez | kdeg_membran__MKN1 | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 1813.6 | 0.02 | $5.6 \times 10^{-3}$ | 241.0 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | ka_MAPK__MKN1 | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 749.7 | 0.03 | $5.6 \times 10^{-3}$ | 215.2 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Salazar-Cavazos | ratio_kpkd_Y1068__FREE | I/I | $[-0.02, 0.02]$ | 2936.9 | 0.02 | $1.5 \times 10^{-4}$ | 181.1 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 1070.4 | 0.03 | $1.5 \times 10^{-4}$ | 133.4 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Schwen | ini_R1 | I/I | $[-0.23, 0.16]$ | 21.8 | 0.18 | 11.07 | 14.8 | 0.95 | 1.05 | |
| | ini_R2fold | I/I | $[-0.06, 0.06]$ | 225.1 | 0.06 | 11.07 | 22.7 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Smith | k8 | N/N | $[-\infty, 1.3 \times 10^{-3}]$ | $1.8 \times 10^{4}$ | $6.4 \times 10^{-3}$ | 82.20 | 12.8 | $1.4 \times 10^{-5}$ | 2.00 | |
| | kminus7b | I/F | $[-1.9 \times 10^{-3}, 1.5 \times 10^{-3}]$ | $3.5 \times 10^{5}$ | $1.4 \times 10^{-3}$ | 82.20 | 336.7 | 0.43 | 1.57 | |
| Sneyd | l4 | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 841.9 | 0.03 | $4.6 \times 10^{-3}$ | 57.5 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | l2 | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.03]$ | 762.7 | 0.03 | $4.6 \times 10^{-3}$ | 99.5 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| Weber | s12 | I/I | $[-0.11, 0.11]$ | 54.4 | 0.12 | $8.9 \times 10^{-4}$ | 185.0 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| | a21 | I/I | $[-0.05, 0.07]$ | 195.1 | 0.06 | $8.9 \times 10^{-4}$ | 137.1 | 1.00 | 1.00 | |
| Zhao | R_Stage_I_China | I/I | $[-0.15, 0.05]$ | 152.1 | 0.07 | $6.2 \times 10^{-4}$ | 19.7 | 0.85 | 1.15 | |
| | R_Stage_II_Wuhan | I/I | $[-0.03, 0.02]$ | 1257.7 | 0.02 | $6.2 \times 10^{-4}$ | 40.0 | 0.99 | 1.01 | ✓ |

| Problem | Parameter | Class | CI ($\log_{10}$) | $I_j$ | Wald | $\gamma$ | $\varepsilon$ | $d_-$ | $d_+$ | Lean |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | gamma_1_ Stage_I_ Hubei | I/I | $[-0.13, 0.05]$ | 171.5 | 0.06 | $6.2 \times 10^{-4}$ | 17.9 | 0.95 | 1.05 | |
| Zheng | k01_02 | I/I | $[-7.4 \times 10^{-3}, 7.1 \times 10^{-3}]$ | $1.4 \times 10^4$ | $7.2 \times 10^{-3}$ | $2.8 \times 10^{-5}$ | 50.1 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |
| | k13_12 | I/I | $[-6.9 \times 10^{-3}, 7.1 \times 10^{-3}]$ | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $7.0 \times 10^{-3}$ | $2.8 \times 10^{-5}$ | 42.2 | 1.00 | 1.00 | ✓ |

# Supplementary Note: Leakage-free nested validation

## Motivation

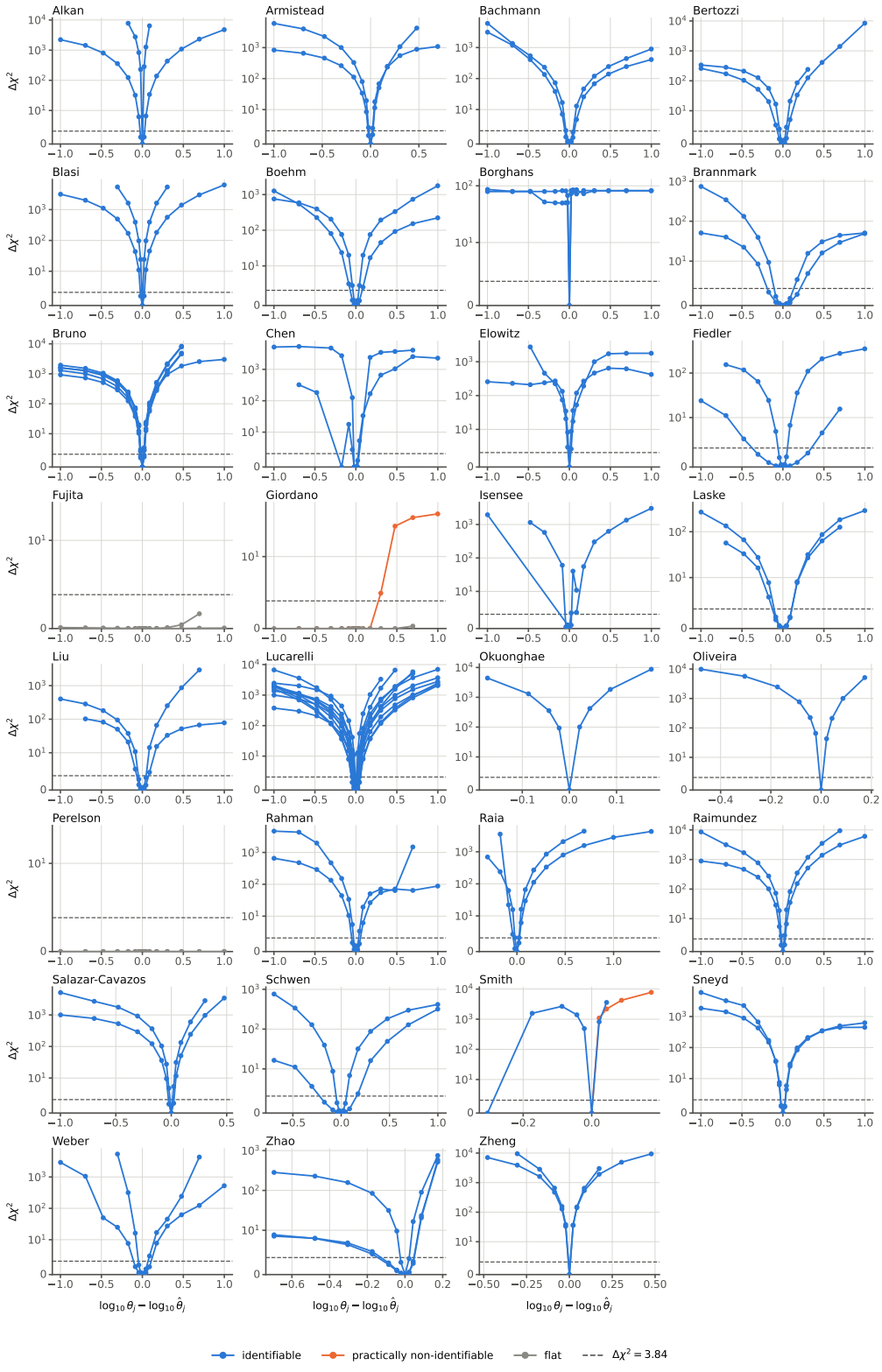
In the external validation the reduced model keeps the non-selected parameters at $\theta_0$, the published estimate, which was obtained from *all* experimental data, including the test experiments. The reduced model may therefore inherit information about the test data through the parameters it keeps fixed. This note quantifies that effect.

## Design

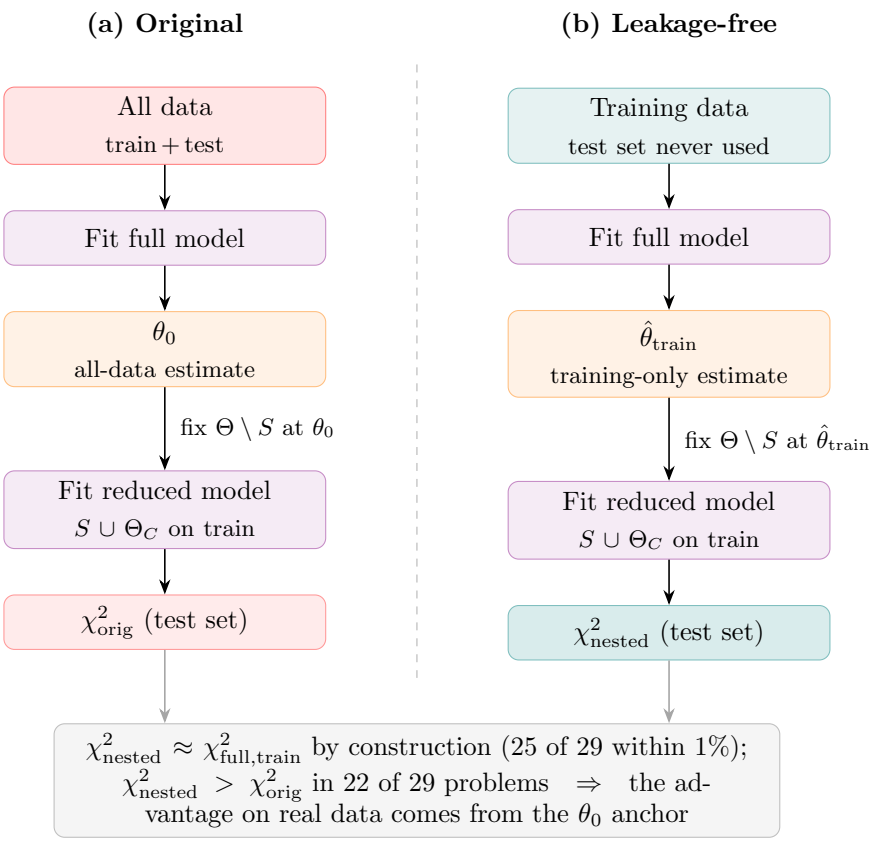
For each problem we ran a *nested* validation in which no value used by the reduced model has seen the test data:

1. the full model was re-estimated on the training data only, giving $\hat{\theta}_{\text{train}}$ (the full-model baseline of the external validation);
2. the reduced model was then re-estimated on the training data with the non-selected parameters fixed at $\hat{\theta}_{\text{train}}$ instead of $\theta_0$, and with search bounds derived from $\hat{\theta}_{\text{train}}$;
3. the test $\chi^2/n$ of this nested reduced model was compared with that of the full training fit and with that of the original, $\theta_0$-anchored reduced model.

Supplementary Figure S8 illustrates both protocols. The protocol removes the leakage through the values of the fixed parameters; it does not repeat the whole procedure on the training data: the subset $S$ and the sensitivity matrix were not recomputed on the training data, and the full training fit starts from $\theta_0$. It is therefore an analysis of the effect of the $\theta_0$ anchor, not a fully leakage-free validation of the selection.




**Supplementary Figure S7. Profile likelihood of the selected parameters in the reduced problem, for the 31 problems with an admissible subset.** Each line is one selected parameter: $\Delta\chi^2$ (symmetric logarithmic scale) against the displacement of $\log_{10}\theta_j$ from the optimum of the reduced problem, with $S \cup \Theta_C$ re-estimated at each point and the other parameters at $\theta_0$. Only points within the bounds $[|\theta_0|/10, 10|\theta_0|]$ and whose simulation succeeded are drawn. Blue, identifiable (the profile exceeds the threshold on both sides); orange, practically non-identifiable (one side); grey, flat. Dashed line, $\Delta\chi^2 = 3.84$. In Okuonghae and Oliveira the profile of one parameter could not be simulated and is not shown.




**Supplementary Figure S8. The two external-validation protocols. (a)** In the original protocol the non-selected parameters of the reduced model are fixed at $\theta_0$, the published estimate obtained from *all* data including the test set. **(b)** In the leakage-free protocol the full model is first re-estimated on the training data only, giving $\hat{\theta}_{\text{train}}$, which then serves both as the value of the fixed parameters and as the reference for the optimisation bounds; the test set is never used to construct the reduced model. The box states the outcome: the nested reduced model reproduces the full training fit, as it must because its re-estimation starts at the training optimum, and it predicts worse than the original reduced model in 22 of 29 problems.

Twenty-nine problems were evaluated. Bertozzi (selected parameters active only in the test conditions) and Blasi (single time point, no split) were excluded. For Chen, whose full re-estimation with 155 free parameters did not finish in serial form, the columns of the finite-difference Jacobian were evaluated in parallel and the integrator tolerances were $10^{-6}/10^{-8}$; its $\theta_0$ and original values agree with those of the main analysis.

## Results

Supplementary Table S21 gives the results and Supplementary Figure S9 compares them graphically.

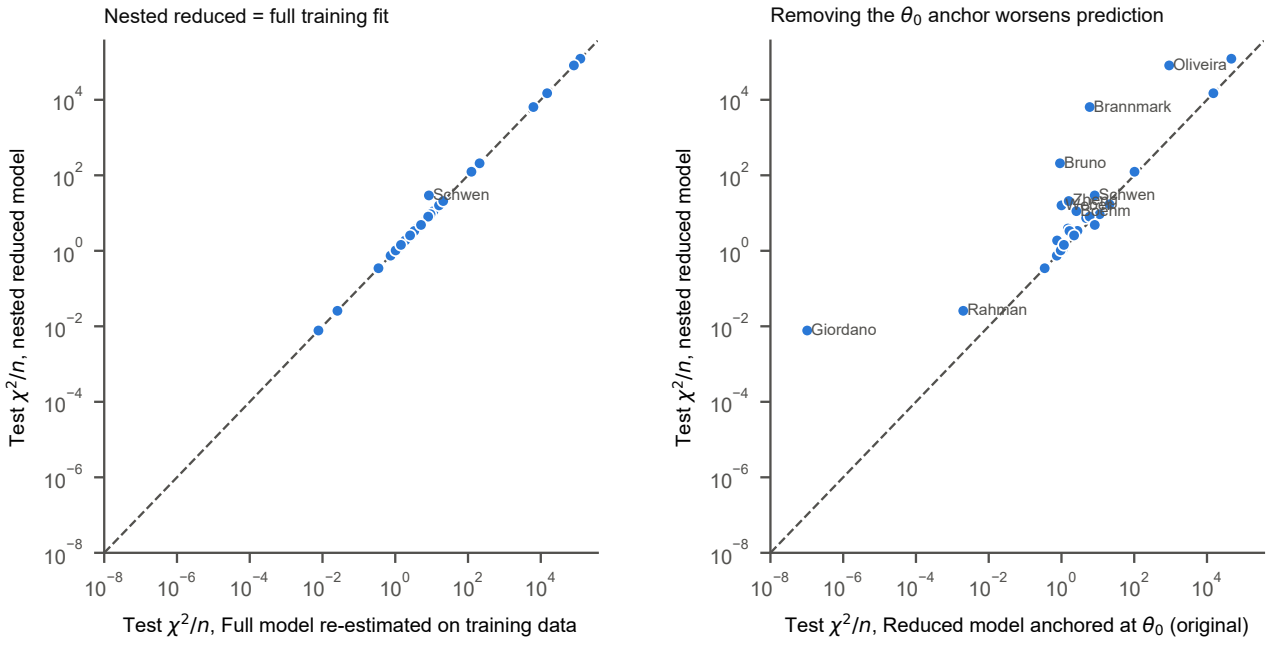
*The nested reduced model coincides with the full training fit.* In 19 of the 29 problems the two test values agree to better than 0.1% and in 25 to better than 1%. This agreement is expected by construction and is not evidence about leakage: the re-estimation of the reduced model starts at $\hat{\theta}_{\text{train}}$, which already minimises the training error, so the optimiser has nothing to improve and returns essentially the full training fit. The exceptions are Schwen (+248%, a worse local minimum of the two re-estimated parameters), Raia (−5.1%), Chen (−3.7%) and Brannmark (+2.4%).

*Removing the $\theta_0$ anchor removes the advantage of the reduced model.* Compared with the original reduced model, the nested reduced model predicted worse in 22 of the 29 problems (21 by more than 5%, the criterion of the main text) and more than four times worse in eight (for example Brannmark 5.96 versus $6.4 \times 10^3$, Bruno 0.91 versus 208, Weber 1.00 versus 16.0, Zheng 1.58 versus 20.8). The better prediction of the reduced model on real data (main text, *Prediction of held-out experiments*) therefore reflects the information in the published values at which the other parameters are fixed. This does not affect the admissibility of the subsets, which is a property of the model, not of the data, and it is why the comparison of prediction without leakage is made on synthetic data, where $\theta_0$ carries no information about the truth (Supplementary Note *Synthetic prediction experiment*).

**Supplementary Table S21.** Leakage-free nested validation (29 problems). $\chi^2_{\text{orig}}$: reduced model with the non-selected parameters at $\theta_0$; $\chi^2_{\text{full,train}}$: full model re-estimated on the training data; $\chi^2_{\text{nested}}$: reduced model with the non-selected parameters at $\hat{\theta}_{\text{train}}$; $\theta_0$: published estimate. $\Delta$%: nested relative to full; last column: nested over original (above 1, the nested reduced model predicts worse).

| Problem | $\chi^2_{\text{orig}}$ | $\chi^2_{\text{full,train}}$ | $\chi^2_{\text{nested}}$ | $\theta_0$ | $\Delta$% | nested/orig |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 2.75 | 3.37 | 3.37 | 2.47 | +0.0 | 1.23 |
| Armistead | 1.22 | 1.37 | 1.37 | 1.16 | -0.0 | 1.13 |
| Bachmann | 4.77 | 7.35 | 7.36 | 1.05 | +0.1 | 1.54 |
| Boehm | 2.57 | 11.2 | 11.2 | 0.341 | +0.0 | 4.37 |
| Borghans | 0.743 | 0.744 | 0.744 | 0.74 | +0.0 | 1.00 |
| Brannmark | 5.96 | 6,277 | 6,431 | 0.938 | +2.4 | 1079.76 |
| Bruno | 0.909 | 208 | 208 | 0.909 | +0.0 | 228.69 |
| Chen† | 20.9 | 17.7 | 17.1 | 15.2 | -3.7 | 0.82 |
| Elowitz | 1.5 | 3.89 | 3.89 | 1.38 | -0.0 | 2.59 |
| Fiedler | 11.2 | 9.32 | 9.3 | 1.22 | -0.2 | 0.83 |
| Fujita | 5.94 | 8.03 | 8.03 | 5.63 | +0.0 | 1.35 |
| Giordano | $1.0 \times 10^{-7}$ | 0.00773 | 0.00773 | $7.4 \times 10^{-9}$ | +0.0 | 75542.33 |
| Isensee | 1.08 | 1.08 | 1.08 | 1.04 | -0.0 | 0.99 |
| Laske | 0.758 | 1.87 | 1.87 | 0.445 | +0.0 | 2.47 |
| Liu | 0.954 | 1.02 | 1.02 | 0.942 | -0.0 | 1.07 |
| Lucarelli | 1.66 | 3.34 | 3.35 | 1.02 | +0.1 | 2.02 |
| Okuonghae | $4.7 \times 10^4$ | $1.2 \times 10^5$ | $1.2 \times 10^5$ | $2.9 \times 10^4$ | -0.0 | 2.62 |
| Oliveira | 912 | $8.1 \times 10^4$ | $8.1 \times 10^4$ | $4.6 \times 10^5$ | +0.0 | 89.16 |
| Perelson | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | +0.0 | 1.00 |
| Rahman | 0.00199 | 0.0257 | 0.0257 | 0.00148 | +0.0 | 12.90 |
| Raia | 8.22 | 5.1 | 4.84 | 0.417 | -5.1 | 0.59 |
| Raimundez | 1.17 | 1.43 | 1.43 | 0.98 | +0.1 | 1.23 |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 102 | 124 | 124 | 96.9 | +0.0 | 1.22 |
| Schwen | 8.2 | 8.4 | 29.3 | 0.768 | +248.4 | 3.57 |
| Smith | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $8.3 \times 10^4$ | -0.3 | 1.00 |
| Sneyd | 2.22 | 2.56 | 2.56 | 1.37 | -0.0 | 1.15 |
| Weber | 1 | 16 | 16 | 0.993 | +0.1 | 15.96 |
| Zhao | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 | +0.0 | 1.00 |
| Zheng | 1.58 | 20.8 | 20.8 | 1.51 | +0.0 | 13.16 |

†Chen: full-model re-estimation with the finite-difference Jacobian evaluated in parallel and integrator tolerances $10^{-6}/10^{-8}$.




**Supplementary Figure S9. Leakage-free nested validation.** Test $\chi^2/n$ of the nested reduced model (non-selected parameters at $\hat{\theta}_{\text{train}}$) against **a**, the full model re-estimated on the training data, with which it coincides by construction, and **b**, the original reduced model anchored at $\theta_0$; points above the diagonal predict worse without the anchor. Dashed line, $y = x$; problems that differ by more than a factor of 3 are labelled; Perelson ($\chi^2/n < 10^{-12}$) lies outside the axes.

# Supplementary Note: Pivoted QR selection

## Motivation

This note examines whether a simpler, purely sensitivity-based selection criterion achieves an external validation accuracy comparable to that of our method, which additionally tests admissibility and applies backward elimination. We compared against column-pivoted QR selection (Vélez-Reyes and Verghese, 1995), a well-established subset-selection method that selects parameters by their linear independence in the sensitivity matrix, without re-estimation or test-set evaluation. The collinearity index of Brun *et al.* (Brun et al., 2001) is a different criterion and is compared separately in Supplementary Note *Brun and Morris selections*.

## Method: QR-pivoted selection

**Sensitivity matrix.** For each problem the normalised sensitivity matrix $\widetilde{J} \in \mathbb{R}^{n_{\text{obs}} \times n_{\text{bio}}}$ is computed at $\theta_0$ on the training data using forward finite differences. Column $j$ is

$$\widetilde{J}_{\cdot j} = \frac{\partial z/\partial \theta_j}{\|\partial z/\partial \theta_j\|_2}, \qquad \frac{\partial z_i}{\partial \theta_j} \approx \frac{z_i(\theta_0 + \varepsilon_j e_j) - z_i(\theta_0)}{\varepsilon_j},$$

where $\varepsilon_j = \max(10^{-4}|\theta_{0,j}|, 10^{-8})$ and $n_{\text{obs}}$ counts training-data points with finite measurements. Columns with $\|\partial z/\partial \theta_j\|_2 \leq 10^{-10}$ (zero sensitivity) are discarded before pivoting.

**Column-pivoted QR.** Pivoted QR decomposition of $\widetilde{J}$ is

$$\widetilde{J}\,P = Q\,R, \qquad |R_{11}| \geq |R_{22}| \geq \cdots ,$$

where $P$ is a column-permutation matrix. The leading pivot columns of $\widetilde{J}\,P$—equivalently, the first entries of $P$—correspond to the parameters that contribute most independently to the measured outputs.

**Subset selection.** For each problem we select the top $k = |S|$ biological parameters from the QR ranking and append the same calibration parameters $\Theta_C$ used in the original analysis.

**Validation.** The QR-selected subset is fitted on the training data using the same optimiser (trust-region reflective least squares) and the same number of function evaluations as the original reduced model. Test-set $\chi^2/n$ is then computed identically to the main experiment. The test set is never consulted at any stage of the QR selection or fitting.

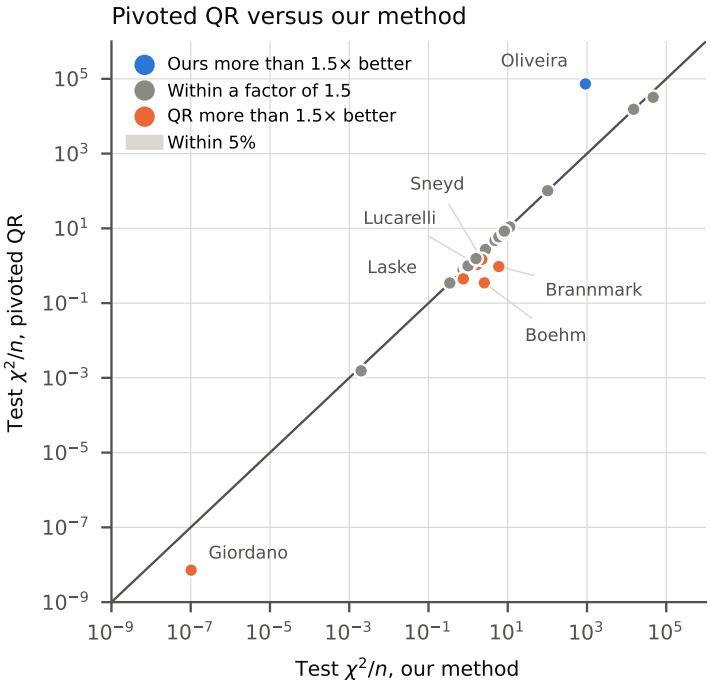
## Results

Figure S10 compares $\chi^2_{\text{ours}}$ and $\chi^2_{\text{QR}}$ for all 28 evaluated problems. The grey band marks ±5% equivalence. Points on or near the diagonal correspond to problems where both methods achieve essentially the same predictive accuracy despite—in most cases—choosing entirely different parameters.

Among 26 non-trivial comparisons (both $\chi^2 > 10^{-3}$) the median ratio $\chi^2_{\text{QR}}/\chi^2_{\text{ours}} = 0.99$ and 15 problems fall within the ±5% band. QR predicted better by more than 5% in 9 problems (most notably Boehm and Brannmark) and our method predicted better in 2 (most notably Oliveira, where $\chi^2_{\text{QR}} = 80 \times \chi^2_{\text{ours}}$; the QR-selected parameters failed to capture the epidemic dynamics on the test partition). In two additional problems (Giordano, Perelson) both methods fit the test data to within machine precision, making the ratio uninformative.

The most striking result is that the two methods selected *completely different* biological parameters in 19 of 28 problems (Table S22); the median overlap was 0 shared parameters. In 7 problems they shared exactly one parameter, in Lucarelli three of its ten, and only in Perelson ($k = 2$) did they agree completely. Despite this divergence, 23 of 26 comparisons produced ratios between 0.5 and 2.0. This is consistent with the sloppy-model picture (Gutenkunst et al., 2007): many distinct parameter combinations describe the training data approximately equally well, so the test-set $\chi^2/n$ is relatively insensitive to which specific $k$-parameter subset is selected.

The comparable performance of the two methods shows that the additional computational cost of the admissibility test and backward elimination does not translate into a systematic improvement in external validation accuracy on this benchmark. Conversely, it also does not lead to a systematic loss of accuracy: the two dramatic failures of QR on Oliveira and the large improvements of QR on Boehm and Brannmark are problem-specific and cancel on aggregate. Our method's value relative to pivoted-QR selection lies in the admissibility test (the reduced model is verified numerically to reproduce the full model's outputs under parameter perturbations; Supplementary Note *Admissibility of the subsets of other criteria* shows that pivoted-QR subsets pass this test in only 13 of 28 problems) and in the systematic backward elimination that delivers a minimal subset, not in a predictive accuracy advantage.




**Supplementary Figure S10.** Scatter plot of test-set $\chi^2/n$ for our method ($x$-axis) versus pivoted-QR selection ($y$-axis), on a log-log scale. Each point is one of the 28 evaluated problems except Perelson, whose values ($\chi^2/n < 10^{-12}$) lie below the plot range. The solid diagonal is the 1:1 line; the grey band marks ±5%. Blue: ours more than 1.5× better; orange: QR more than 1.5× better; grey: within a factor of 1.5. Problems outside that factor are labelled.

## Selected parameters

Supplementary Table S22 lists the biological parameters selected by each method for every problem. Parameter names follow the model's own PEtab identifiers. The overlap column gives the number of shared selections.

**Supplementary Table S22.** Biological parameters selected by our method ($S_{\text{ours}}$) and by column-pivoted QR ($S_{\text{QR}}$) for each evaluated problem. *Overlap*: number of parameters shared by both subsets. Parameter names are PEtab identifiers; long names are line-broken.

| Problem | $k$ | $S_{\text{ours}}$ | $S_{\text{QR}}$ | Ovlp |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 2 | kt, k_rep_nhej | p_chk1_dea_wip1, k_death_reox | 0 |
| Armistead | 2 | k_d, k00 | k00, k2 | 1 |
| Bachmann | 2 | CISRNADelay, JAK2ActEpo | SOCS3Inh, CISEqcOE | 0 |
| Boehm | 2 | k_imp_hetero, k_phos | k_phos, k_imp_homo | 1 |
| Borghans | 2 | Kz, K_par | Kd, init_A_state | 0 |
| Brannmark | 2 | k1f, km2 | k1a, k_IRSiP_DosR | 0 |
| Bruno | 5 | kb1, init_bcar2, init_zea_1, init_bcar1, init_bcry_1 | init_b10_1, init_bcar1, kc4, kc1, kc2 | 1 |
| Elowitz | 2 | n_Hill, tau_mRNA | eff_GFP, tau_prot_GFP | 0 |
| Fiedler | 2 | tau2, k6 | k11, k5 | 0 |
| Fujita | 2 | init_AKT, reaction_6_k1 | reaction_1_k1, reaction_6_k1 | 1 |
| Giordano | 2 | alpha_4, alpha_28 | delta_0, eta_0 | 0 |
| Isensee | 2 | kf_RIIp_C_2__RII_C_2, xi_kf_RII_C_2__RII_2 | kf_Fsk, KD_H89 | 0 |
| Laske | 2 | k_imp, k_syn_R_M | k_imp, k_rel | 1 |
| Liu | 2 | kappa, phi | kappa, rho | 1 |

| Problem | $k$ | $S_{\text{ours}}$ | $S_{\text{QR}}$ | Ovlp |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lucarelli | 10 | init_Rec, S2tot, S3tot, S_dephosphos, S_phos, geneF_turn, k_234, geneK_turn, S4tot, geneH_turn | S4tot, geneK_turn, geneJ_turn, geneB_act2, geneG_act1, geneH_turn, geneL_turn, geneE_act2, geneI_act1, geneC_act1 | 3 |
| Okuonghae | 2 | transmission_rate_effective, gamma_i | asymptomatic_start, d_D | 0 |
| Oliveira | 2 | beta_0, h_hosp_rate | beta_1, symptomatic_init_concentration | 0 |
| Perelson | 2 | c, delta | c, delta | 2 |
| Rahman | 2 | infected_moderate_transmission_rate, infected_normal_worsen_rate | infected_moderate_transmission_rate, treated_moderate_improve_rate | 1 |
| Raia | 2 | SOCS3mRNA_production, init_Rec_i | Rec_recycle, DecoyR_binding | 0 |
| Raimundez | 2 | kdeg_membran__MKN1, ka_MAPK__MKN1 | d_MAPKtotal__MKN1_2_HS746T, d_MPI3Ktotal__fm_2_hm | 0 |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 2 | ratio_kpkd_Y1068__FREE, ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE | GRB2_total__FREE, kdephosYN__FREE | 0 |
| Schwen | 2 | ini_R1, ini_R2fold | kd2fold, kout | 0 |
| Smith | 2 | k8, kminus7b | kminus7a, k43r | 0 |
| Sneyd | 2 | l4, l2 | k_2, k_3 | 0 |
| Weber | 2 | s12, a21 | a22, pu5 | 0 |
| Zhao | 3 | R_Stage_I_China, R_Stage_II_Wuhan, gamma_1_Stage_I_Hubei | R_Stage_I_Wuhan, R_Stage_III_Wuhan, R_Stage_II_Hubei | 0 |
| Zheng | 2 | k01_02, k13_12 | k01_11, k10_00 | 0 |

# Supplementary Note: Profile likelihood

## Purpose

Profile likelihood (Raue et al., 2009) is the standard method to assess which parameters the data determine, and profile-likelihood-based reduction (Maiwald et al., 2016) uses it to decide which parameters to fix. We computed the profile of every biological parameter of every problem in which it was run, for two purposes: as an independent estimate of how many parameters the data determine, and as one of the four criteria with which our selection is compared (main text, *Comparison with existing selection criteria*).

## Design

1. The full model (all free parameters) was re-estimated on the training data of the external validation, from $\theta_0$, giving $\hat{\theta}_{\text{train}}$ and the minimum $\chi^2_{\text{min}}$. The finite-difference Jacobian of this fit was evaluated in parallel.
2. For each biological parameter $j$, $\log|\theta_j|$ was fixed at $\log|\hat{\theta}_{\text{train},j}| \pm \{0.1, 0.3, 0.6, 1.2, 2.3\}$ (up to a factor of 10), within the same bounds $[|\theta_0|/10, 10|\theta_0|]$ as all other fits, and all other free parameters were re-estimated from $\hat{\theta}_{\text{train}}$; $\Delta\chi^2 = \chi^2 - \chi^2_{\text{min}}$. All points of a problem were computed in parallel. Points whose fit failed (simulation failure, $\Delta\chi^2 > 10^4$) were excluded.
3. If a profile point improved the minimum by more than one unit of $\chi^2$, the full model had not converged: it was re-estimated from that point and all profiles were recomputed (at most three times; ten for Raia, which converged after four).
4. A parameter is *identifiable* if its profile exceeds $\Delta\chi^2 = 3.84$ (95%, one degree of freedom) on both sides, *bounded on one side* if only on one side, and *flat* otherwise. For the comparison, the $k = |S|$ parameters with the narrowest profile confidence interval were selected.

The computation requires repeated re-estimation of the full model. It was run for the 26 problems with at most 60 free parameters and, in a separate run with the profile points distributed over 60 cores, for Bachmann (90 free parameters; 70 min, 40 h of computing time) and Lucarelli (72; 11 min, 9 h). It was not run for Raimundez (126) and Chen (155), whose simulations are the most expensive, nor for Blasi, which has no training/test split.

## Results

Supplementary Table S23 gives the classification of every problem. The median number of identifiable biological parameters was 2.5 (17% of the biological parameters); six problems had none and 14 of the 28 had two or fewer. This agrees with the size of the subsets selected by our method, obtained by a different principle. The selected parameters, however, rarely coincide (Supplementary Table S24): a flat profile means that other free parameters can compensate for changes in the profiled parameter, whereas our method asks which parameters suffice when all others are fixed at $\theta_0$. Supplementary Figure S11 shows the profiles of three problems. Three problems needed re-estimations of the optimum (Borghans, Okuonghae, Raia), which shows that the full-model fit from $\theta_0$ on the training data had not converged; Isensee kept a residual improvement of 1.16 after its three re-estimations, slightly above the criterion of one unit.

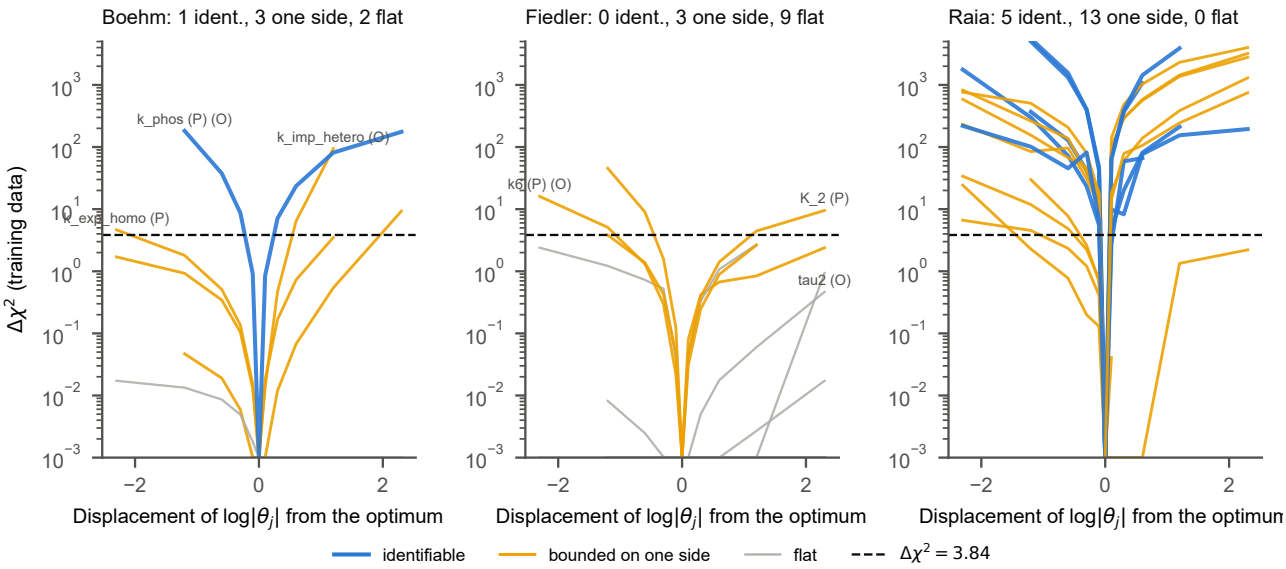
*The two large problems.* Bachmann and Lucarelli were profiled in a separate run, with the same protocol and the profile points distributed over 60 cores. In Bachmann (90 free parameters, of which 27 biological and the rest calibration parameters), the 221 profile points took 70 min of wall-clock time and 40 h of computing time (median 5.4 min per point, at most 54 min), against 10 s for our complete method; 7 of the 27 biological parameters were identifiable, 5 bounded on one side and 15 flat. Profile likelihood selected `STAT5Imp` and `CISRNADelay`, which shares `CISRNADelay` with our subset (`CISRNADelay`, `JAK2ActEpo`); both subsets are admissible (median $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ 0.30 against 0.34 for ours at $\pm 5\%$, 0.30 at $\pm 20\%$) and predict the real test data equally well (test $\chi^2/n$ 4.77 for both). In Lucarelli (72 free parameters, all biological), the 592 points took 11 min and 9 h of computing time (median 46 s per point), against 35 s for our method; 14 parameters were identifiable, 15 bounded on one side and 43 flat. The ten parameters selected by profile likelihood share four with our subset (`init_Rec`, `S4tot`, `S_phos`, `geneK_turn`); they predict the real test data better (test $\chi^2/n$ 1.08 against 1.66) but do not reproduce the full model (median $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ 0.74 at $\pm 5\%$ and 0.75 at $\pm 20\%$, against 0.435 for our subset). Neither problem needed a re-estimation of the optimum. Profile likelihood was not run for Chen and Raimundez, whose simulations are the most expensive (35 s per simulation in Chen; 79 calibration parameters in Raimundez).

**Supplementary Table S23.** Profile likelihood of the biological parameters (training data). Ident.: profile above $\Delta\chi^2 = 3.84$ on both sides; one side: only on one side; flat: on neither side. Selected: the $k$ parameters with the narrowest profile confidence interval. Common: parameters shared with the subset of our method. Re-fits: times the full model was re-estimated because a profile point improved the optimum; residual: remaining improvement (in units of $\chi^2$) after the last re-fit; a residual above one unit means that the optimum of the full model did not converge, so the classification of that problem is provisional. Failed pts: profile points excluded because the fit failed (simulation failure or $\Delta\chi^2 > 10^4$). A side is classified from its remaining points, so a failure can make a parameter look less identifiable than it is; this affects three parameters not classified as identifiable (Okuonghae gamma_i and Weber m31, one side; Weber p31, flat), whose class is therefore an upper bound on non-identifiability.

| Problem | $k$ | Bio | Ident. | One side | Flat | Selected by profile likelihood | Common | Note |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 2 | 34 | 14 | 9 | 11 | kt, k_death_reox | 1 | 6 failed pts |
| Armistead | 2 | 10 | 1 | 0 | 9 | k_d, k2 | 1 | – |
| Bachmann | 2 | 27 | 7 | 5 | 15 | STAT5Imp, CISRNADelay | 1 | – |
| Bertozzi | 2 | 3 | 1 | 1 | 1 | I0_CA, R0_CA | 0 | – |
| Blasi | *not evaluated: no training/test split* | | | | | | | |
| Boehm | 2 | 6 | 1 | 3 | 2 | k_phos, k_exp_homo | 1 | – |
| Borghans | 2 | 20 | 17 | 2 | 1 | Kz, v0 | 1 | 3 re-fits; res. 1.56, **not converged** |
| Brannmark | 2 | 15 | 0 | 2 | 13 | k_IRSiP_DosR, km2 | 1 | – |
| Bruno | 5 | 10 | 9 | 0 | 1 | init_bcar1, kb1, init_bcry_1, init_b10_1, kc2 | 3 | 2 failed pts |
| Chen | *not evaluated: 155 free parameters > PL_PMAX=60* | | | | | | | |
| Elowitz | 2 | 18 | 3 | 1 | 14 | n_Hill, tau_prot_GFP | 1 | – |
| Fiedler | 2 | 12 | 0 | 3 | 9 | K_2, k6 | 1 | – |
| Fujita | 2 | 16 | 7 | 2 | 7 | reaction_8_k1, EGFR_turnover | 0 | – |
| Giordano | 2 | 43 | 0 | 0 | 43 | nu_0, rho_22 | 0 | – |
| Isensee | 2 | 32 | 23 | 3 | 6 | kf_RIIp_2__RII_2, kf_RII_C_2__RIIp_C_2 | 0 | 3 re-fits; res. 1.16, **not converged**; 6 failed pts |
| Laske | 2 | 6 | 0 | 2 | 4 | k_bind_M1, k_syn_R_M | 1 | – |
| Liu | 2 | 7 | 2 | 0 | 5 | kappa, rho | 1 | – |
| Lucarelli | 10 | 72 | 14 | 15 | 43 | init_Rec, Rec_act, geneL_turn, S4tot, geneK_turn, geneJ_turn, S_phos, geneC_turn, geneA_turn, geneB_turn | 4 | 2 failed pts |
| Okuonghae | 2 | 14 | 3 | 9 | 2 | sigma, nu | 0 | 2 re-fits; 4 failed pts |
| Oliveira | 2 | 12 | 2 | 6 | 4 | t_1, beta_1 | 0 | 1 failed pt |
| Perelson | 2 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 2 | c, delta | 2 | – |

*(continued)*

| Problem | $k$ | Bio | Ident. | One side | Flat | Selected by profile likelihood | Common | Note |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rahman | 2 | 9 | 0 | 1 | 8 | behavioural_change_rate, infected_normal_worsen_rate | 1 | – |
| Raia | 2 | 18 | 5 | 13 | 0 | pSTAT5_dephosphorylation, pJAK2_dephosphorylation | 0 | 4 re-fits; 2 failed pts |
| Raimundez | *not evaluated: 126 free parameters > PL_PMAX=60* | | | | | | | |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 2 | 6 | 4 | 0 | 2 | ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE, kdephosYN__FREE | 1 | – |
| Schwen | 2 | 13 | 1 | 4 | 8 | ini_R2fold, ini_R1 | 2 | – |
| Smith | 2 | 16 | 6 | 9 | 1 | kminus7b, k30r | 1 | – |
| Sneyd | 2 | 14 | 2 | 3 | 9 | l4, k_3 | 1 | – |
| Weber | 2 | 26 | 1 | 11 | 14 | pu5, m22 | 0 | 2 failed pts |
| Zhao | 3 | 21 | 3 | 5 | 13 | R_Stage_II_Hubei, R_Stage_II_China, gamma_2_Stage_III_Wuhan | 0 | – |
| Zheng | 2 | 45 | 4 | 0 | 41 | k02_01, k01_02 | 1 | – |




**Supplementary Figure S11. Profile likelihoods of three problems.** $\Delta\chi^2$ on the training data as a function of the displacement of $\log|\theta_j|$ from the optimum, for every biological parameter, coloured by class. Dashed line, 95% threshold. Labels mark the parameters selected by profile likelihood (P) and by our method (O); in Raia they are omitted for legibility.

# Supplementary Note: Brun and Morris selections

## Purpose

The main text cites two further families of selection criteria: indices based on the collinearity of the sensitivity matrix, whose reference method is that of Brun *et al.* (Brun et al., 2001), and global sensitivity screening, of which Morris's method (Morris, 1991) is the most widely used. We implemented both with the same protocol as the other criteria.

## Design

*Brun.* Dimensionless sensitivities $s_{ij} = \theta_j \, \partial y_i / \partial \theta_j$ on the training outputs (forward differences with relative step $10^{-4}$), importance $\delta_j^{\mathrm{msqr}} = \|s_{:,j}\|/\sqrt{n}$, collinearity index $\gamma_K = 1/\sqrt{\lambda_{\min}(\tilde{S}_K^\top \tilde{S}_K)}$ of the column-normalised subset and determinant measure $\rho_K = \det(S_K^\top S_K)^{1/(2k)}$. Among the 15 most important parameters, every $k$-subset was evaluated and the one with $\gamma_K \leq 10$ and the largest $\rho_K$ was selected (the one with the smallest $\gamma_K$ if none satisfies the bound). The importance $\delta_j^{\mathrm{msqr}}$ orders the parameters as the energy $E_j$ of our method; the difference lies in the selection rule and in the absence of a re-estimation test.

*Morris.* Ten trajectories (seed 42) on a four-level grid of $\log|\theta_j|$ within $[\theta_0/10, 10\theta_0]$ for the biological parameters (calibration parameters at $\theta_0$), step $\Delta = 2/3$ of the range; elementary effect $\mathrm{EE}_j = \|y(x + \Delta e_j) - y(x)\|/\Delta$ on the training outputs; the $k$ parameters with the largest $\mu_j^* = \mathrm{mean}|\mathrm{EE}_j|$ were selected.

Chen was not included, because the sensitivity computations alone would take hours, as in the pivoted-QR comparison. Supplementary Table S24 lists the parameters selected by all five criteria.

## Implementation differences between the criteria

All criteria chose the same number $k$ of biological parameters and were evaluated with the same tests, but they were not implemented with identical numerical settings. The differences, which a strictly controlled comparison would remove, are:

- *Data used to select.* Our method selects on all measured outputs of the problem; pivoted QR, Brun, Morris and profile likelihood select on the training outputs of the external validation. This is why Bertozzi, whose selected parameters act only in the test conditions, was excluded from the admissibility comparison (main text). In the other problems the training set is a subset of the outputs used by our method.
- *Derivatives.* Our method uses central differences in $\log\theta$ with relative step $10^{-2}$; pivoted QR and Brun use forward differences with relative step $10^{-4}$; Morris uses finite elementary effects of 2/3 of the logarithmic range (a factor of about 21 in the parameter), so it measures global rather than local sensitivity, whereas the admissibility test is local ($\pm 5\%$ and $\pm 20\%$).
- *Candidates.* Brun evaluates all $k$-subsets of the 15 most important parameters only; the other criteria consider all biological parameters. Columns with zero sensitivity are discarded by pivoted QR and Brun (norm below $10^{-10}$) and by our method (zero energy).
- *Normalisation and ties in pivoted QR.* The columns are normalised to unit length, as is standard, so the magnitude of the sensitivity is discarded. As a consequence, all columns have the same norm at the first pivoting step, and the first parameter is chosen among them by rounding differences and column order; only the subsequent pivots are determined by the residual norm, that is, by

collinearity with the parameters already chosen. This is a property of normalised pivoted QR, not of our implementation, and it contributes to its low admissibility.

- *Computational budget.* The criteria do not use the same number of simulations: pivoted QR and Brun need $p + 1$ simulations, Morris $10(p + 1)$, profile likelihood ten re-estimations of the full model per parameter, and our method $3p$ simulations for $J$ and the stage-2 ordering plus the re-estimations of the admissibility test for every candidate subset.

These differences do not by themselves invalidate the comparison, and some of them disadvantage our method (for example, profile likelihood uses far more computation), but the comparison should be read as a comparison of the criteria as usually implemented, not of criteria that differ only in their selection rule. We did not repeat the comparison with harmonised settings. The profile-likelihood classification has two further caveats, marked in Supplementary Table S23: in Borghans and Isensee a profile point still improved the optimum by more than one unit of $\chi^2$ after the last re-estimation (1.56 and 1.16), so their full-model optimum did not converge and their classification is provisional; and failed profile points (simulation failure or $\Delta\chi^2 > 10^4$) were excluded, which can make a parameter look less identifiable than it is (three parameters in Okuonghae and Weber).

**Supplementary Table S24.** Biological parameters selected by each criterion (same number $k$ for all). –, criterion not computed for the problem.

| Problem | Ours | Pivoted QR | Brun | Morris | Profile likelihood |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | kt, k_rep_nhej | p_chk1_dea_wip1, k_death_reox | kt, p_atm_act_dsb | kt, k_damage_sn38_ssb | kt, k_death_reox |
| Armistead | k_d, k00 | k00, k2 | k_d, k00 | k00, k_d | k_d, k2 |
| Bachmann | CISRNADelay, JAK2ActEpo | SOCS3Inh, CISEqcOE | STAT5Imp, JAK2ActEpo | CISRNADelay, JAK2ActEpo | STAT5Imp, CISRNADelay |
| Bertozzi | R0_NY, I0_NY | R0_CA, I0_CA | R0_CA, I0_CA | gamma_CA, R0_CA | I0_CA, R0_CA |
| Blasi | a_basal, a_k16_k12k16 | – | – | – | – |
| Boehm | k_imp_hetero, k_phos | k_phos, k_imp_homo | k_phos, k_imp_hetero | k_phos, k_imp_hetero | k_phos, k_exp_homo |
| Borghans | Kz, K_par | Kd, init_A_state | K_par, Vm2 | K_par, beta_par | Kz, v0 |
| Brannmark | k1f, km2 | k1a, k_IRSiP_DosR | k1f, k1a | k22, k3 | k_IRSiP_DosR, km2 |
| Bruno | kb1, init_bcar2, init_zea_1, init_bcar1, init_bcry_1 | init_b10_1, init_bcar1, kc4, kc1, kc2 | init_bcar1, kb1, init_bcry_1, init_b10_1, kc2 | init_bcry_1, init_b10_1, init_bcar1, kb2, kc2 | init_bcar1, kb1, init_bcry_1, init_b10_1, kc2 |
| Chen | k106, k44 | – | – | – | – |
| Elowitz | n_Hill, tau_mRNA | eff_GFP, tau_prot_GFP | n_Hill, tau_mRNA | n_Hill, tau_prot_GFP | n_Hill, tau_prot_GFP |
| Fiedler | tau2, k6 | k11, k5 | tau2, k5 | K_1, tau2 | K_2, k6 |
| Fujita | init_AKT, reaction_6_k1 | reaction_1_k1, reaction_6_k1 | init_AKT, reaction_6_k1 | reaction_6_k1, reaction_8_k1 | reaction_8_k1, EGFR_turnover |
| Giordano | alpha_4, alpha_28 | delta_0, eta_0 | alpha_4, alpha_22 | alpha_4, alpha_0 | nu_0, rho_22 |
| Isensee | kf_RIIp_C_2__RII_C_2, xi_kf_RII_C_2__RII_2 | kf_Fsk, KD_H89 | kf_RII_C_2__RIIp_C_2, xi_kf_RII_C_2__RII_2 | kf_RII_C_2__RIIp_C_2, kf_RIIp_2__RII_2 | kf_RIIp_2__RII_2, kf_RII_C_2__RIIp_C_2 |
| Laske | k_imp, k_syn_R_M | k_imp, k_rel | k_syn_R_M, k_bind_M1 | k_syn_R_M, k_bind_M1 | k_bind_M1, k_syn_R_M |
| Liu | kappa, phi | kappa, rho | kappa, rho | kappa, rho | kappa, rho |
| Lucarelli | init_Rec, S2tot, S3tot, S_dephosphos, S_phos, geneF_turn, k_234, geneK_turn, S4tot, geneH_turn | S4tot, geneK_turn, geneJ_turn, geneB_act2, geneG_act1, geneH_turn, geneL_turn, geneE_act2, geneI_act1, geneC_act1 | init_Rec, S2tot, S_dephosphos, S_phos, Rec_act, geneF_turn, k_234, geneK_turn, geneH_turn, geneG_turn | init_Rec, S3tot, S2tot, pRec_degind, S_dephosphos, S_phos, geneF_turn, geneF_act1, Rec_act, geneF_inh1 | init_Rec, Rec_act, geneL_turn, S4tot, geneK_turn, geneJ_turn, S_phos, geneC_turn, geneA_turn, geneB_turn |
| Okuonghae | transmission_rate_effective, gamma_i | asymptomatic_start, d_D | transmission_rate_effective, psi | sigma, nu | sigma, nu |
| Oliveira | beta_0, h_hosp_rate | beta_1, symptomatic_init_concentration | beta_0, t_1 | beta_0, t_1 | t_1, beta_1 |

*(continued)*

| Problem | Ours | Pivoted QR | Brun | Morris | Profile likelihood |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Perelson | c, delta | c, delta | c, delta | c, delta | c, delta |
| Rahman | infected_moderate_transmission_rate, infected_normal_worsen_rate | infected_moderate_transmission_rate, treated_moderate_improve_rate | infected_moderate_transmission_rate, behavioural_change_rate | infected_normal_transmission_rate_relative, infected_moderate_transmission_rate | behavioural_change_rate, infected_normal_worsen_rate |
| Raia | SOCS3mRNA_production, init_Rec_i | Rec_recycle, DecoyR_binding | SOCS3mRNA_production, init_Rec_i | SOCS3mRNA_production, Rec_recycle | pSTAT5_dephosphorylation, pJAK2_dephosphorylation |
| Raimundez | kdeg_membran__MKN1, ka_MAPK__MKN1 | d_MAPKtotal__MKN1_2_HS746T, d_MPI3Ktotal__fm_2_hm | kdeg_membran__MKN1, ka_MAPK__MKN1 | d_AKTtotal__fm_2_hm, ki_AKT__MKN1 | – |
| Salazar-Cavazos | ratio_kpkd_Y1068__FREE, ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE | GRB2_total__FREE, kdephosYN__FREE | ratio_kpkd_Y1068__FREE, ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE | ratio_kpkd_Y1068__FREE, ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE | ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE, kdephosYN__FREE |
| Schwen | ini_R1, ini_R2fold | kd2fold, kout | ini_R1, kon_unspec | ini_R2fold, ini_R1 | ini_R2fold, ini_R1 |
| Smith | k8, kminus7b | kminus7a, k43r | k8, k30f | kminus8, kminus7b | kminus7b, k30r |
| Sneyd | l4, l2 | k_2, k_3 | l4, l2 | l2, k4 | l4, k_3 |
| Weber | s12, a21 | a22, pu5 | a21, s12 | pu3, a21 | pu5, m22 |
| Zhao | R_Stage_I_China, R_Stage_II_Wuhan, gamma_1_Stage_I_Hubei | R_Stage_I_Wuhan, R_Stage_III_Wuhan, R_Stage_II_Hubei | R_Stage_I_China, gamma_1_Stage_I_Wuhan, R_Stage_II_Hubei | R_Stage_I_China, gamma_2_Stage_I_China, R_Stage_II_China | R_Stage_II_Hubei, R_Stage_II_China, gamma_2_Stage_III_Wuhan |
| Zheng | k01_02, k13_12 | k01_11, k10_00 | k01_11, k12_13 | k01_02, k12_13 | k02_01, k01_02 |

## Supplementary Note: Comparison on real data

Supplementary Table S25 gives the test $\chi^2/n$ on the held-out experiments of every criterion and baseline, together with the full model and the published estimate, and Supplementary Table S26 the paired comparison with our method over problems. When the non-selected parameters are kept at $\theta_0$, all selection criteria and the random and calibration-only baselines predict similarly: the median ratios to our method are between 0.98 and 1.00, and only pivoted QR (1% lower $\chi^2$) and calibration-only re-estimation (2% lower) differ significantly, in favour of the alternative. Oliveira is the only problem in which the specific selection matters strongly. As discussed in the main text, this test does not discriminate between criteria because the fixed parameters carry the information of $\theta_0$, which was estimated with all data.

**Supplementary Table S25.** Test $\chi^2/n$ on the held-out experiments (real data) of every selection criterion and baseline. All variants keep the non-selected parameters at $\theta_0$ except the full model, which re-estimates all parameters on the training data. Bold: lowest value among the seven selection variants. $\theta_0$, published estimate, obtained using all data including the test experiments.

| Problem | Ours | Calib. only | Random | QR | Brun | Morris | Profile | Full | $\theta_0$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 2.75 | **2.72** | 2.72 | 2.73 | 2.74 | 2.86 | 2.74 | 3.37 | 2.47 |
| Armistead | 1.22 | **1.16** | 1.16 | 1.21 | 1.22 | 1.22 | 1.37 | 1.37 | 1.16 |
| Bachmann | 4.77 | 4.76 | 4.84 | **4.75** | 4.75 | 4.77 | 4.77 | 7.35 | 1.05 |
| Boehm | 2.57 | **0.341** | 1.09 | 0.349 | 2.57 | 2.57 | 0.425 | 11.2 | 0.341 |
| Borghans | 0.743 | 0.778 | 0.768 | 0.776 | **0.742** | 0.743 | 0.744 | 0.744 | 0.74 |
| Brannmark | 5.96 | **0.938** | 2.95 | 0.951 | 1.17 | 147 | 1.82 | 6,277 | 0.938 |
| Bruno | 0.909 | **0.909** | 0.911 | 0.911 | 0.909 | 0.911 | 0.909 | 208 | 0.909 |
| Chen | **20.9** | – | – | – | – | – | – | 17.7 | 15.2 |
| Elowitz | 1.5 | **1.39** | 1.44 | 1.41 | 1.5 | 1.43 | 1.43 | 3.89 | 1.38 |
| Fiedler | 11.2 | 11.7 | 11.2 | 10.9 | 11 | 11.1 | **9.56** | 9.32 | 1.22 |
| Fujita | 5.94 | **5.94** | 6.02 | 5.94 | 5.94 | 5.94 | 5.98 | 8.03 | 5.63 |
| Giordano | $1.0 \times 10^{-7}$ | $7.4 \times 10^{-9}$ | $8.7 \times 10^{-9}$ | $7.2 \times 10^{-9}$ | $2.7 \times 10^{-8}$ | $1.3 \times 10^{-8}$ | $1.4 \times 10^{-8}$ | 0.00773 | $7.4 \times 10^{-9}$ |
| Isensee | 1.08 | 1.08 | 1.08 | 1.08 | 1.08 | **1.08** | 1.08 | 1.08 | 1.04 |

*(continued)*

| Problem | Ours | Calib. only | Random | QR | Brun | Morris | Profile | Full | $\theta_0$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Laske | 0.758 | 0.445 | 0.445 | 0.445 | **0.445** | **0.445** | **0.445** | 1.87 | 0.445 |
| Liu | 0.954 | **0.942** | 0.942 | 1.03 | 1.03 | 1.03 | 1.03 | 1.02 | 0.942 |
| Lucarelli | 1.66 | **1.02** | 1.06 | 1.07 | 1.02 | 1.03 | 1.08 | 3.34 | 1.02 |
| Okuonghae | $4.7 \times 10^4$ | $2.9 \times 10^4$ | $5.6 \times 10^4$ | $3.2 \times 10^4$ | $8.0 \times 10^4$ | $5.1 \times 10^4$ | $5.1 \times 10^4$ | $1.2 \times 10^5$ | $2.9 \times 10^4$ |
| Oliveira | 912 | $4.6 \times 10^5$ | $2.0 \times 10^4$ | $7.3 \times 10^4$ | **553** | **553** | $3.0 \times 10^5$ | $8.1 \times 10^4$ | $4.6 \times 10^5$ |
| Perelson | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ | $4.0 \times 10^{-13}$ |
| Rahman | 0.00199 | **0.00148** | 0.00171 | 0.00154 | 0.00247 | 0.00163 | 0.00272 | 0.0257 | 0.00148 |
| Raia | 8.22 | **0.439** | 2.21 | 7.24 | 8.23 | 8.15 | 0.799 | 5.1 | 0.417 |
| Raimundez | 1.17 | **1.17** | 1.18 | 1.17 | 1.17 | 1.17 | – | 1.43 | 0.98 |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 102 | **96.9** | 103 | 102 | 102 | 102 | 119 | 124 | 96.9 |
| Schwen | 8.2 | **8.06** | 8.35 | 8.43 | 8.3 | 8.2 | 8.2 | 8.4 | 0.768 |
| Smith | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $1.6 \times 10^4$ | $1.6 \times 10^4$ | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $1.4 \times 10^4$ | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $8.3 \times 10^4$ |
| Sneyd | 2.22 | **1.37** | 1.89 | 1.48 | 2.22 | 2.18 | 1.52 | 2.56 | 1.37 |
| Weber | 1 | 0.997 | 1.01 | **0.997** | 1 | 45.6 | 0.997 | 16 | 0.993 |
| Zhao | **0.345** | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 |
| Zheng | 1.58 | **1.51** | 1.52 | 1.55 | 1.59 | 1.58 | 3.16 | 20.8 | 1.51 |

**Supplementary Table S26.** Real data: paired comparison of the test $\chi^2/n$ of our method with each alternative over problems. Better/worse: our method lower/higher by more than 5%; equal: within 5%. Median ratio: alternative over ours (below 1, the alternative predicts better). $p$: two-sided Wilcoxon signed-rank test on the log ratios.

| Our method compared with | Problems | Ours better | Ours worse | Equal | Median ratio | $p$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pivoted QR | 28 | 2 | 10 | 16 | 0.99 | 0.026 |
| Brun | 28 | 3 | 5 | 20 | 1.00 | 0.27 |
| Morris | 28 | 4 | 6 | 18 | 1.00 | 0.46 |
| Profile likelihood | 27 | 7 | 9 | 11 | 1.00 | 0.44 |
| Random subsets (median of 20) | 28 | 3 | 9 | 16 | 1.00 | 0.27 |
| Calibration only ($k = 0$) | 28 | 2 | 13 | 13 | 0.99 | 0.0027 |
| Full model re-estimated on training data | 29 | 20 | 3 | 6 | 1.23 | 8.2e-05 |
| Reduced model, leakage-free nested | 29 | 21 | 3 | 5 | 1.35 | 7.2e-05 |
| Published estimate $\theta_0$ | 29 | 2 | 20 | 7 | 0.90 | 0.00022 |

Supplementary Table S27 classifies every problem according to how our method, pivoted QR and the two baselines compare.

**Supplementary Table S27.** External validation against three baseline selectors, with a classification of each problem. Test $\chi^2/n$ of our method, of calibration-only re-estimation ($|S| = 0$), of pivoted QR and of random biological subsets of the same size $k$ (median over 20 draws). Category: **S**, sloppy—all four values within 10% of each other; **C**, calibration dominates (bold, lowest value); **O**, our method clearly best; **P**, all methods near zero (<0.01); **F**, all methods fail ($\chi^2/n \gg 1$).

| Problem | $k$ | $\chi^2_{\text{ours}}$ | $\chi^2_{\text{vac}}$ | $\chi^2_{\text{QR}}$ | $\chi^2_{\text{rand}}$ | Cat. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 2 | 2.748 | 2.720 | 2.727 | 2.722 | S |
| Armistead | 2 | 1.218 | 1.157 | 1.207 | 1.159 | S |
| Bachmann | 2 | 4.768 | 4.759 | 4.746 | 4.845 | S |
| Boehm | 2 | 2.567 | **0.341** | **0.349** | 1.095 | C |
| Borghans | 2 | 0.743 | 0.778 | 0.776 | 0.768 | S |
| Brannmark | 2 | 5.956 | **0.938** | **0.951** | 2.952 | C |
| Bruno | 5 | 0.909 | 0.909 | 0.911 | 0.911 | S |
| Elowitz | 2 | 1.498 | 1.391 | 1.407 | 1.439 | S |
| Fiedler | 2 | 11.21 | 11.73 | 10.95 | 11.22 | S |
| Fujita | 2 | 5.939 | 5.937 | 5.941 | 6.022 | S |
| Giordano | 2 | <0.01 | <0.01 | <0.01 | <0.01 | P |
| Isensee | 2 | 1.082 | 1.081 | 1.081 | 1.081 | S |
| Laske | 2 | 0.758 | **0.445** | **0.445** | **0.445** | C |
| Liu | 2 | 0.954 | 0.942 | 1.026 | 0.942 | S |
| Lucarelli | 10 | 1.659 | **1.015** | 1.073 | 1.059 | C |
| Okuonghae | 2 | $4.7 \times 10^4$ | $2.9 \times 10^4$ | $3.2 \times 10^4$ | $5.6 \times 10^4$ | F |
| Oliveira | 2 | **912** | $4.6 \times 10^5$ | $7.3 \times 10^4$ | $2.0 \times 10^4$ | O |
| Perelson | 2 | <0.01 | <0.01 | <0.01 | <0.01 | P |
| Rahman | 2 | <0.01 | <0.01 | <0.01 | <0.01 | P |
| Raia | 2 | 8.224 | **0.439** | 7.236 | 2.213 | C |
| Raimundez | 2 | 1.167 | 1.167 | 1.168 | 1.182 | S |
| Salazar-C. | 2 | 101.8 | 96.93 | 101.7 | 103.2 | F |
| Schwen | 2 | 8.196 | 8.063 | 8.432 | 8.353 | S |
| Smith | 2 | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $1.6 \times 10^4$ | $1.5 \times 10^4$ | $1.6 \times 10^4$ | F |
| Sneyd | 2 | 2.222 | **1.373** | 1.480 | 1.890 | C |
| Weber | 2 | 1.001 | 0.997 | 0.997 | 1.014 | S |
| Zhao | 3 | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 | 0.345 | S |
| Zheng | 2 | 1.582 | 1.505 | 1.553 | 1.521 | S |

# Supplementary Note: Admissibility of the subsets of other criteria

## Purpose

Our method returns a subset only if re-estimating it reproduces the full model under random parameter changes (admissibility). This note applies exactly the same test to the subsets of the other criteria, to determine whether they have this property without being selected for it.

## Design

The test replicates the code of the method: 15 scenarios $\theta^{(k)} = \theta_0 \odot (1 + \varepsilon u^{(k)})$ with the same seed (42), re-estimation of the subset together with the calibration parameters from two starting points, scenarios with non-finite outputs discarded, and the subset is admissible if the smaller of the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ and the median $e_{\text{rel}}$ is at most $\tau_e = 0.436$ (with $|S| \geq 2$), exactly as for our method (Methods of the main text; with nonlinear re-estimation the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ is never larger than the median $e_{\text{rel}}$, so the

rule reduces to the median $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$). The eight problems that the method treats to first order were treated in the same way for every criterion. As a check, the test reproduces the published $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ of our subsets (for example Armistead 0.330, Boehm 0.094, Fiedler 0.147). Because our subsets are selected by this test at $\varepsilon = 0.05$, it was repeated at $\varepsilon = 0.20$, a level used by none of the criteria.

## Results

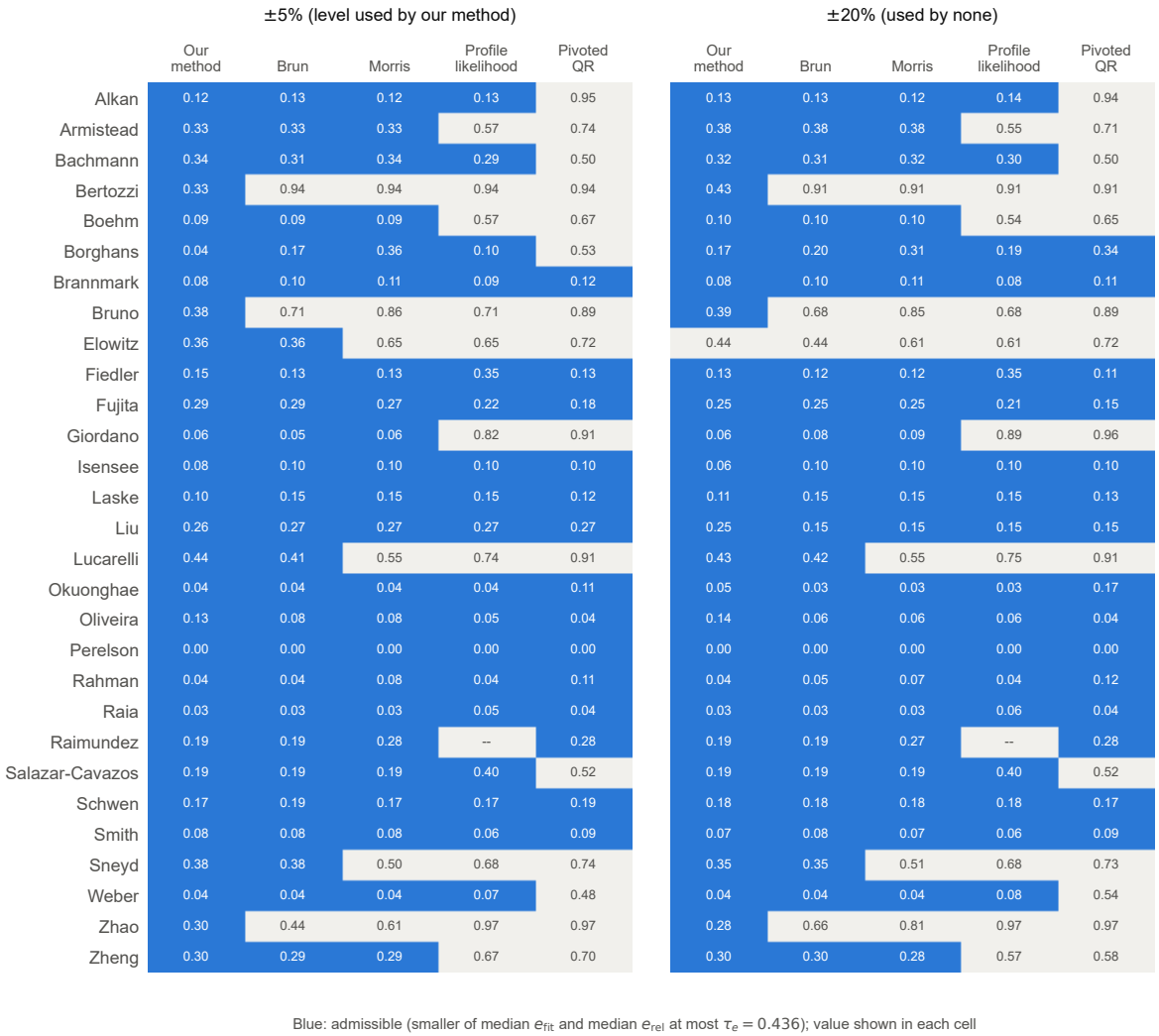
Supplementary Table S28 and Supplementary Figure S12 give the result of every criterion in every problem, and Supplementary Table S29 the paired comparison. At ±5% our subsets were admissible in all 28 problems, against 26 (Brun), 23 (Morris), 18 of 27 (profile likelihood) and 14 (pivoted QR); at ±20%, 27 of 28 against 25, 23, 18 of 27 and 15. Bertozzi is not included: our method selected its parameters on all measured outputs, which in this problem include the test conditions, whereas the other criteria selected on the training outputs, so the criteria did not use the same information. There is no problem in which the subset of another criterion is admissible and ours is not. The only problem in which our subset loses admissibility at ±20% is Elowitz, one of the problems that are admissible with a small margin at ±5% (main text, *Robustness*).

**Supplementary Table S28.** Admissibility of the subsets of every criterion: smaller of the median $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ and the median $e_{\mathrm{rel}}$ over 15 scenarios (the quantity compared with $\tau_e = 0.436$ by the method), for parameter changes of ±5% (left) and ±20% (right). ✓, admissible. The eight problems that the method treats to first order are treated in the same way for every criterion.

| | ±5% | | | | | ±20% | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Problem | Ours | QR | Brun | Morris | Profile | Ours | QR | Brun | Morris | Profile |
| Alkan | 0.121✓ | 0.945 | 0.126✓ | 0.116✓ | 0.131✓ | 0.133✓ | 0.940 | 0.131✓ | 0.122✓ | 0.136✓ |
| Armistead | 0.330✓ | 0.741 | 0.330✓ | 0.330✓ | 0.567 | 0.385✓ | 0.708 | 0.385✓ | 0.385✓ | 0.555 |
| Bachmann | 0.337✓ | 0.503 | 0.307✓ | 0.337✓ | 0.295✓ | 0.324✓ | 0.499 | 0.312✓ | 0.324✓ | 0.303✓ |
| Boehm | 0.094✓ | 0.670 | 0.094✓ | 0.094✓ | 0.565 | 0.095✓ | 0.648 | 0.095✓ | 0.095✓ | 0.535 |
| Borghans | 0.043✓ | 0.533 | 0.166✓ | 0.355✓ | 0.097✓ | 0.169✓ | 0.345✓ | 0.198✓ | 0.313✓ | 0.190✓ |
| Brannmark | 0.078✓ | 0.116✓ | 0.098✓ | 0.105✓ | 0.088✓ | 0.080✓ | 0.111✓ | 0.103✓ | 0.110✓ | 0.084✓ |
| Bruno | 0.378✓ | 0.894 | 0.705 | 0.858 | 0.705 | 0.388✓ | 0.893 | 0.680 | 0.847 | 0.680 |
| Elowitz | 0.358✓ | 0.719 | 0.358✓ | 0.650 | 0.650 | 0.436 | 0.715 | 0.436 | 0.610 | 0.610 |
| Fiedler | 0.147✓ | 0.133✓ | 0.133✓ | 0.134✓ | 0.347✓ | 0.133✓ | 0.115✓ | 0.118✓ | 0.118✓ | 0.346✓ |
| Fujita | 0.294✓ | 0.177✓ | 0.294✓ | 0.268✓ | 0.217✓ | 0.252✓ | 0.154✓ | 0.252✓ | 0.251✓ | 0.211✓ |
| Giordano | 0.058✓ | 0.909 | 0.054✓ | 0.064✓ | 0.816 | 0.059✓ | 0.964 | 0.080✓ | 0.086✓ | 0.893 |
| Isensee | 0.076✓ | 0.102✓ | 0.098✓ | 0.103✓ | 0.103✓ | 0.058✓ | 0.096✓ | 0.098✓ | 0.103✓ | 0.103✓ |
| Laske | 0.101✓ | 0.125✓ | 0.149✓ | 0.149✓ | 0.149✓ | 0.106✓ | 0.131✓ | 0.146✓ | 0.146✓ | 0.146✓ |
| Liu | 0.261✓ | 0.271✓ | 0.271✓ | 0.271✓ | 0.271✓ | 0.252✓ | 0.146✓ | 0.146✓ | 0.146✓ | 0.146✓ |
| Lucarelli | 0.435✓ | 0.911 | 0.413✓ | 0.549 | 0.740 | 0.428✓ | 0.908 | 0.422✓ | 0.549 | 0.746 |
| Okuonghae | 0.041✓ | 0.112✓ | 0.041✓ | 0.042✓ | 0.042✓ | 0.047✓ | 0.169✓ | 0.034✓ | 0.035✓ | 0.035✓ |
| Oliveira | 0.129✓ | 0.039✓ | 0.078✓ | 0.078✓ | 0.048✓ | 0.141✓ | 0.039✓ | 0.062✓ | 0.062✓ | 0.060✓ |
| Perelson | 0.000✓ | 0.000✓ | 0.000✓ | 0.000✓ | 0.000✓ | 0.000✓ | 0.000✓ | 0.000✓ | 0.000✓ | 0.000✓ |
| Rahman | 0.037✓ | 0.112✓ | 0.035✓ | 0.085✓ | 0.035✓ | 0.040✓ | 0.124✓ | 0.047✓ | 0.069✓ | 0.039✓ |
| Raia | 0.033✓ | 0.042✓ | 0.033✓ | 0.034✓ | 0.048✓ | 0.032✓ | 0.040✓ | 0.032✓ | 0.032✓ | 0.061✓ |
| Raimundez | 0.187✓ | 0.282✓ | 0.187✓ | 0.277✓ | – | 0.194✓ | 0.279✓ | 0.194✓ | 0.275✓ | – |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 0.187✓ | 0.520 | 0.187✓ | 0.187✓ | 0.398✓ | 0.188✓ | 0.518 | 0.188✓ | 0.188✓ | 0.396✓ |
| Schwen | 0.171✓ | 0.189✓ | 0.193✓ | 0.171✓ | 0.171✓ | 0.179✓ | 0.173✓ | 0.184✓ | 0.179✓ | 0.179✓ |
| Smith | 0.078✓ | 0.085✓ | 0.078✓ | 0.077✓ | 0.060✓ | 0.069✓ | 0.088✓ | 0.075✓ | 0.069✓ | 0.065✓ |
| Sneyd | 0.381✓ | 0.736 | 0.381✓ | 0.497 | 0.682 | 0.349✓ | 0.731 | 0.349✓ | 0.512 | 0.685 |
| Weber | 0.041✓ | 0.482 | 0.041✓ | 0.044✓ | 0.069✓ | 0.039✓ | 0.543 | 0.039✓ | 0.044✓ | 0.081✓ |
| Zhao | 0.296✓ | 0.970 | 0.438 | 0.608 | 0.975 | 0.282✓ | 0.972 | 0.662 | 0.807 | 0.975 |
| Zheng | 0.300✓ | 0.697 | 0.294✓ | 0.292✓ | 0.671 | 0.296✓ | 0.580 | 0.296✓ | 0.285✓ | 0.571 |
| Admissible | 28/28 | 14/28 | 26/28 | 23/28 | 18/27 | 27/28 | 15/28 | 25/28 | 23/28 | 18/27 |

**Supplementary Table S29.** Admissibility of our subsets compared with those of each criterion: exact McNemar test over problems (problems in which only one of the two subsets is admissible).

| Level | Criterion | Problems | Only ours admissible | Only the other | $p$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ±5% | Pivoted QR | 28 | 14 | 0 | 0.00012 |
| ±5% | Brun | 28 | 2 | 0 | 0.5 |
| ±5% | Morris | 28 | 5 | 0 | 0.062 |
| ±5% | Profile likelihood | 27 | 9 | 0 | 0.0039 |
| ±20% | Pivoted QR | 28 | 12 | 0 | 0.00049 |
| ±20% | Brun | 28 | 2 | 0 | 0.5 |
| ±20% | Morris | 28 | 4 | 0 | 0.12 |
| ±20% | Profile likelihood | 27 | 8 | 0 | 0.0078 |




**Supplementary Figure S12. Admissibility of the subsets of every criterion in every problem.** Cell value: smaller of the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ and the median $e_{\text{rel}}$ over 15 scenarios; blue, admissible ($\leq \tau_e = 0.436$). Left, ±5%; right, ±20%. –, criterion not computed.

# Supplementary Note: Comparison of selection criteria on synthetic data

## Design

The synthetic prediction experiment (Supplementary Note *Synthetic prediction experiment*) was repeated with the subsets of every criterion, with the same 20 seeds (42–61), so that the five criteria are evaluated on exactly the same truths and noise realisations. Each subset, with the calibration parameters, was re-estimated on the synthetic training data from $\theta_0$ and $e_{\mathrm{pred}}$ was computed on the test data. The comparison uses the cases common to the five criteria in which the parameter change exceeded the noise (282 cases in 24 problems). Because the 20 seeds of a problem are not independent, the main statistic resamples whole problems (Methods, *Statistics*).

## Results

Supplementary Table S30 gives the results per problem and Supplementary Table S31 the statistics. Our subsets reached $e_{\mathrm{pred}} \leq \tau_e$ in 56% of the cases, those of Brun in 55%, Morris 48%, profile likelihood 39% and pivoted QR 34%; the advantage of our method over pivoted QR (22 percentage points, 95% confidence interval 10–34), profile likelihood (17, 8–28) and Morris (9, 2–16) is significant, whereas the difference from Brun is not. The per-problem median prediction error did not differ significantly between criteria (Wilcoxon $p \geq 0.07$). Supplementary Figure S13 shows that the ordering of the criteria is similar across seeds.

**Supplementary Table S30.** Synthetic prediction experiment for the five criteria (20 seeds, cases common to all criteria in which the parameter change exceeded the noise). Each entry: number of cases with $e_{\mathrm{pred}} \leq \tau_e$ and, in parentheses, the median $e_{\mathrm{pred}}$.

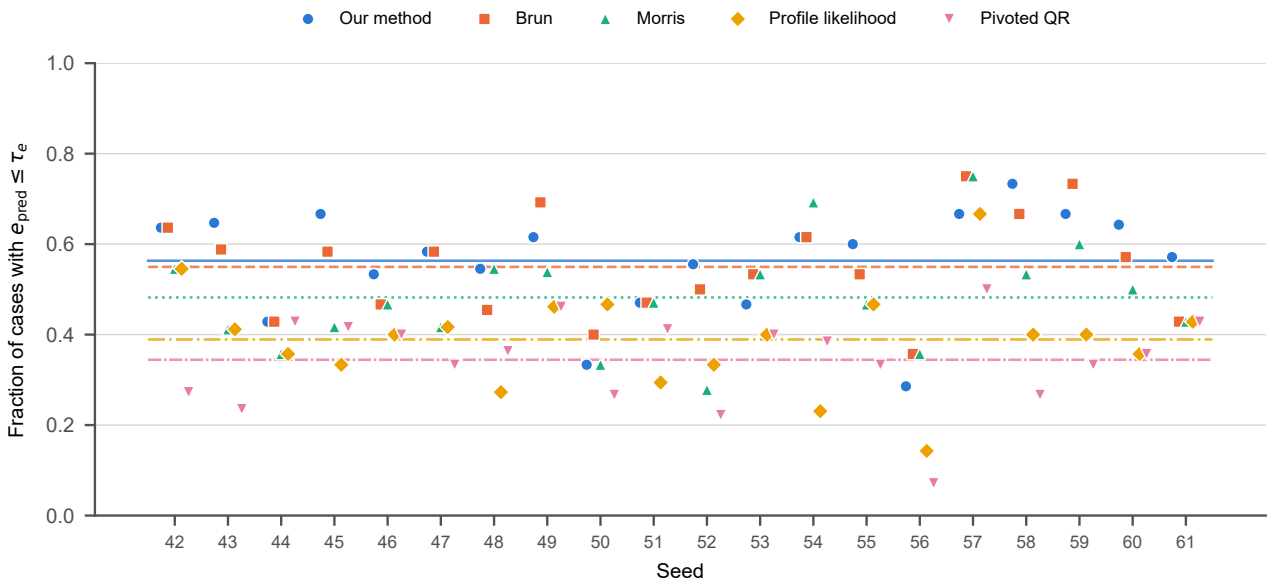
| Problem | Cases | Ours | Pivoted QR | Brun | Morris | Profile |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 3 | 3 (0.21) | 0 (0.93) | 3 (0.28) | 3 (0.16) | 3 (0.28) |
| Armistead | 12 | 7 (0.42) | 5 (0.51) | 7 (0.42) | 7 (0.42) | 4 (0.65) |
| Bachmann | 2 | 0 (1.63) | 0 (1.87) | 0 (1.81) | 0 (1.36) | 0 (1.75) |
| Boehm | 4 | 1 (0.53) | 0 (0.79) | 1 (0.53) | 1 (0.53) | 0 (0.94) |
| Borghans | 11 | 2 (0.81) | 1 (0.92) | 1 (0.83) | 1 (0.83) | 1 (0.85) |
| Brannmark | 18 | 1 (1.84) | 0 (1.00) | 0 (1.23) | 0 (7.56) | 0 (0.99) |
| Bruno | 6 | 4 (0.34) | 0 (1.00) | 4 (0.34) | 0 (0.99) | 4 (0.34) |
| Elowitz | 17 | 11 (0.27) | 3 (0.61) | 11 (0.27) | 7 (0.54) | 7 (0.54) |
| Fiedler | 6 | 1 (1.00) | 1 (0.90) | 1 (1.00) | 1 (0.99) | 0 (1.68) |
| Fujita | 18 | 14 (0.31) | 15 (0.27) | 14 (0.31) | 14 (0.30) | 16 (0.24) |
| Isensee | 12 | 9 (0.13) | 9 (0.15) | 7 (0.19) | 6 (0.59) | 3 (0.94) |
| Liu | 1 | 0 (0.64) | 0 (0.50) | 0 (0.50) | 0 (0.50) | 0 (0.50) |
| Okuonghae | 20 | 17 (0.16) | 10 (0.45) | 18 (0.06) | 18 (0.09) | 18 (0.09) |
| Oliveira | 20 | 12 (0.39) | 6 (1.36) | 13 (0.35) | 13 (0.35) | 7 (0.63) |
| Perelson | 1 | 0 (20.95) | 0 (20.95) | 0 (20.95) | 0 (20.95) | 0 (20.95) |
| Rahman | 19 | 15 (0.12) | 17 (0.20) | 13 (0.13) | 13 (0.39) | 14 (0.23) |
| Raia | 8 | 7 (0.24) | 7 (0.23) | 7 (0.24) | 7 (0.23) | 0 (1.01) |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 18 | 12 (0.33) | 0 (0.92) | 12 (0.33) | 12 (0.33) | 2 (0.83) |
| Schwen | 9 | 0 (1.62) | 0 (1.62) | 0 (1.42) | 0 (1.62) | 0 (1.62) |
| Smith | 20 | 18 (0.10) | 18 (0.10) | 19 (0.11) | 18 (0.09) | 19 (0.11) |
| Sneyd | 1 | 1 (0.27) | 0 (0.62) | 1 (0.27) | 0 (0.88) | 1 (0.40) |
| Weber | 20 | 11 (0.36) | 0 (1.00) | 11 (0.36) | 2 (0.86) | 6 (0.59) |
| Zhao | 16 | 0 (1.00) | 0 (1.00) | 0 (1.00) | 0 (1.00) | 0 (1.00) |

*(continued)*

| Problem | Cases | Ours | Pivoted QR | Brun | Morris | Profile |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Zheng | 20 | 12 (0.41) | 4 (0.69) | 11 (0.42) | 11 (0.41) | 4 (0.72) |
| Total | 282 | 158 (56%) | 96 (34%) | 154 (55%) | 134 (48%) | 109 (39%) |

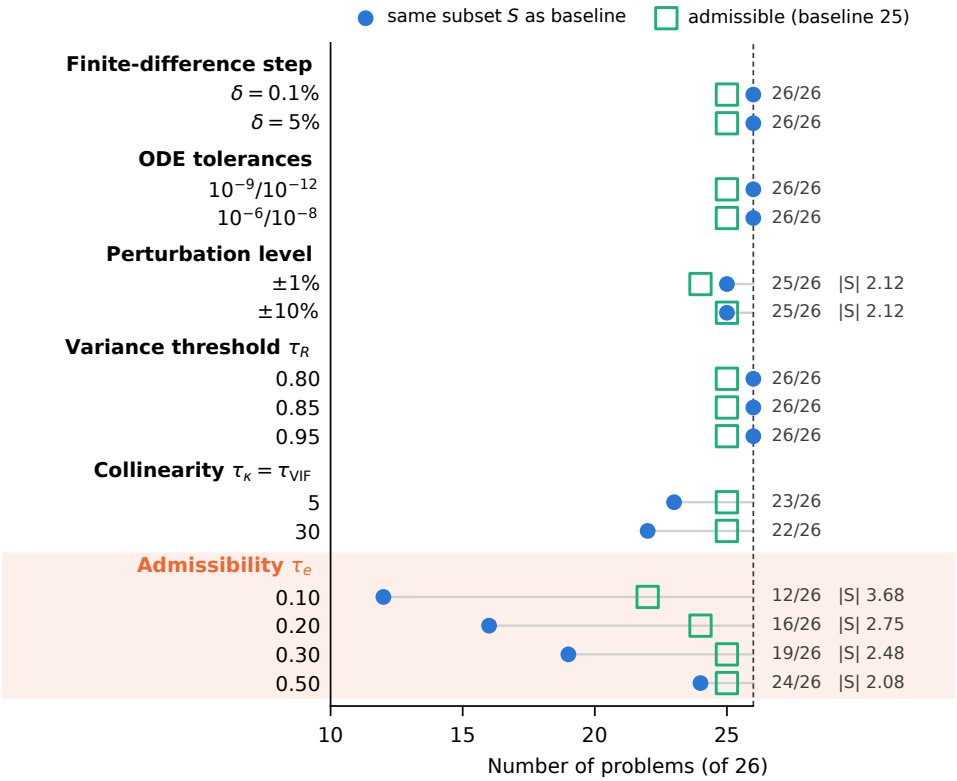
**Supplementary Table S31.** Synthetic experiment, statistics over problems. Left: difference in the fraction of cases with $e_{\text{pred}} \leq \tau_e$ (ours minus criterion, percentage points) with a 95% confidence interval and $p$-value from resampling whole problems with all their seeds (10,000 replicates). Right: per-problem median over seeds of the ratio $e_{\text{pred}}$(criterion)/$e_{\text{pred}}$(ours) (problems with at least 10 seeds), its median and the two-sided Wilcoxon $p$-value.

| Criterion | Difference | 95% CI | $p$ | Problems | Median ratio | $p$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pivoted QR | +22.0 | +10.2 to +33.8 | 0.0001 | 28 | 1.03 | 0.075 |
| Brun | +1.4 | -1.0 to +4.1 | 0.33 | 28 | 1.00 | 0.37 |
| Morris | +8.5 | +2.3 to +16.4 | 0.0038 | 28 | 1.00 | 0.29 |
| Profile likelihood | +17.4 | +7.6 to +27.9 | 0.0008 | 27 | 1.04 | 0.23 |




**Supplementary Figure S13. Synthetic experiment: fraction of cases with $e_{\text{pred}} \leq \tau_e$ for each criterion and seed.** Horizontal lines, mean over seeds. Cases common to the five criteria with signal.

# Supplementary Note: Sensitivity to the method settings




**Supplementary Figure S14. Sensitivity of the selection to the method settings**. The complete method was re-run on 26 problems changing one setting at a time with respect to the baseline ($\delta = 1\%$, tolerances $10^{-7}/10^{-10}$, perturbation $\pm 5\%$, $\tau_R = 0.89$, $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\mathrm{VIF}} = 10$, $\tau_e = 0.436$; 25 admissible problems with a mean of 2.16 selected biological parameters). Filled circles, number of problems whose selected subset is identical to the baseline; open squares, number of problems with an admissible subset; dashed line, all 26 problems. $|S|$, mean number of selected biological parameters among admissible problems, where it differs from the baseline. The admissibility threshold $\tau_e$ (shaded) is the only setting with a large effect. Results for every problem are given in Supplementary Table S32.

The method depends on a finite-difference step $\delta$, the integrator tolerances, the perturbation size used for admissibility and four thresholds ($\tau_R$, $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\mathrm{VIF}}$, $\tau_e$). The complete method (selection, admissibility and backward elimination, with the calibration parameters always re-estimated) was re-run changing one setting at a time, with all others at their baseline values ($\delta = 1\%$, relative/absolute tolerances $10^{-7}/10^{-10}$, perturbation $\pm 5\%$, $\tau_R = 0.89$, $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\mathrm{VIF}} = 10$, $\tau_e = 0.436$). The 26 problems whose complete method could be re-run fifteen times in reasonable time were used; the other 8 (Alkan, Bachmann, Beer, Chen, Isensee, Lang, Lucarelli, Raimundez) need hours per run. For each setting and problem we record whether the selected subset is identical to the baseline and whether the problem is admissible.

**Supplementary Table S32.** Effect of each setting on every problem: =, same subset and admissibility as the baseline; ≠, different subset (still admissible); ×, not admissible; ∘, not admissible in the baseline either. Columns in the order of the rows of Supplementary Fig. S14.

| Problem | $\delta = 0.1\%$ | $\delta = 5\%$ | tolerances $10^{-9}/10^{-12}$ | tolerances $10^{-6}/10^{-8}$ | perturbation ±1% | perturbation ±10% | $\tau_R = 0.80$ | $\tau_R = 0.85$ | $\tau_R = 0.95$ | $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\mathrm{VIF}} = 5$ | $\tau_\kappa = \tau_{\mathrm{VIF}} = 30$ | $\tau_e = 0.10$ | $\tau_e = 0.20$ | $\tau_e = 0.30$ | $\tau_e = 0.50$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Armistead | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | ≠ | = |
| Bertozzi | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | ≠ | = |
| Blasi | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | ≠ | = |
| Boehm | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = |
| Borghans | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = |
| Brannmark | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | = | = | = | = |
| Bruno | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | ≠ | ≠ |
| Crauste | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ | ∘ |
| Elowitz | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | ≠ | = |
| Fiedler | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | = | = | = |
| Fujita | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | = | = |
| Giordano | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | = | = | = | = |
| Laske | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | = | = | = |
| Liu | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | × | × | = | = |
| Okuonghae | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | = | = | = | = |
| Oliveira | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | × | = | = | = |
| Perelson | = | = | = | = | × | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = |
| Rahman | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | = | = | = | = | = |
| Raia | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | = | = | = | = | = |
| Salazar-Cavazos | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | = | × | = | = | = |
| Schwen | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | = | = | = |
| Smith | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = |
| Sneyd | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | ≠ | = |
| Weber | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = |
| Zhao | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | = | ≠ |
| Zheng | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | = | ≠ | ≠ | ≠ | = |
| Admissible | 25 | 25 | 25 | 25 | 24 | 25 | 25 | 25 | 25 | 25 | 25 | 22 | 24 | 25 | 25 |
| Same $S$ | 26 | 26 | 26 | 26 | 25 | 25 | 26 | 26 | 26 | 23 | 22 | 12 | 16 | 19 | 24 |

## Reproduction error in units of the noise

*Purpose.* The admissibility threshold bounds the relative error $e_{\mathrm{fit}} = \|y(\hat{\theta}_{S\cup\Theta_C}) - y(\theta^{(k)})\|/\|\Delta y_{\mathrm{full}}\|$, the part of the change of the model response that the reduced model cannot reproduce after re-estimation. A relative error does not say whether the remaining discrepancy matters for the data: 40% of a change that is itself much smaller than the measurement noise is irrelevant, whereas 5% of a change of a hundred noise units is not. The threshold $\tau_e = \sqrt{1 - c^2} = 0.436$ follows from the cosine requirement $c = 0.9$ (Theorem 1 of the main text), which is a design choice; to judge it against the precision of the measurements we expressed the same error in absolute terms.

*Derivation.* The outputs of the method are scaled by the recorded noise, $y_i = h(g_i)/\sigma_i$, so a Euclidean

norm of a change of $y$ is measured in noise units. For scenario $k$ at $\pm 5\%$, with $n$ measurements,

$$\text{change}_k = \frac{\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)}\|}{\sqrt{n}}, \qquad \text{error}_k = e_{\text{fit}}^{(k)} \, \frac{\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)}\|}{\sqrt{n}} = \frac{\|y(\hat{\theta}_{S \cup \Theta_C}^{(k)}) - y(\theta^{(k)})\|}{\sqrt{n}}$$

are the root mean square per measurement of the change of the full model and of the error that remains after re-estimating the selected and calibration parameters, both in units of $\sigma$. An error below one means that, on average over the measurements, the reduced model reproduces the perturbed full model to within the noise of the data. The values of $e_{\text{fit}}^{(k)}$ are those of the robustness analysis at $\pm 5\%$ (the scenarios of the selection), and $\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}^{(k)}\|$ was recomputed with the same directions (`absolute_error.py` in the reproducibility package; results in `results/absolute_error/`).

*Results.* Supplementary Table S33 gives the median change, the median error and the largest error over the scenarios for every admissible problem. The median error is below $0.1\sigma$ in 17 of the 31 problems and below $\sigma$ in 29, and the largest error over the scenarios is below $\sigma$ in 27. The relative error and the absolute error answer different questions: Lucarelli, with the largest relative error (43.5%, on the threshold), has an absolute error of only $0.05\sigma$, because a $\pm 5\%$ perturbation changes its outputs by $0.13\sigma$; in Giordano and Perelson the perturbations change the outputs by far less than the noise ($10^{-4}\sigma$ or less), so their relative errors, although computed, have no consequence for the data. Conversely, in Okuonghae and Oliveira a $\pm 5\%$ perturbation changes the outputs by about 30 and 120 noise units, so a small relative error (4% and 13%) still leaves an error of about one and fourteen noise units; these are also the problems in which even the published $\theta_0$ fits the data far worse than the recorded noise (main text, *Prediction of held-out experiments*), which indicates that their recorded noise levels are much smaller than the actual scatter. An application that requires the reduced model to stay within the noise of its own data should therefore check this absolute error in addition to $e_{\text{fit}}$, or choose $c$ accordingly.

**Supplementary Table S33.** Reproduction error of the selected subsets in units of the recorded noise, over the scenarios at $\pm 5\%$. $n$: number of measurements; Valid: valid scenarios. Change: root mean square of $\Delta y_{\text{full}}$ per measurement, in units of $\sigma$ (median over the scenarios); Error: root mean square of the remaining error after re-estimation, $e_{\text{fit}}\|\Delta y_{\text{full}}\|/\sqrt{n}$ (median and maximum over the scenarios). A value below one means that the reduced model reproduces the perturbed full model to within the noise of the measurements.

| Problem | $n$ | Valid | Median $e_{\text{fit}}$ (%) | Change (RMS, $\sigma$) | Error (RMS, $\sigma$) | Max error |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 1733 | 15 | 12.1 | 0.30 | 0.03 | 0.04 |
| Armistead | 58 | 15 | 33.0 | 0.23 | 0.11 | 0.20 |
| Bachmann | 541 | 15 | 33.7 | 0.14 | 0.04 | 0.06 |
| Bertozzi | 22 | 15 | 32.9 | 0.33 | 0.16 | 0.26 |
| Blasi | 252 | 15 | 40.2 | 0.29 | 0.11 | 0.18 |
| Boehm | 48 | 15 | 9.4 | 0.13 | $9.4 \times 10^{-3}$ | 0.02 |
| Borghans | 111 | 15 | 4.3 | 0.87 | 0.03 | 1.01 |
| Brannmark | 43 | 15 | 7.8 | 0.81 | 0.06 | 0.14 |
| Bruno | 77 | 15 | 37.8 | 0.38 | 0.16 | 0.23 |
| Chen | 120 | 8 | 8.2 | 1.95 | 0.15 | 0.21 |
| Elowitz | 58 | 15 | 35.8 | 0.57 | 0.16 | 0.26 |
| Fiedler | 72 | 15 | 14.7 | 0.17 | 0.02 | 0.04 |
| Fujita | 144 | 15 | 29.4 | 0.72 | 0.22 | 0.33 |
| Giordano | 313 | 15 | 5.8 | $5.5 \times 10^{-5}$ | $3.6 \times 10^{-6}$ | $7.5 \times 10^{-6}$ |
| Isensee | 687 | 4 | 9.8 | 0.43 | 0.05 | 0.06 |
| Laske | 42 | 15 | 10.1 | 0.21 | 0.02 | 0.03 |
| Liu | 100 | 15 | 26.1 | 0.07 | 0.01 | 0.02 |

| Problem | $n$ | Valid | Median $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ (%) | Change (RMS, $\sigma$) | Error (RMS, $\sigma$) | Max error |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lucarelli | 1755 | 15 | 43.5 | 0.13 | 0.05 | 0.06 |
| Okuonghae | 92 | 15 | 4.1 | 31.56 | 1.18 | 3.68 |
| Oliveira | 120 | 15 | 12.9 | $1.2 \times 10^{2}$ | 13.74 | 46.98 |
| Perelson | 16 | 2 | 0.0 | $2.9 \times 10^{-7}$ | 0 | 0 |
| Rahman | 23 | 15 | 3.7 | 1.21 | 0.05 | 0.09 |
| Raia | 205 | 15 | 3.3 | 4.24 | 0.10 | 0.19 |
| Raimundez | 627 | 15 | 18.7 | 0.81 | 0.17 | 0.26 |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 18 | 15 | 18.7 | 0.74 | 0.11 | 0.27 |
| Schwen | 286 | 15 | 17.1 | 0.14 | 0.02 | 0.04 |
| Smith | 62 | 15 | 7.8 | 9.31 | 0.66 | 1.29 |
| Sneyd | 135 | 15 | 38.1 | 0.15 | 0.05 | 0.14 |
| Weber | 135 | 15 | 4.1 | 0.90 | 0.04 | 0.07 |
| Zhao | 82 | 15 | 29.6 | 0.42 | 0.15 | 0.23 |
| Zheng | 60 | 15 | 30.0 | 0.98 | 0.28 | 0.57 |

## Supplementary Note: Computational cost

The dominant cost of the selection is the number of model simulations: the relative sensitivity matrix $J$ by central differences needs $2p$ simulations and the stage-2 ordering by finite effects $p$ more, $3p$ in total; all of them are independent and can run in parallel. The greedy selection, the conditioning tests, backward elimination and the first-order $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ use only $J$ (linear algebra, negligible in comparison). The admissibility test adds, for each candidate subset, 15 scenario simulations and the re-estimations, whose cost depends on the number of retained parameters rather than on $p$. Supplementary Table S34 gives the measured time of one simulation of all measured outputs (all experimental conditions) at $\theta_0$ and the resulting time for the $3p$ simulations, in series and on four cores, for the problems timed.

**Supplementary Table S34.** Computational cost of the sensitivity computations: estimated parameters $p$, outputs used, time of one simulation, number of simulations for $J$ and the stage-2 ordering ($3p$), and total time in series and on four cores.

| Problem | $p$ | Outputs | $t_{\mathrm{sim}}$ (s) | $3p$ | Series | 4 cores |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Boehm | 9 | measured | 0.00168 | 27 | 0 s | 0 s |
| Elowitz | 21 | measured | 0.00243 | 63 | 0 s | 0 s |
| Fiedler | 22 | measured | 0.00257 | 66 | 0 s | 0 s |
| Smith | 25 | measured | 0.346 | 75 | 26 s | 6 s |
| Weber | 36 | measured | 0.00374 | 108 | 0 s | 0 s |
| Raia | 39 | measured | 0.0106 | 117 | 1 s | 0 s |
| Alkan | 44 | measured | 0.13 | 132 | 17 s | 4 s |
| Zheng | 46 | measured | 0.00449 | 138 | 1 s | 0 s |
| Isensee | 46 | measured | 0.64 | 138 | 88 s | 22 s |
| Giordano | 50 | measured | 0.00613 | 150 | 1 s | 0 s |
| Beer | 72 | measured | 0.173 | 216 | 37 s | 9 s |
| Lucarelli | 84 | measured | 0.04 | 252 | 10 s | 3 s |
| Bachmann | 113 | measured | 0.04 | 339 | 14 s | 3 s |
| Raimundez | 136 | measured | 0.37 | 408 | 3 min | 38 s |
| Chen | 155 | measured | 35 | 465 | 4.5 h | 68 min |
| Lang | 294 | measured | 0.65 | 882 | 10 min | 2 min |
| Froehlich | 4,231 | states | 2.93 | 12,693 | 10.3 h | 2.6 h |

The time of Smith was measured later on a different machine and scaled by the ratio of the times

of Boehm and Weber measured on both machines (factor 1.55). For Froehlich (4,231 parameters, 1,228 species) the analysis was carried out on the state trajectories; on its measured outputs each evaluation requires about 9,000 simulations (one per experimental condition), which was infeasible with the resources available.

### Time of the complete method and comparison with profile likelihood

The table above covers only the sensitivity computations. To measure the cost of the complete method, including the admissibility test (15 scenarios with re-estimation for every candidate subset) and backward elimination, we ran it from scratch, without any cached result, for all 34 problems, once with the sensitivity computations distributed over 16–64 cores and once on a single core per problem (Supplementary Table S35). The complete method took between 2 s and 33 min per problem (median 19 s) in parallel. Its cost is not proportional to $p$: it depends mostly on the simulation time and on the number of parameters re-estimated in the admissibility test, so that Smith (25 parameters, slow simulations, nine calibration parameters) took 19 min and Lang (294 parameters) about 3 min. Profile likelihood, with all the profile points of a problem computed simultaneously on 120 cores, was much slower whenever simulations are expensive (Alkan 27 min against 25 s; Isensee more than 1 h for the first round, and about 5 h including the re-estimations of the optimum, against 10 min; Zheng 5 min against 14 s), took 70 min for Bachmann and 11 min for Lucarelli, the two admissible problems with more than 60 free parameters in which it was run (on 60 cores; 10 and 35 s for our method), was not run for Chen and Raimundez, and was faster than our method on small problems, for which the fixed cost of the admissibility test dominates; over the 28 problems with both times our method was faster in 12. All runs shared a 128-core server with other computations, so the times are upper bounds; main-text Fig. 4d plots the two times against each other.

**Supplementary Table S35.** Computation time (seconds of wall-clock time) of our complete method (selection, admissibility test and backward elimination, run from scratch without cached results) with the sensitivity computations in parallel and on a single core, and of profile likelihood with all profile points of a problem computed in parallel (120 cores; 60 cores for Bachmann and Lucarelli, whose more than 60 free parameters were profiled in a separate run) (first round, and including the re-estimations of the optimum). Profile likelihood was not run for three reasons, given in the last column: not run, more than 60 free parameters and the most expensive simulations (Chen, Raimundez); no split, no training/test split on which to select (Blasi); not admissible, our method found no admissible subset, so there was nothing to compare. Our method was faster in 12 of the 28 problems with both times. All runs shared a 128-core server with other computations, so the times are upper bounds. For the eight problems treated to first order the parallel time is that of the run that reproduces the reported results (Supplementary Note *Reproducibility package*).

| Problem | $p$ | Ours, parallel | Ours, 1 core | Profile, 1st round | Profile, total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 44 | 25.4 | 46.0 | 1,645 | 1,645 | |
| Armistead | 14 | 6.8 | 5.9 | 2.7 | 2.7 | |
| Bachmann | 113 | 9.7 | 27.2 | 4,225 | 4,225 | |
| Beer | 72 | 197 | 309 | – | – | not admissible |
| Bertozzi | 8 | 3.2 | 4.3 | 0.5 | 0.5 | |
| Blasi | 9 | 4.5 | 4.5 | – | – | no split |
| Boehm | 9 | 4.5 | 3.4 | 0.2 | 0.2 | |
| Borghans | 23 | 17.9 | 37.1 | 30.7 | 124 | |
| Brannmark | 22 | 27.1 | 37.1 | 13.2 | 13.2 | |
| Bruno | 13 | 23.2 | 33.8 | 2.3 | 2.3 | |
| Chen | 155 | 1,959 | – | – | – | not run |

*(continued)*

| Problem | $p$ | Ours, parallel | Ours, 1 core | Profile, 1st round | Profile, total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Crauste | 12 | 36.4 | 51.1 | – | – | not admissible |
| Elowitz | 21 | 11.5 | 8.7 | 9.6 | 9.6 | |
| Fiedler | 22 | 17.0 | 12.1 | 0.6 | 0.6 | |
| Fujita | 19 | 77.8 | 78.8 | 25.9 | 25.9 | |
| Giordano | 50 | 12.5 | 16.9 | 123 | 123 | |
| Isensee | 46 | 584 | 1,415 | 4,453 | 18,861 | |
| Lang | 294 | 199 | – | – | – | not admissible |
| Laske | 13 | 26.9 | 28.1 | 5.3 | 5.3 | |
| Liu | 9 | 4.2 | 6.3 | 1.1 | 1.1 | |
| Lucarelli | 84 | 34.7 | 75.1 | 651 | 651 | |
| Okuonghae | 16 | 3.4 | 5.7 | 6.8 | 23.0 | |
| Oliveira | 12 | 5.0 | 10.9 | 5.1 | 5.1 | |
| Perelson | 3 | 2.1 | 2.7 | 0.4 | 0.4 | |
| Rahman | 9 | 2.9 | 4.2 | 2.1 | 2.1 | |
| Raia | 39 | 30.5 | 49.2 | 14.1 | 211 | |
| Raimundez | 136 | 120 | 306 | – | – | not run |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 6 | 67.5 | 37.6 | 13.9 | 13.9 | |
| Schwen | 30 | 92.9 | 147 | 110 | 110 | |
| Smith | 25 | 1,144 | 1,698 | 854 | 854 | |
| Sneyd | 15 | 20.7 | 17.6 | 4.0 | 4.0 | |
| Weber | 36 | 17.6 | 23.1 | 120 | 120 | |
| Zhao | 28 | 7.5 | 21.8 | 20.5 | 20.5 | |
| Zheng | 46 | 13.9 | 17.0 | 287 | 287 | |

## Supplementary Note: Computing time of the analyses

This note reports the computing time of every analysis of the paper, problem by problem, with the purpose of showing what it costs to select and verify a subset with the method, how that cost compares with the standard identifiability analysis, profile likelihood of the full model, and where the computing time of the whole study was spent.

### How the times were measured

Each program records, for every problem, the elapsed time of its computation (field `segundos` of the result files of the reproducibility package). Several analyses use parallelism within a problem: the selection distributes the columns of $J$ and the stage-2 ordering over 16 to 64 processes; the nested validation distributes the finite-difference Jacobian of each fit of the full model; profile likelihood of the full model computes all points of a problem in parallel on up to 120 cores. Other analyses consist of many independent single-core tasks (the seeds of the synthetic experiment, the scenarios and seeds of the admissibility test of the other criteria, the points of the identifiability profiles); for them the tables give the sum over the tasks, which is processor time and is larger than the elapsed time. The problems with expensive simulations were computed on shared servers with 128 and 256 cores and the others on an 8-core workstation; the times on shared servers are upper bounds, because other computations ran at the same time. The complete method was timed in a run from scratch, without cached sensitivities (Supplementary Table S35 compares it with profile likelihood).

### What the times show

*Selecting a subset is affordable.* The complete method took a median of 19 s per problem and less than ten minutes in 32 of the 34 problems; the slowest were Chen (33 min, 35 s per simulation), Smith (19 min) and Isensee (10 min). On one core the same computation took at most about three times longer (Supplementary Table S37).

*Verifying it is affordable too.* Determining the identifiability of the selected parameters (one fit of the reduced problem and the re-estimations at the profile points) took a median of 34 s per problem, and it was feasible in all 31 admissible problems, including those in which profile likelihood of the full model took hours or was not run (Supplementary Table S38). Profile likelihood of the full model, the standard identifiability analysis, took a median of 17 s in the 28 problems in which it was run (Supplementary Table S39), so on small problems it is as fast as our method, which was faster in 12 of these 28 problems; it took 70 min for Bachmann and 11 min for Lucarelli, and it was not run for Chen and Raimundez, for Blasi, which has no training/test split, or for the three problems without an admissible subset (Supplementary Table S35), in which the method and the identifiability check of the reduced problem still ran in minutes to hours.

*Where the computing time went.* All analyses of the study together took about 168 hours of computing time (Supplementary Table S36). Most of it was spent in analyses that re-estimate models many times and that are not part of the method: the variants of the method settings (50 h, because each variant reruns the complete method), the synthetic experiments (44 h over the three amplitudes), the identifiability profiles (26 h) and the tests of the subsets of the other criteria (25 h). Five problems with slow simulations or many calibration parameters, Isensee, Raimundez, Chen, Smith and Lang, account for 87% of the total, whereas the median over the problems of the time of all analyses together is 21 minutes.

**Supplementary Table S36.** Summary of the computing time per analysis over the problems of Supplementary Tables S37–S39: number of problems, median and maximum time per problem and total time.

| Analysis | Problems | Median | Maximum (problem) | Total (h) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Selection, parallel | 34 | 19 s | 32.6 min (Chen) | 1.3 |
| Selection, 1 core | 32 | 25 s | 28.3 min (Smith) | 1.3 |
| Settings (15 variants) | 28 | 2.6 min | 25.8 h (Raimundez) | 50.3 |
| Robustness, paired | 31 | 34 s | 22.1 min (Smith) | 1.4 |
| Robustness, independent | 31 | 27 s | 1.7 h (Smith) | 3.8 |
| Single parameter | 27 | 32 s | 1.6 h (Smith) | 3.2 |
| External validation | 29 | 7 s | 34.0 min (Smith) | 1.9 |
| Nested validation | 29 | <1 s | 11.0 min (Chen) | 0.4 |
| Synthetic, ±20%, 20 seeds | 29 | 2.8 min | 7.3 h (Chen) | 22.3 |
| Synthetic, ±5%, 10 seeds | 29 | 1.6 min | 2.8 h (Chen) | 8.6 |
| Synthetic, ±50%, 10 seeds | 29 | 2.6 min | 4.1 h (Chen) | 13.1 |
| True signal, 3 amplitudes | 29 | 31 s | 54.8 min (Chen) | 1.5 |
| Identifiability of $S$ | 31 | 34 s | 14.8 h (Chen) | 26.0 |
| Pivoted QR | 28 | <1 s | 1.9 min (Isensee) | 0.0 |
| Brun and Morris | 29 | 10 s | 29.6 min (Isensee) | 0.8 |
| Random subsets (20) | 29 | 4 s | 1.2 h (Isensee) | 1.6 |
| Calibration only | 28 | <1 s | 4.6 min (Isensee) | 0.1 |
| Criteria test, ±5% | 29 | 1.8 min | 13.8 h (Isensee) | 23.2 |
| Criteria test, ±20% | 29 | 33 s | 1.4 h (Smith) | 2.3 |
| Profile likelihood, full model | 28 | 17 s | 5.2 h (Isensee) | 7.6 |
| All analyses (selection on one core excluded) | | | | 169 |

**Supplementary Table S37.** Computing time of the method and of the analyses of its behaviour, for every problem. Selection: complete method (sensitivities, stages 1 and 2, admissibility test and backward elimination) run from scratch, with the sensitivities in parallel or on one core; Settings: the 15 variants of Supplementary Note *Sensitivity to the method settings* together; Robustness: seven perturbation sizes with paired or independent directions; Single parameter: Supplementary Note *Single-parameter subsets*. Times recorded by each program for each problem: elapsed time of the computation of that problem with the parallelism described in the text; where an analysis consists of independent single-core tasks (seeds, scenarios, profile points) the time is their sum, i.e. processor time. –, not computed (problem not admissible, not applicable or not run). Large problems were computed on shared servers with 128 or 256 cores, the others on an 8-core workstation; times on shared servers are upper bounds.

| Problem | *Selection, parallel* | *Selection, 1 core* | *Settings (15 variants)* | *Robustness, paired* | *Robustness, independent* | *Single parameter* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 25 s | 46 s | – | 47 s | 32 s | 1.0 h |
| Armistead | 7 s | 6 s | 56 s | 10 s | 6 s | 4 s |
| Bachmann | 10 s | 27 s | – | 34 s | 16 s | – |
| Beer | 3.3 min | 5.1 min | – | – | – | – |
| Bertozzi | 3 s | 4 s | 12 s | 4 s | 3 s | 2 s |
| Blasi | 4 s | 4 s | 1.3 min | 11 s | 9 s | 8 s |
| Boehm | 4 s | 3 s | 20 s | 11 s | 7 s | 6 s |
| Borghans | 18 s | 37 s | 2.6 min | 1.7 min | 1.1 min | 3.4 min |
| Brannmark | 27 s | 37 s | 3.5 min | 2.1 min | 1.6 min | 2.2 min |
| Bruno | 23 s | 34 s | 4.9 min | 22 s | 16 s | 8 s |
| Chen | 32.6 min | – | – | 7.0 min | 1.4 h | – |
| Crauste | 36 s | 51 s | 3.3 min | – | – | – |
| Elowitz | 12 s | 9 s | 2.2 min | 39 s | 28 s | 32 s |
| Fiedler | 17 s | 12 s | 1.9 min | 54 s | 38 s | 1.1 min |
| Fujita | 1.3 min | 1.3 min | 26.5 min | 9.6 min | 3.2 min | 3.0 min |
| Giordano | 12 s | 17 s | 1.0 min | 30 s | 20 s | 44 s |
| Isensee | 9.7 min | 23.6 min | – | 13.5 min | 11.5 min | – |
| Lang | 3.3 min | – | 18.8 h | – | – | – |
| Laske | 27 s | 28 s | 3.8 min | 4.6 min | 1.4 min | 30 s |
| Liu | 4 s | 6 s | 39 s | 46 s | 12 s | 12 s |
| Lucarelli | 35 s | 1.3 min | – | 46 s | 11 s | 3.9 min |
| Okuonghae | 3 s | 6 s | 16 s | 23 s | 6 s | 15 s |
| Oliveira | 5 s | 11 s | 36 s | 49 s | 12 s | 18 s |
| Perelson | 2 s | 3 s | 2 s | 5 s | 1 s | <1 s |
| Rahman | 3 s | 4 s | 11 s | 14 s | 5 s | 5 s |
| Raia | 30 s | 49 s | 4.9 min | <1 s | 2.2 min | 2.3 min |
| Raimundez | 2.0 min | 5.1 min | 25.8 h | 2.6 min | 2.7 min | – |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 1.1 min | 38 s | 5.0 min | 3 s | 1.5 min | 1.8 min |
| Schwen | 1.5 min | 2.5 min | 24.6 min | 10.7 min | 8.1 min | 14.3 min |
| Smith | 19.1 min | 28.3 min | 4.0 h | 22.1 min | 1.7 h | 1.6 h |
| Sneyd | 21 s | 18 s | 2.0 min | <1 s | 27 s | 36 s |
| Weber | 18 s | 23 s | 2.8 min | 32 s | 1.2 min | 2.8 min |
| Zhao | 8 s | 22 s | 2.5 min | 21 s | 17 s | 12 s |
| Zheng | 14 s | 17 s | 5.5 min | 22 s | 16 s | 21 s |

**Supplementary Table S38.** Computing time of the validation and identifiability analyses, for every problem: external and nested validation on real data, synthetic experiment (20 seeds at ±20%, 10 seeds at ±5% and ±50%), true signal $y(\theta^*) - y(\theta_0)$ at the three amplitudes, and the identifiability of the selected parameters (fit of the reduced problem and all profile points). Times recorded by each program for each problem: elapsed time of the computation of that problem with the parallelism described in the text; where an analysis consists of independent single-core tasks (seeds, scenarios, profile points) the time is their sum, i.e. processor time. –, not computed (problem not admissible, not applicable or not run). Large problems were computed on shared servers with 128 or 256 cores, the others on an 8-core workstation; times on shared servers are upper bounds.

| Problem | *External validation* | *Nested validation* | *Synthetic, ±20%, 20 seeds* | *Synthetic, ±5%, 10 seeds* | *Synthetic, ±50%, 10 seeds* | *True signal, 3 amplitudes* | *Identifiability of S* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 5.3 min | 6 s | 59.2 min | 23.6 min | 33.7 min | 1.5 min | 21.6 min |
| Armistead | <1 s | <1 s | 58 s | 10 s | 11 s | 26 s | <1 s |
| Bachmann | 4.8 min | 1.6 min | 1.6 h | 34.3 min | 53.5 min | 58 s | 35.2 min |
| Beer | – | – | – | – | – | – | – |
| Bertozzi | – | – | – | – | – | – | 1 s |
| Blasi | – | – | – | – | – | – | 5 s |
| Boehm | <1 s | <1 s | 24 s | 12 s | 10 s | 27 s | 4 s |
| Borghans | 6 s | <1 s | 1.4 min | 1.1 min | 2.6 min | 26 s | 34 s |
| Brannmark | 8 s | <1 s | 2.8 min | 1.6 min | 1.6 min | 29 s | 58 s |
| Bruno | <1 s | <1 s | 18 s | 8 s | 9 s | 25 s | 19 s |
| Chen | 31.3 min | 11.0 min | 7.3 h | 2.8 h | 4.1 h | 54.8 min | 14.8 h |
| Crauste | – | – | – | – | – | – | – |
| Elowitz | 6 s | <1 s | 1.4 min | 39 s | 42 s | 26 s | 22 s |
| Fiedler | 5 s | <1 s | 2.7 min | 1.1 min | 1.3 min | 43 s | 35 s |
| Fujita | 7 s | <1 s | 1.9 min | 1.0 min | 1.5 min | 30 s | 1.1 min |
| Giordano | 28 s | <1 s | 8.4 min | 5.0 min | 3.7 min | 43 s | 6 s |
| Isensee | 27.4 min | 10.6 min | 5.0 h | 1.7 h | 2.9 h | 13.2 min | 4.3 h |
| Lang | – | – | – | – | – | – | – |
| Laske | 3 s | <1 s | 1.4 min | 42 s | 41 s | 43 s | 1.2 min |
| Liu | <1 s | <1 s | 27 s | 12 s | 10 s | 27 s | 7 s |
| Lucarelli | 3.2 min | 49 s | 51.7 min | 23.6 min | 29.2 min | 1.2 min | 54.9 min |
| Okuonghae | 7 s | <1 s | 1.8 min | 54 s | 49 s | 25 s | 4 s |
| Oliveira | 2 s | <1 s | 46 s | 20 s | 20 s | 28 s | 6 s |
| Perelson | <1 s | <1 s | 12 s | 6 s | 5 s | 22 s | <1 s |
| Rahman | <1 s | <1 s | 30 s | 10 s | 12 s | 25 s | 1 s |
| Raia | 18 s | <1 s | 3.2 min | 1.6 min | 2.6 min | 31 s | 1.4 min |
| Raimundez | 3 s | 1.2 min | 57.9 min | 37.0 min | 1.3 h | 2.7 min | 4.0 h |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 21 s | 2 s | 4.7 min | 2.1 min | 3.0 min | 2.5 min | 40 s |
| Schwen | 39 s | 2 s | 12.5 min | 7.4 min | 9.7 min | 34 s | 6.2 min |
| Smith | 34.0 min | 19 s | 4.0 h | 1.3 h | 1.7 h | 3.8 min | 48.1 min |
| Sneyd | 2 s | <1 s | 43 s | 19 s | 34 s | 29 s | 20 s |
| Weber | 1.1 min | <1 s | 13.4 min | 5.9 min | 9.2 min | 31 s | 37 s |
| Zhao | 22 s | <1 s | 5.7 min | 3.1 min | 4.0 min | 27 s | 9 s |
| Zheng | 1.3 min | <1 s | 27.4 min | 10.7 min | 21.3 min | 33 s | 9 s |

**Supplementary Table S39.** Computing time of the comparison with other criteria, for every problem: selection and validation by pivoted QR, Brun and Morris, the random and calibration-only baselines, the admissibility and synthetic tests of the subsets of all criteria (±5%, including the synthetic seeds, and ±20%), and profile likelihood of every biological parameter of the full model (all rounds). Times recorded by each program for each problem: elapsed time of the computation of that problem with the parallelism described in the text; where an analysis consists of independent single-core tasks (seeds, scenarios, profile points) the time is their sum, i.e. processor time. –, not computed (problem not admissible, not applicable or not run). Large problems were computed on shared servers with 128 or 256 cores, the others on an 8-core workstation; times on shared servers are upper bounds.

| Problem | *Pivoted QR* | *Brun and Morris* | *Random subsets (20)* | *Calibration only* | *Criteria test, ±5%* | *Criteria test, ±20%* | *Profile likelihood, full model* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Alkan | 4 s | 1.9 min | 2.4 min | 5 s | 28.6 min | 50 s | 27.4 min |
| Armistead | <1 s | <1 s | <1 s | <1 s | 28 s | 14 s | 3 s |
| Bachmann | 1 s | 1.8 min | 10.1 min | 19 s | 1.5 h | 3.8 min | 1.2 h |
| Beer | – | – | – | – | – | – | – |
| Bertozzi | <1 s | 2 s | <1 s | <1 s | 16 s | 6 s | <1 s |
| Blasi | – | – | – | – | – | – | – |
| Boehm | <1 s | 3 s | <1 s | <1 s | 35 s | 10 s | <1 s |
| Borghans | <1 s | 6 s | 12 s | <1 s | 3.0 min | 1.3 min | 2.1 min |
| Brannmark | <1 s | 10 s | 5 s | <1 s | 4.3 min | 2.1 min | 13 s |
| Bruno | <1 s | 3 s | <1 s | <1 s | 39 s | 13 s | 2 s |
| Chen | – | – | – | – | – | – | – |
| Crauste | – | – | – | – | – | – | – |
| Elowitz | <1 s | 4 s | 2 s | <1 s | 1.1 min | 23 s | 10 s |
| Fiedler | <1 s | 6 s | 4 s | <1 s | 1.8 min | 34 s | <1 s |
| Fujita | <1 s | 9 s | 6 s | <1 s | 10.9 min | 2.9 min | 26 s |
| Giordano | <1 s | 12 s | <1 s | <1 s | 1.3 min | 23 s | 2.1 min |
| Isensee | 1.9 min | 29.6 min | 1.2 h | 4.6 min | 13.8 h | 25.5 min | 5.2 h |
| Lang | – | – | – | – | – | – | – |
| Laske | <1 s | 11 s | 6 s | <1 s | 3.7 min | 1.2 min | 5 s |
| Liu | <1 s | 3 s | <1 s | <1 s | 35 s | 11 s | 1 s |
| Lucarelli | 3 s | 1.4 min | 52 s | <1 s | 11.1 min | 33 s | 10.9 min |
| Okuonghae | <1 s | 10 s | <1 s | <1 s | 34 s | 9 s | 23 s |
| Oliveira | <1 s | 2 s | 1 s | <1 s | 40 s | 12 s | 5 s |
| Perelson | <1 s | 2 s | <1 s | <1 s | 6 s | 1 s | <1 s |
| Rahman | <1 s | 3 s | <1 s | <1 s | 16 s | 4 s | 2 s |
| Raia | <1 s | 11 s | 11 s | <1 s | 4.0 min | 1.8 min | 3.5 min |
| Raimundez | 18 s | 7.5 min | 10 s | 2 s | 2.9 h | 5.4 min | – |
| Salazar-Cavazos | 2 s | 12 s | 12 s | 2 s | 8.4 min | 1.6 min | 14 s |
| Schwen | <1 s | 28 s | 30 s | 2 s | 19.4 min | 6.5 min | 1.8 min |
| Smith | 5 s | 5.3 min | 8.0 min | 14 s | 3.1 h | 1.4 h | 14.2 min |
| Sneyd | <1 s | 3 s | 2 s | <1 s | 1.3 min | 25 s | 4 s |
| Weber | <1 s | 10 s | 4 s | <1 s | 2.4 min | 51 s | 2.0 min |
| Zhao | <1 s | 5 s | 2 s | <1 s | 44 s | 13 s | 20 s |
| Zheng | <1 s | 14 s | 2 s | <1 s | 1.0 min | 15 s | 4.8 min |

## Supplementary Note: The social cognitive theory model

The method was conceived while estimating a dynamical model of Bandura's social cognitive theory (SCT) of physical activity from the daily records of one participant (Miranda et al., 2025 IEEE Ecuador

Technical Chapters Meeting, doi:10.1109/ETCM67548.2025.11304524; cited in the main text). This note documents that case. It is not part of the PEtab benchmark (it is not an SBML/PEtab problem and its data are not public), it is not counted in any benchmark statistic, and its model was not translated into Lean; it is reported because it shows, on a small model with real data, the problem that the method addresses.

## Model and data

Six psychosocial constructs $x_1, \ldots, x_6$, of which $x_4$ is behaviour (daily steps), evolve as a linear system $\tau_i \dot{x}_i = -x_i + \sum_j \beta_{ij} x_j + \sum_k \gamma_{ik} u_k$, i.e. $\dot{x} = A(\theta)x + B(\theta)u$, $y = x_4$, with ten couplings $\beta_{14}, \beta_{21}, \beta_{25}, \beta_{31}, \beta_{34}, \beta_{42}, \beta_{43}, \beta_{45}, \beta_{46}, \beta_{54}$, six input gains $\gamma_{33}, \gamma_{35}, \gamma_{36}, \gamma_{57}, \gamma_{64}, \gamma_{68}$ ($\gamma_{35}$ with negative sign) and six time constants $\tau_1, \ldots, \tau_6$: 22 parameters. The data are 31 days of six measured inputs and daily steps, each standardised (z-score). The model is simulated from $x(0) = 0$ with inputs held constant over each day (exact discretisation with the matrix exponential), and the output of day $k$ is $x_4$ at the end of that day. Bounds are $\beta \in [-1.5, 1.5]$, $\gamma \in [0, 3]$, $\tau \in [0.3, 12]$, and only parameter values with stable dynamics ($\max \mathrm{Re}\, \lambda(A) \leq -10^{-3}$) are admitted.

## The problem that motivated the method

In that study, differential evolution reached $R^2 = 86.11\%$, but local refinement from that estimate with a Levenberg–Marquardt grey-box method reached only 11% and, after 20 recursive iterations, 41.17%: different parameter sets fitted the data with very different quality, and gradient-based refinement was unreliable. The estimate used here as $\theta_0$ was obtained with the same differential-evolution framework, with stability enforced and couplings of either sign (seed 2026, $R^2 = 0.881$). Repeating the search with 100 seeds gave fits of essentially the same quality ($R^2$ between 0.878 and 0.884) with very different parameters: 8 of the ten couplings change sign between runs, and most parameters span almost their whole admissible range (Supplementary Table S40). The data cannot separate the parameters, and fitting all 22 of them is ill-posed. Deciding which few parameters the data can inform, before fitting, is the question that the method answers.

**Supplementary Table S40.** Parameters of the SCT model: value at $\theta_0$, range over the 100 differential-evolution runs (all with $R^2 \geq 0.87$), sign change between runs, and share of the sensitivity energy $E_j / \sum_k E_k$ of behaviour at $\theta_0$.

| Parameter | $\theta_0$ | min | max | Energy share | Sign change |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $\beta_{14}$ | 0.628 | -1.49 | 1.47 | 0.4% | yes |
| $\beta_{21}$ | 1.09 | -1.49 | 1.43 | 0.4% | yes |
| $\beta_{25}$ | 0.333 | -1.46 | 1.47 | 0.1% | yes |
| $\beta_{31}$ | 0.74 | -1.48 | 1.29 | 0.0% | yes |
| $\beta_{34}$ | -0.756 | -1.47 | 1.27 | 0.0% | yes |
| $\beta_{42}$ | 1.08 | -1.43 | 1.49 | 0.5% | yes |
| $\beta_{43}$ | 0.00603 | -0.508 | 0.543 | 0.0% | yes |
| $\beta_{45}$ | 1.36 | 0.809 | 1.5 | 27.0% | – |
| $\beta_{46}$ | 0.247 | -1.49 | 1.46 | 0.0% | yes |
| $\beta_{54}$ | -0.732 | -1.5 | -0.561 | 8.5% | – |
| $\gamma_{33}$ | 2.91 | 0.00653 | 2.91 | 0.0% | – |
| $\gamma_{35}$ | 1.03 | 9.3e-04 | 2.98 | 0.0% | – |
| $\gamma_{36}$ | 1.49 | 0.0126 | 2.97 | 0.0% | – |
| $\gamma_{57}$ | 1.42 | 1.08 | 2.84 | 46.2% | – |
| $\gamma_{64}$ | 0.519 | 0.0832 | 3 | 0.0% | – |

**Supplementary Table S40.** Parameters of the SCT model: value at $\theta_0$, range over the 100 differential-evolution runs (all with $R^2 \geq 0.87$), sign change between runs, and share of the sensitivity energy $E_j / \sum_k E_k$ of behaviour at $\theta_0$.

| Parameter | $\theta_0$ | min | max | Energy share | Sign change |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $\gamma_{68}$ | 0.571 | 0.00602 | 2.89 | 0.0% | – |
| $\tau_1$ | 5.71 | 0.36 | 11.5 | 0.1% | – |
| $\tau_2$ | 4.82 | 0.469 | 11.1 | 0.1% | – |
| $\tau_3$ | 8.67 | 0.606 | 12 | 0.0% | – |
| $\tau_4$ | 0.462 | 0.308 | 1.05 | 7.0% | – |
| $\tau_5$ | 0.578 | 0.327 | 1.03 | 9.7% | – |
| $\tau_6$ | 10.9 | 0.609 | 12 | 0.0% | – |

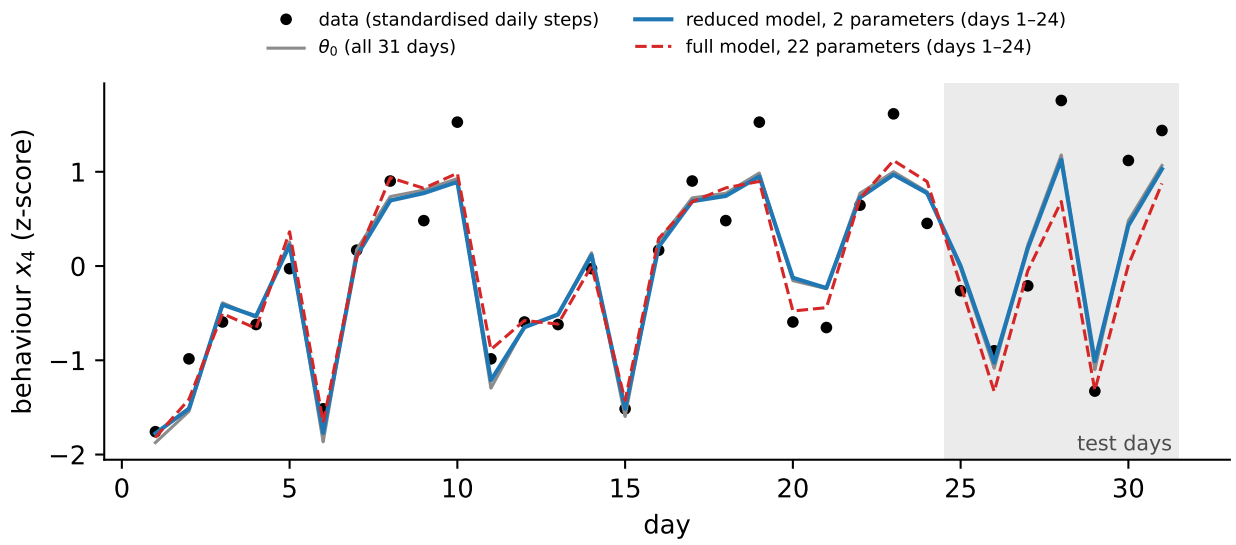
## What the method finds

**Collinearity.** The sensitivity matrix of behaviour at $\theta_0$ is exactly rank-deficient (infinite condition number, largest VIF $4.5 \times 10^{15}$), and 9 pairs of parameters have sensitivity vectors with cosine $\geq 0.95$, for example $\beta_{14}$–$\beta_{21}$ (1.000), $\tau_4$–$\tau_5$ (0.997), $\beta_{34}$–$\beta_{42}$ (0.984), $\beta_{14}$–$\beta_{31}$ (0.965).

**Selection.** Stage 1 reached $R_{\text{var}} = 74\%$ with 7 parameters, below the threshold of 89% because the remaining candidates failed the conditioning test; stage 2 selected two parameters, $\gamma_{57}$ and $\beta_{45}$ (condition number 4.2, VIF 5.0), which form the path from the external input through construct $x_5$ to behaviour and together carry 73% of the sensitivity energy. The conditioning test rejected redundant candidates such as $\tau_4$ and $\tau_5$, strongly collinear with $\beta_{45}$ (cosine about 0.8). Backward elimination removed nothing.

**Admissibility and robustness.** Re-estimating only these two parameters reproduces the output of the full model with a median $e_{\text{fit}}$ of 11.4% at ±5%, and between 10.6% and 15.1% for perturbations up to ±50% (pattern A). The median $\cos\Delta$ is 0.94 and $R_{\text{var}} = 0.73$, so the subset reaches level 2 of the guarantees defined in Supplementary Table S1.

**Prediction of unseen days.** Both models were refitted to days 1–24 (by least squares from $\theta_0$, within the bounds and with the stability constraint) and used to predict days 25–31 (Supplementary Fig. S15). The reduced model predicted the held-out week with $R^2 = 0.84$ (test $\chi^2/n$ 1.63), better than the full 22-parameter model ($R^2 = 0.67$, $\chi^2/n$ 3.44; refitted with the same differential-evolution search: $R^2 = 0.79$, $\chi^2/n$ 2.13), even though the full model fits the training days more closely ($\chi^2/n$ 0.65 versus 0.84). All refitted models are stable. The published estimate $\theta_0$, at which the non-selected parameters stay and from which both refits start, was obtained from all 31 days, and the standardisation of the data and the noise level were also computed on all days; this comparison is therefore an illustration anchored at $\theta_0$, not an independent prospective validation (Supplementary Note *Leakage-free nested validation*).




**Supplementary Figure S15. SCT model of one participant.** Standardised daily steps (dots), the fit of $\theta_0$ to all 31 days (grey), and the reduced (two parameters, blue) and full (22 parameters, red dashed) models refitted to days 1–24; the shaded region contains the seven test days.

### Relation with the formal results

The SCT model is linear with constant inputs on each day, so its vector field is globally Lipschitz and the existence and differentiability results of steps 14–18 (Supplementary Note *Logical sequence of the formal proofs*) apply directly; the model was not translated into Lean, so this is a mathematical observation rather than a machine-checked statement. The model shows on a small, transparent example the situation that the method is designed for: a good fit of the data, parameters that the data cannot determine, and a reduced set of two parameters that reproduces and predicts the measured behaviour.

## Supplementary Note: System-by-system summary

This note summarises, for each of the 34 benchmark problems, what the model describes, which parameters the method selected and what they mean in the model, how well the reduced model reproduces the full one, and how it predicted held-out data. The meaning of each selected parameter was taken from the reactions and rules of the SBML model in which it appears (following assignment rules and condition-specific parameters to the reactions they affect). The numbers are those of Table 1 of the main text and Supplementary Table S1: $p$ is the number of estimated parameters, $\kappa$ and VIF are the condition number and largest variance inflation factor of the selected sensitivity columns, $R_{\mathrm{var}}$ is the fraction of sensitivity energy kept, $\cos\Delta$ and $e_{\mathrm{fit}}$ are medians over 15 random scenarios at ±5% (threshold $\tau_e = 0.436$), the level of guarantee is defined in the Results of the main text, and the robustness patterns A–D are those of Fig. 5 of the main text. In the external validation, both the reduced and the full model are refitted to the training data, and the test $\chi^2/n$ (mean squared residual divided by the recorded noise variance; about 1 for a model that predicts within the noise) is computed on the held-out data. The published estimate $\theta_0$ was obtained with all the data, including the test data, so its test $\chi^2/n$ is a reference rather than a competing prediction, and the reduced model, whose non-selected parameters stay at $\theta_0$, inherits part of that information (Supplementary Note *Leakage-free nested validation*).

### Alkan_SciSignal2018

Cell-cycle progression, DNA double-strand-break damage and repair under chemotherapy (36 species). Source: `doi:10.1126/scisignal.aat0229`. The full model has 44 parameters, 10 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `kt` and `k_rep_nhej` (stage 1, ranking by sensitivity energy); the reduced problem has 73% fewer free parameters than the full one. `kt` is the cell-cycle transition rate, shared by the transitions G1→S, S→G2 and G2→division; `k_rep_nhej` is the rate of repair by non-homologous end joining, which returns damaged S and G2 cells to the cycle. For this subset $\kappa = 1.3$ and VIF 1.1 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 94\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.98$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 12.1\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 3 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ and $R_{\text{var}} \geq 0.89$); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (555 test and 1178 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 2.75 for the reduced model, 3.37 for the full model refitted to the same data and 2.47 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. The model was not verified in Lean because the automatic checks of the domain and quasi-positivity conditions fail.

### Armistead_CellDeathDis2024

Ceramide and sphingolipid metabolism (4 species). Source: `doi:10.1038/s41419-024-07134-2`. The full model has 14 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `k_d` and `k00` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 86% fewer free parameters than the full one. `k_d` is the degradation rate of ceramide; `k00` is the basal rate of de novo production of sphinganine. For this subset $\kappa = 1.0$ and VIF 1.0 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 58\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.81$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 33.0\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern B: admissible up to $\pm 30\%$ but not at $\pm 40\%$ or $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (29 test and 29 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 1.22 for the reduced model, 1.37 for the full model refitted to the same data and 1.16 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Bachmann_MSB2011

JAK2/STAT5 signalling induced by erythropoietin (Epo) with negative feedback by CIS and SOCS3 (25 species). Source: `doi:10.1038/msb.2011.50`. The full model has 113 parameters, 74 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `CISRNADelay` and `JAK2ActEpo` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 33% fewer free parameters than the full one. `JAK2ActEpo` is the rate of Epo-induced activation of JAK2 at the receptor (EpoR:JAK2 → EpoR:pJAK2); `CISRNADelay` is the transit rate through the chain of delay compartments of CIS mRNA, i.e. it sets the delay of the CIS feedback. For this subset $\kappa = 2.8$ and VIF 2.5 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 36\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.85$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 33.7\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (202 test and 339 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 4.77 for the reduced model, 7.35 for the full model refitted to the same data and 1.05 for

the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. Profile likelihood of the full model, computed in a separate run (70 min on 60 cores, 40 h of computing time, against 10 s for our method), selects `STAT5Imp` and `CISRNADelay`; this subset is also admissible and predicts the test data equally well (Supplementary Note *Profile likelihood*). The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Beer_MolBioSystems2014

Growth of bacterial cultures and production of the pigment indigoidine by engineered synthetase variants (4 species, 19 conditions). Source: `doi:10.1039/c3mb70594c`. The full model has 72 parameters. **Not admissible.** The selection stopped at 18 parameters (synthesis, dimerisation and degradation rates of particular strains, growth rates $\beta$ of particular experiments and the initial amount of bacteria), because any further parameter violated the conditioning test ($\kappa = 7.2$, VIF 9.998, just below the limit of 10). Re-estimating these 18 parameters gave a median $e_{\text{fit}}$ of 50%, above the threshold of 43.6%; the outputs depend on many strain- and experiment-specific parameters, and no small subset can compensate for all of them. The Lean verification of this model is only conditional, because the growth check fails.

### Bertozzi_PNAS2020

SIR model of the COVID-19 epidemic, fitted to two regions (3 species). Source: `doi:10.1073/pnas.2006520117`. The full model has 8 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `R0_NY` and `I0_NY` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 75% fewer free parameters than the full one. `R0_NY` is the basic reproduction number in New York, which sets the infection rate; `I0_NY` is the initial number of infected individuals in New York. For this subset $\kappa = 3.9$ and VIF 4.3 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 78\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.92$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 32.9\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern B: admissible up to $\pm 20\%$ but not at $\pm 30\%$ or more.

External validation was not possible: both selected parameters belong only to the held-out condition, so they cannot be estimated from the training data. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Blasi_CellSystems2016

Acetylation of the four lysines of histone H4 (16 acetylation states). Source: `doi:10.1016/j.cels.2016.01.002`. The full model has 9 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `a_basal` and `a_k16_k12k16` (stage 1, ranking by sensitivity energy); backward elimination had removed `a_k12k16_k8k12k16`, `a_k5k12_k5k8k12` and `a_k8k12k16_4ac` from the initial selection; the reduced problem has 78% fewer free parameters than the full one. `a_basal` is the basal acetylation rate, from which most of the transition rates are derived by assignment rules; `a_k16_k12k16` is the rate of acetylation of K12 in H4 already acetylated at K16. For this subset $\kappa = 1.8$ and VIF 1.4 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 79\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.91$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 40.2\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, although only just within the threshold, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern B: admissible up to $\pm 20\%$ but not at $\pm 30\%$ or more.

External validation was not possible: the problem has a single condition and a single measurement time, so the data cannot be split. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Boehm_JProteomeRes2014

Phosphorylation, dimerisation and nuclear import of STAT5A and STAT5B (8 species). Source: `doi:10.1021/pr5006923`. The full model has 9 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `k_imp_hetero` and `k_phos` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 78% fewer free parameters than the full one. `k_phos` is the rate of phosphorylation and dimerisation of STAT5 (the three reactions forming pApA, pApB and pBpB); `k_imp_hetero` is the rate of nuclear import of the heterodimer pApB. For this subset $\kappa = 1.0$ and VIF 1.0 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 68\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.93$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 9.4\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on later time points ($t \geq 80$; 18 test and 30 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 2.57 for the reduced model, 11.22 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.34 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data much better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Borghans_BiophysChem1997

Intracellular $Ca^{2+}$ oscillations by $Ca^{2+}$-induced $Ca^{2+}$ release (3 species). Source: `doi:10.1016/s0301-4622(97)00010-0`. The full model has 23 parameters, 2 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `Kz` and `K_par` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 83% fewer free parameters than the full one. `Kz` is the threshold constant of the release of $Ca^{2+}$ from the $Ca^{2+}$-sensitive pool into the cytosol; `K_par` is the constant of the removal of cytosolic $Ca^{2+}$. For this subset $\kappa = 2.7$ and VIF 2.4 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 21\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.86$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 4.3\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on later time points ($t \geq 6.48875$; 37 test and 74 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 0.74 for the reduced model, 0.74 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.74 for the published $\theta_0$. The two refitted models predict equally well. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Brannmark_JBC2010

Insulin signalling in adipocytes: insulin receptor and IRS1 phosphorylation and internalisation (9 species). Source: `doi:10.1074/jbc.M110.106849`. The full model has 22 parameters, 3 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `k1f` and `km2` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 77% fewer free parameters than the full one. `k1f` is the rate of dephosphorylation and recycling of the internalised phosphorylated receptor (IRiP $\rightarrow$ IRi); `km2` is the rate of dephosphorylation of IRS1 (IRSiP $\rightarrow$ IRS). For this subset $\kappa = 1.9$ and VIF 1.4 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 32\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.85$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 7.8\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (26 test and 17 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 5.96 for the reduced model, 6,277 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.94 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data much better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified*

*benchmark models*).

### Bruno_JExpBot2016

Enzymatic cleavage of carotenoids ($\beta$-carotene, $\beta$-cryptoxanthin, zeaxanthin) into apocarotenoids (7 species, 6 experiments). Source: `doi:10.1093/jxb/erw356`. The full model has 13 parameters. The method selected five biological parameters, `kb1`, `init_bcar2`, `init_zea_1`, `init_bcar1` and `init_bcry_1` (stage 1, ranking by sensitivity energy); backward elimination had removed `szea` and `init_b10_1` from the initial selection; the reduced problem has 62% fewer free parameters than the full one. `kb1` is the cleavage rate of $\beta$-carotene; the other four are initial amounts of the substrates in particular experiments: $\beta$-carotene (`init_bcar1`, `init_bcar2`), zeaxanthin (`init_zea_1`) and $\beta$-cryptoxanthin (`init_bcry_1`). For this subset $\kappa = 2.3$ and VIF 1.6 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 75\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.90$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 37.8\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (28 test and 49 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 0.91 for the reduced model, 208 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.91 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data much better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Chen_MSB2009

ErbB receptor network (ErbB1–4) with the MAPK and PI3K/AKT cascades (500 species). Source: `doi:10.1038/msb.2008.74`. The full model has 155 parameters, 3 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `k106` and `k44` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 97% fewer free parameters than the full one. `k106` is the binding rate of PIP2 to the receptor complexes that carry PI3K; `k44` is the binding rate of MEK to phosphorylated Raf, the first step of MEK activation. For this subset $\kappa = 1.0$ and VIF 1.0 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 25\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.90$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 8.2\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (30 test and 90 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 20.88 for the reduced model, 17.71 for the full model refitted to the same data and 15.22 for the published $\theta_0$. Here the refitted full model predicts the test data better than the reduced model; $\chi^2/n \gg 1$ for all three indicates that the benchmark noise levels do not match the scatter of the data. During the admissibility test and the full-model re-estimation the CVODE integrator occasionally reduces the step size to near-machine-precision ($h \approx 10^{-13}$) for parameter combinations that approach the boundaries of the ODE solution domain; these are recorded as integration failures, the corresponding scenarios are excluded from the median, and the remaining scenarios determine admissibility. This behaviour is deterministic for a given parameter combination but may differ across floating-point environments; because the model passes the admissibility test with comfortable margin ($e_{\text{fit}} = 8.2\% \ll \tau_e$), and the synthetic experiment confirms the reduction, this does not affect the conclusions. In the synthetic experiment, the reduced model achieved $e_{\text{pred}} = 0.076$ ($\leq \tau_e$), correctly recovering the true parameter change, whereas the full model gave $e_{\text{pred}} = 1.00$, identical to the uninformative baseline $\theta_0$. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Crauste_CellSystems2017

CD8 T-cell response to infection: naive, early and late effector and memory cells and pathogen (5 species). Source: `doi:10.1016/j.cels.2017.01.014`. The full model has 12 parameters. **Not admissible.** The published parameters lie at the edge of a regime in which the solution grows without bound in finite time: changing a single parameter by 1% (for example, decreasing the proliferation rate of early effectors $\rho_E$) makes the effector populations grow from about $5 \times 10^2$ to $5 \times 10^5$ cells within four days, after which no solution exists on the measured horizon. This happened for 8–9 of the 24 one-at-a-time perturbations of $\pm 1\%$ and for 7 of the 15 scenarios at $\pm 5\%$, so the sensitivity matrix and the admissibility test are not defined and no local reduction method is applicable. Consistently, the existence of solutions could only be proved in Lean on a short horizon ($T \leq 1$, Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Elowitz_Nature2000

The repressilator, a synthetic oscillator of three mutually repressing genes with a GFP reporter (8 species). Source: `doi:10.1038/35002125`. The full model has 21 parameters, 2 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `n_Hill` and `tau_mRNA` (stage 1, ranking by sensitivity energy); backward elimination had removed `tau_prot`, `tau_prot_GFP` and `eff` from the initial selection; the reduced problem has 81% fewer free parameters than the full one. `n_Hill` is the Hill coefficient of transcriptional repression, shared by the four transcription reactions; `tau_mRNA` is the mRNA lifetime, which enters the degradation of the three mRNAs and the translation rates. For this subset $\kappa = 2.9$ and VIF 2.6 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 70\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.89$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 35.8\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern B: admissible up to $\pm 10\%$; at $\pm 20\%$ the median $e_{\text{fit}}$ (43.62%) exceeds the threshold (43.59%) by a small margin, and it stays above it at larger changes.

External validation on later time points ($t \geq 410$; 20 test and 38 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 1.50 for the reduced model, 3.89 for the full model refitted to the same data and 1.38 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Fiedler_BMCSystBiol2016

RAF/MEK/ERK cascade with ERK feedback, under different inhibitor treatments (6 species). Source: `doi:10.1186/s12918-016-0319-7`. The full model has 22 parameters, 8 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `tau2` and `k6` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 55% fewer free parameters than the full one. `tau2` is a time constant of the activation input of RAF; `k6` is the rate of dephosphorylation of pERK, and it also enters the steady state from which every simulation starts. For this subset $\kappa = 1.5$ and VIF 1.2 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 42\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.87$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 14.7\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (20 test and 52 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 11.21 for the reduced model, 9.32 for the full model refitted to the same data and 1.22 for the published $\theta_0$. Here the refitted full model predicts the test data better than the reduced model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Fujita_SciSignal2010

EGF-dependent AKT signalling and S6 phosphorylation (9 species). Source: `doi:10.1126/scisignal.2000810`. The full model has 19 parameters, 3 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `init_AKT` and `reaction_6_k1` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 74% fewer free parameters than the full one. `init_AKT` is the initial amount of AKT; `reaction_6_k1` is the rate of release of pAKT and pS6 from the pAKT:S6 complex, i.e. of S6 phosphorylation. For this subset $\kappa = 2.3$ and VIF 1.9 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 36\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.77$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 29.4\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (48 test and 96 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 5.94 for the reduced model, 8.03 for the full model refitted to the same data and 5.63 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Giordano_Nature2020

SIDARTHE model of the COVID-19 epidemic in Italy, with parameters that change at the dates of the containment measures (8 species). Source: PubMed 32322102. The full model has 50 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `alpha_4` and `alpha_28` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 96% fewer free parameters than the full one. `alpha_4` and `alpha_28` are the transmission coefficient $\alpha$ (infection by undetected asymptomatic individuals) after the changes of day 4 and day 28. For this subset $\kappa = 3.7$ and VIF 3.9 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 74\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.97$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 5.8\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on later time points ($t \geq 30$; 112 test and 201 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ $<0.01$ for the reduced model, $<0.01$ for the full model refitted to the same data and $<0.01$ for the published $\theta_0$. All fits reproduce the data almost exactly, so the comparison is not informative. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Isensee_JCB2018

Activation of protein kinase A type II by cAMP in sensory neurons (25 species). Source: `doi:10.1083/jcb.201708053`. The full model has 46 parameters, 11 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `kf_RIIp_C_2__RII_C_2` and `xi_kf_RII_C_2__RII_2` (stage 1, ranking by sensitivity energy); backward elimination had removed `ks_AC_cAMP`, `KD_cAMP`, `xi_AC_cAMP_Fsk`, `kf_RIIp_cAMP_C_2__RIIp_2` and `kf_RII_2__RII_C_2` from the initial selection; the reduced problem has 72% fewer free parameters than the full one. `kf_RIIp_C_2__RII_C_2` is the rate of dephosphorylation of the regulatory subunit within the holoenzyme ($pRII_2{:}C_2 \rightarrow RII_2{:}C_2$); `xi_kf_RII_C_2__RII_2` is the factor that scales the dissociation of the catalytic subunits from the phosphorylated holoenzyme. For this subset $\kappa = 1.0$ and VIF 1.0 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 68\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.87$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 7.6\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (219 test and 468 training measurements): test

$\chi^2/n$ 1.08 for the reduced model, 1.08 for the full model refitted to the same data and 1.04 for the published $\theta_0$. Here the refitted full model predicts the test data better than the reduced model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Lang_PLOSComputBiol2024

Mammalian cell cycle (E2F, RB, cyclins and CDK inhibitors) in the cytoplasm and nucleus (several hundred species). Source: `doi:10.1371/journal.pcbi.1011151`. The full model has 294 parameters, 16 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. **Not admissible.** Ranking by finite-perturbation effects (stage 2), the selection stopped at 13 parameters (`kDeE2f1`, `kDeCe`, `kDeCa2`, `kPhCAEB`, `kDpCdh`, `kImImSKP2_1`, `kImImCDKN1A_CCNE_A_B_Ser130p__1`, `ic_wt_Nuc__CDKN1B_CCNE_A_Thr187p_`, `ic_wt_Cyt__CDKN1B_CCNE_A_Thr187u_`, `ic_wt_Nuc__SKP2`, `ic_wt_Cyt__CCNE_CDKN1A_B_`, `ic_wt_Cyt__SKP2` and `ic_wt_Cyt__CCNE_CDKN1A_B_1__CDKN1A_CCNE_A_B_1_Ser130u_`), because any further parameter violated the conditioning test ($\kappa = 8.7$, VIF 9.99, just below the limit of 10). Re-estimating these 13 parameters gave a median first-order $e_{\text{fit}}$ of 56%, above the threshold of 43.6%. Admissible pairs nevertheless exist: on the same scenarios, the search with conditioning thresholds of 5 or 30 instead of 10 (Supplementary Note *Random scenarios and large problems*, Supplementary Table S14) adds a different second parameter and finds {`kDeE2f1`, `kSySkp2`} ($e_{\text{fit}} = 13\%$) and {`kDeE2f1`, `kSyCb1`} ($e_{\text{fit}} = 16\%$). With the default threshold the second parameter is `kDeCe`, whose pair is not admissible, and the greedy search then grows until the conditioning limit without becoming admissible; the failure is therefore a limitation of the greedy search in this oscillating cell-cycle model (simulated to $t = 136{,}472$), not evidence that no small subset exists. Our simulation of this model also differs from the reference simulation of the benchmark more than in any other problem (22% of the measurements by more than one noise unit; Supplementary Note *Verification of the simulator*), so this result should be read with that caveat.

### Laske_PLOSComputBiol2019

Influenza A virus replication: nuclear import of viral ribonucleoproteins and viral RNA synthesis. Source: `doi:10.1371/journal.pcbi.1006944`. The full model has 13 parameters, 2 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `k_imp` and `k_syn_R_M` (stage 1, ranking by sensitivity energy); backward elimination had removed `k_bind_M1` from the initial selection; the reduced problem has 69% fewer free parameters than the full one. `k_imp` is the rate of nuclear import of viral ribonucleoproteins (cytoplasm $\rightarrow$ nucleus); `k_syn_R_M` is the synthesis rate of viral mRNA, from which the rates of the eight mRNA segments are derived. For this subset $\kappa = 1.4$ and VIF 1.1 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 84\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.99$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 10.1\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (9 test and 33 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 0.76 for the reduced model, 1.87 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.44 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Liu_IFACPapersOnLine2025

Virus–cell model: uninfected cells with logistic growth, five stages of infected cells and free virus (7 states, written as rate rules). Source: `doi:10.1016/j.ifacol.2025.07.160`. The full model has 9 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `kappa` and `phi` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 78% fewer free parameters than the full one. `kappa` is the carrying capacity of the logistic growth of the cells; `phi` is the rate of transition between successive stages of infection. For this subset $\kappa = 1.3$ and VIF 1.1 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 81\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.92$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 26.1\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (50 test and 50 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 0.95 for the reduced model, 1.02 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.94 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. The model was not verified in Lean because the model has events that depend on the state.

### Lucarelli_CellSystems2018

TGF-$\beta$/SMAD signalling and the expression of its target genes (several dozen species). Source: `doi:10.1016/j.cels.2017.11.010`. The full model has 84 parameters. The method selected ten biological parameters, `init_Rec`, `S2tot`, `S3tot`, `S_dephosphos`, `S_phos`, `geneF_turn`, `k_234`, `geneK_turn`, `S4tot` and `geneH_turn` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 88% fewer free parameters than the full one. `init_Rec` is the amount of receptor; `S2tot`, `S3tot` and `S4tot` are the total amounts of SMAD2, SMAD3 and SMAD4; `S_phos` and `S_dephosphos` are the rates of phosphorylation and dephosphorylation of SMAD2/3; `k_234` is the rate of formation of the ppSMAD2:ppSMAD3:SMAD4 complex; `geneF_turn`, `geneH_turn` and `geneK_turn` are the turnover rates of three target genes. For this subset $\kappa = 6.5$ and VIF 9.8 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 64\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.81$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 43.5\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, although only just within the threshold, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern C: irregular, with an error that stays close to the threshold and crosses it at some sizes.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (598 test and 1157 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 1.66 for the reduced model, 3.34 for the full model refitted to the same data and 1.02 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. Profile likelihood of the full model, computed in a separate run (11 min on 60 cores, 9 h of computing time, against 35 s for our method), selects ten parameters, four of them shared with our subset; they predict the test data better (test $\chi^2/n$ 1.08) but do not reproduce the full model (median $e_{\text{fit}}$ 0.74; Supplementary Note *Profile likelihood*). The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Okuonghae_ChaosSolitonsFractals2020

Model of the COVID-19 epidemic in Lagos, Nigeria, with detected and undetected infected classes (9 species). Source: `doi:10.1016/j.chaos.2020.110032`. The full model has 16 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `transmission_rate_effective` and `gamma_i` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 88% fewer free parameters than the full one. `transmission_rate_effective` is the effective transmission rate (force of infection, susceptible $\to$ exposed); `gamma_i` is the recovery rate of detected infected individuals. For this subset $\kappa = 1.3$ and VIF 1.1 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 53\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 1.00$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 4.1\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A:

admissible at all perturbation sizes up to ±50%.

External validation on later time points ($t \geq 32$; 32 test and 60 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 46,705 for the reduced model, 122,443 for the full model refitted to the same data and 28,748 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. Even $\theta_0$ has $\chi^2/n \gg 1$, which indicates that the noise levels recorded in the benchmark do not match the scatter of the data. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Oliveira_NatCommun2021

Model of the COVID-19 epidemic in Bahia, Brazil, with hospital and intensive-care compartments. Source: `doi:10.1038/s41467-020-19798-3`. The full model has 12 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `beta_0` and `h_hosp_rate` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 83% fewer free parameters than the full one. `beta_0` is the transmission rate (susceptible → exposed); `h_hosp_rate` is the fraction of symptomatic individuals who are hospitalised, which splits the outflow of symptomatic cases between recovery, hospital and ICU. For this subset $\kappa = 1.2$ and VIF 1.0 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 47\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.95$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 12.9\%$ at ±5%: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to ±50%.

External validation on later time points ($t \geq 40$; 40 test and 80 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 912 for the reduced model, 81,349 for the full model refitted to the same data and 460,396 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model, which fits the training data closely ($\chi^2/n$ 8.75) but predicts the test data poorly, a sign of overfitting. Even $\theta_0$ has $\chi^2/n \gg 1$, which indicates that the noise levels recorded in the benchmark do not match the scatter of the data. The model was not verified in Lean because the model has events that depend on the parameters.

### Perelson_Science1996

HIV-1 dynamics in a patient treated with a protease inhibitor (infected cells, infectious and non-infectious virus). Source: `doi:10.1126/science.271.5255.1582`. The full model has 3 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `c` and `delta` (stage 1, ranking by sensitivity energy); the reduced problem has 33% fewer free parameters than the full one. `c` is the clearance rate of free virions; `delta` is the death rate of productively infected cells. For this subset $\kappa = 1.9$ and VIF 1.5 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 100\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 1.00$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 0.0\%$ at ±5%: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 3 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ and $R_{\text{var}} \geq 0.89$); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to ±50%.

External validation on later time points ($t \geq 2.038$; 6 test and 10 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ <0.01 for the reduced model, <0.01 for the full model refitted to the same data and <0.01 for the published $\theta_0$. All fits reproduce the data almost exactly, so the comparison is not informative. The model was not verified in Lean because the quasi-positivity check fails for two terms.

### Rahman_MBS2016

Transmission model with infected classes of different severity and a treated class. Source: `doi:10.1016/j.mbs.2016.07.009`. The full model has 9 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `infected_moderate_transmission_rate` and `infected_normal_worsen_rate` (stage 2,

ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 78% fewer free parameters than the full one. `infected_moderate_transmission_rate` is the transmission rate of moderately infected individuals, to which the rates of the other classes are tied by assignment rules (it sets the force of infection); `infected_normal_worsen_rate` is the rate of progression from normal to moderate infection. For this subset $\kappa = 5.9$ and VIF 9.3 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 60\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.97$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 3.7\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on later time points ($t \geq 15$; 8 test and 15 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ <0.01 for the reduced model, 0.03 for the full model refitted to the same data and <0.01 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model, which fits the training data closely ($\chi^2/n$ <0.01) but predicts the test data poorly, a sign of overfitting. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Raia_CancerResearch2011

IL-13 signalling through JAK/STAT6 with SOCS3 feedback in Hodgkin lymphoma cells (several dozen parameters, 4 conditions). Source: `doi:10.1158/0008-5472.CAN-10-2987`. The full model has 39 parameters, 5 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `SOCS3mRNA_production` and `init_Rec_i` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 82% fewer free parameters than the full one. `SOCS3mRNA_production` is the production rate of SOCS3 mRNA, which drives the negative feedback; `init_Rec_i` is the initial amount of internalised receptor, which is recycled to the membrane. For this subset $\kappa = 5.5$ and VIF 8.1 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 69\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 1.00$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 3.3\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (72 test and 133 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 8.22 for the reduced model, 5.10 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.42 for the published $\theta_0$. Here the refitted full model predicts the test data better than the reduced model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Raimundez_PCB2020

EGFR and MET signalling in two gastric cancer cell lines (MKN1 and HS746T) treated with EGF, HGF and cetuximab. Source: `doi:10.1371/journal.pcbi.1007147`. The full model has 136 parameters, 79 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `kdeg_membran__MKN1` and `ka_MAPK__MKN1` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 40% fewer free parameters than the full one. `kdeg_membran__MKN1` is the degradation rate of membrane receptors (EGFR, EGFR:EGF, EGFR:cetuximab) in MKN1 cells; `ka_MAPK__MKN1` is the rate constant of MAPK (ERK) phosphorylation in MKN1 cells; its published value lies at the upper bound of the benchmark range ($10^3$). For this subset $\kappa = 1.3$ and VIF 1.1 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 42\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.79$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 18.7\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (208 test and 419 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 1.17 for the reduced model, 1.43 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.98 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### SalazarCavazos_MBoC2020

Multisite phosphorylation of the epidermal growth factor receptor (EGFR). Source: `doi:10.1091/mbc.E19-09-0548`. The full model has 6 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `ratio_kpkd_Y1068__FREE` and `ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 67% fewer free parameters than the full one. `ratio_kpkd_Y1068__FREE` and `ratio_kpkd_YN__FREE` are the ratios of phosphorylation to dephosphorylation rate of tyrosine Y1068 and of the other tyrosines in receptors that are not bound to adaptor proteins. For this subset $\kappa = 5.4$ and VIF 7.9 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 84\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.97$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 18.7\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (3 test and 15 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 102 for the reduced model, 124 for the full model refitted to the same data and 96.93 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. Even $\theta_0$ has $\chi^2/n \gg 1$, which indicates that the noise levels recorded in the benchmark do not match the scatter of the data. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Schwen_PONE2014

Binding and uptake of insulin by hepatocytes through receptors of low and high affinity. Source: `doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0133653`. The full model has 30 parameters, 15 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `ini_R1` and `ini_R2fold` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 43% fewer free parameters than the full one. `ini_R1` is the initial amount of low-affinity receptors, and `ini_R2fold` the factor that gives the amount of high-affinity receptors from it; both set the binding and uptake of insulin. For this subset $\kappa = 3.1$ and VIF 3.0 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 46\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.93$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 17.1\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (19 test and 267 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 8.20 for the reduced model, 8.40 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.77 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. The model was not verified in Lean because the quasi-positivity check fails for two terms.

### Smith_BMCSystBiol2013

Insulin signalling through IRS1, PI3K and serine phosphorylation of IRS1. Source: `doi:10.1186/1752-0509-7-41`. The full model has 25 parameters, 9 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `k8` and `kminus7b` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 56% fewer free parameters than the full one. `k8` is the binding rate of PI3K to tyrosine-phosphorylated IRS1; `kminus7b` is the rate of removal of the serine phosphorylation of IRS1 (reverse of the inhibitory serine phosphorylation). For this subset $\kappa = 3.2$ and VIF 3.1 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 41\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.96$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 7.8\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (15 test and 47 training measurements): test

$\chi^2/n$ 14,977 for the reduced model, 14,976 for the full model refitted to the same data and 82,921 for the published $\theta_0$. The two refitted models predict equally well. Even $\theta_0$ has $\chi^2/n \gg 1$, which indicates that the noise levels recorded in the benchmark do not match the scatter of the data. The model was not verified in Lean because the rate laws contain a non-differentiable maximum.

### Sneyd_PNAS2002

Gating of the $IP_3$ receptor $Ca^{2+}$ channel (open, shut and inactivated states). Source: `doi:10.1073/pnas.032281999`. The full model has 15 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `l4` and `l2` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 87% fewer free parameters than the full one. `l2` and `l4` are rate constants of the $Ca^{2+}$-dependent transitions of the receptor from the rest state to the open and inactivated states. For this subset $\kappa = 1.1$ and VIF 1.0 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 44\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.88$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 38.1\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \le \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (45 test and 90 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 2.22 for the reduced model, 2.56 for the full model refitted to the same data and 1.37 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Weber_BMC2015

Feedback between protein kinase D (PKD), the ceramide transfer protein CERT and PI4KIII$\beta$ at the Golgi. Source: `doi:10.1186/s12918-015-0147-1`. The full model has 36 parameters, 5 of which are measurement calibration parameters (scales, offsets or noise levels) that are always re-estimated. The method selected two biological parameters, `s12` and `a21` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 81% fewer free parameters than the full one. `s12` is the constant production rate of PKD; `a21` is the first-order removal rate of PI4KIII$\beta$. For this subset $\kappa = 3.7$ and VIF 4.0 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 25\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.41$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 4.1\%$ at $\pm 5\%$: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \le \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to $\pm 50\%$.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (59 test and 76 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 1.00 for the reduced model, 15.95 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.99 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data much better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Zhao_QuantBiol2020

Model of the COVID-19 epidemic in China with unquarantined and quarantined infected individuals, in two stages and three regions. Source: PubMed 32219006. The full model has 28 parameters. The method selected three biological parameters, `R_Stage_I_China`, `R_Stage_II_Wuhan` and `gamma_1_Stage_I_Hubei` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 89% fewer free parameters than the full one. `R_Stage_I_China` and `R_Stage_II_Wuhan` are the reproduction numbers of stage I in China and of stage II in Wuhan, which set the infection rate; `gamma_1_Stage_I_Hubei` is the quarantine rate of infected individuals in Hubei in stage I. For this subset $\kappa = 1.2$ and VIF 1.0 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 69\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.90$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 29.6\%$

at ±5%: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 2 ($\cos\Delta \geq 0.9$ as well); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to ±50%.

External validation on held-out experimental conditions (25 test and 57 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 0.35 for the reduced model, 0.35 for the full model refitted to the same data and 0.35 for the published $\theta_0$. The two refitted models predict equally well. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

### Zheng_PNAS2012

Methylation of histone H3 at lysines 27 and 36 (combinatorial methylation states). Source: `doi:10.1073/pnas.1205707109`. The full model has 46 parameters. The method selected two biological parameters, `k01_02` and `k13_12` (stage 2, ranking by finite-perturbation effects); the reduced problem has 96% fewer free parameters than the full one. `k01_02` is the rate of methylation of K36 from mono- to dimethyl in histones without K27 methylation; `k13_12` is the rate of demethylation of K36 from tri- to dimethyl in histones with K27me1. For this subset $\kappa = 1.4$ and VIF 1.1 (no collinearity), $R_{\text{var}} = 35\%$, median $\cos\Delta = 0.57$ and median $e_{\text{fit}} = 30.0\%$ at ±5%: the reduced model reproduces the full one, with guarantee level 1 ($e_{\text{fit}} \leq \tau_e$ only); robustness pattern A: admissible at all perturbation sizes up to ±50%.

External validation on later time points ($t \geq 10$; 30 test and 30 training measurements): test $\chi^2/n$ 1.58 for the reduced model, 20.82 for the full model refitted to the same data and 1.51 for the published $\theta_0$. The reduced model, anchored at $\theta_0$, predicts the test data much better than the refitted full model. The hypotheses on the dynamics were verified in Lean (Supplementary Note *Verified benchmark models*).

## Supplementary Note: Concluding remarks

This Supplementary Information was written so that every claim of the main text can be traced to its source and checked independently. Supplementary Tables S1 and S2 give the subsets selected for each benchmark problem and the notation of the method, and Supplementary Note *Verification of the simulator* compares our simulation of the measured outputs with the reference simulations of the benchmark. Supplementary Note *Prediction of held-out experiments* and Supplementary Fig. S1 show the prediction of held-out experiments on an absolute scale. These materials connect the results reported in the paper with the data and code from which they were obtained.

The remaining material documents the formal verification and, just as importantly, its scope. Supplementary Fig. S3 and Supplementary Table S5 separate three levels of evidence: general mathematical guarantees proved in Lean 4 (G1–G4 and G6), hypotheses proved for specific models (G5), and numerical conditions computed in Python, on which the application of the guarantees to a particular result depends. Supplementary Table S4 and Supplementary Note *Logical sequence of the formal proofs* follow the 32 modules of the formalisation in the order in which they depend on each other, from the energy bound on the error of the reduced model and the relation between $\cos\Delta$ and the best rescaled fit, through the differentiability of ODE solutions with respect to the parameters, to certificates for ODE models and the hypotheses of the benchmark models; they also state what the proofs do not establish, such as identifiability of the full nonlinear models or the convergence of the numerical optimisation; for the selected parameters of the reduced problem, step 32 gives a sufficient condition for practical identifiability whose hypotheses are checked numerically at the computed profile points (Supplementary Note *Identifiability of the selected parameters*). Supplementary Note *Statements of the formal theorems* and Supplementary Tables S6 and S7 give the statement and meaning of each of the 304 theorems and lemmas, so that every formal statement can be compared with the mathematics it encodes. Supplemen-

tary Note *Verified benchmark models* and Supplementary Tables S8 and S9 show, model by model, the data on which the Lean kernel executed its checks, a complete worked example, an independent check that the translated equations agree with the SBML models, and the reasons why seven benchmark problems were not verified. Supplementary Note *Reproducibility package* explains how to reproduce all of this. The numerical analyses cited in the main text are documented in full: Supplementary Note *Verification of the simulator* compares our simulator with the reference simulations of the benchmark, Supplementary Note *Robustness to the size of parameter changes* gives the distribution of the fitting error over the paired random scenarios at every perturbation size, Supplementary Note *Synthetic prediction experiment* reports the prediction of held-out data when the truth is known, Supplementary Note *Single-parameter subsets* examines the minimum subset size of two parameters, a design choice (a single parameter is already admissible in 16 of 27 problems), Supplementary Note *Sensitivity to the method settings* gives the effect of every setting of the method on every problem, and Supplementary Note *Computational cost* the computational cost. Finally, Supplementary Note *The social cognitive theory model*, Supplementary Table S40 and Supplementary Fig. S15 document the social cognitive theory model that motivated the method: a small model with real data in which 22 parameters fit the data equally well with widely different values, and in which two parameters selected by the method reproduce the model and, anchored at the published values, predict the held-out week better than the full model. Supplementary Note *System-by-system summary* closes with a summary of each of the 34 benchmark problems: what the model describes, what the selected parameters mean in its reactions, how well the reduced model reproduces the full one and how it predicted held-out data.

Taken together, the formalisation establishes that the steps of the method are mathematically sound under explicit hypotheses and that 28 benchmark models satisfy the hypotheses on the dynamics; the numerical quantities reported in the paper are computed in floating point by the accompanying Python code, and the formal results state precisely which conclusions follow from them. Everything described here can be reproduced from the repository: the proofs compile with a single command, the supplementary tables and notes are generated from the Lean sources and the result files, and the analyses can be rerun from the published benchmark. We hope that this combination of a public benchmark, open code and machine-checked mathematics, together with a clear statement of what each part guarantees, makes the reduction method easy to verify, to reuse and to extend to other dynamical models.